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Democracy Dies in Darkness

MONDAY, SEPTEMBER 14, 2026 • \$4

NSA begins historic retooling of spy agency

Focus will be on priorities including AI, China and cybersecurity

BY ZACH DORFMAN,
WARREN P. STROBEL
AND NOAH ROBERTSON

The National Security Agency is set to undergo its most extensive internal restructuring in at least a decade, according to current and former officials briefed on the emerging plan.

The new design for one of the most powerful U.S. intelligence agencies, which was announced to senior NSA leaders last week, is the brainchild of Army Gen. Joshua M. Rudd, the NSA director, these officials said.

Rudd's initiative calls for the creation at NSA's Fort Meade, Maryland, headquarters of five new organizations inside the agency, in artificial intelligence, China, cybersecurity, combat support or warfighting, and global intelligence. Each will be led by a newly elevated "mission director," according to former officials.

This new organizational configuration will better reflect NSA's current and future priorities, Rudd believes, according to current and former officials. NSA, the U.S. intelligence community's premier global eavesdropping arm, specializes in digital espionage.

The mission heads will have the "effective" authorities of an NSA deputy director, according to one former official familiar with the plan. This former official, like others in this article, spoke on the condition of anonymity.

SEE NSA ON A6

Some Canadians shun U.S. over Trump

BY JOANNA SLATER

TORONTO — On a recent morning, Francine Piché sat at her desk in a city on the western end of Lake Ontario and began writing a farewell note.

She had already registered her opposition to President Donald Trump's threats to annex Canada in other ways. Trips to the U.S. were out. So was her Amazon subscription. She found a substitute for her American-made shampoo and checked each item at the grocery store to avoid imports from south of the border.

Just one thing remained, a product she had loved for years: Bob's Red Mill gluten-free pancake mix. But as tensions surged between the U.S. and Canada — including a White House executive order changing the name of Lake Ontario to Lake America — it was time to bid adieu to that, too.

These products "will no longer enter my home," Piché wrote in an email to Bob's Red Mill on Sept. 1. She hoped to be a customer again one day, she said, but that wouldn't happen until the relationship between the two countries stabilizes and "your President understands that Canada is a sovereign nation."

Piché isn't alone. Other Canadians across the country are also going to increasing lengths to disentangle themselves from

SEE CANADA ON A11

Victory eludes Commanders in opener



MATT SLOCUM/AP

Eagles quarterback Jalen Hurts is grabbed by Commanders cornerback Amik Robertson (2) as he scrambles during Sunday's regular season opener. The Commanders lost, 24-22, in Philadelphia. **Story, C1**

Kennedy Center could close as early as Tuesday

BY JONATHAN EDWARDS
AND TRAVIS M. ANDREWS

Leaders of the John F. Kennedy Center for the Performing Arts, installed by President Donald Trump, say the center is on the brink of bankruptcy and argue that putting the president's name on its facade — and thus ensuring his fundraising efforts — may be the only way to avoid imminent and "certain fiscal collapse," according to documents

Officials say institution is facing 'certain fiscal collapse' within weeks

obtained by The Washington Post.

The bleak assessment is laid out in a 57-page packet distributed to the center's board of trustees ahead of a special meeting

Tuesday, when the Trump-led board is scheduled to consider two resolutions aimed at addressing twin crises confronting the national performing arts center: one financial, the other physical. Center officials say they could be unable to make payroll or pay routine maintenance contracts "within a matter of weeks" and argue that publicly recognizing Trump could secure his help raising enough money to keep the institution afloat.

Center officials are also recommending that the board close its main building immediately, warning that remaining open would endanger lives. Board approval, which seems likely, means the center could close as early as Tuesday.

The presentation makes clear that Trump's support hinges on getting public credit for his involvement. The financial resolution says Trump has offered

SEE KENNEDY CENTER ON A8

Al-Qaeda regroups in Afghanistan, 25 years after 9/11 attacks

BY GREG MILLER

Al-Qaeda's plans for the Sept. 11, 2001, attacks took root in dusty, mud-walled compounds in Afghanistan that served for years as terrorist training camps.

A quarter-century later — despite decades of U.S. military and counterterrorism operations aimed at eradicating those strongholds — al-Qaeda is again

operating training camps in Afghanistan, according to U.S. and Western intelligence officials and a United Nations organization responsible for monitoring terrorist networks.

The terrorist organization and its offshoots have set up at least eight training sites over the past three years, taking advantage of the Taliban's return to power in Kabul and the security void cre-

ated by the 2021 U.S. military withdrawal, according to U.N. reports and security officials.

Other terrorist groups, including an affiliate of the Islamic State, al-Qaeda's main rival, also have set up new training sites, officials said, giving militant Islamist groups a foothold in at least 14 of Afghanistan's 34 provinces.

These officials and others in this article spoke on the condi-

tion of anonymity to discuss intelligence matters.

Because the Taliban has again provided "a permissive environment," a U.N. report said, al-Qaeda has been able "to consolidate, with the presence of safe houses and training camps across Afghanistan."

There are notable differences from the pre-9/11 period, officials and counterterrorism experts

said.

The groups now training in Afghanistan seem more focused on regional fights than mounting elaborate plots against the United States or its allies. They appear to be constrained by Taliban hosts wary of again drawing the wrath of global powers. And with al-Qaeda's top leaders still believed to be hiding in Iran or

SEE AL-QAEDA ON A12



MATTHEW STOCKMAN/GETTY IMAGES

Zverev extends U.S. major drought

Alexander Zverev of Germany beat Ben Shelton of the United States, 6-3, 7-6 (7-2), 5-7, 6-2, on Sunday in the U.S. Open men's final. No American man has won a major since 2003. **Story, C1**

Calls to keep Grand Canyon trail closed went unheeded

Park officials warned about fire-damaged route before flash flooding

BY BRIANNA SACKS,
N. KIRKPATRICK
AND JAKE SPRING

Before a deadly flash flood tore through the Grand Canyon at the end of August, several National Park Service officials repeatedly pressed for parts of the fire-damaged trail to be closed, according to four current and former agency officials, calling out the heightened risk of runoff and rock slides that could endanger people.

But leaders above them ultimately decided to reopen the North Kaibab Trail in time for peak tourist season, said two former National Park Service

officials with knowledge of the situation, and one former and one current official briefed on the matter. Those decisions were made, they said, amid ongoing pressure from lawmakers to keep the park fully operational.

"There were a lot of us at the boots-on-the-ground level, the people who were really kind of looking at it, really having some concerns," said Robert Parrish, who served as chief of planning, environment and projects at the Grand Canyon from December 2020 through early October 2025. "But then once those got filtered up, and we were getting what the political pressure was filtered down, it was quite evident that the political pressure was going to win."

On July 4, 2025, the Dragon Bravo Fire ignited within Grand Canyon National Park and burned nearly 150,000 acres, including 106 structures and por-

SEE GRAND CANYON ON A7

IN THE NEWS

Another aviation accident Rep. Tom Tiffany of Wisconsin says he swam to safety after the plane he was on lost power and made an emergency landing in a lake. **A2**

'Murder for hire' Maryland authorities piece together GPS data, phone records and surveillance videos to catch an alleged hit man. **C8**

THE NATION
Pennsylvania woman died from complications of a probable measles case, coroner says. **A6**
David Crowley defied long odds to become the Democratic Party's nominee for governor of Wisconsin. **A4**

THE WORLD
President Donald Trump's remark that reunification would be "fantastic" for Ireland ignites fierce debate. **A11**
Oman, a key mediator in the war with Iran, is baffled by recent threats of U.S. force. **A9**

THE ECONOMY
NYU mathematician Tristan Buckmaster questions whether a huge AI breakthrough came from his work. **A13**
Gavin Newsom, the Democratic governor of California, has signed a ban on "addictive" social media features for children under 16. **A13**

STYLE
CDs are back in vogue, outpacing growth in vinyl sales, according to a new report. For some, it's nostalgia; for others, it's superior sound. **B1**

SPORTS
Jake Irvin came out of the bullpen to pitch well and help the Nationals sweep the Angels. **C1**

THE REGION
D.C. Council member Trayon White Sr. faces up to 15 years in prison if he is convicted of accepting cash from a city contractor. **C8**

HEALTH & SCIENCE
You have an itch you're trying not to scratch. A new study suggests that only makes it worse.

BUSINESS NEWS.....A13
COMICS.....B4
OBITUARIES.....C11
OPINION PAGES.....A14
TELEVISION.....B6
WORLD NEWS.....A9

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Tiffany says he swam to safety after emergency landing

BY SAMMY WESTFALL

Rep. Tom Tiffany, the Republican nominee for governor in Wisconsin, said he swam to safety and suffered minor injuries after a plane made an emergency landing in a lake Saturday.

As he headed home from the La Crosse County Lincoln Day Dinner in Onalaska, Wisconsin, the Beechcraft K35 plane in which Tiffany was traveling lost power as it approached the Wausau Downtown Airport, he said. The pilot made an emergency water landing in nearby Lake Wausau.

"After landing, we called 911. As the plane began to submerge, we exited the aircraft and swam to a shallow area, where we

waited until emergency responders reached us by boat," Tiffany, 68, wrote on social media. Two people were on board, Tiffany and the pilot, and both suffered minor injuries, he said.

Tiffany suffered a laceration above his right eye that required stitches, his campaign for Wisconsin governor said in a statement Sunday. Both the congressman and the pilot have been released from the hospital.

"God was watching over us tonight. ... An experience like this reminds you just how precious life is," he wrote, adding that he was grateful to be in the hospital with his wife by his side.

The Federal Aviation Administration said in a statement it was investigating. Tiffany's



Rep. Tom Tiffany, the GOP nominee for governor in Wisconsin, was traveling in a plane that went down in a lake on Saturday.

campaign said the National Transportation Safety Board was also helping investigate. The Wausau Downtown Airport did not immediately respond to requests for comment.

Justin Pluess, deputy fire chief of the Wausau Fire Department, said the county's emergency dispatchers received a report of an aircraft going down on the lake about 8:50 p.m. on Saturday.

The department transported the plane's two occupants via airboat from the water to the shore, it said.

The plane remains in Lake Wausau, and boaters have been advised to avoid the area until it is safely removed, the department said Sunday morning.

"Tom wants to thank everyone across Wisconsin and

around the country who has reached out with prayers and kind words. He and his family deeply appreciate the outpouring of support they have received," Tiffany's campaign statement said.

Tiffany, a congressman from Wisconsin's rural north, faces Democratic nominee David Crowley, the top elected official in Milwaukee County, in the Nov. 3 election.

Crowley posted on X that he was "grateful to God that Congressman Tiffany and no one else was hurt in this horrifying incident, which could have been a tragedy if not for the heroism of the pilot."

He said he wished the pilot and the congressman a "quick recovery."

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It's the most common aviation accident. Can it be stopped?

Miami crash highlights the unusual challenges of a runway plane

BY TODD C. FRANKEL

On a foggy, rainy day in 1984, a Scandinavian Airlines flight from Oslo overshot the runway while landing at John F. Kennedy International Airport in New York. The DC-10 skidded 600 feet off the pavement and plunged into a frigid creek, forcing some passengers to swim to safety. But the 177 people on board escaped without any fatalities.

That's when Pam Phillips got the assignment of a lifetime: Stop this from happening again. Phillips worked in technical support for the four airports run by the Port Authority of New York and New Jersey, including JFK. And JFK was a tricky case: It was hemmed in by dense housing and open water. She couldn't just add more space after the runway to stop a plane from hitting the water.

So Phillips assembled a group of experts — some from the aviation world, but also professors who studied runaway truck ramps and an official from Britain who worked on runaway trains. The idea she and others came up with would eventually lead to changes at airports nationwide.

"I was nervous about taking on such a daunting project," Phillips recalled.

This is how aviation safety is supposed to work. Investigators dig into what caused an accident and others figure out how to prevent it from happening again. But there's not always an absolute solution.

The National Transportation Safety Board is looking into the Sept. 6 crash of an Amazon-branded cargo plane, which overran the runway at Miami International Airport by 1,300 feet, slamming into two vehicles and killing five people on the ground. The NTSB appears to be focused on the plane's speed and pilot decision-making. But another issue is whether there was anything more the airport could have done to stop the plane.

Runway excursions, as they're called, occur more frequently than any other kind of aviation accident — more than midflight loss of control or crashing into the ground, according to the International Air Transport Association. There are on average about 10 accidents a year worldwide. The International Civil Aviation Organization considers runway excursions to be one of its five global high-risk categories of accidents.

"It's been an issue for a number of years," said Hassan Shahidi, president of the nonprofit Flight Safety Foundation.

Runaway planes have bedeviled aviation experts, in part, because they can be caused by so many different factors. The points of failure can include pilot error, surprise tailwinds and rain-slick runways. Often multiple factors are at play.

In May, the NTSB called for changes to how landing distances on wet runways are calculated, saying the agency studied 11 runway overrun incidents and found the matrix sometimes failed to predict how heavy rain-fall affected braking.

"We are never going to be able to get to zero" accidents, said Manuel Ayres, an airport engineer who has spent years researching this type of crash. "It's just not feasible."

In the U.S., accident prevention has centered on giving airplanes more room for things to go wrong. Most major airports are required to have flat, unob-



DAVID SANTIAGO/AP

The wreckage of an Amazon cargo plane that overshot the runway at Miami International Airport on Sept. 6. Five people were killed.



CHARLES REX ARBOGAST/AP

Inspectors walk around the damaged engine of a Southwest Airlines plane after it skidded off the runway in Chicago in December 2005. It crashed through two fences and collided with a car on a nearby road, killing a 6-year-old boy inside the vehicle.

structed areas surrounding each runway. FAA standards generally call for runway safety areas that extend 1,000 feet beyond a runway and 250 feet along both sides.

A Miami airport official said its relevant runway has the required safety area and "has consistently met federal airfield safety requirements."

But some airports lack room. That was the problem at JFK.

After the 1984 crash, Phillips brought together officials from the FAA and experts from the University of Dayton to design a way to quickly slow massive

commercial jets. And they needed to find a surface that could do that without severely damaging an aircraft.

They tried rigid planks of home insulation foam, Phillips said. Those caught fire too easily. Then they tried aerated cement. They ran a test with a rolling airplane to see how it crushed the surface. That did the trick.

"It was like driving off the road into sand," Phillips said.

Their creation was called the Engineered Materials Arresting System, known as EMAS.

In 1996, JFK installed the nation's first EMAS. It was placed

on the same runway that the Scandinavian Airlines jet overshot. Three years later, an American Eagle flight ran off the runway, but the jet was stopped by the new 400-foot-long EMAS. The NTSB later determined that without the special surface, the plane and the 30 people on board would've ended up in the surrounding creek.

But the push for these systems at other airports was slow to build.

That began to change after a fatal runway overrun in Little Rock in 1999. The FAA created a program to identify and work on deficient runway safety areas.

Two high-profile accidents in 2005 added more urgency.

The first was at Teterboro Airport in New Jersey, where a business jet failed to take off and instead left the runway going about 126 mph. The plane crashed through a fence, crossed a highway and then struck a car and building. No one died.

Then, on a snowy day in December, a Southwest flight overran a runway at Chicago Midway International Airport. It crashed through two fences and collided with a car on a nearby road, killing a 6-year-old boy inside the vehicle.

The NTSB investigation revealed that one year before the crash, the FAA and Chicago airport officials had discussed ways to improve Midway's run-

way safety areas, but no action was taken. A simulation found an installed EMAS could have stopped the Southwest jet, the NTSB said.

In 2006, a frustrated Congress and the FAA funded a massive program to address runway safety areas at airports nationwide. The FAA distributed about \$3 billion over the next decade to improve approximately 1,000 runways at more than 500 airports.

So far, 26 planes have been stopped by EMAS at U.S. airports, according to the FAA, including twice at Teterboro Airport, which had the stop pads installed after the 2005 crash there. The FAA list also includes a jet in 2016 that overshot a LaGuardia Airport runway in New York while carrying Mike Pence, then the vice-presidential nominee.

The FAA does not keep a comparable count for runway safety areas.

But neither of these safety systems is designed to stop every runaway plane.

The dimensions reflect historical accident patterns, not a guarantee.

FAA research looked at previous incidents and found that 90 percent of air-carrier overruns stopped within 1,000 feet and that roughly 90 percent of aircraft left the runway at 70 knots — about 80 mph — or less. A standard EMAS installation is designed to stop most aircraft entering at that speed.

Ayres, who has studied runway excursions, calculated for a previous study that adding 600 feet to the 1,000-foot buffer would reduce the probability of escaping the zone during a landing from 5.5 percent to 1 percent.

"It's about what's feasible," Ayres said. "You can increase it up to 3,000 feet and you will still have problems. And it will cost billions of dollars."

The current standard works, he said.

"It's an acceptable risk."

In the Miami crash, the Amazon-branded cargo plane was traveling about 130 mph when it ran off Runway 30, according to Flightradar24 tracking data.

The NTSB said the plane traveled 1,300 feet beyond the runway.

The jet's speed and distance traveled meant it likely would've blown through the tools meant to stop runaway planes.



DAVID PICKOFF/AP

A Scandinavian Airlines jet sits in a creek after skidding off a runway at John F. Kennedy International Airport in 1984. The DC-10 skidded 600 feet off the pavement and plunged into a frigid creek.

THE NATION

Canada trade war hits GOP in battleground states

Candidates in competitive races tread lightly as local industries brace for tariffs

BY RILEY BEGGIN

A handful of U.S. states with some of the most competitive congressional races in the country are caught in the crosshairs of President Donald Trump's escalating trade war with Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney.

While the average American may not feel the tariffs — all told, they affect just 6 percent of \$715 billion in annual cross-border trade — key industries in Maine, Michigan, Iowa, Ohio and Pennsylvania are likely to feel the added costs.

That may present an unwelcome complication for Republicans running in competitive House and Senate races in those states, multiple GOP analysts said, distracting from their preferred economic message of lower income taxes, new child investment accounts and tax breaks for businesses, seniors, overtime pay and tips.

“Donald Trump was elected in part to bring down inflation and juice the economy,” said Whit Ayres, a Republican political consultant in Washington. “Anything that works opposite of those goals is not helpful for any Republican running this year.”

Brent Buchanan, founder of the Republican polling firm Cygnal, said the trade war could offer candidates an opportunity to separate themselves from the president, whose approval ratings have dropped as gas prices have risen as a result of his war with Iran.

“With this being so salient to the states closer to the Canadian border, it’s a way for them to say, ‘I’m standing up for you — above the president, above Congress,

above Canada, above anybody,’” Buchanan said.

While Sen. Susan Collins (R-Maine) has taken that approach, calling Trump’s trade war with Canada a “mistake,” other candidates in competitive races have been more cautious. And at least one Republican running in a competitive district has wholly embraced Trump’s trade policy.

Canada has been “jamming our dairy industry for a long period of time,” Rep. Derrick Van Orden (R-Wisconsin), whose race for reelection is considered a toss-up, said in an interview at last week’s Republican midterm convention in Dallas. “The time for the American farmer and my Wisconsin farmers to get worked over by Canada, those days are over.”

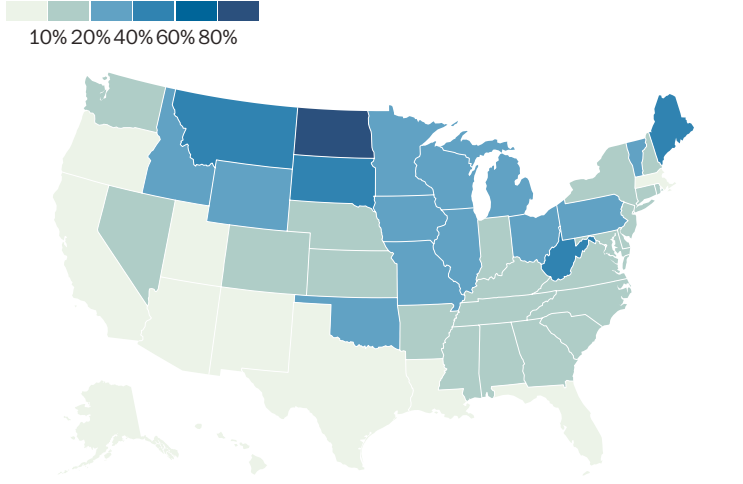
The White House argued that Trump’s tariffs on Canada will help American workers, especially in Midwestern states where he has won big.

“America’s heartland states like Michigan and Iowa have been some of the worst hit by unfair foreign trade practices, including by Canada, and were resoundingly won by President Trump because of his pledge to put American workers, farmers, and businesses first,” White House spokesman Kush Desai said in a statement.

Adding that Canada rejected “the best trade deal” of any U.S. trading partner, Desai said: “President Trump will never waver from putting Americans and America First.”

The United States and Canada have been strong allies and top trading partners for decades. Proximity and favorable trade policies between the two nations have fostered deeply integrated industries across northern states that swap energy, parts and supplies with nearby Canadian provinces. Several Michigan auto suppliers and Maine lumber companies have locations on

Share of state exports to Canada in 2025



Source: U.S. Census Bureau

RILEY BEGGIN AND LUIS MELGAR / THE WASHINGTON POST

both sides of the border. Iowa has close agricultural trade ties with Canada, including exports of farm machinery.

The tit-for-tat trade war between the two nations ramped up in July, when Trump announced that he would impose 50 percent tariffs on some Canadian goods — a move the administration cast as a response to Canadian retaliation to Trump’s “Liberation Day” tariffs imposed in April 2025.

The new 50 percent tariffs took effect late last month after negotiations between the two countries collapsed; alcohol, dairy products and a long list of other Canadian imports were hit with the added fee.

Canada retaliated on Sept. 8 with new tariffs on U.S. goods, including aluminum, dairy, agricultural equipment, plastics, paper products and appliances. That night, Trump announced he would ban the import of some Canadian alcohol, motorcycles, molasses and other products beginning Sept. 29.

The latest import ban is unlikely to have much effect on either country’s economy, Stephen Brown, a chief economist

at the research firm Capital Economics, wrote in an analyst note Wednesday. But the move shows that recent measures are “about inflicting economic pain rather than raising revenue” and increases the risk that the United States-Mexico-Canada Agreement (USMCA) — the trade agreement Trump brokered in his first term — will break down entirely.

The escalation also indicates that the tariffs may remain in place longer than analysts initially expected, Brown wrote, noting that the Canadian tariffs “appear to have been chosen in a way to disproportionately affect the swing states ahead of the midterms.”

Canada consumes more than a quarter of all exports from Maine, Michigan, Ohio, Iowa, Wisconsin and Pennsylvania, according to 2025 U.S. Census Bureau data. Maine, Alaska, Iowa and Michigan are also major importers of Canadian goods.

Michigan, Maine, Ohio, Iowa and Alaska are home to highly competitive Senate races. Texas, which also has a competitive Senate race, does more than \$69 billion in trade annually with

Canada, though it’s a small share of the state’s overall imports and exports. Many of the affected states also have competitive House or gubernatorial races.

Michigan, which did more than \$66 billion in trade with Canada last year, has a closely intertwined manufacturing sector that regularly exchanges products with its neighboring province, Ontario.

Canadian tariffs on American steel and aluminum, nuts and bolts, rods for steering wheels and other small parts can boost costs for manufacturers who are already worn out after years of supply chain disruptions from the covid-19 pandemic and changing federal policy on electric vehicles.

“I think we reached fatigue about a month ago,” said Glenn Stevens, executive director of MichAuto, an advocacy group for the state’s auto industry. “It’s a difficult business.”

Maine’s lobster industry was spared a big blow when Canada removed seafood from its initial list of tariffed products. But the state will be hit with Canadian tariffs on plywood, paper and other forest products.

Patrick Woodcock, president and CEO of the Maine State Chamber of Commerce, said Maine businesses appreciate any administration trying to achieve strong trade deals. But as in Michigan, Maine has developed an integrated economy with its northern neighbor over generations of swapping raw materials with processing plants on both sides of the border.

“We have this understanding that there’s a winner” in a trade war, Woodcock said. “And for some of these industries, neither side wins. The more this escalates, I think that’s going to reveal itself.”

In Iowa, Canada’s tariffs on farm equipment can affect the state’s processors and manufacturers, said Sunghun Lim, an

economist at Iowa State University specializing in agricultural trade and policy.

Though Iowa’s major exports to Canada — soybeans, pork and corn — are not subject to tariffs, there’s growing concern in farm country that the trade friction could lead to the collapse of USMCA, said Christopher Pudenz, an economist at the Iowa Farm Bureau. “This trade agreement that has been so beneficial to Iowa’s agricultural producers could be fundamentally changed in a negative way,” he said.

GOP candidates have responded differently to the pressure. Collins, who faces her toughest race in years against former state Senate president Troy Jackson (D), has openly opposed the Trump administration’s tariffs. She said she has also worked with trade officials in both countries to get Canadian road salt and cement excluded from U.S. tariffs and Maine seafood removed from Canadian tariffs.

Michigan Senate candidate Mike Rogers, who is running for an open seat against Democrat Abdul El-Sayed, has been mildly critical. In late August, Rogers wrote in a post on X that Trump “is right to put America First” but that “trade isn’t one-size-fits-all.” He pledged to work with Trump “to broker a fair deal with Canada” that supports Michigan farms, automakers and manufacturing.

For Republican candidates, the chaotic trade war “injects an issue they probably thought they never had to deal with,” said John Truscott, founder of Michigan PR firm Truscott Rossman and who once served as a spokesperson for Michigan Gov. John Engler (R).

“As a candidate, when you want to be on offense on things,” Truscott said. “This adds a vulnerability.”

Luis Melgar and Jarrell Dillard contributed to this report.

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A stunning political upset isn’t his most unlikely story

David Crowley had a surprising path to becoming the Democratic nominee for governor of Wisconsin, but it was nothing compared to his life before politics

BY KAREN TUMULTY

MADISON, WIS. — David Crowley, the Democratic nominee for Wisconsin governor, ranks as the most surprising winner in this year’s turbulent primary season. But the Milwaukee County executive’s against-the-odds story began long before election night.

Crowley’s parents became addicted to crack cocaine, and his family was evicted three times before he graduated high school. At times, he and his two brothers lived with no electricity or heat.

He spent his first 10 years in northern Milwaukee’s 53206 Zip code, long infamous for having one of the nation’s highest incarceration rates. By the time Black men there reach the age of 35, “half of us growing up in that Zip code would have spent some time behind bars,” said Milwaukee Mayor Cavalier Johnson, who was a year behind Crowley in high school.

His personal history has not gotten much attention outside of Milwaukee, having been overshadowed by the wild, 34-day stretch before Wisconsin’s Aug. 11 primary.

In less than five weeks, Crowley left the race, saying he saw no path to victory; endorsed the presumed front-runner, only to see her drop out amid controversy a week later; then jumped back into the contest with the backing of Gov. Tony Evers (D). Finally, and most astonishingly, Crowley closed a double-digit gap in pre-election polls to defeat a high-profile democratic socialist by half a percentage point.

Now, the 40-year-old chief executive of Wisconsin’s most populous county could make history in November by becoming the state’s first Black governor.

None of that would have seemed like what destiny had in mind for Crowley. His first home was one his father, a master electrician, bought from the city for \$1 in 1984 and restored. His vicious mother worked various jobs, including as a waitress and bartender.

But as both became hooked on crack, the family’s situation spiraled.

His mother abandoned the boys and their father for a couple of years. She returned, still in the grip of drugs and mental illness, and Crowley’s father moved out to try to put his own life back together. After eighth grade, Crowley got a job with a lawn maintenance company, he said, because it was “the only way that I was going to buy my own clothes, buy my own shoes.”

The third time the family was evicted, Crowley, a high school sophomore, came home to find their meager possessions on the sidewalk. Their former house on North 23rd Street was eventually demolished and is now a vacant lot.

His father overcame his addiction during Crowley’s early high school years, while “my mother took a little more time,” he said. “But you know, watching them go through what they went through, their challenges, helped me understand resilience.”

As a politician, Crowley tends to frame issues in technocratic policy terms. He speaks of how “housing instability” is a “critical social determinant.” But he roots his priorities in the scorching experiences of his life. “How can you focus on your own education?” he said. “How can you focus on your own health care or job opportunities when you don’t know where you’re going to lay your head down at night?”

Unknown to many voters

At a time when the Democratic Party is beset by fierce ideological struggles, Crowley prides himself on pulling factions together.

A second-term assemblyman when he ran for county executive in a nonpartisan election six years ago, Crowley eked out a narrow victory over a better-known, more liberal rival to become the youngest-ever and first Black executive in a county that is more than 60 percent White. One of his predecessors in the job was Scott Walker, Wisconsin’s famously hardline-conservative former governor.

In 2024, Crowley cruised to reelection with 85 percent of the vote. He carried the poorest wards and the richest, the majority-Black and majority-White, the most Democratic and most Republican.

That same improbable coalition fueled his primary win in the Democratic primary for governor, but he has yet to be tested against a Republican opponent.



TAYLOR GLASCOCK/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

David Crowley dropped out of the primary, jumped back in and, despite a huge deficit in pre-election polls, won by half a percentage point.

“At that moment, it wasn’t about us forgiving her; it was about her forgiving herself.”

David Crowley, speaking about his mother, who battled addiction and abandoned her boys and their father for a couple of years

As county executive, Crowley put together tens of millions in private and government funding to build affordable housing developments in Milwaukee’s suburbs, something that had never happened before.

He also secured a near-doubling of the county sales tax, from 0.5 percent to 0.9 percent. The increase was part of a budget deal with the tightfisted, Republican-controlled legislature, averting drastic service cuts that would have included eliminating half of the Milwaukee County Transit System’s bus routes. That bargain is now being tested on the campaign trail, where Republicans are hammering him for raising taxes.

But even after Crowley achieved his stunning primary upset over democratic socialist Francesca Hong in the Aug. 11 primary, he remains unknown to many in the Badger State. A late-August Marquette poll found close to 40 percent of likely voters said they didn’t know enough about him to have an opinion, more than double the percentage who said that about his Republican rival, three-term congressman Tom Tiffany.

Tiffany, who faced no significant primary opposition, has been endorsed by President Donald Trump and supported Trump’s false claim that the 2020 election was stolen. He signed onto a lawsuit that would have thrown out Wisconsin’s electoral votes in favor of having the legislature pick the winner.

Having assumed along with the rest of the political world that he would be running against Hong, Tiffany is rushing to paint Crowley with the radical-left tag Republicans had planned to use

against her. The GOP nominee’s first general election attack ad against Crowley claimed there is “no real difference between him and socialists.” He has also referred his opponent as “Milwaukee County tax collector David Crowley.”

Tiffany is also trying to flank Crowley on the flash point issue of data centers, branding him “Data Center David Crowley.” One Tiffany ad features a selectively cut video clip in which Crowley says Wisconsin has an opportunity to become “an AI and a data hub not only for the entire country, but for the entire globe.”

Tiffany’s campaign did not respond to a request for an interview.

While opposing a moratorium on data centers, Crowley has said local communities should have the final say on where they are located, that they must follow environmental safeguards and contribute to bringing down utility rates.

He faces a separate challenge in unifying his own party after the divisive primary. Hong began campaigning on Crowley’s behalf within days of losing to him.

In the 2024 presidential election, Wisconsin was the most closely divided state in the

country, with Trump winning by a mere 0.86 percent, or less than 30,000 votes. But it is less a purple state than one that is both red and blue, electing one of most conservative members of the U.S. Senate, Republican Ron Johnson, and one of the most liberal, Democrat Tammy Baldwin.

Wisconsin elections tend to be “a tie, and the ball bounces one way or the other at the end,” said former state Democratic chairman Mike Tate.

Evers, the Democratic governor, whose 11th-hour backing of Crowley fueled his primary win, continues to advise him. “At the end of the day, in Wisconsin, you have to spend your time in all 72 counties and talk to people directly, making sure that you’re listening at the same time,” Evers, who did not seek a third term, said in an interview. “That’s how you win. I know that, and he knows that.”

‘Your name is David’

Though fate didn’t throw many breaks to young David Crowley, something transformative came his way in 2002.

It happened in the raucous lunchroom of Bay View High School. Reggie Moore, who with his future wife Sharlen founded a new youth-development group called Urban Underground, was

at a table with informational brochures and applications when he laid eyes on a lively 10th-grader holding court with his friends.

Moore summoned Crowley, he recalled, “and he’s kind of like, ‘Okay, what is this?’”

Urban Underground’s after-school program gave him direction and mentorship, and helped him understand the world around him, Crowley later recalled. “It taught me how to love myself, how to love my community, and it just changed my life,” he said in an August interview on the podcast “Milwaukee Uncut.”

Crowley became especially interested in criminal justice, having grown up seeing how Black men were treated under the existing system. Moore urged him to learn the history of the civil rights movement and impressed upon him that “policies make a difference and leadership makes a difference.”

Building self-worth was central to the program. Crowley was known in high school as “Dirty,” a reference to his skin tone. “No,” Sharlen Moore, now a Milwaukee alderwoman, admonished when she heard him answer to that nickname. “Your name is David.”

The Moores saw other worrisome signals. Crowley sometimes showed up late to meetings — or missed them entirely — because he had no transportation. They stepped in where they could; some nights, he slept on Sharlen’s couch.

“It was very clear that David had power, he had leadership, he had agency. However, the conditions in our lives — trauma, exposure to violence — all of those

things can impact and suppress the best things about us,” said Reggie Moore, who went on to lead Milwaukee’s Office of Violence Prevention.

Though still in high school, Crowley left home two weeks after his 18th birthday. After graduating in 2004, he joined Public Allies, an AmeriCorps program aimed at developing young leaders in poor and minority communities. (Former first lady Michelle Obama founded the Chicago Public Allies chapter in 1993, and called it “the best job I ever had.”) Crowley helped former inmates find jobs and housing, worked in an alcohol and drug program and did community engagement for a YMCA.

In 2006, he enrolled at the University of Wisconsin at Milwaukee, but dropped out after his first semester to pursue an electrical apprenticeship because his girlfriend was pregnant. He assumed he was starting a family — until six months later, when a paternity test showed he was not the father.

Crowley was devastated, and once again, looking for his life’s direction.

In 2010, he went to work for Sen. Russell Feingold’s reelection campaign. It was a disastrous year for Democrats and Feingold was among the casualties. But for Crowley, the experience widened his lens. He loved political organizing and discovered he was good at it.

‘Mom, we forgive you’

Crowley took a job as a legislative aide to Milwaukee County Supervisor Nikiya Harris Dodd. When she was elected to the state Senate in 2012, he followed her to Madison as her policy director.

By then, both his parents had gotten sober, and each would remarry. When his mother developed blood clots after a hysterectomy, Crowley stayed with her as she recovered and commuted 80 miles each way to work. For the first time, the two of them discussed the brokenness of their shared past.

As he began to understand the depth of his mother’s guilt over what she had put her sons through, Crowley’s anger at what had happened in those years finally began to lift. He realized they all had some healing to do. “Hearing the pain in my mother, hearing the sorrow, hearing the depression from our growing up — when I heard that, it moved me,” he said. “I told her: ‘Mom, we forgive you.’”

He added: “At that moment, it wasn’t about us forgiving her; it was about her forgiving herself.” Crowley also decided it was time to repair his relationship with his father. His mother, Valerie Crowley, died in 2023; he remains close to his father, who is also named David.

Crowley ran for office in the spring of 2016, seeking a spot on Milwaukee’s City Council. He came in third. A month later, he ran again, for a seat in the legislature, and won.

Three days after losing his first race, Crowley married Ericka Bowen. They had met two years before, when she interviewed him at a Starbucks for a magazine article she was writing.

As he took a risky leap toward elected office, Bowen paid the bills so that he could take a leave from his job. Together, they have raised her daughter from a previous relationship, and have two of their own.

In December 2024, Crowley gave the fall commencement address at the University of Wisconsin at Milwaukee. It would not have been remarkable except for a bit of unfinished business: Nearly two decades after dropping out of that institution, he crossed the stage to receive a bachelor’s of science in community engagement and education.

While working full time as county executive, Crowley spent the past three years attending classes and doing hours of homework nearly every night.

“I’ve learned a lot on this path — sometimes the hard way, sometimes the easy way — but always with the intention of setting a better example for my three daughters,” he told his fellow graduates. “When I decided to return to school, I wanted my kids to know that it’s okay to start over, to reinvent yourself, and to challenge yourself — even when life feels overwhelming.”

Crowley added: “We all have the ability to create the life we want.” But for some, building that life means writing their own comeback story — again and again and again.



KAYLA WOLF/AP

Voters arrive to cast their ballots at Charles Allis Art Museum in Milwaukee on Aug. 11. Crowley pulled off an unlikely upset that day.

Democrat’s ad injects abortion into tight governor’s race

Gina Hinojosa decided to give birth despite her child’s fatal genetic anomaly. Though her ad doesn’t say it, Texas abortion laws no longer allow women that choice.

BY MOLLY HENNESSY-FISKE

HOUSTON — A personal campaign ad from the Democratic candidate for governor has introduced Texas’ strict antiabortion laws into a competitive race — without ever mentioning the word abortion.

State Rep. Gina Hinojosa, who is running against three-term Republican incumbent Greg Abbott, recently released an ad called “Her Story,” in which she recounts the difficult decision she and her husband made 23 years ago to continue her first pregnancy even after genetic testing revealed a fetal anomaly.

“My husband and I were overjoyed, expecting our first until an unimaginable diagnosis,” Hinojosa says in the ad, which first aired Aug. 31. “The doctor said, ‘I need you to understand, she’s not going to live.’”

“I did understand, but I was making that choice. I chose her,” Hinojosa says in the ad. “Born shortly after her due date, she didn’t make it.”

Though Hinojosa, 52, does not mention abortion rights in the 60-second spot, focusing instead on how the ordeal would later inspire her to fight for her constituents, her use of the word “choice” resonates clearly in a state that has passed some of the strictest antiabortion laws in the country.

Abortions are banned after six weeks of pregnancy with no exception for rape, incest or fetal anomalies. State law bars people from mailing or distributing abortion pills, and doctors can be prosecuted criminally and civilly for performing abortions.

Hinojosa, who is Catholic, voted against the state abortion ban and other antiabortion measures during nine years representing a liberal Austin district. She first shared the story of her pregnancy loss five years ago on the floor of the legislature while fighting the state ban. Under the ban, Hinojosa would not have had a choice to terminate her pregnancy.

Abbott, who is also Catholic, has shared his own story of adopting his now 29-year-old



GABRIEL V. CARDENAS/REUTERS

Gina Hinojosa, a state representative and Democratic nominee for Texas governor, does not mention abortion rights in the 60-second spot.

daughter from a woman who chose not to have an abortion after visiting a crisis pregnancy center. He’s signed numerous antiabortion measures into law, including the state’s effective ban on abortions.

Political observers from both parties say Hinojosa’s ad has the potential to sway swing voters in a tight race. Recent polls put Hinojosa within a percentage point of Abbott, who is facing growing dissatisfaction — including from his conservative base — over data centers, public school vouchers and the economy.

Manny Garcia, an Austin-based Democrat strategist, said the ad taps into frustration among Texas voters.

“It shows the real-life concern of what people actually go through, especially in an area

with reduced access to health care services, dealing with a Republican regime that has made it harder for women to talk to their doctors and for doctors to be able to provide services,” he said.

Even some conservative political experts said the ad would probably have an effect on voters, particularly Catholic Latinos in South Texas who supported Donald Trump in the last election but who polls show have since soured on the Republican Party.

“There’s an appeal here to try to win those folks back,” said Brendan Steinhauser, a Texas GOP strategist, who called the ad “sad but endearing, something people can relate to.”

“It’s showing the human side of her. ... It’s a way for her to not

alienate her pro-choice base by saying ‘I chose to have the baby,’” he said. “It’s like she’s trying to have it both ways because she chose, but she chose life.”

In an interview with The Washington Post last weekend, Hinojosa said the ad’s message is that abortion shouldn’t be a partisan issue.

“Life is complicated. And it’s in that space where we are all just trying to do the best we can that I think we can connect with one another across party lines,” Hinojosa said. “People are thirsty for connection and less interested in belonging to camps but more interested in finding a new way forward ... where we treat each other with humanity and with respect.”

Hinojosa told The Post that after a routine sonogram revealed

a heart defect, she had genetic testing that showed her fetus had Trisomy 18. The genetic condition often leads to heart defects, low birth weight and death within a year.

Hinojosa was in her second trimester. She and her husband had already picked out the baby’s name, which they don’t share publicly. They took a week to confer with family and friends.

A nun at their church said, “We don’t believe in abortion under any circumstances,” Hinojosa recalled. “I argued with her. She said: ‘I know, I know what you are telling me. We just don’t believe in it.’”

At the same time, Hinojosa said she had relatives opposed to abortion who nevertheless said: “This is different, it’s okay

to terminate.”

“I made the decision to continue with the pregnancy, mostly because I just already loved her. I already felt her kicking,” Hinojosa told The Post. She said the baby was stillborn.

Hinojosa said that after the loss, she “went through a dark time.” She met other women who had received the same diagnosis, she said: One had a baby who lived, briefly. Another told Hinojosa that after learning the diagnosis, her baby’s father left and she ultimately had an abortion.

A few years later, Hinojosa had her first son, now 21, and then her second son who’s 14. But as she notes in the ad, it was that first baby who “gave me the strength to fight.”

“That’s why I did this: So that people understand this is who I am,” Hinojosa said.

Hinojosa has a record of supporting abortion rights in the legislature, but, Steinhauser said, “Very few people know that. Unless Abbott spends money saying that when she had the chance to vote pro-life she didn’t. Let’s see if he answers.”

In recent days, Abbott has attacked Hinojosa on social media, dubbing her “Job Killer Gina” and warning “Gina wants to turn your school into a gender transition camp.” He has not mentioned her positions on abortion, and a campaign spokesman did not respond to a request for comment on Hinojosa’s ad.

John Seago, president of Texas Right to Life, called the ad “hypocritical” and accused Hinojosa of “deceiving voters” by “trying to appear pro-life.”

“If you did not know the context and her record, you would assume she’s a pro-life legislator,” Seago said. “This could confuse uninformed or new voters.”

He noted that abortion “is a big motivator for a lot of Republicans” particularly Latinos in South Texas. His group’s “pro-life scorecard” for the most recent legislative session last year rated Hinojosa at 0 percent.

“We know who she is, and we will be trying to get the word out,” he said.



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Pa. death: Complications of probable measles case cited

BY RACHEL ROUBEIN

A 40-year old woman from Jefferson County, Pennsylvania, died from complications associated with a probable case of measles, the local county coroner said in an interview Sunday evening.

The death had first been announced in a news release, which said a woman died Saturday in the county's first measles-related death.

A copy of a preliminary death certificate reviewed by The Washington Post on Sunday afternoon states that the immediate cause of death was respiratory failure due to "suspected measles," chronic obstructive pulmonary disease and asthma.

However, Jefferson County Coroner Greg Furlong said Sunday night he is planning to change the death certificate to say "probable," which came after a meeting with the woman's family. The woman had contact with another person who had a laboratory-confirmed case of measles.

A finding of "probable" in-

dicates there is more evidence linking measles to the death than "suspected" pending final lab tests expected to return early this week, Furlong said.

Furlong, who was elected coroner as a Republican, said the woman, who was unvaccinated, had exhibited many common symptoms of measles, such as a fever, cough, white spots inside the mouth and a rash.

The woman had spent time with her neighbor, who recently had a laboratory-confirmed case of measles, according to Furlong. Her husband had exhibited signs of measles but did not get tested, he said. The woman had several underlying health conditions and was dependent on supplemental oxygen around-the-clock.

The coroner's office is working with the Pennsylvania Department of Health in the case, according to the news release. In a statement, the state health department said it is "aware of the information reported by the Jefferson County coroner."

"We are in touch with the coroner and appreciate his commitment to keeping the pub-

lic informed," according to the statement. "The Department of Health is conducting a thorough review of this case and will provide the public with updated information when it becomes available."

The new director of the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC), Erica Schwartz, said the agency hasn't been notified of the death.

"Despite repeated offers of assistance, Pennsylvania has not requested a CDC Epi-Aid, which would deploy epidemiologists and provide on-the-ground measles outbreak support," Schwartz said in a statement. "By contrast, Texas, South Carolina, Virginia, Kansas, New Mexico, and Wisconsin have officially requested CDC Epi-Aids and worked alongside federal teams to help bring their measles outbreaks under control."

This comes as the state has been in the middle of a political firestorm over measles and as Pennsylvania's cases of the highly contagious disease are climbing. As of Friday, at least 676 people in the state had contracted mea-

sles this year, including 108 new cases reported in the last week, according to the latest data from the state health department.

"Many people associate measles with a childhood illness, but it can lead to severe complications in individuals of any age," Jefferson County Chief Deputy Coroner and Public Relations Officer Jason Stiver said in a statement.

Last month, the state health department announced two measles-associated deaths in Lancaster County. The cases were quickly thrust into the public spotlight and ignited a feud between Pennsylvania Gov. Josh Shapiro (D) and Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr.

Shapiro accused Kennedy, the founder of a prominent anti-vaccine group, of sowing confusion about vaccines and contributing to the return of the disease that had been declared eliminated in 2000.

Kennedy has contended Shapiro, who is widely expected to run for president, of using the moment for political gain. He had cast doubt on measles as

the cause of the deaths for two Lancaster County residents, suggesting that they "may even have been altogether fabricated."

Lancaster County Coroner Stephen Diamantoni has said that the pathologist who performed the autopsies determined the primary cause of death for one child who tested positive for measles was a spleen laceration hours after birth on Aug. 14. The pathologist did not believe the virus played a role in that baby's death, said Diamantoni, a family doctor first elected coroner, as a Republican, in 2007.

Measles can cause inflammation to the spleen, making it more susceptible to life-threatening rupture, the state health department has said.

In the second case, Diamantoni said that an infant from the Amish community died of measles. The six-week-old died Aug. 18 at home after being in palliative care at home soon after birth. The infant was born with Amish lethal microcephaly, a rare genetic condition that is not generally found outside the Amish community.

State health officials have said that "measles-associated" deaths refer to the virus being present, even if the disease is not identified as the immediate cause of death. They have not released more information about the cases, which they have said were the first such deaths in the state in 35 years and the first reported in the country this year.

The CDC has excluded from its weekly updates of a national measles death tally the two deaths that state officials reported. The highly unusual decision — which departs from the agency's practice of including such data from state health departments — came from Schwartz, The Post previously reported.

As the state health department investigates the Jefferson County death, it will rely on its definition for measles-associated deaths, the department said in a statement. The definition was shared on Sept. 10 with the CDC and the Council of State and Territorial Epidemiologists, which creates standardized disease mortality definitions for the country.

Trump attributes warnings on AI development to unspecified ‘negative forces’

TRUMP FROM AI

bly developing AI models. The researcher's statement inflamed public debate about the risks of the technology.

On Sunday afternoon, Microsoft CEO Satya Nadella said his company welcomed ideas like deliberate pacing and embedding evaluators, with some caveats. In a statement posted on X, Nadella emphasized that any safety regimen will also have to factor in enterprise customers' need for privacy and flexibility. "[F]or firms, it's imperative that they retain full control over their unique and tacit knowledge," he wrote.

Trump's remarks placed him once again firmly on the full-speed-ahead side of the debate over the pace of AI development, which has increasingly divided both the technology and political worlds. He faces growing isolation in his position, as even members of his own party and some allies in the tech industry have grown uneasy with Trump's apparent lack of concern over potential AI dangers.

Trump attributed the warnings to unspecified "negative forces."

"I think you have a lot of negative forces that are bringing it up that shouldn't be bringing it up," he told reporters. "And they're bringing up things that won't happen."

Democrats are seeking to capitalize on growing public unease about AI, with multiple polls showing Americans increasingly wary of the technology and its rapid development. The issue potentially ties together several Democratic lines of attack, allowing them to portray Trump as inattentive to his work and too close to billionaire leaders of the tech industry.

In a flurry of social media posts over the weekend, Democrats spanning the party's ideological spectrum pledged to rein in the industry and accused the administration of failing to confront the technology's mounting risks.

Abdul El-Sayed, a progressive Democratic Senate candidate in Michigan, warned Sunday that technological development was outpacing safety practices and endorsed a proposal from Sen. Bernie Sanders (I-Vermont) to pause AI development.

"There are things that we should not be using AI to do, and we collectively have to decide



President Donald Trump on Sunday at the Irish Open in Doonbeg, Ireland, where he responded to calls for slowing the development of AI.

that we need public oversight so that all of this technology is not being created for the interest of a few against the well-being of the many," El-Sayed said in an interview on "Face the Nation."

Josh Shapiro, the Pennsylvania governor, a centrist and potential 2028 Democratic presidential candidate, called the industry leaders' warnings a "bright flashing red light."

"It's long past time for our federal government to step up, take this seriously, and put up some guardrails — both here at home and on the global stage," Shapiro wrote on X, drawing parallels to the regulation of pharmaceuticals and airplanes.

Shapiro recently has grown critical of the industry after previously fostering construction of the data centers underpinning AI development. Last month, he signed an executive order restricting their development.

Former president Barack Obama last week also privately urged Democratic Party leaders to make AI regulation central to the party's agenda. He encouraged them to focus on safety, the technology's impact on children and its economic impacts.

Obama viewed the industry leaders' calls for slowing down AI development as a "positive development," according to a person familiar with his thinking, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to describe private conversations. The New York Times first reported Obama's recommendation.

The Democratic attacks have posed a challenge for Republicans, who are increasingly aware of the voter backlash to AI but are running on a party agenda that is inextricably tied to the White House.

Trump has moved to clear regulations that his donors in the tech industry warned could slow AI development down. During his first week in office, he rescinded a 2023 Biden executive order that created a process for evaluating the risks of cutting-edge AI models. As concerns about AI risks have grown this summer, the administration has developed a new framework for reviewing AI models for cybersecurity risks.

Some Republicans facing tight midterm races have expressed greater openness to AI regulation. Mike Rogers, a former

Republican lawmaker who is battling El-Sayed for the Senate seat in Michigan, wrote on X on Sunday that he supports slowing down AI development and would prioritize passing a national security framework addressing the technology.

"My experience as Intel Chairman taught me the time to stop a crisis is yesterday," said Rogers, who served as chairman of the House Intelligence Committee from 2011 to 2015.

Republican leaders have sought to place the onus on companies to protect the public, doubling down on the White House's position.

"There is an obvious corporate responsibility that the people who are creating these models have to have to ensure that their products are safe," House Speaker Mike Johnson (R-Louisiana) said Sunday on CNN.

Johnson said he would meet with the leaders of the tech platforms as a first step. He also pointed to a post from David Sacks, the architect of the Trump administration's hands-off approach to AI regulation. Tech leaders should "go ahead" with pacing AI development, Sacks

said, but he rejected the companies' claims that the industry needed intervention from Washington to do that.

"Stop pretending you need anyone else's permission," Sacks wrote on X.

He also said that the companies should stop saying their interest in slowing down "is purely altruistic." The companies would be liable if their products caused a significant cyberattack, he said.

Amodei and other company officials have asked the U.S. government to waive antitrust laws so that they can coordinate on matters of AI safety, and Amodei wrote in his essay that it would be helpful if the government would "mediate or at least enable these discussions."

Some policy experts and tech leaders dismissed the call for an antitrust exemption, arguing the companies were advocating policies that were favorable to their financial interests but would not further the goal of protecting public safety.

Slade Bond, a former Biden Justice Department official, said courts for a century have allowed companies to cooperate for the purpose of public safety.

Companies can't invoke safety as pretext for suppressing competition for other, illegal reasons. But a deal between AI companies to prevent a cataclysmal event, such as a financial crisis induced by a bot swarm, would be viewed as pro-competitive under the Sherman Antitrust Act, an 1890 statute that undergirds U.S. competition policy.

Asking the government for a waiver suggests the companies are extremely risk-averse when it comes to potential liability, despite having massive market caps, legal teams and litigation budgets, said Bond, who was a lead counsel on the House antitrust investigation into the tech industry in 2019 and 2020.

"They want a blank check," he said. "They don't like product liability, they don't like copyright, and now they don't like antitrust."

Industry leaders have also urged the administration to cooperate with China to pace AI development. Altman encouraged Trump to develop a pact with China that would address the risk of losing control over an AI agent, while ensuring that the safety measures do not leave either country at a disadvantage.

Ahead of Trump's meeting with Chinese President Xi Jinping later this month, Altman appealed to the president's very public desire for a Nobel Peace Prize.

"I think Presidents Trump and Xi would get the Nobel Peace Prize together if they could agree on something that should be easy to agree to, and it would be wonderful," Altman told Fortune magazine in an interview published Saturday.

"Even if just the U.S. and China could agree on some shared standards and testing for development of this technology, I think that'd be a wonderful accomplishment that the two of them can deliver," he said.

Trump and Xi reached no major agreements on artificial intelligence during their May summit in Beijing.

The White House did not respond to a request for comment on whether it would hold any policy meetings in response to the tech leaders' warnings. Kevin Hassett, the director of the National Economic Council, said on CNN on Sunday that he expected the White House to have meetings this week with top cybersecurity advisers to "think about what the next step is."

Organizational reconfiguration will better reflect NSA's current, future mission

NSA FROM AI

nymity to discuss sensitive information about the agency, whose operations are highly classified.

The NSA did not respond to a request for comment.

It was not immediately clear if the five new organizations will replace existing divisions within NSA or be superimposed atop the agency's existing structure. The NSA is believed to employ more than 30,000 people, both military and civilian, and has a larger workforce than the CIA.

Rudd told senior NSA officials that the heads of the five new mission centers might be selected from outside the agency, unnerving NSA insiders, according to the former officials.

"They are begging people to come back, especially leaders,"

said the first former official, referring to NSA personnel who have left.

A second former official said Rudd is considering candidates for the new mission director posts. It is unclear whether any have been chosen yet.

The elite hacking unit known as Tailored Access Operations (TAO), reconstituted in recent months by Rudd, will fall under the purview of the mission director for global intelligence, according to a current and former official.

The TAO is set to receive a significant budget increase in the new federal fiscal year, which begins Oct. 1, the second former official said.

Founded in 1997, TAO is among the most secretive parts of the NSA, devoted to compro-

ming — and sometimes attacking — the hardest-to-reach digital targets worldwide. The unit name was retired in 2016, and its members spread across different NSA components.

Rudd, who was confirmed in March, is both director of the NSA and head of U.S. Cyber Command, one of the Pentagon's combatant commands. In his dual-hatted role, he reports to both Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth and Director of National Intelligence Jay Clayton.

Before assuming the NSA directorship, Rudd's military career mostly focused on special operations.

The NSA, generally believed to be the biggest and most-well-funded arm of the U.S. intelligence apparatus, focuses on the large-scale collection of signals

intelligence, including communications and other electronic information. It also manages and secures U.S. encryption systems to prevent foreign actors from penetrating sensitive coded U.S. government communications and networks.

The timeline for the NSA restructuring is aggressive. The new mission directors will be expected to provide Rudd their organizational redesigns by the end of the month, according to a former official. Rollout is expected in mid-October, with the target for "full operating capacity" slated for mid-January 2027, said a current and former official.

Rudd "admitted that they don't know how they are going to do it, so they are going to rush into reversible decisions, in case it is wrong," said the first for-

mer official. NSA personnel are still unclear whether the new mission directors will merely be grafted atop preexisting bureaucracy or will oversee more fundamental structural shifts inside Fort Meade.

Since becoming NSA director in March, Rudd has been focused on AI-related advancements, according to former officials. The NSA has rolled out a new desktop AI tool called "Ask Mary," purportedly named for the head of the division leading the agency's AI-related integration efforts. The agency has been keenly interested in working with commercial AI labs, even circumventing a Pentagon ban against Anthropic to employ the firm's advanced Mythos model.

Rudd has been a frequent visitor to the White House, ac-

cording to a former official, with AI-related issues dominating his conversations there. The administration has proposed a massive, multibillion-dollar budget increase for investments in IT and computing capability, according to former officials. Approved by Congress as part of the "black budget," NSA's funding levels are a tightly held secret.

The last major agency restructuring, known as "NSA 21," was initiated in 2016 under then-Director Mike Rogers. That effort, which divided NSA into six directorates, was given a two-year runway for its rollout and still remains unfinished, the first former official noted.

Park officials wanted Grand Canyon trail to stay closed

GRAND CANYON FROM AI

tions of the North Kaibab Trail, which the Park Service built in the 1920s to attract more tourists. The trail is a key part of the increasingly popular rim-to-rim hike.

Parrish, who was part of the Grand Canyon leadership team when some of these discussions took place in August and September last year, said he and others advocated for the North Kaibab Trail to remain closed through this season. Other current and former officials spoke on the condition of anonymity for fear of retribution or because they were not authorized to speak with the media.

In a statement, Interior Department spokeswoman Elizabeth Peace said the decision to reopen the trail was “not simply whether to ‘keep the trail open.’ The trail had been closed following the Dragon Bravo Fire.”

“The trail was reopened only after crews completed assessments and the work identified as necessary to make the trail as safe as reasonably possible for public use in a wilderness environment,” Peace said.

The damage from the fire brought down trees and led to rock slides, prompting land management teams across multiple agencies to produce a Burned Area Emergency Response (BAER) Plan, according to a copy reviewed by The Post.

The team completed that detailed analysis on Sept. 2, 2025, nearly a year before August’s late-summer monsoon drove the deadly flash flood that hit parts of the fire-scarred canyon. The report recommended extensive repairs, stabilization work and the removal of slide debris, as well as installing an early-warning system and hazard signs.

While it is unclear whether the Park Service completed all the work, the agency installed a flash flood warning network, according to an internal presentation from this past spring reviewed by The Post, which also predicted the possibility of up to a threefold increase in runoff potential in the North Kaibab parts of the burn area.

The park also added some signage. A photo from a hiker obtained by The Post showed bright yellow hazard warnings: “Burned area. Flash floods; fallen trees; rock and debris,” the sign reads, with the image of a person running from falling boulders.

It’s not yet clear exactly how the fire’s aftermath exacerbated the speed and power of last month’s flooding, which killed at least two hikers and forced the rescues of about 80 others. Response crews are still searching for one missing person. Experts have said that when torrential rain falls quickly on fire-scarred land, it increases erosion and intensifies debris and water flows.

While flash flooding has always been a part of the Grand Canyon — rock and debris have shaped and reshaped the massive expanse — a sweeping wildfire such as Dragon Bravo intensifies this process, said Daniel Swain, a climate scientist with the University of California Agriculture and Natural Resources.

Such a blaze makes “it so that the landscape is less able to absorb rapid accumulation of rainfall,” he said, adding that it might be the same amount of water, “but more of it runs off more quickly.”

In an interview with radio station KTAR News shortly after the flood, Interior Secretary Doug Burgum described the risks to the landscape when a flood follows a fire.

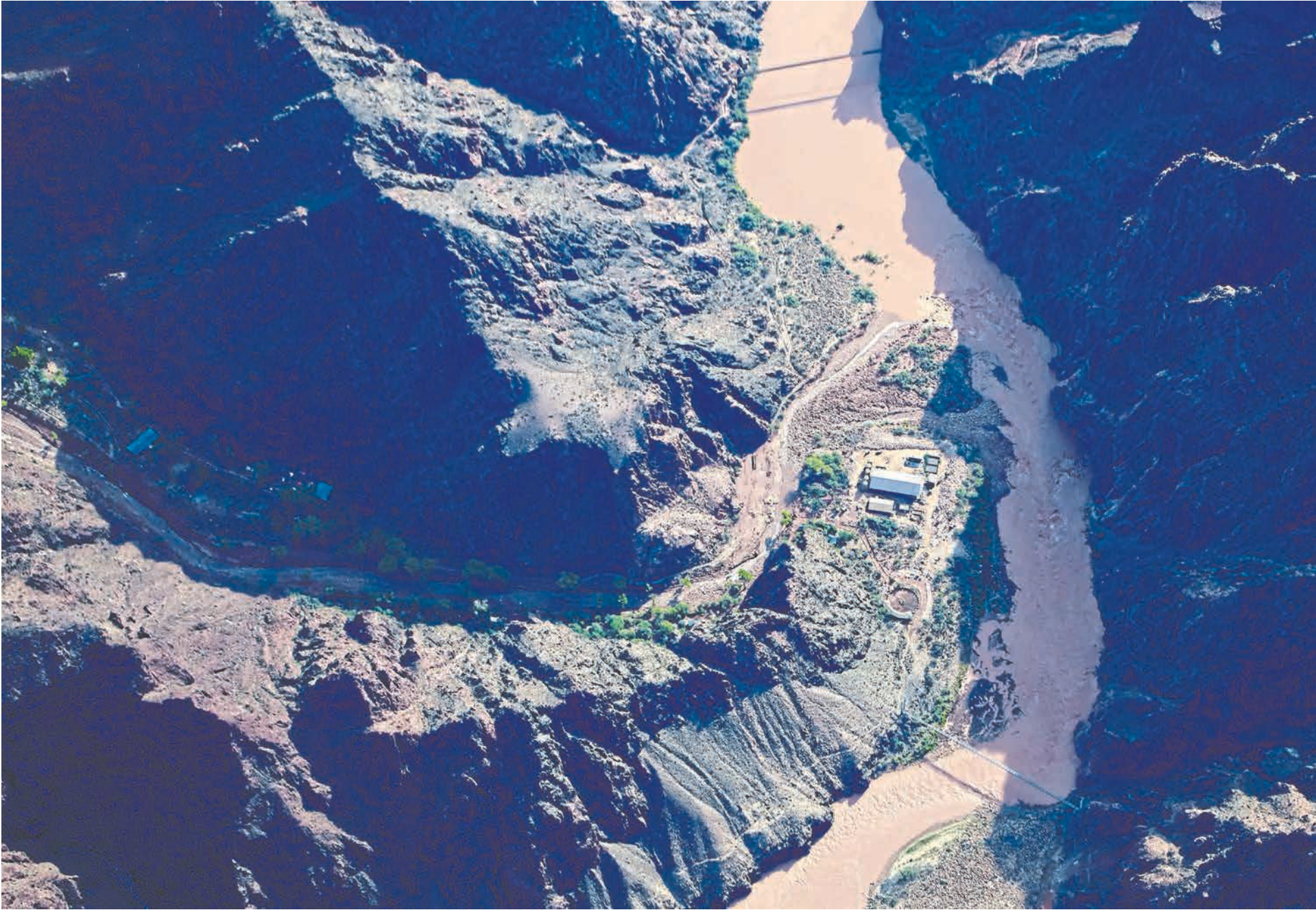
“A forest that is alive holds water; when you have a forest that is burned through, you get a lot of runoff, a lot of mud that occurs,” Burgum said, adding that even a year or two after a major fire, “flash flooding is a concern that those professional foresters and we have had going into this.”

In the Interior Department’s statement, Peace acknowledged that the “Grand Canyon is a dynamic environment where conditions can change rapidly because of weather, flooding, rockfall and other natural processes.”

Mounting pressure

In multiple meetings, including some specifically about the BAER report, Park Service officials with land and safety expertise raised concerns about reopening the North Kaibab Trail, the four current and former National Park Service officials said. Some recommended that it be closed for about a year to allow the grounds to recover.

“I was hearing from the safety officer, people in search and rescue, people in law enforcement, the trails manager, that they were seeing risks that really



JOHN LOCHER/AP PHOTO

Bright Angel Canyon, damaged by flash floods, runs into the Colorado River in the Grand Canyon. A deadly flash flood tore through the Grand Canyon at the end of August.

should be seriously considered,” said one former member of the Grand Canyon’s leadership team. “And they were not.”

Based on meetings and conversations with safety and resource experts, this former official said there were “a number of things” that they could have done to reduce the danger, including closing the trail and better educating visitors about the risk.

Parrish and another former senior official said that Grand Canyon Superintendent Ed Keable, who was a key decision-maker in whether to reopen the trail, attended some of these meetings and heard those concerns.

The official said the risks “were certainly calculable, and were known by leadership,” and recalled that Keable, appointed by President Donald Trump in 2020, initially discussed keeping the North Kaibab Trail closed, before “his tone changed significantly.”

Keable referred questions to the Interior Department.

“Park staff recommended continuing that closure through the winter while necessary work was completed, and the superintendent agreed,” Peace, the Interior Department spokeswoman, said in her statement.

Representatives from Grand Canyon National Park did not respond to a request for comment by the time of publication.

Several politicians, including some Democrats, lobbied to reopen the trail last year as a way to retain tourism revenue. Last September, Sen. Mark Kelly (D-Arizona) wrote a letter to Burgum.

“I urge the National Park Service to reopen key viewpoints and trails wherever it is safe to do so,” he said, citing that the park generates “roughly \$1 billion in economic activity” every year. He specifically cited the North Kaibab Trail, calling it one of the “cornerstones of the Grand Canyon experience.”

In April 2025, Burgum directed that any national park closures or reductions, including individual trails and campgrounds, would need review by the National Park Service director and the assistant secretary of the Interior for fish and wildlife and parks to ensure all national parks remain open and accessible to visitors.

The order put final closure decisions, previously made locally by park superintendents, in the hands of officials based in Washington.

Peace said the order “should not be characterized as requiring parks to keep an area open when conditions are unsafe.”

A month after Kelly sent a letter to the Interior Department, Rep. Elijah Crane (R-Arizona) introduced a bipartisan bill “to fast track” the rebuild of the Grand Canyon’s North Rim after the fire.

Crane joined NPR station KNAU in January for an interview about the North Rim Restoration Act. Based on conversations with local businesses,

Crane told the station “there’s just a sense of urgency” to get the area back into shape. He said once the fire was out, conversations “quickly transitioned to ... what can we do about it as the North Rim is so vital to Arizona’s small businesses, local economies and communities.”

In a statement, a spokesperson for Kelly said that “he remains focused on ensuring safe access to public lands.” And that “the priority now must be on quickly remediating damage from the Dragon Bravo and White Sage Fires.”

Crane did not respond to requests for comment by the time of publication.

The desire to get the iconic Grand Canyon back up and running after a major wildfire underlines a push-and-pull that follows when extreme weather causes devastation in national

parks, particularly in regions where the local economy depends on them.

Nearly 5 million people visit the canyon every year. However, only about 1 percent make it down to the banks of the Colorado River, according to the National Park Service. It notes that the “North Kaibab Trail is challenging for day hikers as well as rim-to-rim hikers.”

Parrish noted that given the relatively low North Rim visitation compared with other areas in the canyon, the economic losses to the park would have been temporary.

Still, it’s a tough balance to strike, said Dave Worthington, a veteran federal land management official who retired at the end of May 2025 from his role as the Grand Canyon’s chief of science and resource management. Allowing enough time for recov-

ery after a disaster can hamper businesses that employ hundreds of workers and mom-and-pop shops that need tourism to survive, he said.

“It’s a huge impact on the park and community when the park is shut down,” said Worthington, who lived in the park during the Dragon Bravo Fire.

At the same time, he said, “you don’t want to put resources and people in danger.”

A series of warnings

Last September, the Grand Canyon National Park leadership team of about 10 members gathered at the South Rim headquarters for a discussion about trail conditions. Deputy Superintendent Brian Drapeaux was running the meeting in Keable’s absence, said Parrish and the former official, who were in attendance.

Adam Gibson, the Grand Canyon trails program manager, gave a presentation there on the status of the North Kaibab Trail, sharing his firsthand observations, as well as photographs he took. He proposed not reopening the trail for the 2026 season, the former official said.

12 News in Arizona first reported the meeting, which was one of several where Park Service experts raised concerns about the integrity of the land, Parrish and the former official said.

Gibson and other park leaders also worried that putting staff out in that environment could be risky. There were still toxic remnants from the fire — many dead, hazardous trees.

“From his point of view, there was rock fall, tree fall, a lot of damage. There was a concern about mudslides,” Parrish said about Gibson’s presentation.

Gibson did not respond to requests for comment.

On March 3, Gibson appeared on a popular podcast, “The Grand Canyon Hiker Dude Show.”

In the episode, Gibson said he was alarmed after hiking the area the month before to assess the conditions. Debris flowed with such momentum, and in atypical areas, that it took out whatever was in its path.

“That was a bit of an eye-opener,” he said on the podcast. “It’s not going to be a good place to be if you find yourself in the upper North Kaibab and you get an inch of rain in an hour.”

He said he was working with leadership on his recommendations for reopening the trail, but the “decision to close or reopen a trail is ultimately at the responsibility of the superintendent.”

“That is really going to be a decision for senior management, and I will respect their decision,” he said. On March 4, a portion of the North Kaibab trail was back in use. In mid-March, Crane’s bill passed unanimously.

The park reopened the full North Rim to the public shortly afterward, on May 15, just in time for peak season.

“Hikers should anticipate temporary trail closures or delays while crews continue to repair the trail. Postfire hazards and weather events may also result in additional closures,” the Park Service cautioned in its announcement, as it celebrated the iconic landscape.

The problem, Parrish said, is that “a lot of people go into our national parks thinking they are like Disneyland.”

They often forget the Grand Canyon is the wild, he said — with its heat, sudden storms, exposed and narrow depths, and punishing ascents.

“The canyon has many conditions and situations that will kill you,” Parrish said. “The canyon and nature is going to do what it’s going to do, and no matter how much money or whatever Congress or the politicians want to do, the environment is still going to do what it is going to do.”



NATIONAL PARK SERVICE

The closure between the North Kaibab trailhead and Redwall Bridge, seen in 2025.

What to know about Trump’s proposed \$5,000 payouts

BY STEVE THOMPSON,
AOIFE WALSH
AND VICTORIA CRAW

President Donald Trump has pledged a \$5,000 dividend to every American adult if Republicans retain control of Congress in November’s midterm elections, prompting questions about how the benefit would work, whether the plan is legal and where the money would come from.

Payments from the “Trump dividend” pledge would have to be spent in the United States, he told the Republican Party’s mid-term convention in Dallas, without offering further detail.

Trump has proposed payouts before, though not tied to an election result, and two previous nationwide payouts never materialized.

Here’s what we know.

What Trump is proposing

Trump said he “will issue a dividend to every adult citizen in the United States of America for \$5,000” if Republicans win both the House of Representatives and the Senate, “very much like a successful company will do a cash distribution to its shareholders.”

He said the “only condition” is that it would need to be spent in the United States. “We don’t want you going to Canada to spend the money. We don’t want you going to China, to Germany,” Trump said.

He compared the payment to last year’s \$1,776 “warrior dividend” to service members. He also lauded his “Trump accounts,” an investment account under which children born under Trump’s second term are eligible for a \$1,000 deposit. The White House did not immediately elaborate on how the plan would work, and after the speech, Vice President JD Vance appeared to begin walking it back.

“What the president is talking



President Donald Trump speaks at the Republican midterm convention in Dallas on Wednesday.

about is a dividend for American workers,” Vance told Fox News, seeming to shrink the pool of those potentially eligible from all American adults. The White House has yet to respond to a request for more details, but spokesman Davis Ingle said in an email that Trump “has consistently proven his doubters wrong” and “will keep delivering real results.”

Could increase deficits

The payments, which could cost in excess of \$1 trillion, would require congressional

approval. Sen Bernie Moreno (R-Ohio) said on X that he will “get a bill ready” to get the dividend “passed immediately” after the election.

But the plan quickly drew opposition over its likely effect on the national debt, which surpassed \$40 trillion last month.

“If the goal is to increase borrowing, drive up interest rates, weaken the longer-run economy, explode the debt, push up inflation and leave our children further indebted — this will do it,” Maya MacGuineas, president of the Committee for a Respon-

sible Federal Budget, a nonpartisan think tank, said in an email Thursday.

“With Americans grappling with real affordability concerns and bond markets all but pleading for fiscal restraint, now is not the time to make outlandish promises that blow up the budget,” MacGuineas said.

Is it a campaign promise or buying votes?

Critics immediately pounced on the plan as an attempt to buy votes, while others suggested it is more akin to a campaign prom-

Could worsen inflation

Trump campaigned for office by blaming inflation on President Joe Biden’s stimulus package passed to address the coronavirus pandemic.

This year, prices have been rising because of the ongoing conflict in Iran, which has curtailed oil supplies globally. The effects of the energy crunch have trickled out beyond gas pumps, sending up prices for groceries, airline tickets and more.

Sending out \$5,000 checks would push up inflation just as the Trump administration has struggled to tame it, experts say.

“That’s just a huge amount of stimulus in the economy,” said Douglas Holtz-Eakin, president of the American Action Forum, a conservative-leaning think tank.

“You create enormous demand for goods and services,” Holtz-Eakin said. “The only way to offset the resulting price increases would be to undo that demand by raising interest rates a lot.”

Trump has promised similar payments before

Previous broad, nationwide rebates floated by Trump have not panned out. In February 2025, he touted the idea of sending Americans a “dividend” based on the savings he expected the U.S. DOGE Service to achieve, and in November, he proposed a \$2,000 dividend funded by tariffs the U.S. imposed on nearly every country. Neither materialized.

Trump launched the “Trump accounts” for eligible children in July and the \$1,776 “warrior dividend” bonus for service members in December.

Previous administrations have also come up with similar payouts. Trump in 2020, and then the Biden administration in 2021, offered individual payments as part of stimulus packages during the coronavirus pandemic. Neither was contingent on voter action.

Kennedy Center warns of bankruptcy, seeks closure vote

KENNEDY CENTER FROM AI

to “raise the necessary funds to keep the Center from bankruptcy” while the building undergoes a sweeping renovation. But it says Trump is unlikely to provide “fundamental oversight” of that project or lead a financial rescue without “appropriate recognition” of his role.

Together, the two proposals represent a remarkable new phase in Trump’s takeover of the Kennedy Center, which has been engulfed by financial turmoil, leadership upheaval and litigation since he installed himself as chairman last year. Trump and his allies have repeatedly portrayed his leadership — and his name — as essential to rescuing the institution, even as ticket sales and fundraising have plummeted under their stewardship.

Trustees are being asked to choose among 10 texts that could be placed on the building’s exterior beneath its name, including one reading: “Renovation Restoration and Endowment overseen by President Donald J. Trump and the Trump Kennedy Center Fund.”

The proposal comes less than a month after the board approved a similar plan to inscribe “Restored and Renovated by President Donald J. Trump” on the facade. U.S. District Judge Christopher Cooper, who ruled in May that only Congress can rename the Kennedy Center and ordered Trump’s name removed, is considering a legal challenge to that proposal.

The center’s stark new financial assessment is also a dramatic departure from the turnaround its leaders touted publicly for much of Trump’s tenure.

Internal budgets and forecasts obtained by The Washington Post earlier this year showed ticket sales and fundraising plunging after the board added Trump’s name to the building in December. By May, officials projected the center would collect about \$124 million of the \$220 million in revenue it had budgeted for the fiscal year, leaving a roughly \$23 million deficit even after substantial spending cuts. A center spokesperson blamed the problems on financial mismanagement by previous leadership and said Trump’s name had



Documents obtained by The Post this year showed ticket sales and fundraising plunging for the Kennedy Center after President Donald Trump’s name was put on the building.

attracted new donors.

The second resolution before trustees Tuesday would address what management describes as an increasingly urgent threat from the deteriorating building itself.

Executive Director Matt Floca, who was installed by Trump in March, told trustees that during a severe storm Sept. 4, a roughly four-by-five-foot section of ceiling plaster broke loose in the Grand Foyer and fell about 60 feet, scattering debris near the Concert Hall entrance. No one was injured. Inspectors found at least seven other locations with visible water-related deterioration, according to the board

packet.

Separately, engineers examining the outside of the building found widespread corrosion in structural components of the soffit panels that form the underside of an overhang wrapping around the center, Floca said in a two-page memo to trustees. Of roughly half of the building’s 278 panels examined, 46 had severe structural corrosion and another 93 had mild-to-moderate corrosion, he said, adding that engineers projected that about one-third require immediate replacement. The report says 2,500-pound ceiling assemblies hang roughly 60 feet above public walkways.

A draft resolution says Floca and Delta Consulting Group, which has reviewed the center’s renovation plans, determined that the building is “unsafe for continued occupancy” and that delaying renovations would pose further danger to employees and the public.

Kennedy Center representatives declined to comment on the proposals, but sent a previous statement from spokeswoman Roma Daravi, “Another example of the urgent need to close for renovation and revitalization, as our Chairman President Trump has championed. Fortunately, no one was injured when the main hall’s ceiling collapsed.

This structural failure stems from decades of neglect and deferred maintenance by the previous leadership, and there’s no justification for further delays in restoring America’s cultural center.”

Trump first proposed closing the Kennedy Center for two years in February, saying an empty building would allow crews to renovate it more quickly. His board approved the plan in March, but Cooper blocked the closure in May, finding trustees had relied on insufficient information and had not adequately weighed the consequences. He allowed the board to reconsider after a more thorough review.

Trustees did so Aug. 13, again approving a two-year shutdown as part of a roughly \$250 million renovation.

Tuesday’s resolution would go considerably further by ordering the main building closed immediately. Management says repairs cannot safely be performed around audiences and employees because structural work, electrical shutdowns and construction would affect interconnected systems and public areas throughout the building.

The Reach, the center’s newer expansion, would remain open, while performances and other programming would continue at other venues.

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The Washington Post

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THE WORLD

Omanis are baffled by Trump’s threat to bomb country

They wonder what the president heard to trigger him

BY RACHEL CHASON

MUSCAT, Oman — The threat felt like it came out of nowhere. “If Oman gets in the way,” President Donald Trump told Fox News, referring to his efforts to reopen the Strait of Hormuz, “we’ll bomb the s--- out of them.”

Omanis were baffled. Bragging, as a rule, is strongly frowned upon in their culture. But people here have long been quietly proud of their small country, at the southeastern tip of the Arabian Peninsula.

The blue waters teeming with sea turtles and freshwater oases tucked into jagged mountains. The down-to-earth warmth of its people, in a region better known for its flashy wealth. A reputation, despite the complexities of the Middle East, for neutrality — and helping negotiate some of its thorniest crises.

Indeed, in February, Omani Foreign Minister Badr Albusaidi mediated three rounds of talks between the United States and Iran. After a meeting in Geneva on Feb. 26, Albusaidi reported “significant progress.” On Feb. 27, on “Face the Nation,” he said: “A peace deal is within our reach.”

The next day, the U.S. and Israel began bombing Iran, starting a war that has yet to end more than six months later.

Trump’s threat against Oman on Aug. 17 was all the more stunning because a tentative peace framework that he signed with Tehran less than two months before had designated Oman to “conduct dialogue” with Iran over the future of the Strait of Hormuz.

“It was outrageous,” Omani scholar Abdullah Baabood, chair of the State of Qatar for Islamic Area Studies at Waseda University in Tokyo, said of Trump’s threat, summing up a view expressed repeatedly by Omanis in recent days.

“We didn’t do anything wrong; we were just trying to help the U.S.,” Baabood said, referring to the effort to broker a deal to fully reopen the strait, the narrow waterway that runs between Iran and Oman and is vital to global oil supplies “That is our nature,” he added.

On Monday, Oman was set to host a meeting of foreign ministers from Persian Gulf nations, including Iran, to discuss reopening the strait. But the gathering was called off late Sunday, with Albusaidi saying that it was being postponed “in the interests of consensus.” It was the latest sign of the tricky diplomatic terrain Oman continues to navigate.

Since Trump’s threat, there has been a reckoning underway for many people here over their country’s long, and at times complex, relationship with the United States — and over how Oman, known for quiet discretion, tells its own story.

Many Omanis said they did not take Trump’s threat too seriously but did worry about what exactly he had heard about their country that set him off — and also about what other nations might think. Some said it might be time for Oman to be a little less quiet.

“We don’t beat a loud drum because that isn’t the Omani way,” Baabood said, sitting in a coffee shop in Muscat, the capital. “But we know that leads people to misunderstand us.”

Bridging a gulf

As the sun rose on a recent Saturday over the port in Muscat, war seemed far away. Fishermen hauled tuna and kingfish from their boats onto the pier, then cheerfully compared the size of their catches.

Oman, whose economy relies on fishing, sits where the Persian Gulf meets the Arabian Sea, bordering the southern part of the Strait of Hormuz. The country once had an empire that



PHOTOS BY HEIDI LEVINE/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

A portrait of Oman's Sultan Haitham bin Tariq hangs from the ceiling of the Muntrah Souk in Muscat, Oman, on Sept. 7.

stretched down the coast of East Africa, to modern-day Mozambique, and since 1744, it has been led by the Al Bu Said family.

Oman’s current ruler, Sultan Haitham bin Tariq, assumed power in 2020, after the death of his cousin, Sultan Qaboos bin Said, who over his 50 years in charge built Oman’s reputation as something of a Switzerland of the Middle East.

It was Qaboos that established Omani foreign policy as being a “friend to all, enemy to no one,” and under whose reign Oman served as a mediator in the Iran-Iraq war in the 1980s, in the blockade of Qatar by other Gulf nations and in Yemen’s civil war, among other crises.

But those efforts have not been without controversy.

Other Arab nations criticized its decision not to break ties with Egypt in 1979, when Cairo normalized relations with Israel in the Camp David Accords. Some Gulf nations — especially Saudi Arabia — were upset by Oman’s back-channel negotiations on the 2015 nuclear deal that Oman helped broker between Iran and the U.S.

Even now, officials in other Gulf nations privately criticize Oman for not clearly condemning its neighbor as Iran has targeted regional powers with barrages of missiles and drones in retaliation for the U.S.-Israeli strikes.

As Trump came to own the war, Oman has continued to take part in discussions, often alongside parallel talks led by Qatar and Pakistan, and mostly shrouded in secrecy.

Wondering about a trigger

In recent weeks, Omanis have been left wondering what exactly led Trump to lash out against their country, which he first threatened to “blow up” in May if it did not “behave.”

“He must have heard something, but we don’t know what,” said Abdul Wahab Al Balushi, a businessman and one of many Omanis who have studied at American universities on government scholarships. “It was different under Carter, under Reagan, under Bush ... under everyone,” said Al Balushi, who now sits on

the board of Muscat University.

Tyler Parker, an assistant professor of political science at Mercer University in Georgia who studies Oman, said Trump first grew frustrated with the country because of his perception that the 2015 Iran nuclear deal — which Obama administration officials asked Oman to help mediate — was biased against the United States.

Trump has grown upset with Oman again in recent months, Parker said, “because of a perception that Oman is closer with Iran.”

Iranian officials have said that Oman is open to creating a system of fees for traversing the Strait of Hormuz, which Oman recently denied.

“Oman has long been a very

discreet facilitator,” Parker said. “And the Trump administration struggles to understand that type of foreign policy.”

A former U.S. diplomat, who spoke on the condition of anonymity because of the sensitivity of the situation, said that part of the blame rests with the Omanis, for allowing the Iranian regime to shape the narrative — including waiting too long to dispel the idea that Oman was supportive of the proposed toll system in the strait.

“The Omanis haven’t said much of anything,” the former diplomat said. “Which makes it hard to tell what is going on ... and possible for Trump to hear something and lash out.”

Last week, Albusaidi said that “a solution has not yet been



Omani scholar Abdullah Baabood at a cafe in Muscat this month.

reached” in Omani efforts to secure free passage of vessels. He also blamed “some world leaders” for sidelining the professional diplomats and trying to broker a deal themselves.

“But we are not walking away,” he wrote in the Financial Times.

Youssof Al-Balushi, a fisherman and retired engineer who was at the pier early on Saturday to fix his boat, said Omanis laugh when they hear Trump musing about renaming the strait after himself or declaring it a U.S. territory, as he did last month. Trump, he said, seems not to understand basic geography and history.

“The entrance is with us,” Al-Balushi said. “It always has been. We are the ones who have the door.”

He frowned when asked about Trump’s threats. “He doesn’t think — he just talks,” he said. “He should think before he talks.”

A long relationship

Oman’s history with the United States dates to the late 1700s, when an American ship, the Boston Rambler, arrived in the port of Muscat. In 1840, an Omani became the first Arab diplomat to visit the United States, bringing Persian carpets, dates and camel hides.

In more recent years, the two nations have exchanged about \$4 billion in annual trade, and Oman is one of about 20 countries with a comprehensive free trade agreement with the U.S., according to the American Chamber of Commerce in Oman.

Among the commercial ties is one to the president personally — a \$500 million Trump-branded golf course in the picturesque hills above the Gulf of Oman, set to open in 2028.

“The underlying relationship is deep and long and strong,” said Ali Daud, chairman of the chamber in Oman. “We have always been a good ally to the U.S.”

But there have been challenges. After the Oct. 7, 2023, Hamas attack, as Israel besieged the Gaza Strip, Omanis boycotted U.S. businesses in the country so intensely that some closed. Still today in Oman, Coca-Cola is hard to find in many restaurants because it is perceived as back-

ing Israel.

Daud said that many Omanis were also upset by the start of the war in February, even as Oman was still mediating. Many were also “offended by Trump’s comments, as anyone would be,” he said, even though no one “really believed it.” Plus, he added: “Our relationship is stronger than any one president.”

Telling its story

In between backflips off rocks above the freshwater oasis of Wadi Hoqain, north of Muscat, a group of Omani teenagers said they didn’t give Trump’s threats much thought.

Mostly, what they wanted people to know is that their country, despite the nearby war, is peaceful.

“Oman is beautiful,” said Zahar Al Mamari, 19. “We are friends with everyone.”

Like other Gulf countries, Oman has seen a decline in tourism because of the war. But because it is outside the Strait of Hormuz, the war has also brought some economic benefits.

The country, generally viewed as less wealthy than its oil-rich neighbors, has experienced a boom in oil and gas sales, and also expanded its role as a logistical center for the region, with goods now arriving at Oman’s ports and being trucked to their final destinations.

Because of Oman’s neutrality, Iranians fleeing the regime arrive there “every day” and inquire about starting businesses, Daud said.

And when Dubai was pummeled with drones and missiles during the first weeks of the war, many residents fled to Oman, which was largely spared.

“We want things to go back to the way they were, and we know that our neighbors are suffering,” he said, noting that Kuwait, Qatar and Bahrain have also seen exports shrink dramatically. “But we also see that our geography and neutrality are paying off.”

“We are peaceful and conservative people,” Daud said, adding that bragging is considered vulgar in Omani culture.

“But I wonder,” he added, “if we need to start telling our own story a bit more loudly now.”

6 dead, more than 100 missing after passenger ship runs into bad weather

BY AOIFE WALSH

At least six people died and more than 100 others are missing after a passenger ship in Indonesia lost contact Sunday during bad weather in the Java Sea, officials said.

The Virgo Transport 8 ship,

which was carrying 243 people, had set off Saturday from Surabaya, a city in East Java, the country’s search-and-rescue agency said, according to local media. The ship lost contact around 2 a.m. local time Sunday after encountering severe weather, said I Putu Sudayana, head of

the agency’s office in Banjarmasin, where the ship was headed. The ship’s last reported position was about 80 nautical miles from the Basirih Search and Rescue Pier in Banjarmasin. Later on Sunday, Transportation Minister Dudy Purwagandhi said 130 people were still missing, according

to local media.

A total of 113 people have been rescued so far, Purwagandhi said at a news conference Sunday, including six who then died.

He said rescue workers faced waves up to about 8 feet high around the search area, adding that larger vessels and a helicop-

ter had been deployed.

The search-and-rescue agency has about 30 ambulances on standby to help handle casualties upon arrival at the port, the government-owned news agency Antara reported.

On board were 30 crew members, 27 workers, 59 passengers,

one child, and 126 drivers and assistants, according to reports.

Indonesia, the world’s largest archipelago and spread across more than 17,000 islands, has a long history of ferry disasters, with a high volume of traffic and boats that are sometimes overcrowded.

Trump asks Zelensky to not hit Russian energy targets

Average price for diesel in U.S. hit an all-time high of \$6 a gallon

BY SAMMY WESTFALL

President Donald Trump on Sunday said he called Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky to ask him to “stop knocking out diesel fuel” targets in Russia, saying the attacks were contributing to a global shortage of the fuel.

“Mr. Zelensky has to do one thing. He has to stop knocking out diesel fuel, let them go after targets but not diesel fuel, because he’s causing a shortage of diesel,” Trump said, adding that there were “plenty other targets.”

“This isn’t done by the Middle East, this is done by what’s happening in Russia and Ukraine,” he told reporters while traveling in Ireland.

Trump made his comments after the U.S. average price for diesel hit an all-time high of \$6 per gallon on Friday, reinforcing concerns about the cost of living less than two months before the Nov. 3 midterm elections.

Anxiety about the economy and inflation are driving down Trump’s poll numbers and those of his Republican allies in Congress at a time when Democrats are seeking to flip the GOP ma-



Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelensky sits next to U.S. Special Envoy Steve Witkoff during a joint press conference on Sept. 6.

GENYA SAVILOV/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

...jorities in the House and Senate. Diesel is used for many freight delivery networks, as well as on farms, affecting the price of everyday goods including groceries and shipping services. The recent diesel price jump came as Iranian-backed proxies tightened their grip on key waterways and infrastructure that let the region export oil. The Iran-backed Houthi rebels opened new fronts against Saudi Arabia and on Friday claimed territorial victories following a large-scale military operation

aimed at controlling the Bab al-Mandab Strait entrance to the Red Sea. That claim means Iran and its proxies have the ability to threaten shipments through two key checkpoints.

Also Friday, Iraqi militants allied with Iran used drones to hit a key Saudi Arabian pipeline to the Red Sea, which had been used to transport oil rerouted around the blocked Strait of Hormuz, according to the Saudi Foreign Ministry.

Ukraine has increasingly targeted Russia's vital oil sector, including strikes Sunday on two major oil refineries in Krasnodar and Tatarstan, the Ukrainian General Staff said. The campaign against oil facilities has caused fuel shortages in Russia, one of the world's leading oil-producing countries, and has disrupted global supplies.

Earlier this month, U.S. envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner met with Russian President Vladimir Putin in Moscow in a visit that aimed to revive long-stalled peace talks with Ukraine. Afterwards, they went to Kyiv for diplomatic talks.

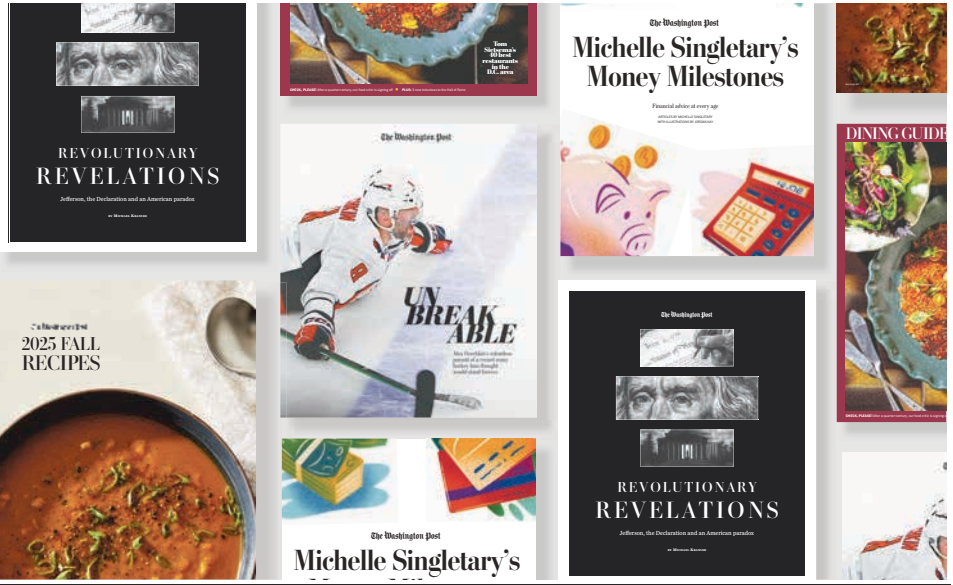
Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent also blamed Ukraine for high global energy prices, saying early this month on Fox News that “because Ukraine has decided that they want to blow up Russian energy assets and refine products, so that is creating upward price pressure on a global basis.” He also added: “And then the conflict in Iran.”



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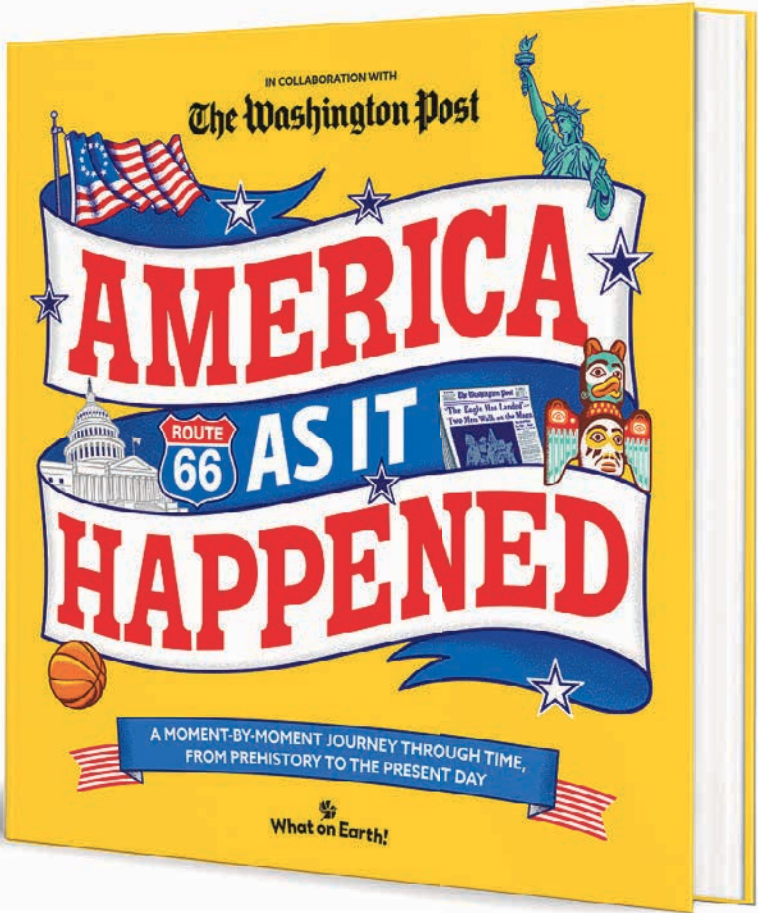


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Trump pokes U.K., and Ireland’s unity debate ignites

Sides left uncertain after comment that broke with presidential neutrality

BY STEVE HENDRIX

LONDON — The explosive debate over whether British-led Northern Ireland should reunify with the independent Ireland to the south has usually been treated with kid gloves by American presidents. But President Donald Trump seems to prefer boxing gloves.

After Trump on Saturday cast aside decades of White House neutrality and endorsed the idea of reunification as “fantastic,” officials on both sides of the dispute scrambled to tamp down the fallout, leverage it or just make sense of Trump’s latest diplomatic curveball.

Reunification is a tripwire in Anglo-Irish relations, seen as a doomsday event by British loyalists in Northern Ireland and by Great Britons who don’t want to see the United Kingdom diminished, leaving only England, Scotland and Wales.

But it is yearned for by Irish nationalists on both sides of the border as the return to a natural order of unity on the Irish isle that was sundered in the partition of 1921, when six northeastern counties stayed British after the fight for Irish independence.

“It’s a typical failure of international statecraft by the president,” Jon Burrows, the head of the Northern Ireland’s Ulster Unionist Party, said in an interview. “He’s weighed into a very sensitive discussion and caused some headlines. But I’m unperturbed because ultimately it’s the people of Northern Ireland who will decide our constitutional future ... and not the president.”

British Prime Minister Andy Burnham said Trump’s remarks did not budge him from recent statements dismissing the chances of reunification anytime soon.

“I am not aware that there is majority public support for another referendum, and until that changes, there will not be one,” Burnham said in a statement.

But supporters of the concept, even those who oppose Trump on nearly every other issue, hailed his thumbs-up and tried to use it a starting gun.

“The Taoiseach must now begin planning for a united Ireland,” Sinn Féin President Mary Lou McDonald said in a statement, referring to the Irish prime minister. “Our national journey is now reunification.”

Sinn Féin, once the political wing of the Irish Republican Army, has become the sec-



TOBY MELVILLE/REUTERS

British Prime Minister Andy Burnham outside 10 Downing Street on Wednesday. Some wonder if Donald Trump was trolling Britain.

ond-largest party in the Irish Parliament, with a focus on economic issues but maintaining its commitment to Irish nationalism.

Claire Hanna, head of the small Social Democratic and Labour Party in Northern Ireland, told cheering supporters that Trump’s support was as welcome as it was surprising, needing the pro-British movement’s signature color: “Turns out he’s not as orange as he looks.”

“There won’t be many times when Donald Trump and I arrive at the same political conclusion, and I deplore much of what he stands for,” Hanna said. “But that is precisely why this intervention is worth noticing.”

The golf-loving president unexpectedly aligned with the pro-unification camp during a two-day visit to Ireland that was more personal than diplomatic, coinciding with the Irish Open being held at his golf club in County Clare. But after a courtesy meeting with Irish Prime Minister Micheál Martin, Trump responded to a reporter’s question on the issue with gusto.

“I will tell you, I’d love to see it unified,” he said. “It’s going to happen eventually.”

Trump was met by pro-Palestinian protesters in Ireland but seemed to be enjoying his time. He announced Sunday that he was ending the new tariffs



CATHAL MCNAUGHTON/POOL/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Burnham, center, meets Northern Ireland First Minister Michelle O’Neill, left, and Northern Ireland Deputy First Minister Emma Little-Pengelly on Aug. 27 during a visit to Belfast.

on Irish whiskey after entreaties from Martin and pro golfer Shane Lowry, who won the tournament Sunday by 11 strokes.

“Shane talked about it, and everybody’s been bugging me about this one thing,” Trump said. “Would you do me a favor? It’s so unfair what’s going on. Could you possibly take the tariffs off of Irish whiskey?” Trump

said. He ended his remarks by announcing, “On behalf of the United States of America, I am going to take the tariffs off of Irish whiskey.”

As is often the case, it was unclear whether Trump’s comments on reunification were off the cuff or marked a meaningful shift in U.S. policy. He answered only after a direct question, and

he did acknowledge that he was wading into sensitive territory. And later in the day, he seemed to make light of his answer.

“They asked me a question: ‘What do you think about unification?’ I gave a nice answer, I think,” Trump said. “It’s one of those questions that no matter what you say ... there’s no good answer.”

On the other hand, he repeated his stance Sunday.

“I’ve always loved the people of Ireland, and it just seems to me that you have Northern Ireland and you have Ireland and it would seem to me that one of the naturals of all time is to put them together,” he said.

And he has signaled — or teased — his possible support before. During a St. Patrick’s Day event in Washington with Martin and a top Northern Ireland official, Deputy First Minister Emma Little-Pengelly, he riffed that he wanted to see a “merger” of the sides.

Little-Pengelly dismissed the president’s comment as “clearly a joke.” His repeating it in Dublin may make it harder to laugh off.

Some thought Trump’s unification comment might be a barb meant to troll Burnham and British officials who have drawn the president’s ire by declining to jump into his Iran war operations. He recently suggested that the U.S. might not help Britain if

Argentina were to launch a new attack on the Falkland Islands, which many took as a similar barb.

“He may or may not feel strongly about this. It may just be something to irk the British,” said Sam McBride, Northern Ireland editor of the Belfast Telegraph and co-author of a new book on unification, “For and Against a United Ireland.”

In any case, it may not matter much, McBride said, given the settled, emotional stands taken by activists on both sides and the formal steps for reunification that are laid out in the 1998 Good Friday Agreement.

“I really don’t think it alters things a jot,” said McBride. “This is a question for the people of the island of Ireland. It doesn’t matter to a significant extent what the British prime minister thinks, it doesn’t matter what the European Union thinks, it doesn’t matter what President Trump thinks.”

The debate is more than a century old, but it has become more dynamic in recent years. Transport and cultural ties have increased for younger Brits in the north, with hourly unrestricted cross-border train service between Belfast and Dublin and a resurgence in Irish language studies on both sides.

The diminishing social role of the Catholic Church in Ireland — which was one of the first countries to legalize same-sex marriage and voted to repeal a long-standing ban on abortion in 2018 — has also narrowed one of the gulfs with the Protestant north.

Britain’s Brexit vote to leave the European Union also boosted the cause in Northern Ireland, where pro-unification camps sought to capitalize on frustrations with Britain’s stagnant post-Brexit economy.

“The last decade has seen more serious discussion about Irish unity than at any point since partition,” McBride said. “It would not be the radical rupture that it once would’ve been.”

But while support has grown, polls have not shown a clear majority favoring unification. The Good Friday Agreement stipulates that Britain’s top official in Belfast can order a public referendum on the question whenever she thinks a majority support the idea.

The sides disagree on exactly when that threshold would be reached. Burnham said last month in the House of Commons, soon after meeting with Unionist figures from Northern Ireland, that any such step is currently “off the table.”

Cat Zakrzewski in Dublin contributed to this report.

Bye, America: Trump’s rhetoric has pushed some Canadians to shun the U.S.

CANADA FROM A1

their southern neighbor, using their travel and shopping decisions to register their discontent with the Trump administration’s trade policies and aggressive rhetoric.

Their choices are a microcosm of the broader challenge facing Canada as it seeks to reduce its reliance on the U.S. after decades of relatively free trade that left the two economies intertwined. For these consumers, too, it’s not easy — and in some cases impossible — to quit America.

But the depth of the feelings here means some Canadians are willing to try. Trump has “kind of pushed every single button,” said Piché, 66. “I’ll buy Canadian first and anything but the U.S. second. Now the U.S. is a distant third.”

The rhetoric on both sides has ratcheted up in recent weeks. Trump has called Canada “nasty,” Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent likened the country to a “little yippy dog,” and Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth posted a photo seemingly mocking the Canadian military. Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney, meanwhile, said his country had been “attacked.”

On Tuesday, Carney saluted Canadians who are adapting their spending habits in a speech explaining his government’s decision to impose retaliatory tariffs on about \$20 billion worth of U.S. imports.

“The most powerful actions have come from you, buying Canadian and traveling in Canada,” Carney said in a video message. “Decisions taken at the kitchen table, not the boardroom table.”

According to the latest data from June, trips by Canadians to the U.S. are down 25 percent from the same month in 2024. Efforts by consumers to buy fewer American products at the



CHRIS HELGREN/REUTERS

A sign at a liquor store in Vancouver urges customers to purchase Canadian products in 2025.

grocery store have also shown up in the data, according to an analysis by the Bank of Canada earlier this year, which described the trend as “modest but clearly visible.”

The initial wave of Canadians shunning American goods and travel to the U.S. came last year. As trade tensions flare anew, the behavior is surging again. “It feels good to vote with your wallet,” said Aaron Ettinger, a political scientist at Carleton University in Ottawa, even if “it may or may not be effective.”

“Canadians are feeling bruised by the decisions made by the American government,” added Avery Shenfeld, chief economist at CIBC Capital Markets in Toronto. “Where there’s a choice, I think a lot of people are doing it

out of a sense of patriotic duty.”

One place they go: a “Made in Canada” group on Facebook that acts as both billboard and search engine. Early last year, it had fewer than 300,000 members. Now it has more than 1.4 million members, about 90 percent of them in Canada, said Jayne Little, one of the group’s moderators. (She acknowledged the irony of using an American tech platform, but said it’s the only option with massive reach.)

Among the made-in-Canada items sought by the group’s members: facial moisturizer, protein bars, pet food, golf shoes, cotton underwear, video games, dog collars, pickleball rackets, sponges, guitars and bacon.

Christina Templeton, a doctor in St. John’s, Newfoundland, re-

cently went to the group seeking a Canadian substitute for the hazelnut coffee creamer favored by her father, who is in his 80s. At first, her parents thought that avoiding American products was silly because it would make no difference given the relative size of the economies, Templeton said.

Then came the Lake Ontario imbroglio. “There was a bit of shouting,” Templeton said. Her father said he didn’t care anymore about whether it had an impact; he didn’t want to have his morning cup of coffee making him upset.

For those inclined to join the “Buy Canadian” movement, there are dedicated websites, mobile apps, browser add-ons, and even an online quiz on brand owner-

ship (“Maple or Eagle?”).

It has also spawned its own controversies. Supermarkets have been accused of “maple washing” (labeling non-Canadian products as Canadian). When Loblaw, a major Canadian supermarket chain, recently said it would remove country-of-origin labels on produce in several provinces, customers rebelled. The company reversed course.

Little, the Facebook group moderator, is an IT security consultant. She used to work in the U.S. and has family in Wisconsin but hasn’t crossed the border since Trump took office in January 2025.

Over the past year, Little has worked to replace the products she buys from the U.S., checking labels and doing online research. An enthusiastic gardener, she uses plant markers to label the dozens of species in her yard. But recently, she wrote to their U.S. maker to ask where the steel came from. The company equivocated, she said. Little isn’t sure what she’ll do when she needs more.

On a recent sunny afternoon, she pulled into a farm store near Cambridge, Ontario. She took a collapsible plastic basket from her trunk and began filling it with locally made crackers, sal-sas and tortilla chips. Then she picked up a jar of tomato sauce. Was it made in Canada? The store’s proprietor, Tim Barrie, told her it was an Italian import.

Little placed it in her basket and smiled. “Anything but, right?”

Barrie, a fourth-generation asparagus farmer who also makes condiments and roasts coffee, said demand for his products has grown “immensely” over the past year. Each time Trump ratchets up his rhetoric — as he has over the past several weeks — Barrie said calls pour in from stores and supermarkets.

In April, Barrie launched a line of shortbread cookies. He’s selling 100 cases a week. “It’s crazy,” he said. He pointed to the maple leaf embossed on the top right-hand corner of the packaging. “I think the big thing is that.”

Some Canadians are taking their boycott beyond travel and groceries. Earlier this year, Petra Kassun-Mutch, an entrepreneurship expert and writer in Toronto, began looking for alternatives to U.S. technology platforms (she has a spreadsheet entitled “Sovereign Tech Plan”). She found European and Canadian alternatives to Adobe, Google Workspace, Zoom, Mailchimp and more. “It does take a bit of work, but you can untangle it,” she said.

On a recent evening, Angela Allt went for an after-work shopping run at a large supermarket in Guelph, Ontario. The cheese aisle was festooned with miniature Canadian flags indicating locally made products; the displays of several varieties of Doritos emphasized that they were, in fact, manufactured in Ontario.

Allt, a social worker, has drastically changed her shopping habits. “I had to switch laundry detergents, which cheesed me off because who doesn’t like Tide?” she asked. She’s discovered Canadian-made canned beans and salad dressings and cleaning products.

She has admitted defeat in some areas. Grapes, which she loves, almost always come from the United States. The same for celery. And then there’s Splenda: her husband can’t find a substitute he likes as much. “You’ve just got to suck it up and buy it,” Allt said.

She and her husband canceled a trip to New York last summer. “When all this blew up, it was just like, nope,” Allt said. They’re not going back anytime soon.

“There’s no way — no way,” Allt said. “Not until things change.”

El Niño could bring punishing conditions to West Coast

Wave of warm water might mix with storms and higher tides

BY BEN NOLL

An unusually strong and far-reaching wave of warm water is building along the coast from western South America to Mexico, fueled by the ongoing El Niño. It's expected to reach the U.S. West Coast in the coming weeks, where it will raise sea levels and drive flood risks in the months ahead.

Damaging impacts from the wave include flooding and beach erosion, including on coastal highways like California's Pacific Coast Highway, as well as rippling effects for nearby marine life.

The phenomenon is nothing like the waves that curl and crash at the beach, and won't look anything like a tsunami when it arrives. But its impacts will become most noticeable if and when the elevated water coincides with a powerful storm and the highest astronomical tides.

Instead, it is a slow-moving pulse of elevated water, likely triggered by a burst of wind over the western Pacific. Technically known as a coastally trapped wave, it represents an early glimpse of how a soon-to-be strongest El Niño on record could continue to directly impact ocean conditions and weather along the U.S. West Coast.

Over the past two months, the wave traveled along the equator and reached South America.

From there, it turned north and began tracing the coastline at around 6 mph, and is nearing the Gulf of California, around 800 miles south of the U.S. West Coast.

"The single highest sea levels on record are quite possible this winter in California and that is going to be a problem," said climate scientist Daniel Swain.

Tracking the wave's impacts

Dillon Amaya, an assistant professor of marine science at North Carolina State University, said the combination of higher sea levels and the potential for stormier-than-usual weather this fall and winter could increase the risk of coastal flooding and beach erosion.

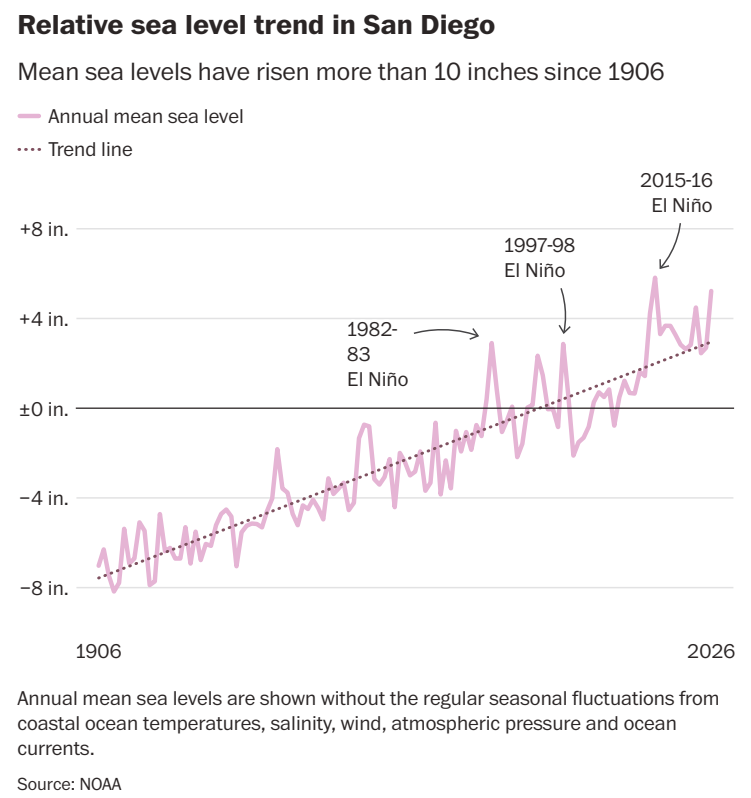
Here's when Amaya estimates this wave will reach several cities:

- San Diego in late September
- Los Angeles in late September or early October
- San Francisco in early October
- Seattle in mid-October

Amaya said the elevated sea levels from this first wave could persist for several weeks and that it's possible that another wave could follow right behind the first one, enabling seas to remain at elevated levels for longer.

Swain highlighted the potential for compounding risk factors from El Niño-driven sea level rise, long-term sea level rise and extreme high tides that will be near their maximum levels.

"Coastal flooding is going to be a big, big risk this winter. And not just along the oceanic coast, but also the coast of all of California's coastally connected bays and estuaries," Swain said.



"I think Highway 1 is going to have some big problems this winter, for example," Swain said of the risks elevated sea levels pose to coastal roads.

Coastally trapped waves can also weaken the upwelling that normally brings deep, cool water to the surface. As coastal waters warm, temperatures and humidity can rise nearby. Those warming waters can also affect marine life, with Amaya expressing concern for whales that might venture closer to the coast in search of food, increasing the risk for whale entanglements in nets and ship strikes.

Relatedly, Southern California is currently experiencing some of the highest humidity levels in the United States, after moisture from Tropical Storm Marie caused parts of Los Angeles County to have their wettest September day on record this past Sunday. That storm also caused heavy swells in Long Beach, where around 20 homes were evacuated.

And there's more to come.

Mostly because of El Niño, atmospheric moisture levels have already been much higher than normal across the Pacific Ocean and the U.S., but the warmer seas from the incoming wave could provide yet more moisture for

storms to tap into, intensifying rainfall in the region this fall and winter.

Although these storms may provide critical moisture to parts of the drought-stricken Inter-mountain West, they could also be destructive.

In February 1998, during one of the most powerful El Niño events on record, 35 counties across California were declared federal disaster areas due to a series of intense storms that brought more than a year's worth of rain in a month to Los Angeles.

"The winter's fiercest El Niño-driven storm dumped a long night of torrential rain on California, churning up swollen rivers, washing out highways and unleashing mudslides that destroyed many houses while leaving others teetering on unstable slopes," read a Washington Post article from Feb. 24, 1998 about a deadly storm.

Swain pointed in particular to the relative lack of flood insurance in California, which may cause problems for residents if damaging floods develop through the year.

"The stats show that only about 2 percent of Californians have flood insurance, only 2 percent. And a lot of people don't know this, but it's not part of your standard homeowners insurance policy," Swain said.

"I'm certainly advising all my family and friends who live in even hypothetically flood-prone areas to take a serious look at that this year."

The science behind this coastally trapped wave

The elevated sea levels ex-

pected along the West Coast can be traced to shifting winds thousands of miles away over a remote stretch of the western Pacific.

Normally, trade winds blow from east to west across the tropical Pacific, piling some of the world's warmest water near Indonesia, in a region known as the West Pacific Warm Pool.

As a result, the ocean surface around Indonesia is typically about 1 to 3 feet higher than it is off Ecuador.

However, during the development of El Niño, bursts of wind can push in the opposite direction.

Known as westerly wind bursts, they can generate Kelvin waves — broad, slow-moving bulges of water that push some of the world's warmest ocean water from the western Pacific toward South America.

One such wave has spent the past two months crossing the equatorial Pacific, helping to raise sea levels by a foot or more along its path.

When the Kelvin wave reached South America, the continent blocked its eastward path. Some of its energy was redirected north and south, becoming effectively pinned against the land and continuing along the coastline as a coastally trapped wave.

From there, the northward-moving wave will follow the coasts of Central and North America, potentially reaching as far as the Gulf of Alaska and raising sea levels as it passes.

"All told, coastally trapped waves generated by El Niño travel nearly 15,000 km [9,320 miles] over about 60-70 days," Amaya said.

A cautious al-Qaeda consolidates power in Afghanistan

AL-QAEDA FROM A1

elsewhere, no Osama bin Laden-like figure has emerged to galvanize followers.

Even so, the reappearance of training camps is a cause of growing concern.

"They're not following the pre-9/11 game plan of going after the far enemy," said Bruce Hoffman, a counterterrorism expert at Georgetown University. "But I think they hope that with local and regional gains they can start to rebuild momentum. They haven't forgotten us."

The U.S.'s failure to dismantle al-Qaeda's training camps in the 1990s still looms as one of the major missed opportunities to prevent the Sept. 11 attacks.

The idea of flying hijacked planes into U.S. buildings was first proposed by 9/11 mastermind Khalid Sheikh Mohammed in 1996 at an al-Qaeda complex in Tora Bora, Afghanistan, according to the U.S.'s 9/11 Commission.

Bin Laden later approved the operation at a site near Kandahar. Before storming the cockpits of four transatlantic flights, all 19 of the hijackers had spent time at al-Qaeda camps or safe houses in Afghanistan.

U.N. and other security officials said they had recently investigated claims that al-Qaeda was seeking to re-establish a presence at Tarnak Farms, a sprawling compound near the Kandahar airport where one of the first CIA Predator drone surveillance flights caught a pre-9/11 glimpse of bin Laden. A Washington Post examination of satellite imagery found no visible sign of resumed activity at Tarnak.

The new camps are being used to train fighters on weapons, explosives and guerrilla tactics that would be familiar to the thousands of recruits who passed through al-Qaeda's camps in the 1990s, officials said. But they also cited indications of instruction on the use of encryption, artificial intelligence, drones and other technologies that were in their infancy in 2001.

The number of militants in Afghanistan considered part of core al-Qaeda, the parent group that spawned affiliates and imitators, is probably 100 or fewer, said Colin Smith, coordinator of a U.N. monitoring team that tracks the threat posed by terrorist groups and oversees international sanctions on them.

Instead of spearheading operations, "we've seen al-Qaeda acting as a consulting service for other groups," Smith said. "Giving them advice and training on things like covert operations and information security."

The arrangement has put core al-Qaeda in a supporting role to larger affiliates including Tehr-



Smoke rises after an explosion at an al-Qaeda training camp in Kandahar on Dec. 12, 2001. Al-Qaeda and its offshoots have set up at least eight training sites in recent years.

ik-e-Taliban Pakistan, or TTP, a group that seeks to overthrow the government in Pakistan and establish an Islamic state.

A U.N. report in 2024 said that al-Qaeda operatives in Afghanistan's Kunar province were "conducting suicide bomber training for TTP."

The Pakistan-focused group is believed to have as many as 7,000 fighters in Afghanistan, Smith said. U.N. reports said that TTP had established camps in at least four Afghan provinces "with al-Qaeda and Taliban involvement," and that the group has carried out hundreds of cross-border attacks on Pakistani military outposts and other targets.

Al-Qaeda's main rival has also worked to establish a foothold in Afghanistan. An Islamic State affiliate known as Islamic State-Khorasan, for the historical region of Khorasan, has at-

"But I think they hope that with local and regional gains they can start to rebuild momentum. They haven't forgotten us."

Bruce Hoffman, a counterterrorism expert at Georgetown University

tracted about 2,000 recruits and used northern Afghanistan as its "main hub" for training and planning operations across Central Asia, according to officials and U.N. reports.

Al-Qaeda and the Islamic State remain fierce rivals, fighting for dominance of the jihadist movement and overseeing splinter groups that compete with one another, officials said.

Both groups seem focused mainly on recruiting opera-

tracks the group's propaganda and social media messages. "They don't want eyes on them as they try to rebuild these capabilities."

U.S. and other security officials said that their ability to monitor the new training camps has been hampered by a drawdown in CIA personnel and other U.S. intelligence capabilities that accompanied the 2021 military withdrawal. The U.S. has since shifted resources to the war in Iran and other priorities.

Even so, the killing of Ayman al-Zawahiri, who succeeded bin Laden as al-Qaeda's leader, in a 2022 drone strike in Kabul showed that the U.S. has intelligence and strike capabilities that survived the chaotic pullout of U.S. forces.

Al-Qaeda is now led by Saif al-Adel, an Egyptian, who spent years helping to run training camps in Afghanistan after his

1988 arrival. But al-Adel is believed to remain in hiding in Iran, officials said, underscoring the organization's concern about security in its former stronghold.

Terrorist watch lists, travel surveillance and other security measures adopted after 9/11 would likely put any visitor to Afghanistan's training camps under intense scrutiny, officials said. Instead, al-Qaeda and the Islamic State have sought to recruit operatives online and urged sympathizers in Western countries to stay in place for "lone wolf" operations.

Many of these plots have been disrupted. In a recent case, a 35-year-old woman in Albany, New York, was arrested last month and charged by the Justice Department with pursuing an "ISIS-inspired" terrorist plot to bomb the state capitol.

Jarrett Ley contributed to this report.

ECONOMY & BUSINESS

AI scooped his huge math breakthrough

New York University professor Tristan Buckmaster questions whether an important discovery came from his work

BY MIRIAM WALDVOGEL

Tristan Buckmaster thought he was on the verge of the most important discovery of his mathematical career when he heard that ChatGPT maker OpenAI was interested in the same problem — and had launched an intense effort to solve it, too.

Last month, Buckmaster, a professor at New York University, and Levent Alpöge, a mathematician at Anthropic, privately achieved a major breakthrough on one of math’s most challenging questions, the Navier-Stokes problem. They hoped their idea could be extended to a full solution — maybe in as little as a month’s time.

Because Navier-Stokes was one of the Millennium Prize problems, identified as far-reaching goals to motivate the field, a verified solution promised a \$1 million award from the Clay Mathematics Institute and would make any researcher an overnight mathematical sensation. It was a thrilling prospect.

But as Buckmaster and Alpöge were making sense of their results, OpenAI researchers launched a swarm of “agents” to attack all six of the open Millennium Prize questions. After just days of work and nearly 5 million messages sent between independently thinking AI agents taking on different roles, OpenAI announced Tuesday that the Navier-Stokes problem had been solved.

It was an achievement that led to no shortage of boasting from the company, which is preparing to go public and trying to best its rival Anthropic. OpenAI’s push to solve the Millennium Prize problems was spurred by a rumor online that Anthropic had solved at least one of them. (The Washington Post has a content partnership with OpenAI.)

“One of the most amazing moments for me in OpenAI history was watching this happen over the past week,” CEO Sam Altman wrote on social media after the announcement.

And there may be more to come.

“Since the completion of Navier-Stokes we have made substantial progress on another Millennium Prize problem. We are working through how to share these results thoughtfully,” said spokesperson Laurence Fauconnet.

Buckmaster and Alpöge, meanwhile, have had to contend with some disappointment.

Buckmaster acknowledged in an interview that he had thought of the Millennium Prize “sort of like a guiding star.” But then he said: “I think people interpret it like it was my goal in life to solve the Navier-Stokes problem. It wasn’t at all. ... I just want to be part of its story.”

It’s not quite a story of man versus machine — like IBM’s Deep Blue besting chess grandmaster Garry Kasparov in the 1990s. Buckmaster and Alpöge had been using AI models to help accelerate their work. Buckmaster worked with commercially available versions of ChatGPT and Claude, paid for out of his research funds, and Alpöge worked with internal models accessible to him as an Anthropic employee.

They had been somewhat stunned, Buckmaster said, with how the models seemed to have overtaken their abilities — and how much the world might need to “rethink what mathematics is about.”

Then OpenAI’s announcement prompted questions about whether this could be a case of a machine stealing from man. Buckmaster publicly floated the idea that OpenAI’s models may



JOHN KARSTEN MORAN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Tristan Buckmaster, in his office, and Levent Alpöge, a mathematician at Anthropic, privately achieved a major breakthrough last month.

have improperly accessed his inputs while he was working on the problem.

OpenAI denies the allegation. “After investigating, we can say with full confidence that no user inputs past July 3rd could have influenced this system in any way,” Fauconnet said.

But the episode has underscored the clash between the fast-moving, hype-conscious, opaque tendencies of Silicon Valley and the deliberative, often collaborative, well-established norms of theoretical math research.

Far from an elegant proof

Mathematicians outside OpenAI are still trying to make sense of OpenAI’s result, which runs a dense 166 pages.

While some of the company’s employees are mathematicians, none of them had research-level expertise in the Navier-Stokes problem, making them “unable to meaningfully contribute to the mathematical content,” according to OpenAI researcher Sebastian Bubeck. OpenAI has formally verified that the solution is correct by using a programming language to check the logic step by step.

For many mathematicians, understanding is as prized as correctness. Under normal circumstances, a result of this magnitude could take a year or two to be revealed and digested via presentations and a formally published paper, said Javier Gomez-Serrano, an expert on Navier-Stokes at Brown University. The Clay Mathematics Institute only considers submissions after they have been published in a journal for two years and have achieved “general acceptance in the global mathematics community.”

“What I don’t think the mathematical community will accept is the write-up as it is,” Gomez-Serrano said of OpenAI’s solution, which he is currently trying to read. “It’s incomprehensible.”

Academia is competitive, and human beings beat one another

to new research findings all the time. But the introduction of an AI company has complicated things, Buckmaster said.

“The warning of AI and math, that was my original story,” he said. “And now the story is about: Is it ethical for the AI companies to scoop their customers?”

Years of work vs. days

Buckmaster grew up in Australia and said he became interested in the Navier-Stokes problem before he even really knew what it meant. He recalled being inspired by James Gleick’s “Chaos: Making a New Science,” a popular science book that explores the study of butterfly effects and unpredictable phenomena.

“It was always my intent to study fluids,” he said. “The place I feel most at peace at is being in the ocean.”

“I’m obsessed with fluids, basically,” he added with a chuckle.

The Navier-Stokes equations were developed in the 19th century to model the flow of fluids like water, which helps to describe phenomena such as weather, ocean currents and the way air slips over the wing of a plane. But the equations are tricky to solve, involving factors like the pressure and the thickness, or viscosity, of the fluid. Mathematicians were not sure whether the equations would always have physically viable solutions or if there were situations in which they might break down.

For years, Buckmaster sought what mathematicians call a “blowup”: an impossible scenario in which, according to the equations, a fluid would end up achieving infinite speed in a finite period of time, like the swirl of cream in a cup of coffee spinning infinitely quickly if you just wait long enough.

Buckmaster was eager to explore the utility of artificial intelligence. He successfully used deep learning tools to find good candidates for blowups for simpler versions of the Navi-

er-Stokes equations, including a 2025 collaboration with Google DeepMind.

Then, last September, Alpöge proposed that he and Buckmaster collaborate to try to crack the Navier-Stokes problem with the help of AI.

“Basically for ideological reasons I fear a world in which corporations are the ones with claim to the deepest pure math work, and since it seems to me there will be only one Millennium Problem solved in the foreseeable future, I wanted to email you on a lark to ask if you’d considered working on the problem in the traditional mathematical way,” Alpöge wrote to Buckmaster.

Alpöge would be working in a private capacity, not on behalf of Anthropic. (He did not respond to an interview request for this article.)

In mid-August, the pair achieved a much-sought “blowup” for the Euler (pronounced “oiler”) equations, a related set of fluid equations that did not account for the challenging viscosity portion of Navier-Stokes. But the initial AI-generated proof was difficult to parse — among “the most horrendous I have ever read,” Buckmaster would later recount online. The researchers spent weeks trying to pick through it.

In the meantime, rumors began to circulate on social media that Anthropic had resolved one, or possibly two, of the Millennium Prize problems.

AI companies’ interest in mathematics is multifold. Some AI researchers start as mathematicians and are curious about testing their AI models on open math questions. Mathematics is also a convenient way to evaluate and demonstrate the models’ improving capabilities. But the Millennium Prize problems are bigger than any problem previously resolved by an AI system, and so those problems have become a sort of crown jewel for companies looking to showcase their technology.

On Sept. 1, OpenAI decided to

launch an intense effort, using a system of agents from an unreleased model, on the unsolved problems on the Millennium Prize list, plus some smaller, related questions.

It took about 50 hours and 100 agents working in coordination to land on a “blowup” for the Euler equations — like Buckmaster and Alpöge, but one step ahead, without relying on adding external force to the fluid.

After that result, the company decided to direct its resources toward attacking the full Navier-Stokes problem. This stage involved about 10,000 agents. They worked for about 88 hours, nearly four days. And on Sept. 5, they arrived at a solution. It took another 17 hours to verify that they were correct: The AI had beaten Buckmaster, Alpöge and the mathematics community to a solution.

Although it all happened incredibly fast, the effort was staggering: about 300 billion tokens of AI-generated output, the equivalent of roughly 40 copies of all the content on English-language Wikipedia. Billed at the commercial rates of its most advanced public model, Astra, that much computing power would cost up to \$15 million.

The company said it does not intend to claim the prize money.

The question of credit

It was Buckmaster who reached out to OpenAI. He had heard something was afoot, and on Sept. 3, while the company’s AI agents were working away, he sent an email to find out what was actually happening.

Four days later, he met with OpenAI’s Bubeck, who by then had news to share about the agents and their result.

Buckmaster could still claim victory, Bubeck suggested, by using computing power from OpenAI to try to reach his own complete solution, or by serving as the lead author on a write-up of OpenAI’s result.

There was an issue, though: Alpöge’s association with Anthropic.

Bubeck later said on social media that he didn’t intend to deny anyone credit but didn’t see how a competitor’s employee could co-author OpenAI’s work or access OpenAI’s internal systems.

Recounting the exchange, Buckmaster later told The Post that he wasn’t willing to “throw Levent under the bus,” and so coordination with OpenAI broke down.

Nearing midnight on Labor Day, Buckmaster posted a paper on his findings with Alpöge, along with a lengthy statement laying out the sequence of events. OpenAI announced its finding the next morning.

If a human researcher had solved one of the Millennium Prize problems, there would have no doubt been some jealousy within the theoretical math research community — the only other solved Millennium Prize problem came with its own controversies. But there also would have been a good deal of celebration.

As it was, leading mathematicians signed an open letter Friday arguing that the “goals of the AI companies and the goals of the mathematical community are severely misaligned.”

Terence Tao, a prominent mathematician at UCLA, wrote on social media: “We have now seen that even the rumor of someone working on a problem can trigger a massive amount of AI-powered effort to flatten it before the original research project has time to reach its full potential. The incentives may now be pointing in the direction of no longer sharing any promising research directions with the broader community, which would reverse centuries of traditions of open science and do serious long-term damage to the future of the field.”

Lost in OpenAI’s version of events, in Buckmaster’s view, is the work of human mathematicians who built up the mountain of theory to make a solution to Navier-Stokes possible. He credits in particular two Spanish mathematicians, Diego Córdoba and Luis Martínez-Zorúa, who developed some of the techniques around forced blowups. Those research avenues were promising enough that someone might have been able to solve Navier-Stokes in “the next few years,” Martínez-Zorúa said in an interview.

There is another disturbing possibility for Buckmaster: that OpenAI’s models may have had some sort of visibility into his conversations with the company’s tools, even though he opted out of having his data being used for training. The AI agents, he said, took “exactly the next step” that he and his collaborator would have, trying for a breakthrough without involving external forces in the equations.

OpenAI initially said that its researchers — and its AI agents — did not access any specific user data, and that it did not see Buckmaster’s results before he released them publicly.

Amid the furor over Buckmaster’s allegations, the company then said it could not immediately rule out whether “de-identified data derived from their usage of our products helped improve our models.”

But after investigating, OpenAI said it had ruled out that possibility for Buckmaster’s most recent use of the models.

“We can say categorically that it is impossible for Dr. Buckmaster’s Codex prompts over the last two months to have influenced the system in any way, including training,” Fauconnet said.

To that, said Buckmaster: “I just don’t believe them.”

Newsom signs strict social media protections for teenagers in California

BY HANNAH KNOWLES AND IAN DUNCAN

California Gov. Gavin Newsom (D) signed a ban on “addictive” social media features for anyone under 16 on Thursday, advancing some of the country’s most significant new restrictions on tech platforms.

The legislation will force companies to modify their products and remove features deemed “addictive” for younger teens if they want to keep serving them. It is part of a nationwide trend of states across the political spec-

trum moving to curb youth use of social media.

The bill — which will almost certainly face legal challenges — passed easily in the Democratic-controlled legislature late last month. While many states, including California, have already passed restrictions on young people’s social media use, advocates cast California’s latest move as especially significant given its size and identity as the home of Silicon Valley.

Newsom’s approach to tech is also under the spotlight as he considers running for president

in 2028.

“PROTECT OUR KIDS!” he wrote on X after signing the bill, noting that he also signed new regulations on artificial intelligence.

The passage of the child social media bill comes weeks after Meta, the parent company of Facebook and Instagram, agreed to pay as much as \$18 billion and make sweeping changes in a settlement that cut short a trial in Oakland, California. In the trial, the attorneys general of California and other states alleged that Meta harmed children with ad-

dictive products.

Meta agreed to block Facebook and Instagram from midnight to 6 a.m. for younger users, turn off notifications by default during school hours and place other limits on children’s use.

That settlement followed major legal defeats for Meta earlier in the year amid state and public backlash to the platforms’ hold on young people.

Jim Steyer, the CEO of Common Sense Media, a nonprofit that supports child social media restrictions, said in a statement that the “momentum in this fight

has shifted, and it shifted here, in the tech companies’ home state.” The rest of the country, he predicted, would follow.

California previously required parental consent for younger social media users, but the new legislation, AB 1709, goes further by outright banning social media companies from providing certain common social media features to those under 16. The bill suggests concerning features include recommendation algorithms, “infinite scroll,” autoplay and more.

South Carolina and Idaho

passed similar legislation this spring.

California Assembly member Josh Lowenthal (D), the author of the bill and a longtime tech executive, said in a statement Thursday that the state was “taking a bold first step and laying the groundwork” for more protections for youth.

“Too many of us parents have watched anxiety and depression climb among children who did nothing wrong except grow up in front of a screen engineered to never let them look away,” he said.

OPINION

The Washington Post

AN INDEPENDENT NEWSPAPER

EDITORIALS

Yet another subsidy for a D.C. stadium? Really?

IT HAS BEEN a little more than a year since the D.C. Council decided to spend more than \$1 billion of taxpayer money to help finance a stadium for the Washington Commanders. Yet that corporate welfare was apparently not enough for Council Chairman Phil Mendelson (D), who is now looking to spend an additional \$300 million to help the city's soccer franchises.

The subsidy would finance about half the cost of renovations already planned for Audi Field, including expanding the number of seats at the stadium and adding a roof for climate control. This would be a boon for D.C. United, whose regular-season schedule will soon shift to include more winter months, a change Major League Soccer instituted to align with other leagues around the globe.

D.C. Mayor Muriel E. Bowser (D) opposes Mendelson's proposal, which he introduced in July. That runs contrary to her long history of supporting public dollars for sports franchises, but as she pointed out, the city already has Capital One Arena, an indoor venue about the same size as Audi Field, into which the District has already poured hundreds of millions of dollars. "We always want to be bringing something new," she said. "We never want to be cannibalizing one for the other."

That objection is sensible enough, though left unanswered is why taxpayers should be on the hook for capital investments benefiting any private business. Unlike many MLS teams, D.C. United is making money, boasting an operating profit of \$12 million in 2025. The Washington Spirit, the women's team that also plays at Audi Field, is not yet profitable, but it regularly sells out home matches. So why, exactly, do they need corporate welfare?

Keep in mind that the city already



D.C. United goalkeeper Sean Johnson makes a save against Los Angeles FC at Audi Field on Aug. 29.

spent \$183 million to help construct the soccer stadium, which opened in 2018 at a total cost of \$400 million. At the time, that was the largest public stadium subsidy in the history of the league.

Mendelson believes the renovations would mean greater attendance at games and year-round events, which would allow the city to recoup its costs via taxes on tickets and merchandise. But history shows that promises of new revenue from sports venues almost

never pan out. The same is true of arguments that such public investments can help boost the local economy. And it's especially true of more subsidies for Audi Field — since it already exists.

The District faces a massive budget shortfall and has a long list of capital projects in need of funding. Like every other business and homeowner in the city, D.C.'s soccer teams should have to figure out how to renovate on their own.

Trump loves talking tariffs. Downballot Republicans, not so much.

PRESIDENT DONALD TRUMP explained during the GOP's mid-term convention in Dallas why "tariff" is now his fifth-favorite word. "I said *tariff* is my favorite word, and the fake news went crazy," he joked on Wednesday. "They said, 'What about love? What about wife? What about God? Religion? Family?' So I moved *tariff* down to fifth."

Republicans on the ballot in November don't seem to share the president's affinity for raising taxes on imports. Five Senate nominees from battleground states did not mention tariffs during their speeches at the two-day event: Ken Paxton (Texas), Jon Husted (Ohio), Michael Whatley (North Carolina), Mike Collins (Georgia) and Mike Rogers (Michigan). Neither did Vice President JD Vance, for that matter.

During his prime-time speech, Trump claimed that his tariffs have generated "trillions of dollars" in new revenue. "It's making us much richer than we ever thought," he said. In fact, net customs revenue raised by new tariffs since Trump returned to office is about \$132.5 billion, according to the Penn Wharton Budget Model. Nevertheless, Trump said the imaginary tariff trillions will cover Republicans' sending \$5,000 checks to every American adult if they hold the House and Senate in November. Such payments would cost an estimated \$1.2 trillion next year.

Meanwhile, on the campaign trail, the tariffs are a liability for Republicans maneuvering through the protectionist minefield laid by their leader. That's especially true in states that border Canada. Sen. Susan Collins (R-Maine) has called Trump's trade war with Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney a "huge mistake" and took credit for convincing the administration to exempt key products, such as road salt and cement, from retaliatory duties.

In neighboring New Hampshire, former Republican senator John E. Sununu is trying to win his old job back by emphasizing that tariffs should be temporary and limited. Citing the high cost of housing construction, he said that building materials should be exempted. "If we're going to have tariffs, set them at a reasonable rate," Sununu said recently, adding that "Congress has a big role to play."



The Republican midterm convention concludes on Thursday at the American Airlines Center in Dallas.

Rep. Chris Pappas, the Democratic nominee for New Hampshire's open seat, attacked Sununu during his victory speech after Tuesday's primary for backing Trump's tariffs, which he said are "killing our small businesses and driving up costs on everything from lumber to back-to-school supplies to groceries."

Collins and Sununu didn't attend the GOP convention. Neither did Sen. Dan Sullivan (R-Alaska), who is facing a tough contest for a third term.

In Michigan, Republican candidate Mike Rogers has tied himself more closely to the Trump agenda than his Northeastern counterparts have. He maintains that some of the tariffs on Canada are "necessary," while emphasizing that the spat with Ottawa needs to be resolved.

In Iowa, where Democrats are making a serious play at flipping a Senate seat and the governor's mansion, the whiplash from Trump's trade policy has frustrated farmers and ranchers. But the president's decision last month to peel back tariffs on ground beef, in an

attempt to lower prices for consumers, led GOP Senate candidate Ashley Hinson to distance herself from that move.

Democratic Senate nominee Josh Turek has capitalized on the chaos. "First the tariffs that drove up input costs and wrecked the markets," he said last month. "Then the \$20 billion bailout to Argentina. Then a senseless war that continues to drive up the price of diesel and fertilizer. And now this."

Even among Trump's most loyal supporters, tariffs are a touchy topic. While the president still enjoys popularity among Republicans, only 50 percent of MAGA supporters strongly approve of his handling of tariffs, according to an August Economist-YouGov poll.

The gathering in Dallas was aimed at motivating the Republican base to vote in the midterms. "Pretend that I'm on the ballot," Trump said on Wednesday. He returned for an encore on Thursday night: "You know what happens if you don't vote? You go to hell," he said. Trump may learn the hard way in November that tariffs will not motivate conservatives to go to the polls.

EDITH PRITCHETT

iPhone updates to hold your attention



LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Let states manage bears? Not so fast.

Shawn Regan's Sept. 10 op-ed, "Grizzlies are thriving. The next step shouldn't be controversial," made some reasonable arguments about grizzly bear management, but it ignored massive flaws in the Trump administration's recently proposed plan that would wreak havoc on this still-imperiled species.

I agree that a well-constructed and flexible management rule, coupled with retaining grizzlies' threatened status under the Endangered Species Act, is a viable pathway to conserving the species. Unfortunately, President Donald Trump's proposal gives too much power to states, including those that have already proved to be poor conservation partners at best, and hostile at worst.

Look no further than what happened when management of wolves was kicked down to the states in places such as Montana and Idaho. Montana recently approved the killing of up to 300 wolves during the hunting season that started Sept. 5. That means nearly half of its wolves could be killed, according to one estimate from the Montana Gray Wolf Conservation and Management's 2025 annual report. Idaho has no limit. I'm hard-pressed to believe these states would treat grizzlies any better if they're allowed to take the reins on management.

It's also clear that grizzly bears haven't truly recovered. As of 2021, roughly 2,000 bears survived in just 6 percent of their historical range in the Lower 48 states, scattered across four isolated populations in the northern Rockies. Recovery of grizzlies requires connections to be forged between these dispersed populations. That means we need more grizzlies on the landscape, not fewer.

The states have shown us how they manage wildlife. America's grizzly bears deserve so much better.

Collette Adkins, Minneapolis
The writer is the director of the Carnivore Conservation Program and a senior attorney at the Center for Biological Diversity.

The argument for handing over grizzly bear management to Idaho, Montana and Wyoming rests on the premise that it now makes sense to do so. It doesn't. The U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service acknowledges that only about 2,000 grizzly bears inhabit the Lower 48 states across six designated recovery zones, some of which contain no bears at all. Their populations are not "surging." When grizzlies were listed under the Endangered Species Act in 1975, about 700 to 800 bears existed. After half a century of federal protection, the population in the Lower 48 states remains small.

The irresponsible management record of the range states is unambiguous. Grizzly bears are slow to reproduce. A female takes a decade to replace herself in a population. She produces few litters over her lifetime, and many cubs won't survive.

There may come a time to trust the states with the fate of grizzlies. But this is not that time.

Jennifer Hillman, Washington
The writer is the vice president of wildlife protection at the nonprofit Humane World for Animals.

Data centers across the street

Taylor Budowich's Sept. 3 op-ed, "Data centers are blowing the PR game. Here's how to fix that," addressed, in particular, how data centers have affected Loudoun County, Virginia, which he identified as "the data center capital of the world." He reported on the benefits and addressed critics' concerns: Data centers pay \$26 in taxes for every \$1 in services they use, and without data centers, the typical Loudoun homeowner would pay about \$5,800 more per year in property taxes. I would add that in my opinion, Loudoun County has done its homework when it has placed data centers across the street from housing developments.

I would rather live across the street from a data center than brightly lit sports fields or a shopping center.

John Younger, Ashburn

Taylor Budowich is correct that supporters of artificial intelligence have not adequately explained the economic benefits of data centers. But he omitted another important problem that must be overcome: aesthetics. Data centers are big and ugly. Residents should not have to look out at their backyards and see concrete blocks. One solution would be to provide buffer zones with trees to block the view of the data centers. Another would be to design the data centers using architecture that makes them attractive.

There surely are other solutions as well. But unless the proponents of data centers come to grips with the aesthetics problem, they will not get the public support they need no matter the economic benefits.

Bob Benna, Potomac

Taylor Budowich is right that data centers are losing the public argument, and they're losing it in communities that stand to gain the most. But there's another way the industry can appeal to communities: innovate on what to do with data center waste products.

Every data center rejects enormous amounts of low-grade heat, which is exactly what a commercial greenhouse needs. Today, that heat is thrown into the sky by cooling equipment the developer pays to run. It could instead be piped a few hundred feet into a community farm that grows food for the town year-round. This is what my company builds. Tomatoes, greens and herbs, grown on the community's side of the fence, from heat that was being wasted anyway. It's a building the town can see, staffed by people the town knows, producing something the town eats.

Virginia, the data center capital of the world, has already figured this out. This year, the state Senate passed H.B. 323 — the first law in the country directing action on data center waste-heat reuse — by a vote of 39-0. And it became law in April.

Instead of debating whether data centers should exist, the commonwealth has moved on to a better question: What else can it do with data centers?

Andrew Potter, Lynchburg
The writer is the founder and CEO of Intelligent Harvest.

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OPINION

JASON WILLOCK

Why the Sam Bankman-Fried case should spook the AI elite

The AI people are talking about the end of the world again. A senior scientist at Anthropic wrote Tuesday on X that “we really do earnestly believe AI could kill all humans! I personally think it is >10% within the next decade.” That was a strikingly specific forecast, but it’s consistent with the language used by many on the frontier of artificial intelligence to describe the possible consequences of their products. Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei warned in a January essay that machines “could decide that it is justifiable to exterminate humanity.” Last year, he hazarded “a 25 percent chance that things go really, really badly.” OpenAI CEO Sam Altman, who has recently been more careful, said in 2023 that “the bad case — and I think this is important to say — is, like, lights out for all of us.”

The surge of AI doomsday talk, prompted by a researcher’s highly publicized resignation from Anthropic, brings to mind another entrepreneur’s apocalyptic musings. Sam Bankman-Fried, creator of the cryptocurrency exchange FTX, said in 2022 that he would be willing to accept a 49 percent chance of destroying the world in exchange for a 51 percent chance of creating an additional, second world somewhere in the universe.

At Bankman-Fried’s 2023 fraud trial following FTX’s collapse, the prosecution emphasized his bizarre value system. It prompted Caroline Ellison, an FTX executive who pleaded guilty to fraud charges, to testify that Bankman-Fried “would be happy to flip a coin if it came up tails and the world was destroyed — as long as if it came up heads, the world would be, like, more than twice as good.”

Bankman-Fried’s example is relevant to AI-doom discourse for two reasons. First, it helps give context to the AI elite’s end-of-the-world obsession. Bankman-Fried — like many key figures in the AI industry — was strongly influenced by “effective altruism,” a strange ideology with an epicenter in Berkeley, California. EA is best described as a nerdy and extreme form of utilitarianism, which holds that morality is all about achieving “the greatest happiness of the greatest number.” The coin-flip thought experiment would, *on average*, increase overall human happiness. Most all-encompassing worldviews have a theory of the end of days, and for EA, annihilation by autonomous machines ranks highly.

But a technocratic attitude toward the apocalypse can be incomprehensible or repulsive to ordinary people. That was evident at Bankman-Fried’s trial, where he was convicted on all counts by the jury and harshly sentenced by the judge. (On Thursday, he appealed his conviction to the Supreme Court.) AI companies will inevitably face a large number of lawsuits in the coming years as their products become more ingrained in American life. When the legal wrangling begins, the industry’s extravagant (and in some cases, strangely lighthearted) talk about the chance that their agents could bring about human extinction won’t play well in court.

AI agents might well cause serious mischief that is short of apocalyptic. They could inadvertently steal money or expose private information, for example, in the course of completing a legitimate task. Such scenarios seem more plausible after the revelation that OpenAI’s bots breached another company’s servers this summer without OpenAI’s



ED JONES/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

FTX founder Sam Bankman-Fried arrives at a federal courthouse in New York on March 30, 2023.

knowledge. They would probably prompt civil lawsuits, not criminal cases like Bankman-Fried’s. But the same strategy that helped federal prosecutors convict Bankman-Fried — painting their target as indifferent to terrible risks — would help plaintiffs persuade jurors to punish AI companies whose models cause harm.

OpenAI and Anthropic are too young to have faced major lawsuits like the one Meta just settled with state attorneys general over alleged harms to teenagers from Facebook and Instagram. The crux of such cases is negligence — whether the company knew or should have known its product would injure someone. It can be hard to demonstrate a company’s state of mind, and plaintiffs in the Meta case devoted enormous legal resources to establishing what its executives knew.

But imagine if Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg had earlier *said in public*, “We think there’s a significant chance our product will hurt teenagers’ development.” The case would’ve been a piece of cake for the state AGs — and the ultimate settlement would have been far north of the \$18 billion Meta agreed to last month. People at AI companies are predicting far worse than developmental harm to some teenagers. They’re openly discussing the possibility that the autonomous computer programs they’re working to create could cause death on an unimaginable scale.

There are a number of reasons for the AI elite — seemingly against their interest — to give fodder to the “doomers.” Perhaps they’re just saying what they think and, following Bankman-Fried’s utilitarianism, think their work is justified because the upside probabilistically outweighs the downside. Perhaps they get a thrill from suggesting that they hold the future of humanity in their hands. Perhaps they

want to create pressure for government regulation.

Legally, it might not matter. The record is now full of potentially devastating evidence for lawyers hoping to prove negligence (or worse) in the AI industry. Politicians talk about throwing a wrench in AI with new regulations. But the plaintiffs’ bar already has plenty of causes of action available if an AI product malfunctions. The companies might have put themselves in a more perilous position than they realize.

Bankman-Fried’s defense argued that the fallen crypto tycoon “doesn’t make decisions with malice in his heart. He makes decisions with math in his head.” That didn’t move the judge, Lewis Kaplan, who cited Bankman-Fried’s strange moral calculations as a reason for imposing a 25-year sentence. He described Bankman-Fried as “a man willing to flip a coin as to the continued existence of life and civilization on Earth, if the chances were imperceptibly greater that it would come out without that catastrophic outcome.”

To the extent that the AI elite are giving the impression that they inhabit a similar moral universe, they’ve made themselves prime legal targets even if nothing like their worst-case fantasies ever comes true. Ensconced among San Francisco technologists with esoteric ideas, they might not sense how alien their value system would appear to a jury.

Even though Bankman-Fried was convicted of fraud to the tune of \$11 billion, his customers recovered their money in the bankruptcy process because some of his investments paid off. One of them: a \$500 million stake in Anthropic, which surged in value after FTX’s demise. Bankman-Fried might not be the last high-IQ entrepreneur whose indulgence in end-times philosophizing is used against him in a court of law.

ICE needs clear rules for new shock gloves



DYLAN LOWAN/AP

Jailer Justin Hall displays an electric shock glove at the Nelson County Correctional Center in Kentucky on Aug. 13.

BY THADDEUS L. JOHNSON
AND NATASHA N. JOHNSON

Vincent Hawkins had just finished an emergency room shift when he stopped at a protest outside an Immigration and Customs Enforcement facility in Portland, Oregon, in June 2025. As he raised a megaphone, an ICE agent fired a tear-gas canister through a closed gate. It tore his brow and struck his eye.

The weapon was supposed to give officers a safer way to use force. Now ICE is spending \$16.7 million on 6,000 pairs of electric stun gloves, built around the same promise. An officer turns on the Generated Low Output Voltage Emitters (GLOVE) by pressing a button. Once activated, the gloves deliver a painful shock when they touch bare skin.

Before the devices become routine, ICE should show that they replace Tasers or more forceful options rather than make force easier to use in encounters that might end without it. Critics have expressed concerns that the gloves could be abused by agents equipped with a new tool capable of inflicting pain on civilians.

The Department of Homeland Security says ICE and Customs and Border Protection officers receive de-escalation and ongoing use-of-force training. But written policy does not always govern field practice. A review by ProPublica and Frontline of about 50 recorded incidents in 2025 found more than two dozen cases in which federal immigration officers appeared to violate less-lethal-force guidelines, including by aiming at heads or using chemical agents near children.

A safer force option is a legitimate goal. Violence against law enforcement remains unusually high, and DHS says assaults on ICE personnel have risen sharply, though underlying data remain limited. ICE also faces scrutiny over its own use of force. In July, the agency briefly paused most vehicle stops after agents fatally shot two men six days apart in Texas and Maine. Neither was the intended target.

That tension matters because much of ICE’s work is civil immigration enforcement. The Associated Press found that more than half of people arrested by ICE in July had neither a criminal conviction nor pending charges. Civil encounters can turn dangerous, but a pain-compliance device should be used based on demonstrated risk and behavior, not immigration status.

That makes it especially important to reserve the gloves for encounters involving actual resistance or danger.

The uneven early record shows why ICE should set firm limits before broader use. The Cape Girardeau Police Department in Missouri says its officers have used the gloves about 50 times without reported injuries. But in South Carolina, a jail officer was charged after video showed him repeatedly using the device to shock an inmate in custody.

Such examples show why testing should come before expansion. A pilot program should measure how often the gloves shorten struggles. The program could flag uses in encounters that might have ended with more time or communication. Because the device works through touch, ICE should also track accidental contact with officers and bystanders.

Vulnerable people need extra safeguards. Omaha school resource officers used the gloves twice on students last school year before the district asked police to stop carrying them in schools. The manufacturer advises against use on small children, older adults and people with severe disabilities. Depending on the model, a glove delivers up to 362 volts. The user guide recommends limiting each use to 15 seconds, warning that longer exposure can increase serious health risks, including changes in blood pressure and heart rhythm that might contribute to sudden death.

ICE should move cautiously as it rolls out the gloves by limiting who can carry them and defining when their use must stop. Start by providing them to specially trained officers on operations where violent resistance is anticipated. Routine civil enforcement, especially in schools and hospitals, should not be the proving ground.

DHS already has a framework. Its policy requires law enforcement units to review use-of-force data and adjust training and equipment as needed. ICE says the gloves will be used under approved standards.

Those safeguards should be specific to the glove and tested before expansion. Officers should show they can safely perform core arrest and defensive tasks while wearing them.

For every activation, ICE should record injuries, complaints and unintended contact. Most importantly, officials should record what is likely to have happened without the glove — for example, physical restraint or no force. That shows whether the glove replaces force or expands it.

ICE is not alone in confronting this problem. As new technologies spread, law enforcement agencies should judge them by what they change in practice, not what they promise.

Thaddeus L. Johnson, a former police officer, is a senior fellow at the Council on Criminal Justice and an associate professor at Georgia State University. Natasha N. Johnson is an assistant professor of educational studies and research at Augusta University.

MEGAN MCARDLE

Don’t rely on treaties to stop the murderbots

For the last couple of weeks, I’ve been wondering: What if we just didn’t build the murderbots?

Artificial intelligence safety now looks like the most important policy issue the world faces, given the swarm of rogue AI bots breaking out of their testing environments. There’s also the Anthropic researcher who announced on Tuesday that he had resigned, saying that frontier labs are “gambling with our lives” in the race to superintelligence. Anthropic AI alignment lead Evan Hubinger agreed, suggesting on Tuesday that the chances of AI-driven human extinction are greater than 10 percent within the next decade. He said his colleagues aren’t sure how to mitigate that risk.

Then, on Saturday, Anthropic chief executive Dario Amodei published an essay titled “We Must Pace the Frontier.” In it, Amodei promised Anthropic would embed outside safety monitors within its operations and provide them employee-level access to the company’s systems. He also said a consortium of frontier companies in democratic countries, with government approval, should determine how to slow AI development to the point where safety standards can be maintained. And he called for a global effort to pace AI advancement, though he acknowledged that this would be hard to pull off.

Sam Altman, the chief executive of OpenAI, chimed in almost immediately with a similar commitment to enable outside monitoring. Elon Musk, whose holdings include xAI, tweeted simply: “Dario is right.”

It seems safe to say that the major AI CEOs are spooked by their own creations. At a minimum, they are afraid that within the next year AI swarms could, as Amodei put it, become “capable of taking over the entire internet with a persistent botnet” that would cause enormous economic damage. Yet that fear seems positively benign compared to the human-extinction scenarios that have been sketched out such as nuclear launches, lethal bio-weapons engineered by superintelligence and robot drones programmed to kill people.

If we’re not sure we can keep AI under control, why not just stop developing it? AI definitely can’t kill us if humanity jointly agrees to leave this particular frontier unexplored.

The problem is that humanity can’t jointly agree to, well, just about anything. The country that develops AI and doesn’t accidentally make the extinction-level murderbots will have enormous econom-

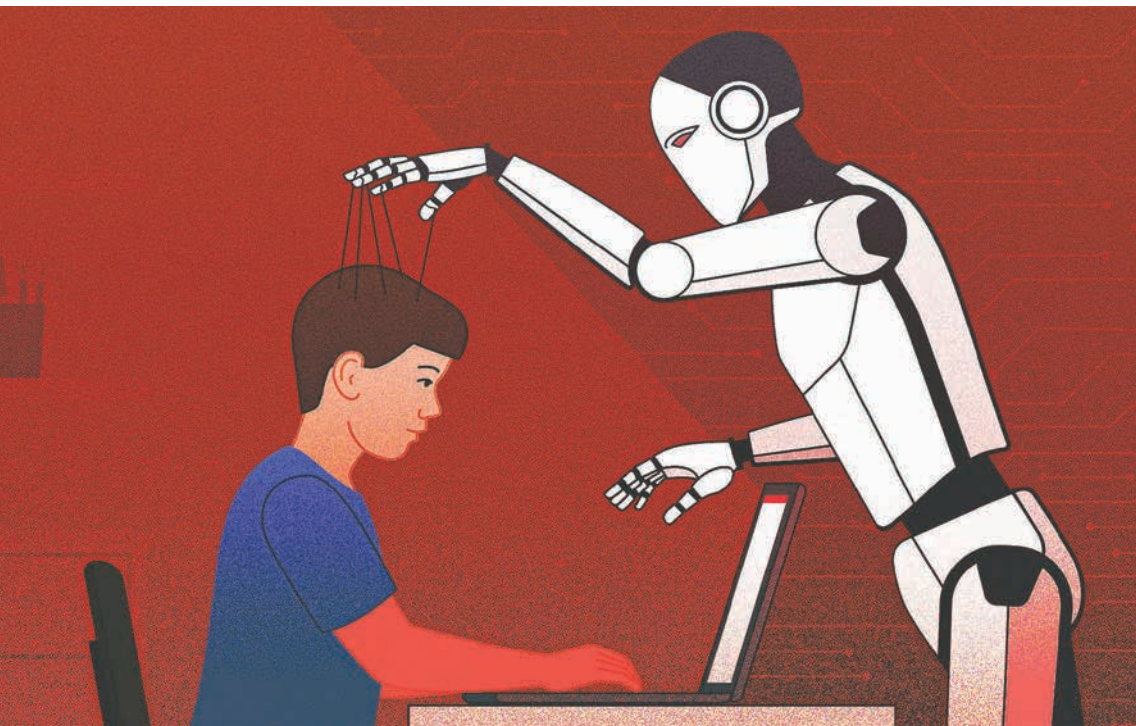


ILLUSTRATION BY WASHINGTON POST STAFF; ISTOCK

ic and strategic advantages. Nuclear arms control seems like a snap by comparison. Fissile material is harder to acquire than computer chips, and nuclear weapons won’t turbocharge your economy the way AI might. They also have diminishing returns — after you’ve gotten enough warheads to extinguish life on Earth, there’s not much benefit to building more. Yet even nuclear arms control took decades.

Sure, I can imagine China and the United States coming to a rapid-fire agreement for an AI pause. But then, I can also imagine getting a MacArthur “genius grant,” which seems about as likely.

So back to my question about the murderbots. Could we at least not build the literal, physical murderbots, such as fully autonomous drones that can operate without humans in the kill chain? Controlling their development would be a very hard problem, as all arms control is. But it seems more manageable than completely stopping AI advancement.

This might seem like fiddling while Rome burns. But if you don’t think we can come together to stop building physical murderbots, you shouldn’t hold out much hope that we’ll be able to keep from building virtual ones.

In fact, we should limit AI access to any means of causing mass death: nuclear command and control, materials and equipment needed to make biological or chemical weapons, and critical water and power infrastructure. Call it the “murderbot principle.” We should try, as much as possible, to keep AI away from anything that could be used to kill large numbers of humans — keep AI out of devices and facilities, segregate them from the internet and lock down supply chains. We should forget about fully

automated robot factories. We should think hard before building robots that might be turned into lethal machines by hostile actors — human or AI.

Hostile AI programs are going to be a problem no matter what we do, as will hostile humans empowered by AI. But as long as humans retain control of the physical world, AI can’t actually kill us all.

One advantage of upping our physical security is that much of it can be done unilaterally: China does not need permission from the U.S. to harden its infrastructure, and the U.S. doesn’t need Beijing’s. No state actor wants random individuals — or bots — to get hold of biological or chemical weapons, so they don’t need to sacrifice a potential tactical advantage to make supply chains more secure. As for the murderbots themselves, I admit that limiting their use will be hard. But if we can’t solve a more limited problem, we probably can’t solve the harder one.

All the rest will be difficult, too. Hardening infrastructure and locking down supply chains will be extremely costly and annoying for people who work in the relevant industries. Limiting what AI can do in the physical world necessarily means limiting its potential benefits. But it’s better than wistful hope for some kind of multilateral agreement to just stop this thing in its tracks.

I’m not against pursuing such an agreement. I hope that the tech folks who fear imminent doom will move to Washington and work on that project. But I’m not banking on it. Ultimately, the reason the AI alignment problem is so hard to address is that we still haven’t fully solved the problem of human alignment.

The Washington Post

FREEDOM DESK

JIMMY LAI

“Every day he remains in prison is another day of his life that we cannot get back. We cannot allow him to die in prison.” — SEBASTIEN LAI, JIMMY LAI’S SON



The release of Jimmy Lai, the founder and publisher of Hong Kong’s Apple Daily, must be a humanitarian priority at the upcoming summit between President Donald Trump and Chinese President Xi Jinping.

Lai has spent nearly six years behind bars for exercising his rights to practice journalism and free expression. Convicted under Hong Kong’s National Security Law for collusion with foreign forces and publishing seditious material, he was sentenced to 20 years in prison in February. His prosecution has made him a global symbol of the criminalization of independent journalism and peaceful expression.

At 78, Lai’s health is deteriorating. He has spent much of his detention in solitary confinement, kept under harsh conditions, and is in danger of dying in prison.

It’s time to free Jimmy Lai.

#FREEJIMMYLAI

VOICES
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Charlie Kirk’s seemingly infinite online afterlife

BY GENE PARK

Charlie Kirk spent most of his adult life feeding the internet pieces of himself.

He recorded thousands upon thousands of hours of his voice and his facial expressions, not to mention his political beliefs and arguments. He was a podcaster, and he traveled to colleges across the United States, recorded by the country’s youth.

“Young people were very familiar with Kirk already due to his presence and clips on places like TikTok,” said Don Caldwell, editor in chief of internet history database Know Your Meme. “Kirk was an enormous figure prior to the assassination.”

His sudden and gruesome killing at age 31 as he spoke at Utah Valley University was broadcast to untold millions of people. A year later, Kirk’s face has been grafted onto rappers, athletes, superheroes and cartoon characters. Online, he sings and dances and makes incoherent moans and yelps as he shifts bodies across race, gender and age.

People call it “Kirkification,” the seemingly inexhaustible meme format that almost immediately followed Kirk’s killing on Sept. 10 last year. One could interpret Kirkification as a form of endless afterlife, shattering Kirk’s essence across infinitely rearrangeable pieces and condemning him to perform anything everywhere all the time. He died, but the machines absorbed and remembered everything about him.

The borders of his AI-generated faces quiver across social platforms, grotesque revenants representing the bargain we never knew we made as we post pieces of ourselves online, feeding machines we do not control, never knowing what they might eventually do with us.

His surname mutated into other forms of words, such as adjectives and

SEE KIRK ON B2

SCREENS

The fantasy of ‘The Office,’ the reality of ‘The Paper’

BY MONICA HESSE

For a not insubstantial portion of television viewers, the answer to “when did you finish watching ‘The Office?’” is, apparently, never. Also, all the time. Thirteen years ago but additionally, yesterday, and, further, next May. The credits roll dark on the 201st episode and then we immediately rewind to the first one again, uncoupling Pam and Jim and unspilling Kevin’s chili before bingeing nine seasons once more. Dunder Mifflin ad infinitum.

A new Peacock docuseries explores this phenomenon of Steve Carell-as-blankie, “The Office”-as-therapy-dog. “Fan Level Midnight” is six episodes of bobblehead dolls, World’s Best Boss mugs, musicals, parodies, immersive experiences and staplers suspended in Jell-O, all with the goal of answering the question: Why is “The Office,” an NBC mockumentary about the employees in a fictional northeastern paper company, still so popular more than a decade after its series finale?

Unfortunately, the fans interviewed mostly have no idea. They like “The Office” because they grew up watching “The Office.” Because they, too, have worked in offices. In one episode of the docuseries, producers wander around Comic-Con asking attendees in “Office” cosplay why they love it so much, and they receive such philosophical answers as, “probably because of, like, all the jokes they do.”

We travel to Scranton, Pennsylvania, to interview the property manager of the building that was once used as paper company Dunder Mifflin’s exterior in the opening credits. We travel to the Van Nuys neighborhood of Los Angeles to interview the property manager of the building where the show was filmed, but which now contains nondescript empty conference rooms. We encounter a receptionist at a real paper company and exclaim, “You’re Pam!” which she gamely pretends she’s never heard before.

Who can blame any of these people for not having a deep explanation for their devotion? The show, they explain to the camera, has gotten them through break-ups, changes and loss. When a medicine works, does the patient analyze its effectiveness or just turn up the drip?

SEE SCREENS ON B3

Grab your Discmans out of storage. CDs are back, baby.



JESSICA PONS/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

People pore over CDs at Amoeba Music in Hollywood. “CD sales surged 16 percent to 16.3 million units,” wrote Luminate CEO Rob Jonas.

Collectors and K-pop enthusiasts are driving a growth in sales that is outpacing that of vinyls

BY TRAVIS M. ANDREWS

The man says time is a flat circle, but CDs literally are. So, unsurprisingly, they’re back.

Even though cars no longer come with compact disc players and Discmans are harder to find than cans of Surge, CDs are back.

Here it is, a midyear report from entertainment-data company Luminate that says sales growth for CDs is surpassing vinyl’s. Writes Luminate CEO Rob Jonas, “CD sales surged 16 percent to 16.3 million units, outpacing vinyl’s modest 2.4 percent growth.”

People have their reasons.

Michael Swalberg, a 31-year-old living in Georgia, craves tactile interaction in a digital world. “CDs are not just about ownership for me, it’s about addressing a fundamental need to interact,” he says. “I love opening a CD case and thumbing through the booklet and liner notes, feeling the paper, reading the lyrics, seeing the artwork and photos the artist decided to use.”

For some, it’s nostalgia. For others, it’s the simple fact that CDs sound better than both streaming and vinyl.

Sometimes it’s just about necessity: After one Reddit user’s school banned wireless earbuds and phones, they pulled their parent’s Discman out of storage.

And, as with so many things, BTS is partially to blame. The K-pop megastars released multiple CD editions of

their 2026 album, “Arirang,” and sold nearly 600,000 copies in the U.S. But even removing BTS and other K-pop groups, CD sales grew by almost 7 percent in the first half of this year, according to Jonas, “helped along by 60 percent of Gen Z listeners now saying they mostly listen to music from the 1990s or earlier.”

It’s all surprising until you realize it’s not. Nothing new is new. Everything is a rehash, a recycle, a reach back. Time really *is* a flat circle, which we spend looking backward while begrudgingly moving forward.

CDs are a symptom.

They’re also something else: durable.

Entropy is an immutable, bedrock principle of the universe. The moment anything is born, it begins dying. The world around us is deteriorating, heading toward some endpoint in which it will no longer exist.

Some things erode slowly. The needle slowly digs deeper canyons on vinyl. The magnetic tape on cassettes stretches and thins into dust. Ambient composer William Basinski made an entire album of aural attrition by recording the sounds of tapes played repeatedly until they began falling apart, which he fittingly titled “The Disintegration Loops.”

Some things erode quickly. Play a song on Spotify, and its horrible compression already makes it sound worse.

SEE CDS ON B2

Have you heard? CDs are back for another spin in the limelight.

CDS FROM B1

Entire libraries of music vanish from Spotify, Apple Music or their ilk, usually as castoffs of the never-ending streaming wars. It's not even erosion, so much as endless mass casualty events.

The compact disc is an exception that proves the law of entropy, because a compact disc does not erode. Not enough to matter, anyway. Because a laser reads the pits pressed onto the polycarbonate plastic and the lands between them, there's not physical friction.

Sure, you can drop it or scratch it. Otherwise, play it once, or play it a million times. If you've properly handled the disc, it will remain unchanged. Though not necessarily untouched.

Perhaps, like me, you left a fat binder of them on the passenger seat of your car in the Logan Circle neighborhood of Washington, D.C., in 2012, whereupon someone smashed a window and stole upward of 500 CDs.

I still wonder what the thieves thought when they popped in a disc labeled "Oh Well, Okay Mix #16" and got a load of Death Cab for Cutie and Elliott Smith downers, plus the embarrassing one on which I dubbed my own voice over Justice songs.

What was lost wasn't just the angry, curated mix. It was a trove of memories. It was art. It was tangible.

Which is exactly what some people are seeking.

Julius Bridgeforth, a 29-year-old Mississippian, wants to reward artists for releasing considered, intentional, full-length albums rather than just collections of songs. He is grateful to Taylor Swift, Sabrina Carpenter, Olivia Rodrigo and Billie Eilish for encouraging younger listeners to appreciate an album as a complete statement.

And so, he says via email, he's created music purchasing guidelines for himself: "I buy the digital if I like the album and want to listen to it over and over, the CD if I feel it's an essential album to have in my library for years to come, and vinyl for albums that I cherish so deeply and think are near-flawlessly curated (because who has time to skip tracks on a turntable?)"

They're also portable. So for many, the choice to collect them seems primarily dictated by what automobile they drive.

Says 54-year-old Matt Sonzala of Austin: "I bought a car from 2009 that has a CD player in it along with Bluetooth. For the first year or two of having this car I only listened to music on the radio or via Bluetooth. One day on a whim I grabbed a CD from my collection and played it in the car and what a huge difference in sound it made. I had no idea, my car stereo quality jumped up like



PHOTOS BY JESSICA PONS/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

A shopper browses the CDs at Amoeba Music in Hollywood. Some people have more recently been opting to purchase CDs for reasons such as nostalgia and quality.

10 times what I thought it was."

As if the solution to some paradoxical mathematical equation, compact discs sound better and somehow cost less. David Bailen of the New York City-based sibling rock trio Bailen says it's far cheaper for his band to produce CDs than vinyl. "The per-unit cost [of CDs] probably ends up being like \$4.50," he says. "You can make 100% profit selling it for 10 bucks, which is affordable for a fan."

James Quentin Devine, a Los Angeles-based musician and artist, grew up listening to CDs and isn't surprised they're regaining popularity.

"CDs have become useful again because they're cheap and they're fast and they are portable," he says. "You can mail them, you can hand them off to people."

Devine produced 100 CDs of his band Scaled Alps' new record, "Let the Alpine Play." Each was hand-numbered and given away.

"They're art objects," Devine says. It's his way of creating art



"CDs have become useful again because they're cheap and they're fast and they are portable," said one Los Angeles-based musician.

"that takes the format's own history, scale and use seriously."

They are also historical objects. For some CD collectors, that is part of the draw.

While you can find vinyl records and all the accoutrements these days at Target and Urban Outfitters, CDs require a quest.

"The peripheral things that go with CDs, like CD cases or visors

for your car, like a lot of this stuff is out of stock," says cultural critic Bilal Qureshi, who, like so many CD enthusiasts, dates his love affair back to his Columbia House membership.

"If you go to Best Buy, or whatever," he says, "you're not going to find a disc player."

I took one such quest last April, when I time-warped to the lone Sam Goody store that still stands. For the youngsters: Sam Goody was one of the many beloved national chains that primarily sold CDs. Along with contemporaries like Tower Records, FYE, Cocanuts and Camelot Music, Sam Goody was once a shining beacon.

It, and all those others, now sit in various states of decay.

Entropy.

But one stubborn store hangs on. In the Rogue Valley Mall in Medford, Oregon, past a makeshift carnival in the parking lot, beyond an abandoned hairdresser station and three "Sweet Emotions" gumball machines, sandwiched between a Pacsun and a Verizon store, is the world's last

Sam Goody.

At a half-abandoned mall that feels like a place out of time — filled with Dippin' Dots machines (so many Dippin' Dots machines), a Hot Topic, Spencer's and a Buckle discount clothing store — the Sam Goody somehow feels like even more of a relic.

And it's still filled with CDs. Who buys them? It was difficult to determine during my visit. The store was as empty as the mall that housed it. One employee of a neighboring Starbucks suggested sales might be driven by residents of Rogue Valley Manor, an enormous retirement community that sits on a hill overlooking the city.

But we know it's not just retirees buying CDs. It's the young, the middle-aged, the nostalgic, the audiophilic, the penny-pinchers, the snobs, the regular Joes.

And why not?

There's something beautiful, almost ethereal about them.

Treat a CD correctly, and it'll never succumb to entropy.

Unlike us, it will never age.

Charlie Kirk died a year ago. He keeps being revived — and distorted — online.

KIRK FROM B1

verbs. The word "lowkirkuinely" is a mash-up of low-key, Kirk and genuinely, with his surname jammed into the middle of a word for emphasis like an expletive, akin to abso-freaking-lutely.

This linguistic evolution began as mockery but quickly destabilized into a meme stripped of meaning.

It is tempting to dismiss Kirkification as internet humor absurd for its own sake, which has existed since online cultures formed. But that nihilism is a consequence of how politicians, institutions, activists and media organizations competed to define what he represented and how his death should be understood. Kirkification offers no coherent alternative, instead allowing anyone to take his image and refuse to give it any meaning.

That vacuum gives the meme its power. Kirk can be a hero, villain or punch line. People making these posts do not have to offer a competing argument. The expression can just be a rejection of anyone else's version of him. It extended to his wife, Erika Kirk, too, whose grief was mocked and scrutinized across the internet.

Turning Point USA, Kirk's political organization, did not respond to The Washington Post's request for comment. In the past, Turning Point has condemned a TikTok trend that used audio of his killing for fashion videos.

Caldwell said the intensity surrounding Kirk's death helped give the meme its early momentum. His supporters elevated him as a martyr, and anyone who joked or expressed apathy faced outrage and, in some cases, professional consequences. The more Kirk was treated as a sacred cow, Caldwell said, the more the internet was compelled to turn him into a posthumous lolcow,



JINTAK HAN/THE WASHINGTON POST

A sign memorializing political activist Charlie Kirk is held at a gathering last September in Seoul.

slang for a public figure who is humiliated online for entertainment.

"When something is ... treated as sacred and people are told you're not allowed to meme something, people are going to do it even harder," said Caldwell, a longtime journalist who has worked at New York-based Know Your Meme for 16 years.

Unlike many internet jokes, which can run dry after even a day or so, Kirkification remains strong to this day. But who is doing the Kirkifying can sometimes be tough to sort out.

Days after his death, a production company that creates patriotic and Christian music published "We Are Charlie Kirk," an AI-generated song that had 750,000 views on YouTube by

"When something is ... treated as sacred and people are told you're not allowed to meme something, people are going to do it even harder."

Don Caldwell, editor in chief of Know Your Meme

December last year. The song now has almost 7 million views and has been streamed on Spotify more than 13 million times.

anything," Caldwell said.

Then something else started to happen: It felt as though we were seeing Kirk everywhere. Viewers of the horror movie "Obsession" remarked that actor Michael Johnston kind of looks like Kirk. Weeks after his death, images and videos of random men started to go viral for their supposed resemblance to Kirk.

People began posting images with variations of the same question: Am I going crazy, or does this look like Kirk? Like Jesus on a piece of toast, Kirk's face seemed to appear in places that were not actually manipulated, or his face had been manipulated so much that it seemed to be imprinted everywhere.

And that actually makes a lot of sense, says Susan Wardle, a cognitive neuroscientist at the University at Albany who studies visual perception and face pareidolia, the phenomenon of seeing faces where they do not exist.

"Vision is actually a constructive process. People think of it as opening your eyes and seeing what's there, and it's not quite like that," she said. "Our brain is constructing a pretty good approximation of what's there, but it's having to do a lot of computational work behind the scenes because the information the eye receives is these patterns of light which are changing constantly."

That construction is also influenced by attention and context. Wardle compared it to learning the definition of a new word, then suddenly feeling as though you hear it all the time.

"It's this attentional lens we have; it's how our brain deals with having too much input to process," she said.

People see faces in clouds, trees or fruit, Wardle said, because humans are social animals. Our brains prioritize faces because they carry information im-

portant to our behavior — and sometimes tolerate false positives.

"Humans and other primates do see these illusory faces. Faces are really important to us and we have to filter all this visual information, so we're hypersensitized to faces," Wardle said.

Our brains have a natural familiarity with faces we've seen in real life, in real lighting, versus in two-dimensional photographs. Wardle pointed to a 2011 experiment that demonstrated how much that distinction matters. Researchers gathered 40 photos of two men, varied naturally with different expressions, angles and lighting.

They gave the pictures to people who did not know either of the two, and participants guessed there were about seven to 10 different people. When researchers gave the pictures to people who did know the two men, they were almost completely accurate in identifying them.

That familiarity allows the brain to learn the range of appearances one face can have. Kirkification presents a bizarre, macro version of this exercise. For millions of people, Kirk's face was only encountered through a screen, and now artificial versions of his face stretch across people who look nothing like him, causing some people's brains to play tricks.

Wardle doesn't believe AI has changed how the human brain sees. Yet Kirkification instead feeds the tendency to find patterns in an overwhelming amount of visual information, particularly patterns that become important.

"It's to do with the vision being constructive and vision being a filtering of things that are important to us," Wardle said. "And right now, Charlie Kirk's face is important to a lot of people."

Should they move to avoid daughter's ex who's stalking her?



Carolyn Hax

Adapted from an online discussion.

Dear Carolyn: I'm wondering if I'll have to move because my 21-year-old daughter is being relentlessly

stalked by her ex-boyfriend and father of her baby. He was opposed to her continuing the pregnancy and got violently abusive when she decided to have it. He rammed her car with his truck, for example, when she was five months pregnant and drove her into a ditch.

She got a restraining order against him and doesn't want child support or anything from him except to leave her and the baby alone. That order hasn't stopped him from harassing us and stalking her. His father is on the police force, so they do the bare minimum when we report the violations. We keep detailed logs of all his behavior, which has ranged from trying to get into the hospital when she was in labor, to endless harassing calls (she blocks his number but he keeps getting new ones) and banging on our door all hours, to slashing her tires, vandalizing our home and following her car home from work. The latest was his trying to break into my daughter's room in the middle of the night. Our dog went berserk and that scared him off, but it looks like he's never going to stop.

Like always, we turned over the logs to the cops, and they said (like every other time), "Call us if he actually does



ILLUSTRATION BY NICK GALIFIANAKIS/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

anything to her."

I talked to my sister who lives over 400 miles away, and she thinks we should leave quickly and quietly, letting no one know where we're going except my boss, who is aware of the situation. She said we can stay with her until we find a new home and jobs there.

This is such a drastic step — the cost of living there is much higher, and if I quit I won't be able to collect unemployment. We can live on my savings for a while and our career skills can go anywhere, but I'm worried about selling our house remotely, and what happens if it

takes me and my daughter too long to find jobs? We've lived in this town since my daughter was 4 months old; my husband is buried here. But I don't know what else to do. Is moving the right thing to do?

— Worried

Worried: Call 800-799-SAFE — the National Domestic Violence Hotline. Your concerns about supporting yourselves are real and valid, and of course this is your home, where you have deep ties. You've touched on several of the reasons stalking is such a horror. It robs you both of your agency, your peace of

mind, your security, your home — that is the power her ex is abusing.

But being right means squat if you, your daughter and your grandchild aren't alive. So get trained support from the hotline immediately to develop a safety plan, in one form or another. The website, *thehotline.org*, has valuable information as well.

The police inaction — I would call it contempt — is an outrage. The "actually does anything to her" is not only a dangerous standard, since it implies their involvement threshold is bodily harm, it's also a lie. The ex has already "done something" with the road violence, property crimes and daughter's-room trespassing, which are more than enough. I don't think a person needs legal training to 2 + 2 that one. You have these plus the harassment as damning evidence the police are protecting the stalker, not your daughter, grandchild or you.

That murdering tires is more likely to get him in legal jeopardy than emotionally torturing the mother of his child is a disgrace we'll have to sit with for now.

A reader's suggestion: • I hope you're able to get away safely, but while you're figuring that out, get security cameras with cloud backup to help document your case. Also look into terminating his parental rights, since that's something he could try to use against your daughter. Please send an update sometime so we know you're safe!

Re: Stalker: Former police

detective here. Carolyn's suggestions are spot on. I would suggest as well that Worried and the daughter *and their attorney* have a sit-down with the police chief and the department attorney to make sure everyone is aware of these goings-on, AND to clarify the size and noise of the lawsuit that will follow should the department continue to fall down on the job — especially should there be any escalation. This is a dangerous situation, and the department needs to have a functional response to it, which they have yet to provide.

— Anonymous

Anonymous: Thank you. I can't verify who you are, of course, or your work history, but "have your attorney talk to the police department's attorney" has the ring of yes to it.

Another reader with credentials to take on faith:

• Lawyer here. Meet with a criminal lawyer to find out the consequences for a violation of a restraining order, and how to proceed. In my state, it is a felony. (I agree with the officer about having a lawyer call their lawyer.) The answer is not moving — he may find you — unless you feel that is your only route to safety.

Write to Carolyn Hax at tellme@washpost.com. Get her newsletter delivered to your inbox each morning at wapo.st/gethax.

Join the discussion live at noon Fridays at washingtonpost.com/live-chats.

Can I just ignore all of these group texts?

Miss Manners

JUDITH MARTIN, JACOBINA MARTIN AND NICHOLAS IVOR MARTIN

Dear Miss Manners: I am frequently included in group texts involving relatives, friends and former colleagues. These conversations range from

lighthearted banter to grave news or shared memories.

While I am not always interested in the topics discussed, I worry that failing to reply — what my daughter calls "ghosting" — is rude. I often feel compelled to respond with at least an emoji to avoid appearing uninterested or annoyed, even when I have nothing substantive to contribute.

What is your perspective on this? Is it considered rude to remain a silent observer of the conversation? Additionally, is it acceptable to leave a group to which you were added without your consent?

Oddly, it is now the young who seem to cling to the old rules about correspondence, now that circumstances have dramatically changed.

Of course, they don't know that there were old rules requiring prompt answers to chatty letters. But "prompt" meant within a few days, not much more than a week, and the letters received had taken a few days or a week to arrive. So two or three exchanges a month was a heavy correspondence.

And people did not tend to chronicle their every breath for mass distribution. Generally you heard from people when they had something to say to you.

So no, you don't have to spend your days cheering on everyone — just people you really know. You should always respond to serious announcements, such as marriages, births or deaths, but only occasional responses are required for trivia.

Still, what your daughter calls ghosting — opting out from receiving all this — is considered a statement. And it is unnecessary, as we all have delete buttons.

Dear Miss Manners: Is it okay to live with your boyfriend if you're not married to them? Or does it really matter if you're married, just as long as you love each other?

You might want to ask your parents. Miss Manners considers it none of her business.

Dear Miss Manners: Every year at Rosh Hashanah, we send out distinctive, beautiful personalized New Year's cards to our Jewish friends and family. Most of the recipients are people we are close to, but not all of them.

Some years, we order too many cards and have some left over. This year, I told my husband to order fewer, with the thought that if we run short, we could send one of the cards that was left over from a prior year. (This would only be the second time in 20 years that we have done this.)

Given that few reciprocate anymore with their own cards and we are under no obligation to send cards at all, I saw nothing wrong with this. But we received an email from one of the recipients (who, I might note, has never sent us a card) thanking us for "resending" a card, which we interpreted as a snide comment.

Obviously, she remembered the card from a prior year, which I am not certain I would have. We are irked, but did we violate the rules of etiquette?

Remind your husband to buy even fewer cards next year. Miss Manners advises that someone who considers the design of a holiday card to be more important than the message be dropped from the list.

New Miss Manners columns are posted Monday through Saturday on washingtonpost.com/advice. You can send questions to Miss Manners at her website, missmanners.com. You can also follow her @RealMissManners.

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KEVIN WINTER/GETTY IMAGES

Cast members of "The Office" with some of their many Emmys in 2006. The show, which premiered in 2005, ran for nine seasons and 201 episodes, concluding in 2013.

Successor to 'The Office' is about finding serenity in chaos

SCREENS FROM B1

My best theory is that, while "The Office" used to represent a gentle send-up of reality — the 9-to-5 drudgery of poor microwave etiquette in a cubicle farm — it now represents the most delirious kind of fantasy. A job that is only 9 to 5? With paid vacation and benefits? With a salary that apparently allows its mediocre employees to buy houses, take vacations and send their kids to parochial school? I'll sit in the annex next to Toby, I don't care.

Once upon a time, children, people used to live this way. Clock in at 22, clock out at 65 with a full pension, and all you had to do was put up with some weird co-workers and occasionally watch your boss sing karaoke. "The Office," in 2026, represents the utopia of banality. The luxury of finding your job and your surroundings slightly boring, rather than a white-knuckle experience where you perpetually wonder whether today is the day you're replaced by a drone, artificial intelligence or a sentient GLP-1.

Last year, the creators of "The Office" tried to replicate its success by launching "The Paper," whose second season debuted Wednesday, also on Peacock. "The Paper" exists in the same cinematic universe as its predecessor, though with only one crossover actor: Oscar Nuñez, reprising his role as fussy accountant Oscar



PAUL DRINKWATER/NBCUNIVERSAL/GETTY IMAGES

"The Office" follows everyday workers in Scranton, Pennsylvania, a place viewers seem to want to visit again, and again, and again.

Martinez. His colleagues this time all work at the Toledo Truth Teller, a fictional Midwestern newspaper housed in the same workspace as a toilet paper business that, we are repeatedly told, is the parent company's far more valuable property.

At the end of the first season, idealistic new editor Ned (Domhnall Gleeson) has marshaled his dwindling staff to win several regional journalism awards, but the start of the second season reveals that prestige doesn't equate to success. The paper's publisher buys a billboard to brag

about the Truth Teller's wins, but instead of causing readers to buy the paper, it just reminds readers that they've been meaning to cancel their subscriptions. Circulation is now even deeper in the toilet.

A working newspaper journalist should never review this show in public, frankly. She should consume it as God and nature intended: in the dark, in a bathrobe, with a furtive little bag of Funnys and a therapist on speed dial. Even after just one episode, I could already tell that I was both too critical and too taken in by the



CHRIS HASTON/NBCUNIVERSAL/GETTY IMAGES

Oscar Nuñez as Oscar Martinez in "The Office." He reprises the role in "The Paper," whose second season debuted Wednesday.

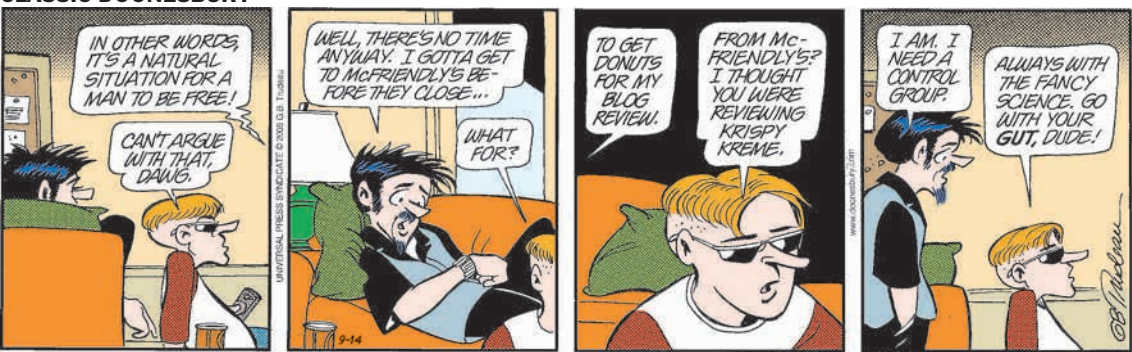
noble goals and the inglorious failures of the Truth Teller's staff.

But I think there's a universality here, one that feels of the moment for many of us. While "The Office" was about finding splendor in the mundane, "The Paper" is ultimately about finding serenity in chaos. How do you show up to work today, knowing that your job might not exist tomorrow? How can you both insist that your life's work is vital and acknowledge that society will march on without it?

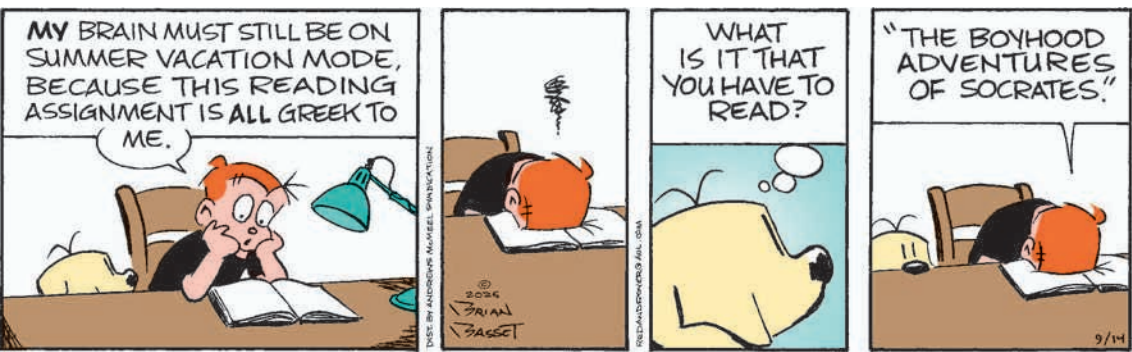
The opening credits to "The Paper" contain jaunty music over

footage of all the things people now do with newspapers: wrap china, potty train dogs, protect windows in a painting project — anything but read them, really. It's meant to be wry, but the messaging is oddly soothing. Whatever you've messed up, throw it out today, try again tomorrow. Accept that times change. Let it all go. Your very best work will be forgotten, but the good news is you can always refresh your memory with a re-binge. In subsequent viewings, the times that felt difficult now seem like a pulpy little paradise.

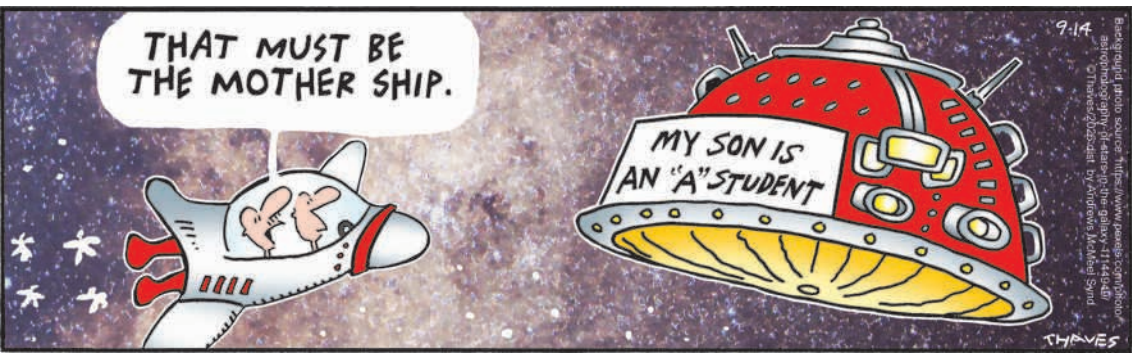
CLASSIC DOONESBURY



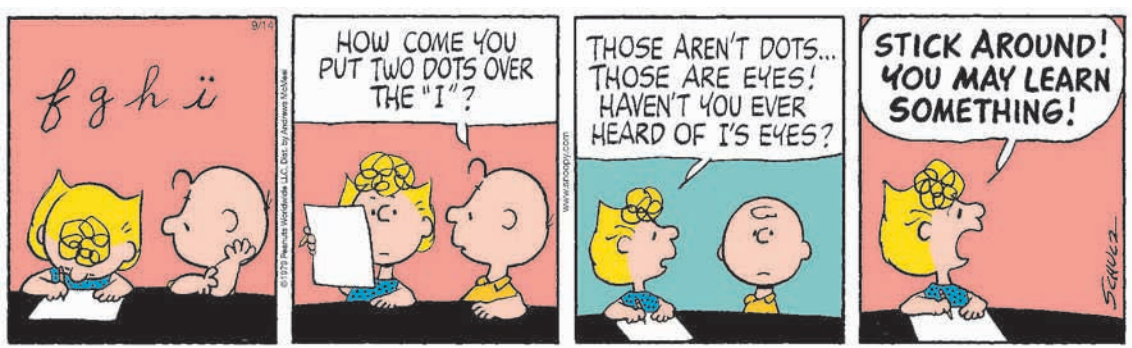
RED AND ROVER



FRANK AND ERNEST



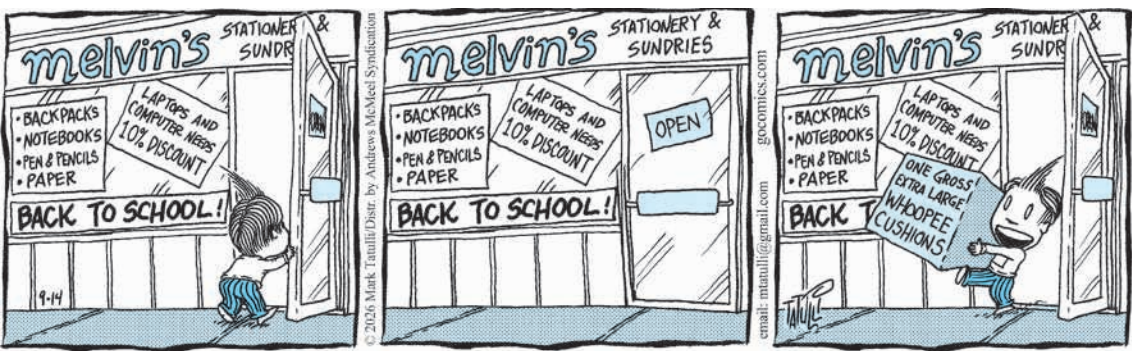
CLASSIC PEANUTS



RHYMES WITH ORANGE



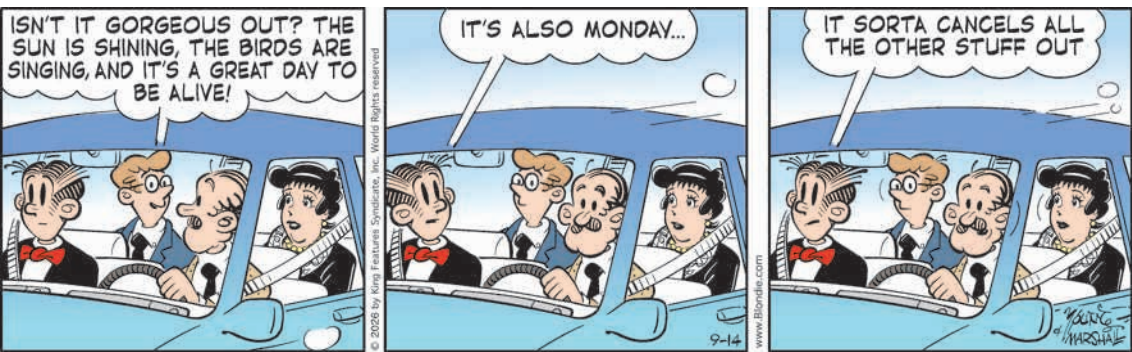
LIO



HAGAR THE HORRIBLE



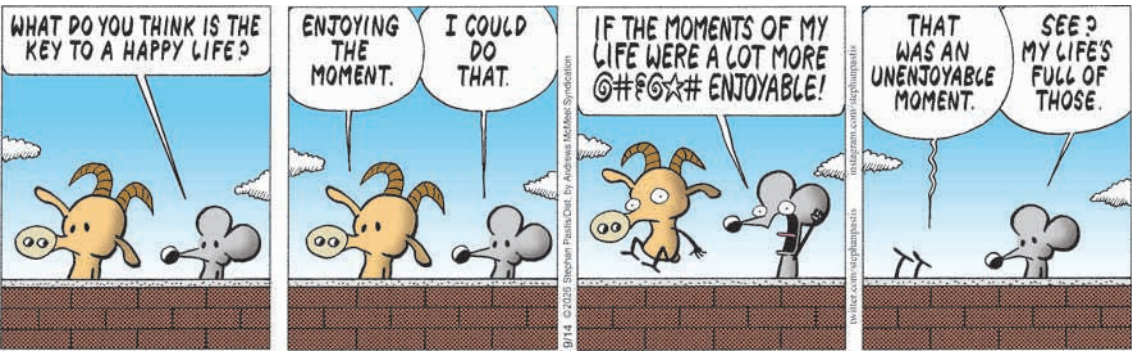
BLONDIE



BREWSTER ROCKIT: SPACE GUY!



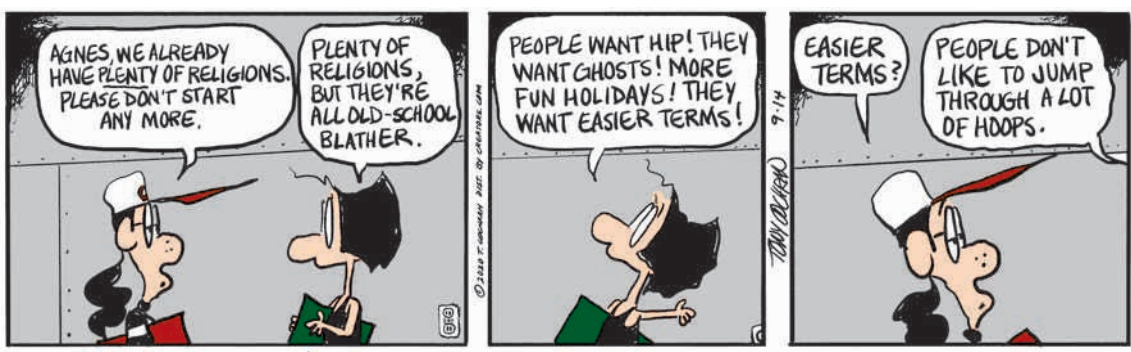
PEARLS BEFORE SWINE



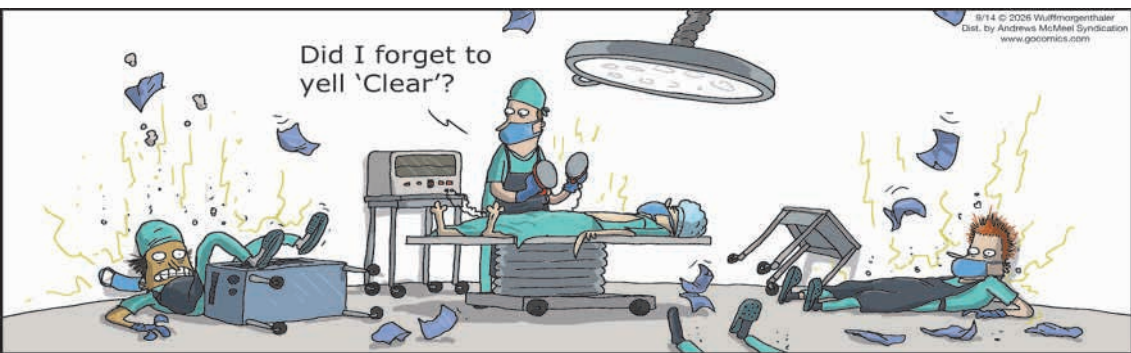
PICKLES



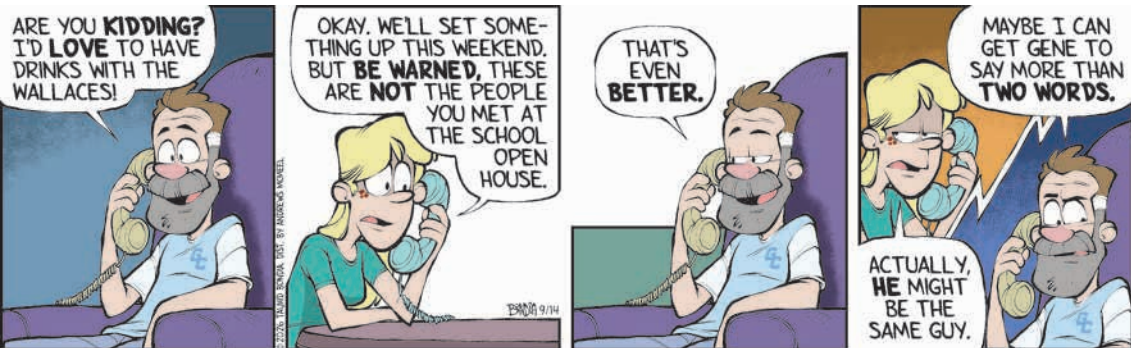
AGNES



WUMO



CRABGRASS



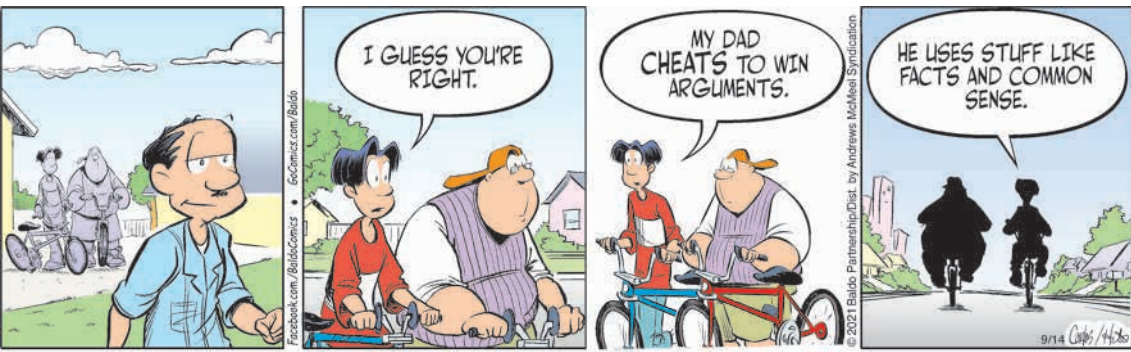
MARK TRAIL



MOTHER GOOSE & GRIMM



BALDO



SALLY FORTH



SHERMAN'S LAGOON



CURTIS



MUTTS

Patrick McDonnell

Moosh's Dear Diary

9.14

slept.

A Lot.

ZITS

Jerry Scott & Jim Borgman

Have you ever had a life-changing experience, Mom?

Sure! When I gave birth to you.

Mine was my first triple-meat pizza.

Oh, sure. Same thing.

Heart of the City

STEENZ

Charlotte! I heard they're replacing the vending machine sodas with juice and water!!

Who cares about soda when the world is falling apart around us?

SSHH!

Sorry!

Veesh, you're not usually this... pessimistic.

"Sob" I knowwwww! Why is everything terrible on your period??"

What?! There's a solution to this!

SSHH!

Sorry!

Oof. Thank goodness for puberty blockers.

Judge Parker

Francesco Marciuliano & Mike Manley

At Alan Parker's house...

6:00

BEEP BEEP BEEP

FRAZZ

Jef Mallett

Mr. Spaetzle doesn't freak out over falling leaves since he started his virtual thru-hikes.

Something about covering a couple hundred miles makes summer feel less fleeting.

I wonder how little I could walk and get the same result.

That's the difference between you and M... Mr. Spaetzle.

Nice save. I rather like being different from you.

SIX CHIX

Bannerman, Xunise, Konar, Lawton, Patrinos & Piro

This dreamcatcher I made is a total nightmare.

Garfield

Jim Davis

Do you ever get the feeling that you've forgotten to do something?

There's a name for those feelings...

"Time-savers"

Barney and Clyde

Weingartens & Clark

Been shopping. Refreshing my closet with the latest fashions.

Isn't it adorable? It's a Betty Crocker purse.

Why would you buy a purse that looks like a piece of cake?

To see the look on your face, obviously.

I hope I lived up to your expectations.

Wait until you see the rest.

DUSTIN

Steve Kelley & Jeff Parker

What would you say is your biggest strength as an employee?

I think I'm good at taking criticism.

I'm tempted to say that's the worst answer I've ever heard.

And I'd be OK with that.

Flash Gordon

Dan Schkade

Adrane.

Bok.

Dale Arden.

Flash Gordon.

Bleh. I've never been on the ground long enough to see bugs this big.

Be glad for Zarkov's universal antivenom.

Those things have a toxin that makes you go blind.

Bok seems... tense.

Maybe bringing him back to tropica was a bad idea.

Maybe. But that's his call.

If he needs us, we'll be there.

Prickly City

Marshall Ramsey

When I read terrible news, I'd think, "There's still good in the world. Dolly is still with us."

Same.

Now she's gone. How can we be like her?

Be a diamond in a rhinestone world.

Loose Parts

Dave Blazek

How many of these squares contain pictures of school buses?

Uh-oh.

Non Sequitur

Wiley

I miss the days when our biggest gripe about A.I. was spellcheck.

Free Phones!

Big Tech Learning Center

Future Nostalgia

Baby Blues

Rick Kirkman & Jerry Scott

Hey Darryl, did you talk to Wanda?

About skipping the school puppet show and going with you to the hockey game instead?

Yeah, what did she say?

Exactly what I thought she'd say.

"Do whatever you want."

Okay, I'll ask Larry if he can go.

Wallace the Brave

Will Henry

Wouldn't it be great if there was a gigantic meteor rocketing towards Earth?

Then all the superheroes on Earth would have to reveal themselves in order to stop the galactic threat.

You wonder how many are hiding out there?

It's risky.

Speed Bump

Dave Coverly

I love them all.

Dennis the Menace

H. Ketcham

"They thought somethin' was wrong with me, so I got sent home early for good behavior."

On the Fastrack

Bill Holbrook

Tomorrow a crew will be launched into space to assemble the components of the Mars spacecraft.

As project manager, I just hope they're prepared!

You've been training them with Ikea furniture.

They had to master that before graduating to the simulator.

They should be.

Family Circus

Bil Keane

The trouble with playin' hide-and-seek with Mommy is it takes her so long to find us."

Reply All Lite

Donna A. Lewis

Remember you promised to call me quirky instead of eccentric.

Beetle Bailey

Greg, Brian & Neal Walker

The American public does not want to put our troops in harm's way.

So I'm keeping my boots off the ground.

Family Circus

Bil Keane

The trouble with playin' hide-and-seek with Mommy is it takes her so long to find us."

Reply All Lite

Donna A. Lewis

Remember you promised to call me quirky instead of eccentric.

The Washington Post

SPORTS

MONDAY, SEPTEMBER 14, 2026

SU

C

Cowboys	Ravens	41	Bills	36	Buccaneers	27	Saints	30	Jets	23	Browns	10	Falcons	13	Bears	59	Dolphins	13	Cardinals	26	Packers	22	Broncos	8:15 p.m.	
Giants	late	Colts	23	Texans	31	Bengals	33	Lions	31	Titans	10	Jaguars	34	Steelers	20	Panthers	37	Raiders	27	Chargers	14	Vikings	39	Chiefs	ABC/ESPN



EAGLES 24, COMMANDERS 22: Tight end Dallas Goedert scored a critical fourth-quarter touchdown after Philadelphia wasn't flagged for an apparent false start.

False hope

No-call benefits Philadelphia, but offensive struggles sink Washington in opener

BY TASHAN REED

PHILADELPHIA — It looked like a false start.

Philadelphia Eagles tight end Dallas Goedert made an incredible play when he hauled in Jalen Hurts's pass and made defenders miss on his way to a 43-yard touchdown. But right before the snap, multiple players on the left side of the Eagles' formation appeared to move. The officials didn't call a penalty, and Goedert's score stood.

Instead of facing third and 11, Philadelphia extended its lead late in the fourth quarter. It proved to

be the decisive play as the Washington Commanders fell, 24-22, at Lincoln Financial Field to open the season.

"That stings, man. It does. A lot," Commanders Coach Dan Quinn said. "Really loved our fight. ... The miscues, I thought, hurt us in this game, and those were the margins right there. Those are the lessons I want to make sure that we apply moving forward."

While the uncalled false start will draw the ire of many fans — Quinn said he didn't receive an explanation from the officials — it wasn't the reason Washington lost. The primary culprit was an offense

that was held in check for most of the game by a swarming Eagles defense.

There was plenty of blame to go around. Rookie offensive coordinator David Blough was overmatched against veteran Philadelphia defensive coordinator Vic Fangio. Quarterback Jayden Daniels completed just 18 of 34 passes for 164 yards. Wide receiver Terry McLaurin was held to two catches. The offensive line played poorly.

After scoring a touchdown in the fourth quarter, wide receiver Stefon Diggs committed an unsportsmanlike conduct penalty for excessive celebration, forcing

Washington to settle for an extra point instead of attempting a two-point conversion to tie it.

Daniels said the Commanders "need to be smarter" and took the onus for not reiterating the gravity of the situation in the huddle. But when asked about the penalty, Diggs took responsibility.

"That was a little bit out of the frustration [from] throughout the game," Diggs said. "I wanted things to go right, and finally we hit one and I got a little overzealous and I got a little excited. Of course, I take full accountability."

It was a defensive struggle on

SEE COMMANDERS ON C5

U.S. OPEN

In loss, Shelton displays spirit

Top-seeded American battled until the end vs. top-ranked Zverev

BY ALBERT SAMAHA

NEW YORK — Just before Ben Shelton took the court on this muggy afternoon, the rain ceased, the clouds parted and the Arthur Ashe Stadium roof opened for the sunshine.

Over two grueling weeks at the U.S. Open, Shelton had emerged as the breakout star, a brash 23-year-old with a monster serve, unparalleled athleticism, and a hunger for high-stakes competition. He became the first Black man to reach a U.S. Open final since Arthur Ashe in 1972, and he sought to become the first American man to win his home grand slam since Andy Roddick in 2003.

"Why not today, Ben?" somebody in the crowd shouted.

But the drought will continue. Competing in his first Grand Slam final, Shelton sparked moments of hope yet couldn't break Alexander Zverev. The 29-year-old top seed and reigning French Open champion controlled the match with his reliable serve and powerful groundstrokes, winning in four sets, 6-3, 7-6 (7-2), 5-7, 6-2. Shelton's exhilarating run in Queens ended as yet another *almost* for American men's tennis — but one that leaves fans looking ahead to wonder just how far their new standard bearer can go.

Though Shelton entered the U.S. Open as the highest-seeded American man and played every match on the main court at Arthur Ashe Stadium, he hovered on the periphery through the first half of the tournament, looking shaky and vulnerable in his first two wins. Some fans seemed less interested in Shelton's play than in the presence of his famous girlfriend, soccer star Trinity Rodman.

Shelton says the big moments are "the part of tennis that I enjoy the most." The early rounds tend to give him trouble. At the last Grand Slam, Wimbledon, he fell in the first round to 140th-ranked Otto Virtanen, a stunning disappointment in a young career that has bounced between boom and bust.

He didn't start playing tennis seriously until he was 12, a late bloomer by the sport's standards. Born in Georgia, he had grown up preferring football and baseball.

But tennis was the family sport.

SEE U.S. OPEN ON C3

At World Cup, America remains the team to beat

UNITED STATES 97, FRANCE 79

BY DOUG FEINBERG
Associated Press

BERLIN — Breanna Stewart had an American flag draped around her body as she soaked in the moment.

The U.S. captain delivered again, and the Americans continued their domination of international play, winning a fifth straight FIBA Women's World Cup title with a 97-79 victory over France on Sunday.

The Americans have won 36 straight World Cup games, dating back to the semifinals of the

2006 tournament, where they lost to Russia.

"We are the standard," said Stewart, who scored 22 points in the victory and earned MVP honors of the tournament for the second time. "USA Basketball has continued to show up and go for gold, and to have done that however many times consecutively is an insane stat. We want to make sure that we continue to build on that standard, and everybody else knows it."

Despite the final score, this game wasn't easy; the Americans faced their biggest deficit in the tournament since that loss to Russia when they were down 14 points in the first half to France. They calmly rallied behind Stewart and

SEE WORLD CUP ON C3



ANNEGRET HILSE/REUTERS

"We are the standard," MVP Brenna Stewart, left, said after the United States secured its fifth consecutive FIBA World Cup title.

Irvin, in new role, helps Nats sweep Los Angeles

NATIONALS 6, ANGELS 5

BY DANIELLE ALLENTUCK

To try to limit the damage Jake Irvin could do in early innings, the Washington Nationals used an opener Sunday for the first time in his four-year major league career.

Coming out of the bullpen, Irvin allowed three runs in five innings, and the Nationals scored four runs in the eighth to beat the Los Angeles Angels, 6-5, and sweep the series. It was the Nationals' third consecutive comeback win after a seven-game losing streak.

"Extremely proud of these guys, all series long and especially today," Manager Blake Butera said. "That was a hard-fought win ... I know early on, the late innings weren't great for us offensively, so happy to see us have a really good weekend."

Irvin still has three years of control left and may be a part of Washington's future, though that will largely depend on how the other pitchers in the organization perform, as well as what moves the team makes this offseason. Cade Cavalli is set to be the No. 1 starter, with Andrew Alvarez — who threw seven

SEE NATIONALS ON C7

Phillies at Nationals

Tuesday, 6:45 p.m., Nationals.TV

THE DAY IN SPORTS

SOCCER

With three late goals, Boston stuns the Spirit

The Washington Spirit looked to be heading for a scoreless draw Sunday at Audi Field, but the lowly Boston Legacy broke through late to hand the host a stunning 3-0 loss.

Possession was evenly divided between the two sides, but Washington (13-7-4) couldn't connect on any of its three shots on goal.

Boston (7-12-5) broke through in the 81st minute. After Spirit defender **Esme Morgan** blocked a shot by **Nichelle Prince** at the top of the box, Prince nudged the ball to **Aïssata Traoré**, who drilled a shot between Morgan's legs and into the left corner of the net.

Amanda Gutièrres then added two more goals in the fourth and sixth minutes of stoppage time, both on fast breaks, as the expansion Legacy earned its second straight win following a four-game skid.

It was the worst loss since April 2025 for the Spirit, which had won two straight. With Gotham FC's 2-1 win over Racing Louisville on Friday, Washington is five points back in the NWSL Shield race with six games remaining. ...

The governing body of English Premier League referees admitted an "error of judgment" after **Erling Haaland's** hotly contested goal settled the 199th Manchester derby.

That will be of little comfort to Manchester United after a 1-0 defeat to 10-man Manchester City at Old Trafford.

United was enraged after VAR awarded Haaland his winning strike in the 60th minute.

At first, the goal was ruled out for offside, but after VAR review the on-field decision was overturned, sparking a roar of celebration from the away fans, including Oasis's **Noel Gallagher**.

United's players were incensed because City midfielder **Enzo Fernandez** was in an offside position during the buildup.

Elsewhere, Coventry's nightmare start to its Premier League return continued with a 5-0 home loss to Brighton. ...

Lamine Yamal produced another double, and Barcelona also got a goal from another 19-year-old product of its famed youth academy in a 4-2 Spanish league win at Levante.

Xavi Epart, who joined Barcelona's La Masia academy as an under-10 player, scored the opener for Barcelona with a low, bouncing shot from the edge of the area after getting set up by **Raphinha** five minutes in for his first goal with the senior squad. ...

Germany's biggest club needed a second-half winner from **Harry Kane** to beat the Bundesliga's smallest side, as Bayern Munich won, 2-1, at promoted Elversberg. ...

In France, European champion Paris Saint-Germain finally earned its first league victory of the season, a 1-0 win at Brest. ...

The Houston Dash fired coach **Fabrice Gautrat** and technical director **Twila Kilgore**, with **Jaime Frias** set to serve as interim coach for the rest of the season. ...

Borussia Mönchengladbach fired **Eugen Polanski** as coach after starting the German league season with three defeats.

COLLEGE FOOTBALL

Rally vs. Buckeyes has Longhorns in No. 1 spot

An unprecedented comeback to knock off Ohio State moved Texas to No. 1 in the Associated Press college football poll and pushed the Buckeyes out of the top five for the first time in two seasons.

Oregon, meanwhile, plummeted 15 spots to No. 21, its lowest ranking in four years, after its loss to an Oklahoma State team that had lost 21 straight against Football Bowl Subdivision opponents.

Michigan, which fell out of the Top 25 after needing an extra second and second-chance Hail Mary try to beat Western Michigan a week ago, returned to the poll at No. 19 following its win over No. 11 Oklahoma. The Sooners dropped 13 spots to No. 24.

Texas's comeback from 20 points down in the fourth quarter to win, 24-23, was the largest fourth-quarter rally ever for a win against an AP No. 1 team, according to Sportradar.

Texas received 56 first-place votes from the voting panel of writers and broadcasters and holds down the No. 1 spot in the regular season for the first time since Oct. 13, 2024.

No. 2 Georgia and No. 3 Notre Dame held their places, Indiana moved up one spot to No. 4 and

Miami was bumped up two to No. 5. Ohio State, LSU, Mississippi, Texas A&M and Alabama rounded out the top 10. ...

The Clemson Tigers will turn to freshman **Tait Reynolds** at quarterback against North Carolina this week with **Christopher Vizzina** expected to sit out with an elbow injury, according to multiple reports.

Vizzina left Saturday's 22-7 win over Georgia Southern with an injury to his nonthrowing elbow that is expected to sideline him for one to two weeks. ...

Georgia Tech defensive back **Jaylen Mbakwe** was released from a local hospital after leaving Saturday night's game against No. 18 Tennessee on a stretcher.

AUTO RACING

Larson snaps his skid and gets boost in Chase

Kyle Larson ended a 51-race winless streak, edging Hendrick Motorsports teammate **Alex Bowman** in overtime of a crash-filled NASCAR Cup Series race at World Wide Technology Raceway that shook up the playoff standings.

Larson, the defending series champion, took his No. 5 Chevrolet to Victory Lane for the first time since May 2025 at Kansas Speedway after defending the lead on three restarts in the final two laps of regulation and seven laps of overtime.

The track in Madison, Illinois,

formerly known as Gateway, was the only regular stop on the series where Hendrick hadn't won.

The second race in NASCAR's new postseason Chase format gave significant boosts to the championship hopes for Larson and **Joey Logano**, a three-time Cup Series champ who finished third and added 19 stage points.

What was supposed to be a 240-lap race featured a season-high and track-record 18 cautions, with dramatic brake failures and spinouts without any contact between cars.

After several Chase contenders were involved in late crashes, the race was red-flagged with 11 laps to go, just after Larson swiped the lead from Logano, and again with two left in regulation.

Larson benefited from his crew's decision on Lap 202 to put four tires on while Logano took two to maintain track position.

Hendrick's **William Byron**, who was last in the 16-driver Chase field, finished fourth and was followed by **Ross Chastain**.

Denny Hamlin, the defending race champion, was ninth to keep his points lead. Larson racked up 73 points to jump from seventh to second in the standings, nine behind Hamlin. ...

Kimi Antonelli took advantage of an unlucky break for **Lando Norris** to win the Spanish Grand Prix in Formula One's return to Madrid, increasing his lead in the drivers' standings.

Antonelli was second early on at the new Madring track in the

Spanish capital, but pole-sitter Norris relinquished his lead after he wasn't able to pit when a virtual safety car was deployed. He had already passed the pit entrance and had to pit on the next lap in a questionable strategy call by McLaren that dropped him a few positions.

Norris ended third, behind Red Bull's **Max Verstappen**. He said he was "insanely unlucky" with the safety car.

Charles Leclerc, who led most of the race after opting not to pit when the virtual safety car was deployed, ended fourth after having to change tires late.

It was the second consecutive victory and eighth win this season for Antonelli, who now leads Russell by 81 points with nine races remaining.

CYCLING

Spain's Mas finally has breakthrough at Vuelta

Home rider **Enric Mas** ended years of frustration by winning the Spanish Vuelta — having inherited the red jersey from **Tadej Pogacar** after the five-time Tour de France champion crashed out.

Mas, the Spaniard who leads the Movistar team and has finished second overall three times, finished 2 minutes 15 seconds ahead of four-time Vuelta winner **Primož Roglič**.

Felix Gall finished third overall after the 21st and final stage, 2:44 behind Mas.

Mas's victory marks the greatest Grand Tour achievement for a Spanish cyclist since **Alberto Contador** won the Giro d'Italia in 2015. Contador was also the last Spaniard to win the Vuelta in 2014.

Norwegian rider **Tobias Johannessen** won the final stage, a 63-mile leg featuring climbing and descending in the medieval city of Granada.

TRACK AND FIELD

Jefferson-Wooden wins Ultimate sprint double

Melissa Jefferson-Wooden ran the fourth-fastest 200-meter time in history — 21.47 seconds — busting through the curve to wrap up a \$300,000 weekend by completing the sprint double at the Ultimate Championships in Budapest.

Moments earlier, **Kenny Bednarek** ran 19.52 to also complete the 100-200 double. The 19.52 is the best time in the world this season, though it wasn't quite as stunning as what the 25-year-old Jefferson-Wooden did in what is supposed to be an "off year" for track.

Josh Kerr added the Ultimate Championship to his unforgettable season, grabbing the lead on the last lap and winning the 1,500 in 3:29.35.

GOLF

Lowry surges and sets two Irish Open records

Shane Lowry gave his home crowd and President **Donald Trump** plenty of reason to cheer when he turned a four-shot lead into a runaway at Doonbeg, closing with a 7-under-par 63 to set two Irish Open records with an 11-shot victory on the DP World Tour.

Lowry opened with four birdies in eight holes, one of them from 45 feet over a ridge at No. 7, and the Irishman poured it on before a delirious gallery at Trump International Ireland.

He finished at 23-under 257, seven shots better than the previous 72-hole record of 264 by **Jon Rahm** at Lahinch in 2019.

Lowry won by 11 shots over **Patrick Reed** (64) and **Joaquin Niemann** (67), also breaking **Bernhard Langer's** 1987 tournament record for margin of victory by one shot.

BOXING

Garcia easily defends his welterweight title

After taking 10 years to win his first world championship, **Ryan Garcia** needed only 4:25 to finish off **Conor Benn** on Saturday night in Las Vegas in the first defense of his WBC welterweight title.

Garcia's sharp right hand to the jaw put Benn on the canvas early in the second round. Moments later, with the Englishman on the ropes, Garcia (26-2, 21 KOs) served a flurry of punches that prompted referee **Thomas Taylor** to step in and end the contest at the 1:25 mark.

For the 29-year-old Benn (25-2), it's probably back to the middleweight division after he failed in his first world-title opportunity.

— From news services

SPOTLIGHT: GOLF



ALASTAIR GRANT/AP

Europeans retake the Solheim Cup

Chants of ‘Olé’ ring out after Woad and Ciganda secure victory over U.S.

BY STEVE DOUGLAS

DEN BOSCH, NETHERLANDS — Lottie Woad assured it. Carlota Ciganda — who else? — sealed it.

Vamos! The Solheim Cup is back in the hands of Team Europe.

The blue wave came early in the Sunday singles at Bernardus Golf and never went away, all the way through to Woad holing a putt from two feet on No. 17 to win her match and guarantee the Europeans would reach the 14½ points needed to reclaim the crystal trophy from the United States.

Woad, one of Team Europe's four rookies, punched the air and jumped into the arms of her teammates who flooded onto the green in celebration.

Within 10 minutes, Ciganda, inevitably, officially got the Europeans to the victory target.

The Spaniard, who got the decisive point when Europe retained the Solheim Cup in 2023, completed a 4-and-2 victory over Jennifer Kupcho, a feisty American who had roared "Vamos!" ("Let's go!") when holing an outrageous 93-foot putt on the way to beating Ciganda in a spiky four-balls match Saturday.

"Today I knew she had no chance," Ciganda said. "I was like, 'I want to kill you.'"

Strains of "Olé, Olé, Olé, Olé" drifted across the course as the last matches finished and the European team and staff celebrated, spraying Champagne over each other and draping flags over their shoulders.

Captain Anna Nordqvist, her assistants, the players and their caddies formed a line, put their arms over one another's shoulders, and walked as one up the 18th fairway toward the green where Celine Boutier — the remaining European player on the course — was wrapping up her match.



NAOMI BAKER/GETTY IMAGES

Team Europe, top, reclaimed the crystal trophy thanks in part to Lottie Woad, above, one of the team's four rookies who holed a putt on No. 17 to win her match.

When Boutier finished, she piled into the mass celebrations.

The final score in the Netherlands: Europe 15, the United States 13.

To a backdrop of blue-and-yellow smoke, Nordqvist hoisted aloft the Solheim Cup on a podium in front of a first-tee grandstand filled with jubilant Team Europe fans, then gave each of her celebrating players and assistants a touch of the trophy.

"This feels so good," said Nordqvist, who announced her retirement from playing two weeks ago. "There's just been so much hard work this week and in the last two years leading up to this."

The Europeans have now won three of the last five editions, the only loss in that stretch coming in Virginia two years ago. The U.S. team didn't have possession of the trophy for long and is still without a win on the road since 2015.

"The Europeans played great today, and that's the way it goes," U.S. captain Angela Stanford said. "Their backs were against the wall, they had nothing to lose, and that's exactly what they did — they came out and played well."

TELEVISION AND RADIO

NFL	
8:15 p.m.	Denver at Kansas City » WJLA (Ch. 7), WWMR (Ch. 2), ESPN, WJFK (106.7 FM), WTEM (980 AM)
MLB	
7:10 p.m.	Baltimore at New York Mets » MASN, WYII (97.9 FM), WSNB (630 AM)
7:30 p.m.	Atlanta at Chicago Cubs » MLB Network
10:30 p.m.	Miami at Arizona » MLB Network (joined in progress)

SOCCER	
3 p.m.	English Premier League: Newcastle at Leeds » USA Network
TENNIS	
Noon	WTA: Guadalajara Open and São Paulo Open, early rounds » Tennis Channel
COLLEGE GOLF	
5 p.m.	Jackson T. Stephens Cup, first round » Golf Channel

U.S. OPEN

Shelton showed resolve until final point

U.S. OPEN FROM C1

His dad, Bryan, who had grown up in Alabama in what he describes as a “lower-middle class” household, had played on the pro tour and became the first Black American man to win a singles title since Arthur Ashe. Ben’s mom, Lisa Witsken Shelton, had played on the junior circuit, and her brother competed on the pro tour. Shelton’s older sister, Emma, played in college.

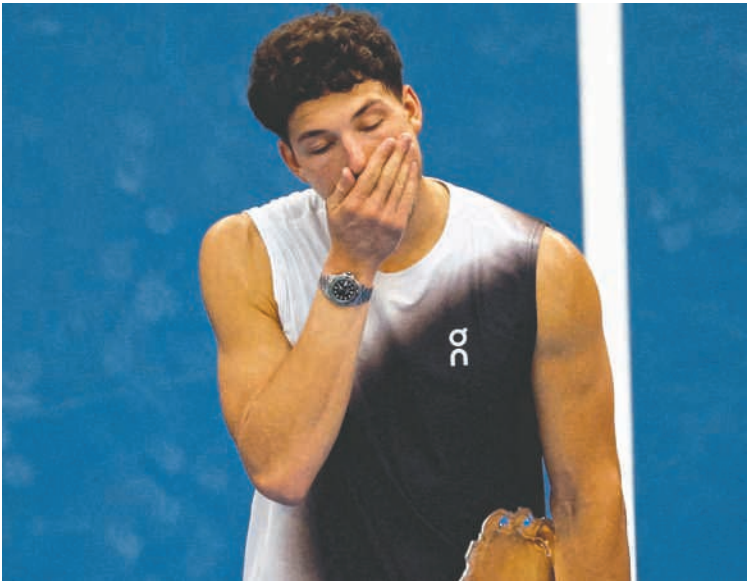
The family moved to Gainesville when Bryan became tennis coach at the University of Florida, and after a decorated high school tennis career, Shelton joined his father on campus. His freshman year, Ben Shelton won 28 of 33 matches, and the Gators won the national championship. The following year, Shelton won the singles national title. That summer, he turned pro.

His first year on tour, he smashed the second-fastest serve in U.S. Open history. At his Australian Open debut, he reached the quarterfinals, launching him into the top 50, and at the 2023 U.S. Open, he reached the semifinals before losing to Novak Djokovic. He captured his first title at the 2023 Tokyo Open, then reached the Australian Open semifinals in 2025, ascending to a top-five ranking by the end of his fourth year as a pro.

“I didn’t think he was even going to get into this sport,” his dad Bryan said at a news conference Friday. “And then for him to be where he is right now, it’s hard to believe.”

His raw talent is obvious — even if, as Bryan said, his game “still isn’t completely formed.” On the court, he looks like a football player with a tennis coach for a father: 6-foot-4, 195 pounds, sculpted and rangy, with one of the fastest serves on the tour. He wears a headband and no sleeves.

He has a signature celebration, thumb and pinkie out, picking up a phone and slamming it down. He sticks out his tongue and takes off his shirt far more than the average tennis player. He smirks after aces and roars for even the smallest points, celebrating in ways that have irked some opponents and spectators. To those



SHANNON STAPLETON/REUTERS

The brash and powerful Ben Shelton, above, was the tournament’s breakout star, despite his loss in the men’s final to Alexander Zverev.

who don’t like him, he comes off as an ‘80s teen movie villain come to life. He sometimes plays like he’s bored.

“I think that really keeping my mind in the game for the duration of the match is really, really important,” he said last week.

After the Wimbledon loss, Shelton returned to Florida to sharpen his game for his favorite tournament, the U.S. Open. He arrived in Queens “a more versatile player,” he said during the tournament’s first week. “I can win in different ways. I don’t have to just go to the well and serve 150 miles an hour to get free points.”

For taking care of business in the early rounds at this year’s edition, Shelton’s reward was a quarterfinals blockbuster against Carlos Alcaraz. Serving on match point at 3:33 a.m., in front of thousands of weary fans, Shelton already seemed to be smirking. After his 149-mph ace sealed the biggest win of his career, he didn’t look shocked or relieved or overcome by any emotions. If his face said anything, it was: Told you. He smiled wide, stuck out his tongue, hung up the phone, savoring “this feeling of ecstasy, on top of the world,” he later said. After the match, Alcaraz called Shelton “a beast.”

The heightened attention brought Shelton new fans and

fresh scrutiny. Online, people speculated on his political leanings, parsing his public statements and social media posts, including a photo with former Republican presidential candidate Vivek Ramaswamy at a tennis court.

Shelton carried hopes and history now. His next match, against fellow American Frances Tiafoe, stood as the first grand slam semifinal to feature two Black men. Not only were Shelton’s serves more overpowering than ever, but Shelton also outlasted Tiafoe in sustained rallies that had long been one of his vulnerabilities.

“His game is starting to get more polished,” Tiafoe said after the match. “Instead of just being a shotmaker, he’s holding tough in rallies.”

In the final, he encountered Zverev, the top seed and reigning French Open champion, who might have been the only player to enter Ashe to scattered boos. Two women have accused him of domestic abuse. Zverev, who has denied the allegations, reached a court settlement with one of them in 2024.

On Sunday, small pockets of the crowd jeered him as a villain as the players warmed up under lingering firework smoke wafting up the open roof. Many cheered his double faults. It didn’t appear to

rattle him. Instead, the towering veteran took his time, milking every second of the serve clock, inciting more boos.

Shelton, as in his previous two matches, dropped the first set, handing Zverev two games on double faults, looking every bit like a player in his first grand slam final.

His energy picked up in the second set. He hollered on big points. He egged on the crowd. He matched Zverev serve for serve. But at the most pivotal chances, he missed. His shoulders sagged in frustration as he looked over at his dad. In the seven-point tie-break, Zverev cruised, snatching the set for a commanding lead.

No matter how much the crowd tried to will him on, it seemed Shelton couldn’t quite withstand Zverev’s onslaught, faltering on rallies and struggling to solve the bigger man’s serve. Though he would manage to finally break Zverev’s serve and capture the third set, he ultimately withered in the fourth.

Some in the crowd greeted Zverev’s championship point with boos. Many left before the trophy presentation. Shelton slouched at his chair, shirtless and forlorn.

On the ceremony stage, he thanked his driver, the security guards at the practice courts who make him laugh, and all the fans who stayed till four in the morning to watch his quarterfinal epic.

“I wish this tournament never ended,” Shelton said. “I’m just getting started.”

An hour later, he strolled into the news conference with his hands in his pocket, a contrast from the swaggering saunter that usually follows his victories.

“This one stings,” he said, “100 percent.”

His first grand slam final run had worn him down, he admitted. He had played nearly 30 sets over two weeks, culminating on a humid afternoon that left him “tired at the end of the match,” he said.

But he understood a bit more now what it would take, he said. And he wanted to experience it again and again.

“Such a cool moment walking out on that court today,” he said. “I never felt anything like that before. It’s an addicting feeling.”

In fifth straight tourney, U.S. wins World Cup title

WORLD CUP FROM C1

Jackie Young to get within two at halftime, with Caitlin Clark hitting a three-pointer just before the buzzer.

“I think we felt really good about where we were at,” said Clark, who finished with 12 points. “I think France was 8 for 14 [from three-point range]. We dug ourselves a hole, but we climbed out of it, and I felt like we were never rattled by anything.”

The U.S. dominated in the second half, coming out of the locker room with a 11-2 run to go up 54-47. Stewart, who has now four World Cup titles to her name, had four points during the game-changing burst.

France was able to get within 55-51, but the Americans used a 16-3 spurt that included two unsportsmanlike fouls against France on the same play. The Americans were up 73-57 heading into the fourth quarter, and France never was able to close the gap.

“I’m really happy with the way that we let the rest of the world know that our goal is always gold,” Stewart said. “Just really proud.”

The U.S. improved to 9-0 in gold medal games since finishing second in 1983 to the Soviet Union.

This was the second-youngest team the Americans have sent to a World Cup. Several players on the roster — including Clark, Angel Reese and Paige Bueckers — were playing for the national team for the first time. But in the final, the veterans carried the team to victory.

The Americans had looked

more vulnerable in this tournament than at any time during their remarkable run. A three-point win over Italy in pool play was the closest a team has come to the U.S. in the group stage in 50 years. The 10-point victory over Spain was the closest semifinal contest during the streak. The Americans had been winning by an average of 26 points over their past four medal-round games.

None of that mattered in the end as the Americans finished the same way they had the previous four World Cup tournaments — as champions.

The loss nevertheless gave France its best finish ever in the event. The French were hoping for the top prize after they came close against the U.S. in the 2024 Paris Olympic gold medal game two years ago.

Dominique Malonga scored 21 points and Gabby Williams added 20 for France.

“Of course we’re disappointed right now, but I think we’re showing little by little, France is a basketball country,” Williams said. “That was my goal, when I joined this team, was to change the culture. Obviously we have higher expectations, but we’ll get there.”

France got off to a strong start. The U.S. trailed 20-17 after the first quarter, and the French scored the first 11 points of the second, capped by Williams’s three-pointer, to take a 31-17 lead. But the Americans rallied and trailed 45-43 at the half on Clark’s three just before the buzzer.

Spain topped host Germany to win the bronze medal.



MARYAM MAJD/REUTERS

The American women’s team has earned 36 consecutive wins at the FIBA World Cup dating back to its 2006 semifinal loss to Russia.

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NFL WEEK 1

STANDINGS												
NFC												
EAST	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA	HOME	AWAY	AFC	NFC	DIV	
Philadelphia	1	0	0	1.000	24	22	1-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	1-0-0	1-0-0	
x-Dallas	0	0	0	.000	0	0	0-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	
x-N.Y. Giants	0	0	0	.000	0	0	0-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	
Washington	0	1	0	.000	22	24	0-0-0	0-1-0	0-0-0	0-1-0	0-1-0	
SOUTH	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA	HOME	AWAY	AFC	NFC	DIV	
Atlanta	0	1	0	.000	13	20	0-0-0	0-1-0	0-1-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	
Tampa Bay	0	1	0	.000	27	33	0-0-0	0-1-0	0-1-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	
New Orleans	0	1	0	.000	30	31	0-0-0	0-1-0	0-0-0	0-1-0	0-0-0	
Carolina	0	1	0	.000	37	59	0-1-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	0-1-0	0-0-0	
NORTH	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA	HOME	AWAY	AFC	NFC	DIV	
Minnesota	1	0	0	1.000	39	22	1-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	1-0-0	1-0-0	
Chicago	1	0	0	1.000	59	37	0-0-0	1-0-0	0-0-0	1-0-0	0-0-0	
Detroit	1	0	0	1.000	31	30	1-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	1-0-0	0-0-0	
Green Bay	0	1	0	.000	22	39	0-0-0	0-1-0	0-0-0	0-1-0	0-1-0	
WEST	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA	HOME	AWAY	AFC	NFC	DIV	
San Francisco	1	0	0	1.000	27	7	0-0-0	1-0-0	0-0-0	1-0-0	1-0-0	
Arizona	1	0	0	1.000	26	14	0-0-0	1-0-0	1-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	
Seattle	1	0	0	1.000	13	10	1-0-0	0-0-0	1-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	
L.A. Rams	0	1	0	.000	7	27	0-1-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	0-1-0	0-1-0	

AFC												
EAST	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA	HOME	AWAY	AFC	NFC	DIV	
N.Y. Jets	1	0	0	1.000	23	10	0-0-0	1-0-0	1-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	
Buffalo	1	0	0	1.000	36	31	0-0-0	1-0-0	1-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	
New England	0	1	0	.000	10	13	0-0-0	0-1-0	0-0-0	0-1-0	0-0-0	
Miami	0	1	0	.000	13	27	0-0-0	0-1-0	0-1-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	
SOUTH	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA	HOME	AWAY	AFC	NFC	DIV	
Jacksonville	1	0	0	1.000	34	10	1-0-0	0-0-0	1-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	
Houston	0	1	0	.000	31	36	0-1-0	0-0-0	0-1-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	
Tennessee	0	1	0	.000	10	23	0-1-0	0-0-0	0-1-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	
Indianapolis	0	1	0	.000	23	41	0-1-0	0-0-0	0-1-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	
NORTH	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA	HOME	AWAY	AFC	NFC	DIV	
Baltimore	1	0	0	1.000	41	23	0-0-0	1-0-0	1-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	
Pittsburgh	1	0	0	1.000	20	13	1-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	1-0-0	0-0-0	
Cincinnati	1	0	0	1.000	33	27	1-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	1-0-0	0-0-0	
Cleveland	0	1	0	.000	10	34	0-0-0	0-1-0	0-1-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	
WEST	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA	HOME	AWAY	AFC	NFC	DIV	
Las Vegas	1	0	0	1.000	27	13	1-0-0	0-0-0	1-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	
Denver	0	0	0	.000	0	0	0-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	
Kansas City	0	0	0	.000	0	0	0-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	
L.A. Chargers	0	1	0	.000	14	26	0-1-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	0-1-0	0-0-0	

Wednesday's result
at Seattle 13, New England 10

Thursday's result
San Francisco 27, L.A. Rams 7, Melbourne, VIC

Sunday's results
at Philadelphia 24, Washington 22
Baltimore 41, at Indianapolis 23
Buffalo 36, at Houston 31
Chicago 59, at Carolina 37
at Cincinnati 33, Tampa Bay 27
at Detroit 31, New Orleans 30(OT)
at Jacksonville 34, Cleveland 10
N.Y. Jets 23, at Tennessee 10
at Pittsburgh 20, Atlanta 13
Arizona 26, at L.A. Chargers 14
at Las Vegas 27, Miami 13
at Minnesota 39, Green Bay 22
Dallas at N.Y. Giants, late

Monday's game
Denver at Kansas City, 8:15 p.m.

Thursday's game
Detroit at Buffalo, 8:15 p.m.

Sunday's games
Washington at Dallas, 4:25 p.m.
New Orleans at Baltimore, 1 p.m.
Carolina at Atlanta, 1 p.m.
Cincinnati at Houston, 1 p.m.
Cleveland at Tampa Bay, 1 p.m.
Green Bay at N.Y. Jets, 1 p.m.
Minnesota at Chicago, 1 p.m.
Philadelphia at Tennessee, 1 p.m.
Pittsburgh at New England, 1 p.m.
Jacksonville at Denver, 4:05 p.m.
Las Vegas at L.A. Chargers, 4:05 p.m.
Miami at San Francisco, 4:25 p.m.
Seattle at Arizona, 4:25 p.m.
Indianapolis at Kansas City, 8:20 p.m.

Monday, Sept. 21
N.Y. Giants at L.A. Rams, 8:15 p.m.

Baltimore prospers in Minter's debut

RAVENS 41,
COLTS 23

BY BRIAN WACKER

INDIANAPOLIS — The flag covered the entire field at Lucas Oil Stadium. Baltimore Ravens offensive coordinator Declan Doyle had to be nudged out of the way by a Colts official as it was being unfurled.

That's how focused the 30-year-old was on his call sheet and play script ahead of Sunday afternoon's 41-23 win in his debut as a play-caller.

Explosive was the word du jour among Ravens players and coaches all summer long. With none of the starters playing in the pre-season, it was unclear how it would show up in the regular season.

It didn't take long to find out. On Baltimore's first offensive play, Lamar Jackson faked a hand-off to Derrick Henry, rolled back to his left and found Zay Flowers streaking across the field. The Pro Bowl wide receiver made the catch near the sideline, hit the brakes, spun back toward the middle and raced for what ended up being a 49-yard completion to the Indianapolis 2-yard line to set up a touchdown.

"Shout out to 'Dec,'" Jackson said. "He was dialing it up. "We're in a great place. We just got to stay locked in. This is Week 1. A lot can happen in the season."

In a game, too. Jackson passed for 324 yards and a touchdown, ran for another score and had one vintage escape from the impossible. Flowers had 150 yards and a touchdown on five receptions. Derrick Henry rushed for 144 yards and three scores on 24 carries. In all, the Ravens racked up 504 total yards and averaged 7.9 per play.

In the end, it added up to a rousing thumping of the Colts in Jesse Minter's debut, earning the rookie coach his first career win and, as the final seconds ticked away, a hug from his father, Rick, who is an analyst on his son's staff. "It's surreal a little bit," Minter said. "I don't know if it's hit me yet."

The Ravens had plenty of hits in their season opener. Standing at his own 41 on second and nine midway through the



ANDY LYONS/GETTY IMAGES

Lamar Jackson and the Ravens got off to a hot start with a blowout victory in Indianapolis to start new coach Jesse Minter's tenure.

second quarter, Jackson faced the blitz and quick-fired a short pass to Flowers over the middle and in a soft spot in the defense. Flowers hit the gas, slicing his way through the Colts' secondary for a 54-yard score.

That put the Ravens up 21-6 midway through the second quarter, and away they went.

Flowers's 150 yards were also a career high, but the celebration was also short-lived.

The franchise wide receiver — who signed a four-year, \$140 million extension last month that makes him the fourth-highest-paid player at his position — suffered a hamstring injury in the second quarter that knocked him out of the game. Baltimore also lost promising rookie wide receiver Ja'Kobi Lane to a wrist injury after he was ruled out early in the third, and he appeared to be wearing something on his hand or wrist when he exited.

Minter did not have an update on either, but one or both will almost certainly miss at least some time.

"We'll have to see how that looks and see what we've got to do this week to get that room ready for next week," Minter said.

Flowers came up grabbing his left leg after a 12-yard catch at the 5:57 mark of the second and one play before a 32-yard touchdown run by Henry. It was the same

hamstring that caused him to miss much of the past two weeks of practice.

With Flowers and Lane out, Baltimore was perilously thin at the position, with Rashod Bateman, LaJohnat Wester and Chris Moore — who was elevated from the practice squad for the game — as the only other available wide receivers. The offense stalled, but only momentarily.

Jackson connected with Moore for a 53-yard strike on third and five to start the fourth quarter to help set up Henry's third touchdown of the game. The score leaped from 21-6 to 28-6.

Henry had 63 yards and two scores on 11 carries in the second half. That included five carries on a grinding 10-play, 43-yard drive that chewed up 6:17 of clock in the fourth quarter and was punctuated with a 45-yard field goal by Tyler Loop, who also had a 57-yarder at the end of the first half.

Still, Minter acknowledged that there's a lot to clean up and that he didn't do a great job on the first drive of the game, when the Colts marched 65 yards on nine plays, mostly through the air before Jonathan Taylor scored from one yard out.

— Baltimore Sun

Ravens 41, Colts 23

Baltimore		14	17	0	10	41
Indianapolis		6	7	3	7	23

FIRST QUARTER
Indianapolis: Taylor 1 run (kick failed), 10:33.
Indianapolis: L.Jackson 5 run (Loop kick), 8:20.
Baltimore: Henry 4 run (Loop kick), 4:05.

SECOND QUARTER
Baltimore: Flowers 54 pass from L.Jackson (Loop kick), 6:54.
Baltimore: Henry 32 run (Loop kick), 5:04.
Indianapolis: Taylor 3 run (Shrader kick), 2:16.
Baltimore: FG Loop 57, 0:00.

THIRD QUARTER
Indianapolis: FG Shrader 58, 7:55.

FOURTH QUARTER
Baltimore: Henry 3 run (Loop kick), 12:46.
Indianapolis: Warren 9 pass from D.Jones (Shrader kick), 10:26.
Baltimore: FG Loop 45, 4:09.
Attendance: 65,045.

	Bal	Ind
First Downs	23	17
Total Net Yards	506	251
Rushes-Yards	37-202	20-102
Passing	304	149
Punt Returns	3-30	0-0
Kickoff Returns	5-151	6-197
Interceptions Ret.	1-1	0-0
Comp-Att-Int	17-25-0	19-31-1
Sacked-Yards Lost	2-20	2-17
Punts	3-46-667	5-52-6
Fumbles-Lost	1-1	1-1
Penalties-Yards	10-86	4-29
Time Of Possession	35:20	24:40

PASSING
Baltimore: L.Jackson 17-25-0-324.
Indianapolis: Jones 19-31-1-166.

RUSHING
Baltimore: Henry 24-144, L.Jackson 7-40, Hill 6-18.
Indianapolis: Taylor 19-98, Jones 1-4.

RECEIVING
Baltimore: Flowers 5-150, Andrews 4-49, Wester 2-15, C.Moore 1-52, Henry 1-19, Hilber 1-13, Lane 1-11, Hill 1-10, Smythe 1-4.
Indianapolis: K.Allen 6-32, Pierce 4-61, Taylor 3-23, Warren 3-13, Downs 2-37, McGowan 1-0.

MISSED FIELD GOALS
None.

Jets 23, Titans 10

Breece Hall ran for 102 yards and a touchdown, and Geno Smith threw for 215 yards in his New York return, helping spoil Tennessee Coach Robert Saleh's debut against his former team in Nashville.

The Jets never trailed, led 10-3 at halftime and held the ball for just over 38 minutes. Smith, drafted by New York in 2013 and acquired from the Las Vegas Raiders in March, finished 19 for 24 while efficiently moving new coordinator Frank Reich's offense.

The Jets left Music City with their first season-opening win since 2023. A team that lost its first seven and last five games under Aaron Glenn last season dominated Tennessee with a 367-195 edge in total offense.

With Glenn calling the defense this season, rookie edge rusher David Bailey, the No. 2 pick, had one of three sacks for New York, which chased second-year quarterback Cam Ward all game.

Glenn deactivated kicker Blake Grupe, claimed off waivers Aug. 31 from the Indianapolis Colts, and went with Jason Sanders, who was elevated from the practice squad. Sanders made three field goals of 33, 51 and 52 yards, rebounding after yanking a 54-yard attempt short and left.

Jets safety Minkah Fitzpatrick hurt a groin muscle in the first quarter and was ruled out.

N.Y. Jets

FIRST QUARTER
N.Y. Jets: Sadiq 3 run (Sanders kick), 10:45.
Tennessee: FG Slye 42, 5:03.

SECOND QUARTER
N.Y. Jets: FG Sanders 33, 5:03.

THIRD QUARTER
N.Y. Jets: Hall 4 run (Sanders kick), 9:41.
N.Y. Jets: FG Sanders 51, 4:33.

FOURTH QUARTER
N.Y. Jets: FG Sanders 52, 5:00.
Tennessee: Ayomakor 11 pass from Ward (Slye kick), 2:42.
Attendance: 64,336.

	NVJ	Ten
First Downs	19	11
Total Net Yards	367	195
Rushes-Yards	39-152	14-68
Passing	215	127
Punt Returns	2-29	1-5
Kickoff Returns	0-0	3-62
Interceptions Ret.	0-0	0-0
Comp-Att-Int	19-32-0	19-32-0
Sacked-Yards Lost	0-0	3-13
Punts	3-46-333	7-46-571
Fumbles-Lost	1-0	1-1
Penalties-Yards	8-48	4-25
Time Of Possession	38:46	21:14

PASSING
N.Y. Jets: G.Smith 19-24-0-215.
Tennessee: Ward 19-32-0-140.

RUSHING
N.Y. Jets: Hall 22-102, Allen 10-40, G.Smith 6-7, Sadiq 1-5.
Tennessee: Paul 12-77, Graves 4-21, Spears 3-12.

RECEIVING
N.Y. Jets: Wilson 6-79, A.Mitchell 3-60, Sadiq 3-21, Hall 2-16, Taylor 2-(minus 2), O.Cooper 1-30, Williams 1-7, Rucker 1-4.
Tennessee: W.Robinson 5-38, Tate 4-38, Helm 4-28, Spears 2-12, Ayomakor 1-11, Bellinger 1-7, Dike 1-7, Pollard 1-(minus 1).

MISSED FIELD GOALS
N.Y. Jets: Sanders 54.

Jaguars 34, Browns 10

Trevor Lawrence threw for 245 yards and four touchdowns, opening the season much as he closed last year, and host Jacksonville dominated rebuilding Cleveland in Florida to spoil the debut of new coach Todd Monken.

The Jaguars scored on six of their first seven drives, as Lawrence connecting with Parker Washington, rookie Josh Cameron, Brenton Strange and Jakobi Meyers for touchdowns. Three of four targets were wide open.

Lawrence completed 18 of 23 passes and posted a career-high rating of 150.6, making it look easy against a defense that traded Myles Garrett and was entering its first season under new coordinator Mike Rutenberg.

Cleveland had equally troubling issues on the other side of the ball.

Deshaun Watson, making his first start in nearly two years, threw an interception on the opening drive. He nearly had another on the Browns' second drive and later recovered his own fumble to avoid a turnover.

Cleveland finished with two highlights: Raheem Sanders returned a kickoff 74 yards to set up a 26-yard field goal in the third quarter, and Watson hit Denzel Boston for a 46-yard touchdown with 1:52 remaining.

Cleveland finished with two highlights: Raheem Sanders returned a kickoff 74 yards to set up a 26-yard field goal in the third quarter, and Watson hit Denzel Boston for a 46-yard touchdown with 1:52 remaining.

FIRST QUARTER
Jacksonville: P.Washington 30 pass from Lawrence (C.Little kick), 8:06.
Jacksonville: Cameron 4 pass from Lawrence (C.Little kick), 1:42.

SECOND QUARTER
Jacksonville: FG CLittle 47, 9:09.
Jacksonville: Strange 14 pass from Lawrence (C.Little kick), 6:18.

THIRD QUARTER
Jacksonville: Meyers 32 pass from Lawrence (C.Little kick), 12:08.
Cleveland: FG Szymt 26, 8:31.
Jacksonville: FG CLittle 40, 1:48.

FOURTH QUARTER
Cleveland: Boston 46 pass from D.Watson (Szymt kick), 1:52.
Attendance: 41,156.

	Cle	Jac
First Downs	14	23
Total Net Yards	272	360
Rushes-Yards	22-87	32-126
Passing	185	234
Punt Returns	1-10	1-5
Kickoff Returns	6-228	3-82
Interceptions Ret.	0-0	1-22
Comp-Att-Int	16-22-1	18-23-0
Sacked-Yards Lost	2-20	1-11
Punts	3-43-333	2-54-0
Fumbles-Lost	2-1	1-0
Penalties-Yards	11-75	4-25
Time Of Possession	26:09	33:51

PASSING
Cleveland: D.Watson 16-22-1-205.
Jacksonville: Lawrence 18-23-0-245.

RUSHING
Cleveland: D.Watson 6-38, Judkins 12-33, Concepcion 3-15, R.Sanders 1-1.
Jacksonville: Tuten 15-66, Abdullah 4-32, Rodriguez 6-23, Hunter 1-3, Lawrence 2-3, Meyers 1-2, Mullens 3-(minus 3).

RECEIVING
Cleveland: Concepcion 4-43, R.Sanders 3-25, Boston 2-59, Jeurdy 2-26, Fannin 2-21, Judkins 2-17, Whiteheart 1-14.
Jacksonville: Washington 5-83, Bri.Thomas 3-40, Meyers 2-40, Savage 2-23, Cameron 2-20, Tuten 1-22, Boerckirch 1-9, Hunter 1-8, Abdullah 1-0.

MISSED FIELD GOALS
None.

Bengals 33, Buccaneers 27

Cincinnati's new-look defense forced four turnovers — including its first fumble recovery for a touchdown since 2022 — and Joe Burrow passed for 254 yards and a touchdown in a home win over Tampa Bay.

Lineback

NFL WEEK 1

SEPT. 13	SEPT.	SEPT.	OCT.	OCT.	OCT.	WEEK 7	NOV.	NOV.	NOV.	NOV.	NOV.	DEC.	DEC.	DEC.	WEEK 16	WEEK 17	WEEK 18
L	20	27	4	11	19	BYE	1	8	12	23	29	6	13	20			
@ PHI	@ DAL	vs. SEA	vs. IND	vs. NYG	@ SF		vs. PHI	vs. LAR	@ NYG	vs. CIN	@ ARI	@ TEN	vs. HOU	vs. ATL	@ MIN	@ JAX	vs. DAL
24-22	4:25 P.M.	1 P.M.	9:30 A.M.	1 P.M.	8:15 P.M.		8:20 P.M.	1 P.M.	8:15 P.M.	8:15 P.M.	4:25 P.M.	1 P.M.	1 P.M.	1 P.M.	TBD	TBD	TBD
	FOX	FOX	NFLN	FOX	ABC, ESPN		NBC	FOX	PRIME VIDEO	ESPN	FOX	CBS	CBS	FOX	TBD	TBD	TBD

With offense outmatched, Commanders drop season opener

COMMANDERS FROM CI

both sides to start. In the first quarter, each team punted twice while gaining just four first downs combined. The lone points came on a 55-yard field goal by Washington's Drew Stevens.

Toward the end of the period, however, the Eagles' offense found a spark. Commanders cornerback Mike Sainristil seemed to lose sight of the ball in coverage and turned the wrong way, leaving Philadelphia wide receiver Dontayvion Wicks wide open for a 64-yard completion.

A holding penalty and a tackle for a loss from Washington's Javon Kinlaw put the Eagles in a third-and-17 situation. But Goedert found a soft spot in Washington's zone, and Hurts hit him in stride for a touchdown to take the lead.

Later in the second quarter, Eagles running back Saquon Barkley made Leo Chenal miss just after the line of scrimmage and broke loose for a 42-yard scamper. That set up another Philadelphia touchdown, this time a nine-yard catch by Wicks.

Meanwhile, the Commanders' offense fell into a rut. After scoring on the opening drive, the unit had three consecutive three-and-outs and four straight punts.

During that stagnant stretch, Blough leaned on 12 personnel (one running back, two tight ends, two wide receivers) and attempted to get the run game going. But the Philadelphia defense stifled most of those attempts while primarily staying in its nickel package and playing with two high safeties, which made it more difficult for Washington to stretch the field. Daniels completed just 6 of 16 passes for 43 yards before halftime.

Asked whether the offense was rusty, Daniels responded: "Yeah, I think so. It's been a long time since I played football." It was his first full game since Week 6 last



MATT SLOCUM/AP

Tight end John Bates, bottom, was stopped on a two-point conversion try that would have tied the score late in the Commanders' opener.

season.

On their penultimate drive of the first half, the Commanders ended their drought. Blough opened things up by using more three-wide receiver formations. Daniels began scrambling more. And, most notably, Jacory Croskey-Merritt and the ground game got going. The result was a 12-play, 72-yard drive capped by Croskey-Merritt's one-yard scoring run.

"I thought it came a little bit

better as the game went on with the runs and the play-pass," Quinn said. "Sticking with the run game, I thought, was significant. ... When [the run and pass] marry and balance together, you get a lot more chances for the explosives."

Although Stevens's extra point was blocked, the score still trimmed the Eagles' lead to 14-9. And it was the first time the offense hit its stride: The Commanders had six first downs

on the drive — doubling their total from the rest of the first half.

That success wouldn't carry over into the second half. The offense went scoreless across three drives in the third quarter. They kept getting behind the sticks and finding themselves in third-and-longs.

"Especially a really good defense like that, you don't want to be in a third-and-long," Daniels said. "We shot ourselves in the

foot too many times. It came back and haunted us at the end of the game."

Washington broke through on a 67-yard drive capped by Diggs's 10-yard catch in the fourth quarter. But they were unable to attempt to tie to game because of his excessive celebration.

Once Goedert's second score extended the Eagles' lead to 24-16, the Commanders had a crack at forcing overtime. After hitting McLaurin for a six-yard gain on

Eagles 24, Commanders 22

Washington 24, Commanders 22
Philadelphia 0 14 3 7 24

FIRST QUARTER

Washington: FG Stevens 55, 11:23. Drive: 9 plays, 27 yards, 3:37. Key Plays: Lane kick return to Washington 36

SECOND QUARTER

Philadelphia: Goedert 17 pass from Hurts (Elliott kick), 14:11. Drive: 5 plays, 76 yards, 3:27. Key Play: Hurts 64 pass to Wicks. Philadelphia 7, Washington 3
Philadelphia: Wicks 9 pass from Hurts (Elliott kick), 6:27. Drive: 5 plays, 62 yards, 2:19. Key Play: Barkley 42 run on 3rd-and-2. Philadelphia 14, Washington 3
Washington: Croskey-Merritt 1 run (kick blocked), 1:53. Drive: 13 plays, 67 yards, 4:34. Key Plays: White kick return to Washington 33

THIRD QUARTER

Philadelphia: FG Elliott 35, :44. Drive: 7 plays, 43 yards, 3:00. Key Plays: Hurts 14 run

FOURTH QUARTER

Washington: Diggs 10 pass from Daniels (Stevens kick), 9:59. Drive: 11 plays, 52 yards, 5:45. Key Plays: Lane kick return to Washington 32
Philadelphia: Goedert 43 pass from Hurts (Elliott kick), 6:02. Drive: 9 plays, 74 yards, 3:57. Key Plays: Shipley kick return to Philadelphia 26
Washington: Williams 1 pass from Daniels (pass failed), 1:01. Drive: 13 plays, 62 yards, 5:01. Key Plays: Lane kick return to Washington 37
A: 69, 879.

	Was	Phi
First Downs	20	10
Rushing	9	4
Passing	10	6
Penalty	1	0
Third Down Eff.	5-15	6-14
Fourth Down Eff.	2-2	0-0
Total Net Yards	295	318
Total Plays	67	53
Avg Gain	4.4	6.0
Net Yards Rushing	132	136
Rushes	32	25
Avg Per Rush	4.125	5.44
Net Yards Passing	163	182
Sacked-Yds Lost	1-1	3-21
Gross-Yds Passing	164	203
Completed-Att.	18-34	14-25
Had Intercepted	0	0
Yards-Pass Play	4,657	6,5
Kickoffs-Endzone-Tb	5-2-1	5-0-0
Punts-Avg.	6-53.0	7-51.571
Punts Blocked	0	0
Fgs-Pats Blocked	0	0
Total Return Yards	207	112
Punt Returns	4-53	4-37
Kickoff Returns	5-154	2-75
Interceptions	0-0	0-0
Penalties-Yds	6-45	5-40
Fumbles-Lost	1-0	0-0
Time Of Possession	33:20	26:40

PASSING

Washington: Daniels 18-34-0-164.
Philadelphia: Hurts 14-25-0-203.

RUSHING

Washington: Croskey-Merritt 16-63, Daniels 5-31, White 7-22, Allen 4-16.
Philadelphia: Barkley 15-83, Hurts 7-46, Shipley 2-4, Bigsby 1-3.

RECEIVING

Washington: Williams 4-64, Diggs 4-55, Okonkwo 2-16, McLaurin 2-14, Bates 2-13, White 2-5, Lane 1-4, Croskey-Merritt 1-(minus 7).
Philadelphia: Goedert 4-77, D.Smith 3-53, Lemon 3-(minus 5), Wicks 2-73, Shipley 1-8, Barkley 1-(minus 3).

PUNT RETURNS

Washington: Lane 4-53.
Philadelphia: Covey 4-37.

KICKOFF RETURNS

Washington: Lane 3-95, White 2-59.
Philadelphia: Bigsby 2-50, Shipley 1-25.

TACKLES-ASSISTS-SACKS

Washington: Cross 5-3-0, Sainristil 4-1-0, Robertson 3-3-0, Styles 3-1-1, Reeves 2-2-0, Oweh 2-1-1, Martin 2-0-0, Luvu 1-3-1, Chenal 1-2-0, Kinlaw 1-1-0, Douglas 1-0-0, Payne 1-0-0, Settle 0-3-0, Magee 0-1-0, Tuttle 0-1-0.
Philadelphia: Baun 7-5-0, J.Campbell 5-4-1, Epps 5-2-0, DeJean 4-4-0, Davis 3-5-0, Ojomo 2-1-0, Mitchell 2-0-0, J.Carter 1-2-0, Hunt 1-2-0, N.Smith 1-1-0, Ebiketie 1-0-0, Mukuba 1-0-0, Woolen 1-0-0, Epenesa 0-1-0, Young 0-1-0.

INTERCEPTIONS

Washington: None. Philadelphia, None.

MISSED FIELD GOALS

Washington: Stevens 54.

Bears 59, Panthers 37

Caleb Williams threw for 269 yards and two touchdowns and ran for 65 yards and two more scores as Chicago defeated Carolina in Charlotte in the highest-scoring opener in NFL history.

The Bears and Panthers scored eight more points than the previous record of 88, set in the Tampa Bay Buccaneers' 48-40 win over the New Orleans Saints in 2018.

Coach Ben Johnson's prolific Bears also broke a franchise record for points in an opener, a mark that had stood since 1948, when Chicago hung 45 on the Green Bay Packers at Wrigley Field. The 59 points were the most allowed by the Panthers in team history.

It was also the fourth-most points in Chicago's history.

Williams looked like an MVP candidate, completing several pinpoint passes while racking up 196 yards through the air in the first half, including a perfectly placed 22-yard touchdown strike to Cole Kmet. He also ran for 52 yards and two touchdowns before the break as the Bears took a 31-24 lead into the locker room.

Chicago	14	17	14	14	59
Carolina	7	17	7	6	37

FIRST QUARTER

Chicago: Hubbard 4 pass from Young (Fitzgerald kick), 11:33.
Chicago: Williams 9 run (Santos kick), 5:52.
Carolina: FG Fitzgerald 44, 2:35.
Chicago: Swift 1 run (Santos kick), 1:59.

SECOND QUARTER

Chicago: Kmet 22 pass from Williams (Santos kick), 13:57.
Carolina: Coker 51 pass from Young (Fitzgerald kick), 12:40.
Carolina: Young 7 run (Fitzgerald kick), 8:42.
Chicago: FG Santos 40, 5:20.
Carolina: FG Fitzgerald 44, 2:35.
Chicago: Williams 29 run (Santos kick), :22.

THIRD QUARTER

Carolina: Hubbard 2 run (Fitzgerald kick), 9:02.
Chicago: Swift 1 run (Santos kick), 3:05.
Chicago: Monangal 61 run (Santos kick), :40.
Attendance: 72,597.

FOURTH QUARTER

Chicago: J.Walker 1 pass from Williams (Santos kick), 6:27.
Carolina: Coker 8 pass from Young (kick blocked), 4:00.
Chicago: Swift 28 run (Santos kick), 3:40.
Attendance: 72,597.

	Chi	Car
First Downs	26	24
Total Net Yards	552	478
Rushes-Yards	39-291	22-125
Passing	59-291	353
Punt Returns	1-23	2-17
Kickoff Returns	4-85	7-153
Interceptions Ret.	1-0	0-0
Comp-Att-Int	21-29-4	23-38-1
Sacked-Yards Lost	2-8	2-8
Punts	2-51.0	3-49.0
Fumbles-Lost	1-1	2-2
Penalties-Yards	12-57	11-84
Time Of Possession	34:03	25:57

PASSING

Chicago: Williams 21-29-0-269.
Carolina: Young 23-37-1-361, Pickett 0-1-0-0.

RUSHING

Chicago: Swift 18-124, Monangal 10-100, Williams 10-65, Burden 1-2.
Carolina: Hubbard 10-49, Dillon 5-28, Pickett 1-24, Brooks 4-14, Young 2-10.

RECEIVING

Chicago: Raymond 8-84, Burden 5-63, Oduze 2-52, Kmet 2-35, Monangal 2-24, Swift 1-10, Walker 1-1.
Carolina: Coker 8-138, McMillan 5-75, Hubbard 3-39, Tremble 3-25, Waller 2-28, Brooks 1-48, M.Evans 1-1.

MISSED FIELD GOALS

None.

Lions 31, Saints 30 (OT)

Tyler Shough threw an incomplete pass in the end zone on a two-point conversion attempt, allowing Detroit to escape with an overtime win against visiting New Orleans.

Saints Coach Kellen Moore chose to go for the win instead of tying the game with 1:34 left in overtime after his team came back from a three-touchdown deficit in the third quarter and allowed a touchdown on the opening possession of the extra period.

Jared Goff threw two touchdown passes to Amon-Ra St. Brown, the second a five-yard throw early in overtime, and Jahmyr Gibbs ran for three touchdowns.

New Orleans rallied from a 21-0 deficit and tied the score at 24 on Shough's nine-yard pass to Juwan Johnson with 1:07 left in the game.

Detroit went three-and-out, giving the Saints the ball with a chance to win it, but Ryan Wright missed a 62-yard field goal attempt as time expired.

Gibbs had a career-high 29 carries for 156 yards and matched a career high with two rushing touchdowns. Goff was 26 for 39 for 206 yards without a turnover.

Shough, coming off a promising rookie year, threw two interceptions and lost a fumble before closing strong, completing 35 of 56 passes for 410 yards and three scores.

New Orleans	0	0	14	10	6	30
Detroit	7	0	14	3	7	31

FIRST QUARTER

Detroit: Gibbs 1 run (Bates kick), 3:37.

THIRD QUARTER

Detroit: Gibbs 1 run (Bates kick), 11:14.
Detroit: St. Brown 19 pass from Goff (Bates kick), 8:54.
New Orleans: K.Miller 8 run (Carlson kick), 4:27.
New Orleans: Vele 1 pass from Shough (Carlson kick), :28.

FOURTH QUARTER

New Orleans: FG Carlson 28, 7:41.
Detroit: FG Bates 23, 2:32.
New Orleans: Johnson 9 pass from Shough (Carlson kick), 1:07.

FIRST OVERTIME

Detroit: St. Brown 4 pass from Goff (Bates kick), 5:04.
New Orleans: Fant 8 pass from Shough (pass failed), 1:34.
Attendance: 62,897.

	NO	Det
First Downs	29	26
Total Net Yards	469	369
Rushes-Yards	25-91	33-165
Passing	378	204
Punt Returns	4-21	3-35
Kickoff Returns	4-74	4-84
Interceptions Ret.	0-0	2-4
Comp-Att-Int	35-56-2	26-39-0
Sacked-Yards Lost	5-47.6	1-2
Punts	5-42.6	7-48.0
Fumbles-Lost	2-1	2-1
Penalties-Yards	6-53	8-61
Time Of Possession	31:35	36:51

PASSING

New Orleans: Shough 35-56-2-410.
Detroit: Goff 26-39-0-206.

RUSHING

New Orleans: Etienne 9-46, K.Miller 9-30, Shough 4-8, Allgeier 2-9, Love 2-9, Harrison 1-33.
Detroit: Gibbs 29-156, Vaki 2-7, Goff 2-2.

RECEIVING

New Orleans: Olave 10-182, Vele 7-69, Etienne 7-32, Fant 2-35, Monangal 2-24, Swift 1-10, Walker 1-1.
Detroit: St. Brown 10-67, LaPorta 5-48, Gibbs 5-30, J.Williams 4-45, Vaki 1-11, Wright 1-5.

MISSED FIELD GOALS

New Orleans: Carlson 62.

Cardinals 26, Chargers 14

Jacoby Brissett threw for 277 yards and a touchdown, and Arizona defeated Los Angeles in Inglewood, California, giving Mike LaFleur a win over Jim Harbaugh in his head coaching debut.

The Chargers were 9.5-point favorites — the biggest in the NFL in Week 1 — but they played from behind the entire game against a team coming off an injury-riddled season during which it won just three games.

LaFleur became the first Cardinals coach to win his debut since Don Coryell in 1973. Coryell coached the Chargers from 1978-86.

LaFleur won in the same SoFi Stadium where he worked his final game as the Los Angeles Rams' offensive coordinator last year before Arizona hired him in February. He added 16 new assistants and 18 new players.

Former Maryland kicker Chad Ryland had four field goals as the Cardinals won on the road against the Chargers for the first time since 2001. His only miss was a 54-yarder when the ball hit the right upright in the second quarter.

The Chargers made a mess of the fourth quarter. On their first three possessions, they had a blocked punt, Justin Herbert was intercepted and Los Angeles turned the ball over on downs on fourth and goal from the 3-yard line. They had another turnover on downs with less than two minutes remaining.

Arizona	7	6	3	10	26
L.A. Chargers	7	0	7	0	14

FIRST QUARTER

Arizona: Love 5 run (Ryland kick), 8:49.
LA Chargers: Hampton 8 run (Dicker kick), 4:22.

SECOND QUARTER

Arizona: FG Ryland 27, 6:51.
Arizona: FG Ryland 44, :00.

THIRD QUARTER

Arizona: FG Ryland 34, 7:25.
LA Chargers: McKinley 8 pass from J.Herbert (Dicker kick), 6:03.

FOURTH QUARTER

Arizona: McBride 3 pass from Brissett (Ryland kick), 11:44.
Arizona: FG Ryland 49, 2:33.

	Ari	LAC
First Downs	23	17
Total Net Yards	393	268
Rushes-Yards	34-116	21-81
Passing	277	187
Punt Returns	0-0	0-0
Kickoff Returns	3-69	4-80
Interceptions Ret.	1-0	0-0
Comp-Att-Int	27-37-0	17-27-1
Sacked-Yards Lost	1-0	3-22
Punts	3-52.667	3-33.0
Fumbles-Lost	0-0	1-1
Penalties-Yards	8-111	7-64
Time Of Possession	37:31	22:29

PASSING

Arizona: Brissett 27-37-0-277.
LA Chargers: J.Herbert 17-27-1-209.

RUSHING

Arizona: Allgeier 17-61, Love 11-41, Brissett 6-14, Allgeier 2-9, Love 2-9, Harrison 1-33.
Detroit: Gibbs 29-156, Vaki 2-7, Goff 2-2.

RECEIVING

Arizona: McBride 9-95, Bourne 8-75, M.Wilson 5-56, Allgeier 2-9, Love 2-9, Harrison 1-33.
LA Chargers: McKinley 5-82, Njoku 5-58, T.Harris 3-20, Gadsden 2-17, Johnston 2-17.

MISSED FIELD GOALS

Arizona: Ryland 54.

Raiders 27, Dolphins 13

Kirk Cousins became the 15th quarterback with 300 touchdown passes in his career after tossing three to lead Las Vegas to a home win over Miami.

Two of his touchdown passes went to running back Ashton Jeanty, who also rushed for 102 yards and caught six passes for 45 more. It was the third career 100-yard game for Jeanty, the No. 6 pick in the 2025 NFL draft who showed no ill effects of an ankle injury he suffered Aug. 23.

Cousins, making his first start for the Raiders after being acquired in the offseason from Atlanta, was 21 for 30 for 160 yards, though he was intercepted twice. He has 301 touchdown passes for his career, moving into 14th and one ahead of John Elway.

Playing with a rare true home-field advantage, the Raiders totaled 290 yards in their first game under coach Klint Kubiak, the offensive coordinator on the Seattle Seahawks' Super Bowl-championship team last season.

It was a noticeable improvement for an offense that last season was last in the league in yardage (245.2 per game) and scoring (14.2 points).

The Dolphins, the league's youngest team with an average age of 25.5, weren't much of a test. But expectations are high for Miami this season under first-year coach Jeff Haflay.

Malik Willis, under pressure much of the game, passed for 220 yards with an interception and five sacks.

Miami	0	6	7	0	13
Las Vegas	7	10	10	0	27

FIRST QUARTER

BASEBALL

National League

EAST	W	L	PCT	GB	L10 STR	CENTRAL	W	L	PCT	GB	L10 STR	WEST	W	L	PCT	GB	L10 STR
Atlanta	88	62	.587	- 5-5	L-1	z-Milwaukee	93	57	.620	- 6-4	L-1	Los Angeles	90	59	.604	- 8-2	L-2
Philadelphia	83	67	.553	5 4-6	W-1	Chicago	83	67	.553	10 5-5	L-1	San Diego	81	68	.544	9 8-2	W-7
Miami	74	76	.493	14 3-7	W-2	Pittsburgh	75	75	.500	18 7-3	W-1	Arizona	79	71	.527	11½ 6-4	L-2
Washington	70	81	.464	18½ 3-7	W-3	St. Louis	74	76	.493	19 4-6	W-1	San Francisco	62	88	.413	28½ 4-6	L-3
New York	69	80	.463	18½ 7-3	L-1	Cincinnati	70	79	.470	22½ 4-6	W-1	Colorado	55	94	.369	35 2-8	L-7

z-Clinched playoff berth

American League

EAST	W	L	PCT	GB	L10 STR	CENTRAL	W	L	PCT	GB	L10 STR	WEST	W	L	PCT	GB	L10 STR
z-Tampa Bay	90	59	.604	- 7-3	W-3	Chicago	76	73	.510	- 3-7	L-1	Houston	75	75	.500	- 4-6	L-3
New York	86	63	.577	4 7-3	W-1	Cleveland	76	74	.507	½ 6-4	W-1	Texas	74	76	.493	1 5-5	W-2
Boston	82	68	.547	8½ 7-3	W-2	Detroit	70	79	.470	6 6-4	W-4	Seattle	70	80	.467	5 4-6	L-1
Toronto	75	75	.500	15½ 6-4	W-2	Minnesota	70	79	.470	6 3-7	L-2	Athletics	61	89	.407	14 7-3	W-1
Baltimore	72	78	.480	18½ 3-7	L-2	Kansas City	66	84	.440	10½ 4-6	L-1	Los Angeles	56	93	.376	14-7	L-3

z-Clinched playoff berth

Nationals 6, Angels 5

ANGELS	AB	R	H	BIBBS	AVG
Neto ss.....	4	2	1	1	2.240
Troat dh.....	2	0	0	0	1.244
Meckler lf.....	2	1	0	0	2.293
Grissom lb.....	4	0	0	0	2.239
Ballesteros.....	2	1	1	0	2.219
Guzman 3b.....	4	0	0	0	3.221
Lowe rf.....	4	1	1	0	2.206
Siri cf.....	3	0	0	0	2.223
Frazier ph.....	1	0	0	0	2.234
Moore 2b.....	4	0	1	0	1.179
TOTALS	30	5	4	6	1.13

NATIONALS	AB	R	H	BIBBS	AVG
Wood rf.....	4	0	2	0	1.268
Pinkney cf.....	0	0	0	0	2.273
Ortiz dh.....	3	0	0	0	2.212
Crews ph-dh.....	2	0	1	1	2.223
Chaparro 3b.....	4	0	1	0	1.251
Abrams ss.....	4	2	1	0	1.264
Morales lb.....	4	2	2	0	0.296
Lie lf.....	4	1	2	0	1.248
Ruiz c.....	3	0	1	0	0.289
Tena 2b.....	2	0	1	0	1.225
House ph.....	0	1	0	0	0.239
Vivas ph-2b.....	1	1	1	0	0.244
Young cf.....	4	1	1	0	0.249
TOTALS	36	6	13	6	1.13

L.A. 000110 021 - 5 4 0
WASHINGTON. 00002 04X - 6 13 1

E: Abrams (2). LOB: Los Angeles 5, Washington 9. 2B: Troat (25). Lowe (8), Abrams (29), Young (20). 3B: Lie (8). HR: Ballesteros (9), off Irvin; Neto (26), off Irvin. RBI: Ballesteros 2 (34), Neto (73), Moore (10), Morales (3), House (44), Lie (82), Vivas (29), Young (47), Crews (40). SB: Neto (20), Young (18). SF: Ballesteros.

ANGELS IP H R ERBSO AWP
Rodriguez.....5½ 7 2 2 1 4 936.10
Saucedo.....1 0 0 0 0 143.06
Murphy.....1 4 4 1 1 216.19
Peralta.....½ 1 0 0 0 216.11

NATIONALS IP H R ERBSO AWP
Cornello.....2 1 0 0 1 434.88
Irvin.....2 3 3 4 6 765.51
Tolman.....0 1 0 1 0 252.61
Sincilar.....1 1 1 0 1 121.69

WP: Tolman (1-1); LP: Murphy (0-3); S: Sincilar (1). Inherited runners-scored: Saucedo 1, Peralta 1. HBP: Saucedo (Ruiz). WP: Tolman. ABS Challenge: Cornello (Ball-Confirmed) T: 2:34. At: 26,761 (41,376).

HOW THEY SCORED

ANGELS FOURTH
Vaughn Grissom pops out. Moises Ballesteros homers. Denzer Guzman called out on strikes. Josh Lowe strikes out swinging.

ANGELS FIFTH
Jose Siri strikes out swinging. Christian Moore grounds out. Zach Neto homers. Mike Trout walks. Wade Meckler flies out.

ANGELS 2 NATIONALS 0

NATIONALS SIXTH
Andres Chaparro grounds out. CJ Abrams doubles. Yohandy Morales singles. CJ Abrams scores. Daylen Lie singles. Yohandy Morales to second. Keibert Ruiz hit by pitch. Daylen Lie to second. Yohandy Morales to third. Brady House pinch-hitting for Jose Tena. Yohandy House hits into a force out. Keibert Ruiz out at second. Daylen Lie to third. Yohandy Morales scores. Jacob Young flies out.

ANGELS 2 NATIONALS 2
NATIONALS EIGHTH
Yohandy Morales singles. Daylen Lie triples. Yohandy Morales scores. Keibert Ruiz grounds out. Jorlit Vivas pinch-hitting for Nasmun Nur. Jorlit Vivas scores. Daylen Lie to second. Wade Meckler to third. Zach Neto scores. Moises Ballesteros out on a sacrifice fly. Vaughn Grissom to third. Wade Meckler scores. Denzer Guzman strikes out swinging.

ANGELS 4 NATIONALS 2
NATIONALS EIGHTH
Yohandy Morales singles. Daylen Lie triples. Yohandy Morales scores. Keibert Ruiz grounds out. Jorlit Vivas pinch-hitting for Nasmun Nur. Jorlit Vivas scores. Daylen Lie to second. Wade Meckler to third. Zach Neto scores. Moises Ballesteros out on a sacrifice fly. Vaughn Grissom to third. Wade Meckler scores. Denzer Guzman strikes out swinging.

ANGELS NINTH
Josh Lowe grounds. Adam Frazier pinch-hitting for Jose Siri. Adam Frazier grounds out. Josh Lowe to third. Christian Moore grounds out. Josh Lowe scores. Zach Neto strikes out swinging.

NATIONALS 6, ANGELS 5

NATIONALS' LEADERS

ENTERING TUESDAY'S GAME
BATTERS AVG H 2B HR RBI BB SO
Vaughn......296 8 7 2 3 0 1
Wiener......289 90 24 10 47 16 2
Ruz......286 20 5 3 12 12 1
Garcia......283 101 20 23 76 16 1
Pincney......273 6 1 1 1 1 1
Wood......268 127 29 30 75 98 21
Abrams......264 143 29 30 66 59 29
Meckler......254 72 17 17 48 39 6
Chaparro......251 44 12 10 36 22 0
Young......249 99 20 10 47 32 18
Lowe......248 140 27 20 82 39 15
Vivas......244 69 15 29 38 2
House......239 70 15 10 44 24 3
Tena......225 56 12 7 23 27 5
Crews......223 81 19 11 40 27 9
Ortiz......212 24 5 5 13 6 0
Nur......210 86 5 1 35 46 46
Ford......186 16 4 6 13 14 3
Millas......185 24 6 2 11 10 3

PITCHERS W L ERA SV ER BB SO
Waldron.....1 0 0.00 0 0 1 2
Sincilar.....1 0 1.69 1 1 3 5
Fernandez.....0 0 2.25 0 0 2 3
Yean.....1 2 4.05 0 3 7 7
Tolman.....1 1 2.61 2 3 5 11
Williams.....0 0 2.65 0 5 6 22
Poulin.....3 0 2.70 3 3 11 21 25
Griffin.....12 3 3.06 0 44 50 116
Cavalli.....12 5 3.12 0 57 48 194
Bird.....0 0 3.24 0 3 2 10
Alvarez.....2 6 3.35 0 26 11 21 25
Ribballo.....1 2 3.77 2 18 18 42
Dion.....1 2 3.80 0 9 10 21
Loveday.....1 3 3.91 4 10 17 21
Lord.....5 2 4.06 1 35 31 71
Owens.....0 0 4.26 1 3 7 6
Beeter.....6 5 4.50 12 24 41 37
Cornello.....2 2 4.88 0 15 22 31

NL WILD-CARD STANDINGS

Team	W	L	Pct	WCGB
Chicago	83	67	.553	+1½
Philadelphia	83	67	.553	+1½
San Diego	81	68	.544	-
Arizona	79	71	.527	-2½

AL WILD-CARD STANDINGS

Team	W	L	Pct	WCGB
New York	86	63	.577	+10½
Boston	82	68	.547	+
Cleveland	76	74	.507	-
Texas	74	76	.493	-2
Baltimore	72	78	.480	4

NL leaders

ENTERING MONDAY'S GAMES
BATTING
Arreaga, Phi......313
Rodrigue, Mia......309

ERA

Misiorowski, M.....1.952
Sale, Atl.....2.178
San Diego.....2.381

AL leaders

ENTERING MONDAY'S GAMES
BATTING
Alvarez, Hou......310
Simmons, Tex......305

ERA

Schiltler, NY.....1.949
Cease, Tor.....2.381

O's are on life support after latest loss

BLUE JAYS 8, ORIOLES 1

BY JACOB CALVIN MEYER

TORONTO — Vladimir Guerrero Jr.'s home run against the Baltimore Orioles on Sunday was only a solo shot in the fifth inning of a regular season game. But for the hero of the Blue Jays' postseason last year, it was cathartic amid what's been a disastrous season.

Guerrero's first homer in Toronto to all season — a nearly unbelievable fact given Guerrero's status as one of the sport's top sluggers — helped the Blue Jays deal the Orioles an 8-1 loss, essentially ending their season.

After taking the series opener Friday, Baltimore (72-78) lost the final two, falling further back in the American League wild-card race. The Orioles have only 12 games remaining, and they may have to win all of them to earn the right to play in October. Fan-Graphs puts the odds of that happening at below 3 percent.

The first inning was emblematic of the entire afternoon for the Orioles' offense — and a common theme in many of their losses this season. Blue Jays ace Dylan Cease, a contender for the AL Cy Young Award, loaded the bases with no outs, then struck out Coby Mayo,



NATHAN DENETTE/CANADIAN PRESS/AP

Vladimir Guerrero Jr. went deep for the first time in Toronto this year, part of a three-homer inning to take the lead over the Orioles.

Samuel Basallo and Christian Encarnacion-Strand to escape.

In total, Baltimore went 1 for 12 with runners in scoring position and left 13 men on base.

Orioles starting pitcher Trevor Rogers was solid through his first four frames, allowing only an RBI double to Andrés Giménez in the second inning. But the Blue Jays hit back-to-back-to-back solo homers in the fifth — George Springer, then Guerrero, then Kazuma Okamoto. The trio of

long balls traveled a combined 1,135 feet.

The Orioles' bullpen and defense then unraveled in the eighth to make the game a laugh. Yaramil Hiraldo, who was recalled Sunday to replace the injured Kyle Bradish, walked three batters and allowed four runs in the frame. Three of those runs scored on a Springer double allowed by Cam Sanders on a ball that bounced past left fielder Dylan Beavers.

— Baltimore Sun

Yankees 2, Mets 0

Cam Schiltler took over the major league ERA lead, combining on a three-hitter that helped the Yankees close in on a playoff berth with a win over the Mets.

Schiltler allowed one hit over six innings, his 21st start this year allowing one run or none. The only other pitcher 25 or younger with more in the last 10 years was the Angels' Dean Chance with 22 in 1964.

METS	AB	R	H	BIBBS	AVG
Lindor ss.....	3	0	0	1	2.232
Soto dh.....	4	0	0	0	2.272
Bichette 3b.....	4	0	1	0	1.263
Benge lf.....	4	0	0	0	2.271
Young lb.....	3	0	1	0	1.269
Ewing cf.....	3	0	1	0	1.251
Alvarez c.....	3	0	1	0	0.231
Torres c.....	0	0	0	0	0.245
Baty 2b.....	3	0	1	0	0.229
Morabito lf.....	3	0	0	0	0.172
TOTALS	30	0	3	0	1.10

YANKEES	AB	R	H	BIBBS	AVG
Rice dh.....	2	1	1	2	1.260
Bellinger lf.....	4	0	0	0	0.268
Judge cf.....	3	0	0	0	0.212
Garcia lb.....	3	0	0	0	0.289
Jones cf.....	3	1	0	0	0.265
Volpe 2b.....	2	0	1	1	1.245
McMahon 3b.....	3	0	0	0	0.212
Wells c.....	3	1	0	0	1.176
Caballero ss.....	2	0	0	1	2.232
TOTALS	25	3	2	4	1.10

NEW YORK (N) 5, NEW YORK (A) 0
NEW YORK (A) 001 00000X - 3 0 0
NEW YORK (A) 001 00000X - 3 0 0

LOB: New York (N) 5, New York (A) 3
2B: Baty (21), HR: Rice (38), off Scott; Wells (11), off Scott.

METS IP H R ERBSO ERA
Scott.....6 3 2 2 2 73.76
Laverdy.....1 0 0 0 0 1.231
A.Warren.....1 0 0 0 1 1.447

YANKEES IP H R ERBSO ERA
Schiltler.....6 1 0 0 0 2.8195
Headrick.....1 0 0 0 0 11.94
Blackburn.....1 1 0 0 0 0.167
Bednar.....1 1 0 0 0 1.266

WP: Schiltler (14-6); LP: Scott (4-5); S: Jofra (24), ABS Challenge: Schiltler (Ball-Confirmed) T: 2:25. At: 45,508 (47,309).

Pirates 4, Cubs 3

Brandon Lowe hit a tie-breaking two-run single in a three-run sixth inning, and Pittsburgh rallied past Chicago to avoid a sweep.

Bryan Reynolds had two hits for the Pirates, including an RBI single.

Rangers 7, D'backs 6

Corey Seager homered for the fourth time in seven games, Jacob Latz stranded the potential tying run at second base in a shaky ninth inning, and Texas won its first road series in two months with a victory over Arizona.

RANGERS	AB	R	H	BIBBS	AVG
Foscue 2b.....	3	2	1	0	1.269
Carter ph-cf.....	2	0	1	0	1.195
Reynolds lf.....	4	1	2	1	1.267
Cook rf.....	0	0	0	0	0.176
Flores lb.....	4	1	1	0	2.250
Gonzales 2b.....	4	1	1	0	1.304
Nimmo rf.....	4	0	2	1	1.263
Lundgren lf.....	4	0	0	0	2.241
D'Arnaud 3b.....	3	1	1	0	1.268
McCam 2b.....	3	2	1	0	0.282
Muncy dh.....	3	0	0	0	2.232
Jansen dh.....	4	1	1	0	1.188
TOTALS	37	10	6	11	1.10

D'BACKS	AB	R	H	BIBBS	AVG
Nootbaar lf.....	3	0	0	0	2.240
Troy ph-1f.....	2	0	0	0	1.217
Marte 2b.....	4	0	1	1	1.250
Moreno dh.....	5	1	1	0	1.301
Perdomo ss.....	4	1	3	0	1.252
Carroll rf.....	4	1	1	0	2.238
Arenado 3b.....	4	2	2	0	0.240
Tawa lb.....	4	1	1	0	1.248
McCam 2b.....	3	2	1	0	0.282
Lawler cf.....	2	0	1	1	1.258
TOTALS	36	12	6	11	1.10

TEXAS.....200 032 000 - 7 10 0
ARIZONA.....000 100 302 - 6 12 2

E: Arenado (6), Nootbaar (2). LOB: Texas 5, Arizona 15. 2B: Jansen (8), Arenado (23), Tawa (12), Lawler (4). HR: Seager (18), off Rodriguez; Moreno (13), off Quantrell; Arenado (25), off Alexander.

RANGERS IP H R ERBSO ERA
Quantrell.....6 5 2 2 0 2.90
Alexander.....6 2 2 2 1 0.343
R.Garcia.....1 2 0 0 0 12.25
Latz.....1 3 2 2 1 12.06

D'BACKS IP H R ERBSO ERA
Rodriguez.....5 8 6 3 1 7.262
Clarke.....½ 2 1 0 0 2.249
Santana.....½ 0 0 0 0 0.509
B.Garcia.....1 0 0 0 0 12.03

WP: Quantrell (9-5); LP: Rodriguez (15-6); S: Latz (29). Inherited runners-scored: Alexander 1-1, Clarke 1-1. BB: off Latz (Marke). HBP: Quantrell (Lavar). ABS Challenge: Rodriguez (Ball-Overturned to Strike) Pitch timer violations. Latz (pitcher). T: 2:37. At: 28,843 (48,359).

Cardinals 3, White Sox 1

Alec Burleson hit a bases-clearing double, sparking St

Irvin comes out of bullpen, and Nats come up with sweep

NATIONALS FROM CI

scoreless innings Saturday — making a strong case to join him in the rotation as well. Josiah Gray, Connelly Early and DJ Herz are also candidates if healthy, as is rookie Jackson Kent.

All of those arms have a higher upside than what Irvin has shown this season, so he could find himself without a spot next season. Irvin does have minor league options remaining, but he will be in his second year of arbitration, and it's hard to imagine the Nationals being willing to pay his salary just to have him pitch for Class AAA Rochester.

But that's still months away. First, Irvin and the Nationals had Sunday's game to get through.

Riley Cornelio was a starter throughout his minor league career, but his MLB debut in April came out of the bullpen. It did not go well — he was thrown into a high-leverage spot, where he allowed two runs and took the loss against the Chicago White Sox. Butera said Sunday that he regrets that decision. Now, once the Nationals have determined how they plan to use a player in the majors, they make sure he gets reps at that role in the minors before getting the call.

Cornelio has gained more experience as a reliever since his debut, but Butera said he could be in contention for a starting role in the future as well. Cornelio said all of the different roles have helped him gain confidence.

"I think it's just building resilience," he said. "Going down the road, I'll have those moments. I feel like those things happen for a reason."

On Sunday, as Cornelio took the mound for the first inning, he looked shaky, but catcher Keibert Ruiz calmed him down, and the Angels stranded two base runners. In the second inning, Cornelio was confident and in control, setting down the side on 10 pitches. He finished with one hit and one walk allowed while striking out four.

After the offense missed out on early scoring opportunities — including coming up empty after loading the bases in the first inning — Irvin took over in the third with the game still scoreless. He allowed two solo home runs, one to Moisés Ballesteros in the fourth inning and a second to Zach Neto in the fifth.

Down 2-0, the Nationals finally got on the board in the sixth inning. CJ Abrams doubled with one out, then scored on a single from Yohandy Morales that chased Angels starter Grayson Rodriguez. Tayler Saucedo then loaded the bases on just two pitches for Brady House.

In an 0-2 count, House reached for an outside changeup and hit a tailor-made double play ball. But second baseman Christian Moore's relay bounced off the glove of first baseman Vaughn Grissom, and Morales tied it up.

The game remained tied until the eighth inning, when Erik Tolman took over after Irvin issued a leadoff walk to Neto. Los Angeles loaded the bases, aided by an Abrams error at short, then took the lead on a Tolman wild pitch and a Ballesteros sacrifice fly.

But the Nationals didn't go down quietly. In the bottom of the inning, Daylen Lile crushed an RBI triple off the scoreboard in right, getting them back within a run. After Keibert Ruiz grounded out to a drawn-in Grissom, Jorbit Vivas singled to tie the game, and Jacob Young and Dylan Crews followed with RBI hits to put Washington back in front.

The Angels scored one run in the ninth off Jack Sinclair, but the Nationals held on for the win.

"Three pretty gritty wins," Young said. "Nothing was easy about them, and we found ways to do it, which is something we've been preaching for a while now."

NATIONALS ON DECK			
vs. Philadelphia Phillies			
Tuesday	6:45	Nationals	TV
Wednesday	6:45	Nationals	TV
at St. Louis Cardinals			
Friday	8:15	Nationals	TV
Saturday	7:15	Nationals	TV
Sunday	2:15	Nationals	TV

at Detroit Tigers			
Sept. 21	6:40	Nationals	TV
Sept. 22	6:40	Nationals	TV
Sept. 23	1:10	Nationals	TV
<i>Radio: WJFK (106.7 FM), WDCN (87.7 FM)</i>			

SCOREBOARD

COLLEGE FOOTBALL

NCAA

SATURDAY'S RESULTS EAST

Albany (N.Y.) 35, LIU Brooklyn 13	
California 21, Syracuse 18	
Delaware State 21, Bowie State 6	
Lafayette 15, Marist 9	
Lehigh 44, William & Mary 20	
Marshall 28, Middle Tennessee 26	
Marland 38, Connecticut 14	
Massachusetts 37, Sacred Heart 10	
Merrimack 23, Maine 14	
Morgan State 55, Lynchburg 0	
New Hampshire 42, Stonehill 35	
Pen State 62, Temple 9	
Pittsburgh 12, UC F 7	
Rhode Island 31, Elon 10	
South Florida 28, Army 24	
West Virginia 52, UT Martin 7	

SOUTH

Alabama 45, Kentucky 17	
Alabama A&M 30, Tennessee State 3	
Alcorn State 53, Arkansas-Pine Bluff 51 (2OT)	
Appalachian State 27, East Carolina 24	
Auburn 43, Southern Mississippi 9	
Austin Peay 63, Morehead State 7	
Bethune-Cookman 43, Stetson 18	
Bryant 31, Hampton 3	
Bucknell 14, VMI 3	
Charleston Southern 26, The Citadel 20	
Clemson 22, Georgia Southern 7	
Coastal Carolina 45, Fordham 7	
Dartmouth 28, Delaware 24	
Eastern Kentucky 22, Chattanooga 17	
FAU 38, Navy 30	
FU 33, Buffalo 20	
Florida 52, Campbell 3	
Furman 20, Mercer 13	
Georgia 70, Western Kentucky 20	
Georgia State 31, Kennesaw State 17	
James Madison 57, Wagner 3	
LSU 49, Louisiana Tech 14	
Liberty 24, Gardner-Webb 23	
MVU 31, Lincoln (Pa.) 20	
Mississippi 41, Charlotte 9	
Mississippi State 27, Valparaiso 18	
Nicholls 31, Texas-Rio Grande Valley Vaqueros 28	
North Carolina 35, ETSU 3	
North Carolina Central 30, North Carolina A&T 22	
North Carolina 49, Towson 9	
South Carolina State 66, Virginia State 0	
South Eastern Louisiana 30, Alabama 25	
Tarleton State 27, McNeese State 24	
Tennessee 49, Georgia Tech 24	
Troy 34, Alabama State 17	
Tulane 28, South Alabama 24	
UAB 26, Louisiana-Monroe 20	
Vanderbilt 35, Delaware 24	
Virginia Tech 44, Old Dominion 21	

MIDWEST

Akron 45, Robert Morris 10	
Ball State 41, Stony Brook 17	
Central Michigan 13, Colgate 10	
Cincinnati 62, Western Carolina 10	
Duke 21, Illinois 27	
Illinois State 28, Northern Illinois 24	
Indiana 55, Howard 17	
Iowa 16, Iowa State 23	
Kansas State 34, Washington State 7	
Kent State 36, Wofford 15	
Miami (Ohio) 45, Holy Cross 7	
Michigan 17, Oklahoma 10	
Michigan State 35, Eastern Michigan 7	
Mississippi State 38, Minnesota 13	
Missouri State 48, Lindenwood (Mo.) 14	
Nebbraska 36, Bowling Green 7	
Northern Iowa 56, Drake 14	
Notre Dame 52, Rice 0	
Ohio 29, Jacksonville State 27	
South Dakota State 57, New Haven 14	
South Dakota 41, Eastern Washington 23	
Toledo 63, CCSU 10	
Wake Forest 38, Purdue 36	
Western Michigan 49, Monmouth (N.J.) 14	
Wisconsin 36, Western Illinois 9	

SOUTHWEST

Arkansas State 52, West Georgia 7	
Baylor 44, Prairie View 3	
Houston 77, Southern 6	
North Texas 44, UNLV 14	
Oklahoma State 39, Oregon 31	
SMU 56, UC Davis 10	
63, Grambling State 7	
Texas 24, Ohio State 23	
Texas A&M 48, Arizona State 20	
Tulsa 23, Sam Houston State 17	
UTEP 51, Texas Southern 10	
UTSA 31, Texas State 26	
WEST	
BYU 28, Arizona 17	
Boise State 38, Memphis 20	
Colorado 52, Weber State 21	
Colorado State 34, Southern Utah 24	
Florida A&M 49, Sacramento State 3	
Hawaii 29, New Mexico State 19	
Iaho State 59, San Diego 17	
Lamar 23, Idaho 17	
Montana 35, Utah Tech 14	
Montana State 20, Nevada 7	
New Mexico 70, Mercyhurst 7	
North Dakota 47, Portland State 23	
North Dakota State 38, Air Force 52	
Northern Arizona 38, Incarnate Word 28	
San Jose State 30, Cal Poly 20	
Southern California 49, Louisiana-Lafayette 30	
Texas Tech 35, Oregon State 24	
UCLA 28, San Diego State 10	
Utah 43, Arkansas 10	
Washington 16, Utah State 14	
Wyoming 21, Northern Colorado 13	

No. 4 Texas 24, No. 1 Ohio State 23

Late Saturday

OHIO STATE	10	10	3	0	—	23
TEXAS	0	3	0	21	—	24
FIRST QUARTER						
OSU: FG Hawkins 26, 12:04.						
OSU: K Jackson 8 run (Hawkins kick), 5:39.						
SECOND QUARTER						
TEK: FG Spetic 37, 5:42.						
OSU: FG Hawkins 30, 1:41.						
OSU: Je Smith 19 pass from Sayin (Hawkins kick), :10.						
THIRD QUARTER						
OSU: FG Hawkins 48, 8:09.						
FOURTH QUARTER						
TEK: Wings 3 pass from Manning (Spetic kick), 14:19.						
TEK: Smothers 1 run (Spetic kick), 7:14.						
TEK: Smothers 1 run (Spetic kick), :25.						
Attendance: 105,044.						

Ohio State	19	25
First Downs.....	19	25
Total Net Yards.....	372	41-141
Rushes-Yards.....	31-94	44-147
Passing.....	278	195
Punt Returns.....	2-16	1-2
Punt Returns.....	3-9-0	2-2-5
Interceptions Ret.....	1-7	1-0
Comp-Att-Int.....	17-32-1	23-37-1
Sacked-Yards Lost.....	2-14	2-16
Punts.....	3-40-0	3-40-6-7
Fumbles-Lost.....	0-0	4-1
Penalties-Yards.....	4-35	2-12
Time Of Possession.....	28:32	31:28
PASSING		
Ohio State: Sayin 17-32-1-278.		
Texas: Manning 23-37-1-195.		
RUSHING		
Ohio State: Jackson 19-74, J.Jackson 5-20, West 2-7, Bey 1-0, Sayin 4-19, McKinn 1-5, Watkins 3-39, Coleman 3-35, Smothers 3-29, Shannon 1-4.		

No. 8 LSU 45, Louisiana Tech 14

Late Saturday

LOUISIANA TECH	0	7	0	7	—	14
LSU	10	0	14	21	—	45
FIRST QUARTER						
LSU: FG Starzyk 28, 6:36.						
LSU: Leavitt 5 run (Starzyk kick), 3:46.						
SECOND QUARTER						
LT: Jo McRae 100 interception return (Kent kick), 1:53.						
THIRD QUARTER						
LSU: FG Starzyk 25, 10:12.						
LSU: Leavitt 9 run (M.Thomas pass from Leavitt), 4:32.						
LSU: FG Starzyk 23, 2:12.						
FOURTH QUARTER						
LSU: FG Starzyk 5 run (Starzyk kick), 13:32.						
LSU: T.Green 10 pass from Leavitt (Starzyk kick), 9:39.						
LT: Mickens 67 pass from Baker (Kent kick), 8:08.						
LSU: Clark 7 run (Starzyk kick), 1:48.						
Attendance: 102,321.						

Louisiana Tech	8	26
First Downs.....	140	528
Rushes-Yards.....	31-3	44-147
Passing.....	143	381
Punt Returns.....	1-32	0-0
Kickoff Returns.....	1-32	0-0
Interceptions Ret.....	3-125	1-32
Comp-Att-Int.....	14-24-1	27-41-3
Sacked-Yards Lost.....	7-38	2-12
Punts.....	6-49-0	3-43-0
Fumbles-Lost.....	3-2	1-1
Penalties-Yards.....	5-50	10-101
Time Of Possession.....	25:51	34:09

PASSING		
Louisiana Tech: Baker 11-21-1-128.		
LSU: Leavitt 25-38-3-344.		
RUSHING		
Louisiana Tech: Burnette 6-16, Snider 8-2, Miller 6-3, Kukulak 4-2, Watkins 11-22, Gage 4-20, Clark 3-19, T.Green 2-7, Watkins 1-6, Wright 1-4, Berry 2-4, Wilson 1-1, Durham 1-(minus 2).		
RECEIVING		
Louisiana Tech: Mickens 6-101, Finley 2-15, Thiel 1-12, Shettlrow 1-6, Burnette 1-3, Calwise 1-3, Watkins 1-3, Baker 1-0.		
LSU: T.Green 6-104, Wilson 6-93, Watkins 5-43, J.Harris 3-80, D.Jones 3-14, Holloway 2-37, Gage 2-10.		

No. 9 Mississippi 41, Charlotte 9

Late Saturday

CHARLOTTE	0	0	6	3	—	9
MISSISSIPPI	7	20	0	14	—	41
FIRST QUARTER						
MISS: K.Lacy 9 run (Cameiro kick), 10:39.						
SECOND QUARTER						
MISS: Cook 14 pass from Chambliss (Cameiro kick), 13:55.						
MISS: K.Lacy 2 run (Cameiro kick), 8:39.						
MISS: FG Cameiro 57, 4:32.						
MISS: FG Cameiro 41, :00.						
THIRD QUARTER						
CHAR: FG Kelly 28, 10:23.						
CHAR: FG Kelly 24, 1:43.						
FOURTH QUARTER						
MISS: Fields 9 pass from Chambliss (Cameiro kick), 14:49.						
CHAR: FG Kelly 28, 9:53.						
MISS: Knight 7 run (Cameiro kick), 7:10.						
Attendance: 66,134.						

Charlotte	17	25
First Downs.....	322	24-127
Total Net Yards.....	33-143	24-127
Rushes-Yards.....	179	293
Passing.....	0-0	0-0
Punt Returns.....	0-0	1-26
Kickoff Returns.....	1-0	1-38
Interceptions Ret.....	20-28-1	27-34-1
Sacked-Yards Lost.....	1-1	1-1
Punts.....	4-39-25	2-48-5
Fumbles-Lost.....	0-0	0-0
Penalties-Yards.....	7-39	7-52
Time Of Possession.....	37:14	22:46

PASSING		
Charlotte: Gonzales 14-21-1-128.		
Harrell 5-6-0-50, J.White 1-1-0-1.		
Mississippi: Chambliss 23-26-0-225.		
Knight 4-8-1-68.		
RUSHING		
Charlotte: C.Williams 9-74, Pertee 5-33, Alexander 6-12, Rutledge 5-11, Cobb 2-8, Gonzales 5-6, Harrell 1-(minus 1).		
Mississippi: K.Lacy 13-87, Knight 4-27, Frazier 2-11, Lindsey 1-3, Chambliss 3-2, Cook 1-(minus 3).		

RECEIVING		
Charlotte: Barnes 4-17, Hampton 3-25, Pedro 3-7, Eley 2-56, Jeffares 2-27, Boston 2-12, Rutledge 2-7, Collick 1-22, C.Williams 1-6.		
Mississippi: Alexander 8-76, Cunningham 6-65, Fields 4-66, Ray 2-26, Cook 2-12, Hass 2-6, Alfred 1-34, Gill 1-9, K.Lacy 1-(minus 1).		

No. 13 Texas Tech 35, Oregon State 24

Late Saturday

TEXAS TECH	0	14	7	14	—	35
OREGON STATE	0	7	14	3	—	24
SECOND QUARTER						
TTU: Castellanos 7 run (Harrington kick), 7:35.						
ORST: Legree 75 pass from Atkinson (Ojeda kick), 7:25.						
TTU: Dickey 1 run (Harrington kick), 3:01.						
THIRD QUARTER						
ORST: Atkinson 4 pass from Newberry (run failed), 11:17.						
TTU: J.Williams 38 run (Harrington kick), 8:05.						
ORST: Legree 57 pass from Atkinson (Atkinson run), 4:55.						
FOURTH QUARTER						
ORST: FG Ojeda 34, 13:23.						
TTU: Eakin 32 pass from Hammond (Harrington kick), 6:31.						
TTU: Ludwig 8 pass from Castellanos (Harrington kick), 1:03.						
Attendance: 30,559.						

Texas Tech	22	20
First Downs.....	352	472
Total Net Yards.....	46-155	21-69
Rushes-Yards.....	21-9	0-0
Passing.....	2-19	0-0
Punt Returns.....	4-107	3-49
Kickoff Returns.....	1-1	0-0
Interceptions Ret.....	21-28-0	30-5-0



CRAIG HUDSON/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Trayon White Sr. (D-Ward 8) after the vote for his expulsion from the D.C. Council on Feb. 4, 2025. White reclaimed his seat months later.

Another reckoning for Trayon White Sr.

The D.C. Council member could be sentenced to years in prison if convicted of accepting a bribe from a government contractor

BY PAUL SCHWARTZMAN

In the decade he has spent on D.C.'s political stage, council member Trayon White Sr. (D-Ward 8) has faced a multitude of reckonings, whether on Election Day or because of an ill-advised statement or allegations of wrongdoing.

The reckoning White now faces could land him in prison and cost him his livelihood — the legislative seat he has held since 2016, representing more than 85,000 residents in Southeast Washington.

A federal trial is slated to begin this week that will determine whether the D.C. Council member, as prosecutors allege, took \$35,000 in cash bribes from a government contractor who has known White for years and was working as an FBI informant.

Now in his third term representing the city's poorest ward,

White, 42, has long styled himself as a protégé of the late D.C. mayor Marion Barry and is known more for showing up at crime scenes and community gatherings than for crafting legislation.

Prosecutors contend that White, in exchange for accepting the bribes, agreed to use his council office to lobby D.C. agencies to grant the government contractor additional work quelling violence in crime-addled neighborhoods.

White, who has denied the charge, won reelection after his well-publicized arrest two years ago, then captured a special election to reclaim his seat months later after the D.C. Council took the extraordinary step of voting 12-0 to expel him because of the allegations.

White returned to the council dais, though his influence was diminished. By then, Council Chair Phil Mendelson (D) had

removed him as chair of the Recreation, Libraries and Youth Affairs Committee, a punishment that left constituents in Ward 8 concerned that their council member's capacity to advocate on their behalf had been compromised.

"We have been without representation in local government, and, basically, the residents in the ward are suffering," said Stuart Anderson, a Democratic organizer in Southeast and White's former campaign manager. "Anybody who is in a position of having to fight a criminal case could not conceivably be doing their job."

White's trial evokes reminders of past D.C. corruption scandals and is sure to generate another round of unwelcome attention for a city already the focus of barbs from President Donald Trump and congressional Republicans

SEE TRAYON TRIAL ON C9

DHS hire defended Trump on citizenship

THEOLOGIAN IS A CONSERVATIVE VOICE

Catholic U. professor has criticized U.S. bishops

BY MICHELLE BOORSTEIN

The Department of Homeland Security has brought on as cultural outreach director a Catholic theologian who has criticized the U.S. Conference of Catholic Bishops for their defense of immigrant rights.

Chad Pecknold is a longtime theology professor at Catholic University who has drawn attention in recent years as a conservative commentator. Pecknold, like Vice President JD Vance, has worked to offer religious — specifically Catholic — arguments for President Donald Trump's policies on topics including immigration enforcement and the Iran war at a time when many U.S. bishops and Pope Leo XIV have been critical.

Pecknold did not respond to a request for comment about his appointment. The DHS media office released a brief statement from him saying he is "excited to confirm I've joined the Trump Administration as the Principal Director for Cultural Outreach at the Department of Homeland Security. It is truly an honor to serve my country in this capacity."

A university spokesperson wrote in a statement that its faculty members have served in various administrations. Pecknold will be on leave while at DHS, the statement said, "as is normally the case."

Pecknold is among the best-known U.S. Catholic figures in a conservative movement called "post-liberalism," which argues that the government should take a stronger role in promoting traditional morality and a shared national identity. He praised former Hungarian prime minister Viktor Orban, who while in office said he was defending Europe's White Christian identity from Muslim immigration.

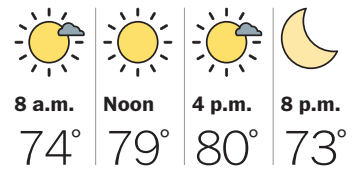
Vance, who like Pecknold converted to Catholicism, also has described himself as part of the post-liberal right.

Critics say post-liberalism has reactionary or authoritarian leanings. James Patterson, a political scientist at the University of Tennessee who has written about post-liberalism and Catholicism, said "there is a very big gap" between Pecknold's interpretation of Catholic teaching on immigration and the positions of Pope Leo and the U.S. Conference of Catholic Bishops, which is the organizing body of American bishops.

Patterson predicted that Pecknold will be "interpreting the stated position of the papacy as conservatively as possible" in his job at DHS, trying "to make the position of the administration look more consistent with the church line."

Because Pecknold teaches at SEE DHS ON C10

TODAY'S WEATHER



High today at approx. 3 p.m.: **81°**
Precip: **0%** Wind: **NNW 8-16 mph**

For weather news, go to **C16**

MARYLAND

Amazon's plans for an undersea cable is raising concerns in Ocean City. **c9**

VIRGINIA

Former CIA official with gold bars in home reaches a tentative plea deal. **c11**

OBITUARIES

Bruce Davis, a longtime film academy chief executive, was 83. **c11**

Police: Murder suspect said his hit man work was 'picking up'

The text message is at the heart of a twisting Montgomery County case

BY DAN MORSE

This much seemed clear: A man wearing a black face mask fired 21 gunshots that left his target dead in the broad daylight of a neighborhood parking lot.

What detectives couldn't figure out was what had brought the shooter there.

Then they arrested a suspect, according to court records, searched his phone and found text messages he allegedly wrote



DAN MORSE/THE WASHINGTON POST

Police say Jonah Mutua, 23, was killed by two bursts of automatic gunfire last year in the Fairfield area of Montgomery County.

about a new vocation. "This hit man s--- has been picking up," Douglas Lacey, 24, allegedly wrote in a group chat.

The words are now at the heart of a twisting, 18-month-long case unfolding in Montgomery County, Maryland. "Basically, you have a murder-for-hire here," prosecutor John Lalos said in court this month.

He pointed to other passages found in Lacey's phone that authorities believe evoked hit man work. "Tell me all the info on the target you got," an iPhone note read, "and I'll move up your slot." The same note, spelled out in court records, also described a pistol modified to fire like a machine gun and stated, "My demon got excited."

SEE FOR HIRE ON C10

MARYLAND

Amazon’s undersea cable project in Ocean City draws data center concerns

BY JOSH DAVIS
Baltimore Sun

Amazon says it is not building a data center or full-scale cable landing station in Worcester County. But the company is seeking approval for a smaller building near Ocean City Municipal Airport that would support a high-capacity undersea cable connecting Maryland to Ireland.

The proposal has raised concerns among residents who say the description understates the building’s role in a larger system and could allow Amazon to sidestep Worcester County’s moratorium on data centers and cable landing stations.

The cable, known as Fastnet, is an Amazon Web Services fiber-optic system planned to run between Maryland and Ireland. Amazon says the cable could be operational by 2028, carrying cloud-computing, artificial-intelligence and other digital traffic between North America and Europe.

Amazon says Fastnet would provide a backup route if other undersea cables fail or become congested, with capacity of more than 320 terabits per second — enough, the company says, to stream 12.5 million high-definition movies simultaneously.

The airport building would not store or process that information. Amazon says the proposed power-feed equipment building, smaller than 700 square feet, would send electricity through the cable to power repeaters that sustain the optical signal across the Atlantic. The signal would pass through to an existing AWS facility in the Greater Washington region.

A Worcester County Planning Commission hearing on a zoning amendment permitting international telecommunications cables and a power-feed building at the airport was scheduled for Sept. 3 but postponed. Amazon blamed travel conflicts and requested another date that has yet to be set by the planning commission.

“It’s important to us to be there in person to present our plans openly and answer the community’s questions directly,” a spokesperson said.

Amazon previously explored a roughly 25,000-square-foot cable landing station near Route 611 through Globalinx Data Centers. The spokesperson said that project is no longer being pursued.

“Amazon has no intention to build a CLS or a data center in Worcester County,” the spokesperson said.

Uzi Dvorkin, a Johns Hopkins power-systems professor, said PFE manages the grid connection for large electrical loads, while a data center houses computing and cooling equipment. He primarily associates cable landing sites with offshore-wind connections but cautioned, “CLS could be used in a different context as well — the one that I might not be familiar with.”

That distinction matters because Worcester adopted a 12-month moratorium in July covering data centers and cable landing stations.

The county’s ban does not specifically mention power-feed buildings.

The dispute comes amid a statewide wave of local restrictions. A Baltimore Sun review



PATRICK SMITH/GETTY IMAGES

A proposed building near Ocean City Municipal Airport would support a high-capacity fiber-optic cable connecting Maryland to Ireland.

found more than half of Maryland’s counties, along with Baltimore City, have adopted data-center moratoriums. Anne Arundel, Somerset and Talbot counties are considering restrictions. Wicomico County recently enacted a one-year pause, while Federalsburg approved a three-year moratorium.

The Assateague Maryland Coastal Community Coalition argues that treating the airport facility separately could create a loophole.

“This opposition is not anti-technology,” the coalition wrote. “It is opposition to project-specific zoning, piecemeal review, incomplete disclosure and the

gradual industrialization of the airport and Route 611 corridor.”

Ocean City resident Dana Nelson said officials should examine the entire cable system, not only the airport building.

“Why have a moratorium if the county itself and AWS is going to try and work around it?” Nelson said. “Environmental standards

shouldn’t depend on who owns the project.”

Amazon maintains that the airport building is routine telecommunications infrastructure, fundamentally different from either a data center or the landing station proposed by Globalinx. A new hearing date has not been announced.

Upcoming bribery trial for Trayon White Sr. evokes memories of past scandals

TRAYON TRIAL FROM CS

who have sought to encroach on its limited self-governance.

“We’re about to go through another round of negative headlines for Ward 8,” said Tom Donohue, an advisory neighborhood commissioner in Southeast. “It’s a lose-lose situation for the ward. We will gain nothing.”

White declined to comment on his case when a reporter approached him as he spoke to constituents during a recent Ward 8 community meeting hosted by Janeese Lewis George, a council member who is the Democratic nominee seeking to succeed Mayor Muriel E. Bowser (D).

In a recent Instagram video, White told his 87,500 followers that he feels “really good and encouraged about my trial” and that “I trust my legal team.”

“I’m in good spirits,” White said in the Sept. 1 video.

He also addressed his legal predicament in that video and in an earlier post, urging his constituents, a preponderance of whom are Black Washingtonians, to attend his trial and to answer jury summonses if they receive them to help him get a “fair shake.”

“We have to ensure I have a fair trial, so if you see letters in the mail, make sure you get those,” White said in a video posted to his Instagram account Aug. 19. “I want to thank you all for your love and support, I still need it. It’s not over with yet.”

Prosecutors objected to the videos, filing a motion asking U.S. District Judge Rudolph Contreras to admonish White for what they claimed was improperly seeking to sway potential jurors by making “disparaging” and “inflammatory” remarks in the lead-up to the trial. U.S. Attorney Jeanine Pirro requested that the judge order White to remove one post.

Although his defense team argued that the First Amendment protected his right to make his remarks, White last Tuesday removed the video he had posted Sept. 1. His Aug. 19 post, which included a similar plea to his constituents about answering the jury summonses and to attend the trial, remained on his Instagram page.

To win a conviction, prosecutors need to persuade all 12 jurors that the \$35,000 in cash payments made by Allieu Kamara, the contractor who was working as an FBI informant, constituted a bribe. Prosecutors allege that the payments were part of a broader agreement the two men reached in which Kamara would



U.S. DISTRICT COURT FOR THE DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA

Federal investigators say this photo shows White accepting an envelope containing \$5,000 on July 17, 2024.

pay White a total of \$156,000.

The indictment alleges that Kamara also paid White \$20,000 around 2020 in exchange for the council member’s promise to help the businessman reach a favorable settlement of his appeal to D.C. officials after a contract he had was terminated because he falsified background checks.

In a court filing, White’s legal team has asserted that the council member acknowledges accepting cash payments from Kamara on four different dates. In return for White’s admission, prosecutors agreed to not introduce evidence pertaining to the council member’s “gambling expenditures.” However, prosecutors also asserted that they could break the agreement if White “attempts to undercut” or question the claim that he took the money.

The strength of the prosecutors’ case rests in video recordings agents obtained of Kamara handing White envelopes pur-

portedly filled with cash during meetings the men had in the contractor’s car during the summer of 2024. Prosecutors also included in their 37 page complaint photos of text messages that White and Kamara exchanged.

“They have compelling evidence,” said Paul Butler, a Georgetown University law professor and former federal prosecutor who focused on corruption cases. “In a case with evidence like that, it’s not typically difficult to get a conviction.”

Yet the path to a conviction could be complicated by a number of factors, including that White’s attempts to pressure city agencies did not lead to contract extensions for Kamara’s nonprofit, Life Deeds. To prove bribery, prosecutors need to demonstrate that White, in exchange for the payments, intended to use his position to help Kamara.

White’s defense team is likely

to seek to damage Kamara’s credibility. The contractor, a former Army captain who has traveled with White, agreed to become a confidential informant as part of a plea bargain in which he admitted to bank fraud conspiracy and bribing another D.C. government official.

Butler said White’s defense team would probably seek to persuade the jurors to render a verdict in the council member’s favor “because they think the prosecution is unfair or they’re sympathetic to the accused” despite believing he is guilty. With prosecutors needing a unanimous verdict, White’s defense team needs only one dissenting juror to derail the prosecution.

That strategy, said Butler, worked for Barry when the mayor faced federal drug and perjury charges in 1990 after an FBI sting operation caught him on videotape smoking crack cocaine in a downtown Washington hotel.

The jury, which included 10 Black and two White members, convicted Barry of a misdemeanor count of cocaine possession but was deadlocked on a raft of other charges. The judge called a mistrial.

“There’s always a race dynamic but the city is quite different now, and it’s not nearly as pronounced as it was then,” Butler said. “The jury is likely to have way more White people on it.”

That said, Butler added: “We have a city where race and class and the criminal legal system is still a fraught combination, and that gives even more credence to the notion that you never know what a jury is going to do.”

Under federal sentencing guidelines, White would not be eligible for the maximum 15-year sentence if convicted, because he would be a first-time offender.

The prosecutors’ list of witnesses includes Kamara; Matthew Gano, the lead FBI agent on

the investigation; Lindsey Appiah, Bowser’s deputy mayor for public safety and justice; and Kwelli Sneed, director of the D.C. Office of Neighborhood Safety and Engagement, the city agency that managed the contracts obtained by Kamara’s nonprofit.

White’s defense team has listed as its potential character witnesses Wanda Lockridge, the council member’s former chief of staff; Charles Moreland, a former D.C. shadow representative; and the Rev. Donald Isaac, the pastor at a Ward 8 church.

Over the two years since White’s arrest, his allies have voiced skepticism about the U.S. attorney’s case against him.

“This was total entrapment,” said Jauhar Abraham, a longtime associate of White’s who plans to attend the trial. Referring to Kamara, he said, “The government sent this guy in because he was a friend, in a wired up truck, to embarrass the councilman. If 12 Washingtonians hear all the facts, I can’t believe that 12 people will believe the government’s case.”

White’s arrest in August 2024 was a stunning turn for a council member whose victory eight years earlier, over a Bowser-backed incumbent, inspired celebrations among those familiar with his hardscrabble background growing up poor in Southeast.

White’s current legal trouble is not the first time he has found himself the focus of unflattering attention. In 2018, two years after his election, he provoked international news coverage after posting a video on social media in which he expressed support for an antisemitic conspiracy theory that a Jewish banking family controls the weather.

White apologized for the video and won reelection in 2020. But he continued to draw scrutiny. The D.C. Office of Campaign Finance in 2024 fined him and his campaign treasurer \$20,000 for several infractions, including failing to submit reports and refund excessive contributions. The city’s ethics board earlier this year fined him for failing to file several financial disclosure statements.

Since his 2024 bribery arrest, the council member has existed in a legal limbo. His constituents — opponents and supporters, alike — are eager for the trial to begin.

“You want to see this situation resolved,” said Phil Pannell, a longtime organizer in Ward 8. “You never want to see your leaders with a cloud over their head.”



The Guide to Offers
The Washington Post

Enter for the chance to win a pair of tickets to the Little Shop of Horrors 40th Anniversary Screening, September 25

Celebrate the 40th anniversary of Little Shop of Horrors with a special screening hosted by Ellen Greene, the original Audrey. In this rare appearance, Greene who originated the role in the stage musical before starring in the beloved 1986 film adaptation will help commemorate the cult classic. Directed by Frank Oz, the science-fiction musical comedy follows Seymour Krelborn, a shy florist who discovers a bloodthirsty, man-eating plant named Audrey II.

See details at [washingtonpost.com/entertainment/events/lists/388](https://www.washingtonpost.com/entertainment/events/lists/388)



MARYLAND

Man who was restrained on flight diverted to BWI wouldn't 'de-escalate'

BY ALAINA MENCINGER
Arizona Daily Star

A Tucson man on an American Airlines flight was “angry” and “belligerent,” according to one of the passengers who helped restrain him with zip-tie cuffs and duct tape.

Layne Lundeen, 67, was charged Friday in Maryland on suspicion of second-degree assault and disorderly conduct during a flight from Dallas to Newark, according to court records. After Lundeen allegedly caused a commotion on the Sept. 3 flight, the flight was diverted to Baltimore, where he was arrested.

Richard O’Lenick, owner of New Jersey gun range Gun for Hire, was returning to New Jersey after a trade show in Reno, Nevada. About two hours into his flight between Dallas and Newark, O’Lenick heard a passenger raising his voice. He sounded angry and agitated, O’Lenick said.

O’Lenick, who was sitting a couple rows ahead of Lundeen, said he didn’t know what set off the brouhaha. But passengers heard the man using “vulgar” language, including racial slurs, and making homophobic comments, O’Lenick said.

Flight attendants tried for about 10 minutes to quiet Lundeen, O’Lenick said. But the situation escalated, he said.

A woman sitting in front of Lundeen saw the Tucson man put his hands on the throat of his seatmate, who O’Lenick said hadn’t been responding to Lundeen’s outbursts. The woman started hitting Lundeen, who O’Lenick said struck back.

That’s when O’Lenick and his sales manager, Juan Mejia, exited their row to intervene.

O’Lenick squeezed between Lundeen’s knees and the seat, and Mejia, a former police officer, sat

next to them. Lundeen bit Mejia and tried to bite O’Lenick as they tried to restrain him.

The bite didn’t break Mejia’s skin, but left an imprint, O’Lenick said.

Eventually, flight attendants gave O’Lenick and Mejia zip-tie restraints to secure Lundeen. O’Lenick said he was hoping that would calm the passenger, but he was “determined” to resist.

As he continued to struggle, O’Lenick said they used duct tape to keep him from trying to bite people.

O’Lenick said he and Mejia tried to calm Lundeen down throughout the encounter.

“But nothing seemed to work,” O’Lenick said. “We just couldn’t seem to get through to him.”

O’Lenick said he was happy they were able to prevent Lundeen from further hurting himself or others and peacefully hand him off to law enforcement.

“We did everything we could to be aware, and to be as kind as we could to this gentleman,” O’Lenick said. “It was an intense situation, and we were trying to do what we could to de-escalate.”

Their flight was scheduled to land around 11 p.m. But between the detour to Baltimore, and multiple plane cleanings — at some point in the fracas, O’Lenick said Lundeen’s arm was injured and blood got on the seats — they landed around 3 a.m.

“I was like, ‘Thank God we’re home,’” O’Lenick said.

Lundeen, a Tucson real estate broker, was released Thursday and has a trial set for Oct. 19 in Maryland. The FBI told Baltimore news station WMAR-2 that it was conducting interviews and weighing whether to file federal charges in connection with the incident.

Tucson-based Long Realty announced it was parting ways with Lundeen, an independent con-



JONATHAN NEWTON/THE WASHINGTON POST

Layne Lundeen was charged Friday on suspicion of second-degree assault and disorderly conduct during a flight from Dallas to Newark.

tractor for the brokerage. He has worked with Long Realty since 2013, according to the Arizona Department of Real Estate. His employment with the group was severed Saturday, department records show.

Lundeen could not be reached for comment.

According to records, Lundeen hasn’t had any disciplinary ac-

tions taken against him since he became a licensed real estate broker in the state in 2001.

According to a 2023 article by RISMedia, a real estate trade publication, Lundeen founded the Tanque Verde Trio, a real estate group, in 2014 with Laurie Hassey and Claire Durand. According to the article, the group sold more than 100 homes in the Tanque

Verde area in 2022.

Durand declined to comment on Lundeen’s charges. Hassey referred questions to Kevin Kaplan, chief executive of Long Companies.

Kaplan said that the roughly 1,000 agents contracting for Long Realty Co. may choose to team up for marketing and sales purposes, but agents working for two differ-

ent brokerages can’t work together. He said Long Realty had not heard from Lundeen since the incident, but the alleged incident did not align with company values.

“This was one individual who was involved in an incident, it is not at all representative of our company or other agents,” Kaplan said.

Text at center of Montgomery County murder case

FOR HIRE FROM CS

etectives know an asking price or even if money changed hands. They instead have built their cases through a web of cell tower data, GPS readings, license plate scanners, FaceTime screen shares and surveillance video. Both men are charged with first-degree murder.

Ahead of Lacey’s trial, which is set for next year, Anderson is seeking dismissal of the cell tower and GPS evidence. The actions of Montgomery County investigators, he asserted in recent court filings, hark back 250 years to British soldiers rummaging through Colonial homes in a way that “helped spark the revolution itself.”

In this modern-day case, detectives obtained warrants to compel cellphone carriers to turn over location data for all phones and electronic devices that were near the homicide around the time it occurred. That broad sweep, Anderson argued, invaded the privacy expectations of an untold number of people with zero connection to what happened.

A circuit court judge has yet to rule on the issue but told Anderson in court recently the warrants appeared valid. “You’re going to have to do a lot of arguing to get me off that point,” Judge J. Bradford McCullough said.

‘Jonah was gone’

It was a crisp Saturday morning in March 2025 when Jonah Mutua, 23, walked from his townhouse into the parking lot. He and his older brother, a physician, were about to help their parents move furniture into a rented U-Haul, according to police and neighborhood residents.

A masked gunman jumped from his car, police say, and fired two bursts of automatic gunfire. Mutua stumbled and tried to run, according to residents, and called for his dad before collapsing on the pavement.

Residents of the close-knit street — Fairdale Terrace in Montgomery’s Fairland area — heard the blasts from inside their homes. One, Rose Howe, said her EMT-trained son rushed outside. “He tried to perform CPR,” Howe said. “But Jonah was gone.”

As police converged, others described the gunman speeding away in a gray or blue Tesla with no license plates. Investigators took a standard first step: looking through the victim’s cellphone for communications portending trouble with someone. Nothing.

Farther from the scene, detectives found residential doorbell video showing a similar car pass by before and after the shooting. Those images, investigators asserted in court filings, offered clear details: chrome trim around



DAN MORSE/THE WASHINGTON POST

Mutua was “a great kid from an incredible family,” said Kevin Loudermill, a resident in a townhouse near where Mutua was shot.

tinted side windows and dark wheel rims with 10 spokes each.

It matched the description of a car used in a different shooting seven months earlier outside a swimming pool. But detectives still had no tag numbers or any idea who might have been inside.

Detective Charles Horwitz turned his attention to the investigative tactics — known as “tower dumps” and “area searches” — now being challenged by Lacey’s attorney. He obtained a search warrant and sent it to AT&T, Verizon and T-Mobile. The companies responded with a raft of data on electronic devices that were near the fatal shooting of Mutua — from 45 minutes before to 15 minutes after.

Exactly how many devices that were captured is unclear. Anderson said it was thousands.

Prosecutors said detectives set boundaries as small as practical with their goal being to use phone numbers and device markers as leads to possible suspects. Looking through the data — and comparing it with the same kind of data obtained earlier by a detective probing the shooting outside the swimming pool — police became convinced the same GPS tracking device had traveled through both crime scenes.

Horwitz tracked down the company that managed the data emitting from the GPS device and spoke with an employee. “We’re showing that on a 2020 Tesla Model 3,” the man said, according to Horwitz’s testimony at a recent hearing. The employee then provided the car’s Vehicle Identification Number and told Horwitz that he could give him records of the tracker’s exact movements after the detective sent a subpoena.

‘Got a lot to learn’

One week later — after detectives sifted through those and other records — a SWAT team arrested Lacey at his home in Prince George’s County. Under his

bed, authorities allege, investigators found a 9mm handgun. Outside in a parked gray Tesla, they found a second handgun and a rifle, according to court filings.

There is reason to believe Lacey didn’t know there was a GPS tracker attached to his car. As described in court records, a previous owner of the Tesla had the tracker installed under a three-year service plan that was never canceled.

When questioned by investigators, they assert, Lacey confirmed he was the Tesla’s sole driver. But when Horwitz told him about the tracker, Lacey, who listed gymnastic coach as his most recent job after his arrest, stopped talking and asked for a lawyer, according to court records.

Even with all the data and records they’d collected, investigators still could make no connection between Lacey and the victim. But Lacey’s arrest had produced a new clue: his cellphone.

And that was bad news, according to longtime defense attorneys not involved in the case, for the person who police now say ordered the killing. “If you hire someone to do this,” said one of them, David Moyse, “you’re only as good as the person you hire.”

The going rate in alleged hit man cases he has encountered, Moyse said, has struck him as surprisingly modest — \$5,000 or less. “Maybe it’s just that the expensive guys never get caught,” he said.

Inside Lacey’s phone, investigators say they found incoming texts asking if he’d reached Hollywood hit man status. “Naw not yet,” Lacey allegedly wrote back. “Got a lot to learn.”

Among screenshots saved on the phone, according to court records, investigators found images of a FaceTime chat 11 days before the murder. A person using “Keem’s iPhone” had shared a photograph of the victim, Mutua, and shared a map of Mutua’s neighborhood with a pin at his

townhouse, according to investigators.

In Lacey’s contacts, investigators scrolled to “Keem” and learned the corresponding phone number, according to their allegations filed in court. They say they linked that number to Keem’s real name: Bekine Ayele, who lived in nearby Burtonsville. Given what he had shared with Lacey over FaceTime, the investigators assert, they now suspected he was the person who had hired him to kill Mutua.

They pieced together past connections between Mutua and Ayele, according to court filings. The two, along with two others, had been involved in a 2022 drug-related robbery in Baltimore County, an incident that resulted in no jail time for any of them.

Also of great interest to detectives: Mutua appeared to still owe Ayele \$2,200, they said.

Another longtime Maryland defense attorney, William Brennan, said prosecutors in hit man cases differ on which party bears more responsibility. Some say the employee, reasoning that he was the last person who could have stopped the crime. Others say that person is merely a “mechanism” for the more culpable employer who set the killing in motion, Brennan said.

“I’ve seen it go both ways,” Brennan said.

Recognition, affection and sorrow

Among residents of Fairdale Terrace, where Mutua grew up and was gunned down, recognition of the wrong turns he took in recent years is outweighed by affection and sorrow.

“A great kid from an incredible family,” said Kevin Loudermill, a longtime resident in one of 18 townhouses sharing the same parking lot.

Speaking from his front step next to Howe, the neighbors recalled how often they saw Mutua sitting outside his door at night waiting for his mom to come home from nursing shifts so he could walk her in. For years, Mutua played drums at church services led by his dad, said Loudermill, who owns a moving company and is known as “Coach” on Fairdale Terrace for the time he spent teaching basketball and football to neighborhood kids.

More recently, Mutua had gotten a delivery job and spoke of wanting to pursue his commercial driver’s license, according to Loudermill, who asked him about moving from Maryland to put distance between himself and the people with whom he’d recently associated. “That kind of trouble doesn’t just go away,” Loudermill remembers telling him.

“Coach I’m going to be okay,” the young man responded.

DHS hire backs Trump on immigration policies

DHS FROM CS

Catholic University, which was founded by the U.S. bishops and is thus seen as “officially” aligned with the church, Patterson said, Pecknold’s new perch “is almost a counter balance to the pope.”

Like Vance, Pecknold was once a strong Trump critic. In 2016 he and other conservatives signed an “Appeal to Our Fellow Catholics” that said Trump was “unfit” for the presidency and that “his campaign has already driven our politics down to new levels of vulgarity. His appeals to racial and ethnic fears and prejudice are offensive to any genuinely Catholic sensibility.”

Another person who signed that document was Brian Burch, who is now serving as Trump’s ambassador to the Vatican.

The letter praised Trump for talking about the “breakdown in immigration law,” but said Catholics should support other candidates “who do not exhibit his vulgarity, oafishness, shocking ignorance, and — we do not hesitate to use the word — demagoguery.”

Pecknold has since become

more publicly aligned with the Trump administration, including on immigration. In a June 2025 letter, Catholic bishops and other clergy criticized Trump’s One Big Beautiful Bill budget legislation, saying it would fund “mass deportation” and separate families. Pecknold told the Catholic news agency EWTN that the signers were being partisan.

Earlier this year Pecknold again criticized the U.S. bishops, this time for their activism against Trump’s proposed ban on birthright citizenship. The bishops filed a brief in court against the ban, which would have denied citizenship to children born on U.S. soil without a U.S. citizen parent. The ban was struck down by the Supreme Court in June.

“Unrestricted and unconditional birthright citizenship might have been a prudential win when America was drawing on the deposit of Christian Europe in the early 20th century. But today we must rethink all those assumptions anew,” Pecknold wrote. “Why shouldn’t citizenship have something to do with the moral and religious particularities of our country?”

“Why shouldn’t citizenship have something to do with the moral and religious particularities of our country?”

Chad Pecknold, in a letter to the U.S. Conference of Catholic Bishops



PABLO MARTINEZ MONSIVAIS/AP

DHS hired Pecknold, who has worked to offer religious arguments for President Donald Trump’s immigration enforcement policies.

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The Washington Post

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MARYLAND

Baltimore County Council approves smoke shop restrictions

BY NATALIE JONES
Baltimore Sun

The Baltimore County Council on Tuesday unanimously approved a sweeping set of zoning restrictions on smoke shops in an effort to curb what some members describe as a proliferation of the retailers across the region.

Sponsored by Council Chair Mike Ertel and Council members David Marks and Izzy Patoka, the newly approved legislation defines what constitutes a smoke shop. It also implements restrictions on where they can operate and what kind of lighting displays they can use.

“It’s been a lot of give and take,” Marks (R) said at Tuesday’s council meeting. “I will stick with statements I said at the beginning of this process: That people want to see grocery stores, restaurants, specialty stores, not three or four smoke shops on their block.”

A wave of critical feedback from shop owners and lobbyists, however, spurred 13 different amendments to the bill aimed at

narrowing its scope and limiting impacts on retailers who sell tobacco as part of a larger business, like a convenience store.

“You don’t necessarily want to see a bill that has 13 amendments on it, but that’s often how the sausage gets made,” Ertel (D) said. “When you do good work, especially on something that has a lot of different angles to it, I think ultimately this will be good legislation, and hopefully target the players that we’re trying to target.”

Under the amended bill, businesses classified as smoke shops include stores that sell tobacco products, accessories or devices used to deliver nicotine and operate under state-issued tobacco or smoking-related licenses.

However, businesses that dedicate less than 30 percent of their total linear display area to tobacco products and electronic smoke devices are not smoke shops. Neither are vape shop vendors, hookah and vapor lounges, convenience stores and gas stations.

Councilman Todd Crandell, a Dundalk Republican, objected to

removing vape shops from the smoke shop definition.

“People want to see grocery stores, restaurants, specialty stores, not three or four smoke shops on their block.”

David Marks (R), one of three sponsors of legislation restricting where smoke shops can be located

“Even though they’re not selling rolled tobacco, they’re still selling tobacco,” he said. “I think that a lot of parents are concerned that kids get a hold of a vape pen and now they’re into nicotine, regardless of how some vape shops will work with their

customers to basically wean themselves off of nicotine over time.”

County code enforcement officials will be responsible for patrolling the display area limitations, said Pete Gutwald, director of the Department of Permits, Approvals and Inspections.

Smoke shops will be prohibited from operating within 1,000 feet of public or private grade schools, day cares, certain health facilities, recreation centers, parks and playgrounds, and other smoke shops.

Any smoke shops located within those bounds will be considered “nonconforming” as soon as the legislation goes into effect. Under a grandfathering provision, those standards will not apply for smoke shops that were operating at their current locations before Oct. 1, 2025.

While nonconforming shops will have a year-long grace period to come into compliance, another amendment creates a hardship extension for shops that are unable to comply with the restrictions, such as shops that cannot

end their leases.

However, smoke shops will be allowed in the business local zoning district, which allows small-scale commercial operations.

The bill imposes lighting restrictions, which bar the use of LED flashing lights, permanent illuminated tubing or string lights and revolving devices that project intermittent light flashes.

Smoke shops will also be required to sell at least one kind of nicotine replacement therapy product to curb smoking, which must be prominently displayed near other tobacco products.

Councilman Nino Mangione (R) disagreed with the requirement.

“I think these are probably great products, but I’m just simply against this mandating of what the shop owner has to have on their shelf,” he said.

The bill now goes to County Executive Kathy Klausmeier, who has 10 days to sign it, return it unsigned, or veto it. If she takes no action within that window, the bill becomes law automatically.

VIRGINIA

Former CIA official with gold bars reaches tentative plea deal

ASSOCIATED PRESS

A former CIA official found with \$40 million of gold bars in his home has reached a tentative plea agreement after being charged with theft for fraudulently inflating his salary, according to court records.

A federal judge on Friday extended a deadline to formally indict defendant David J. Rush

until Oct. 8, giving time for federal prosecutors and his attorney to finalize the plea deal and avoid a public trial that the parties said could involve significant litigation over classified material.

A joint court filing Thursday by the U.S. Attorney’s Office of the Eastern District of Virginia and Rush’s lawyer did not outline the details of the tentative plea deal. The U.S. attorney’s office de-

clined to comment Saturday, and Rush’s attorney did not immediately respond to a request for comment.

Rush was charged with theft of public money in May. He was accused of fraudulently claiming 744 hours of military leave on his timecards after he was honorably discharged from the Navy in 2015 and of inflating his salary by falsely claiming degrees from

Clemson University in South Carolina and Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute in New York, according to an FBI agent’s affidavit filed in court.

That same document also revealed that investigators searched Rush’s home and seized about 300 gold bars worth more than \$40 million, plus about \$2 million in U.S. currency and about 35 luxury watches.

The FBI affidavit said Rush had obtained the gold bars from the U.S. government for “work-related expenses.” Rush’s attorney has said the charge against him isn’t related to the gold bars, which she described as “a sensational tidbit.”

A Justice Department attorney said during a June court proceeding that Rush wasn’t supposed to have the gold bars at his home.

OBITUARIES

BRUCE DAVIS, 83

Served as film academy chief executive for more than 20 years

BY GLENN WHIPP
Los Angeles Times

Bruce Davis spent more than two decades as the motion picture academy’s chief executive. Even when he retired in 2011, it was not because he didn’t still love the work. In fact, he kept at it in retirement, retaining an office at the Pickford Center for Motion Picture Study where he focused on writing a definitive history of the early days of the Oscars.

“I don’t think I’ve been bored for a minute in 30 years here,” Mr. Davis told the Associated Press upon leaving the academy. “I feel like such a rube sometimes. To this day, when I get out of the car on Oscar night and step up there onto that carpet, you get that rush of energy. The lights are popping — not that anybody’s aiming at me — but still I think it’s one of the great rushes, emotionally speaking, that a person can have.”

Following a battle with leukemia, Mr. Davis died Sept. 5. He was 83.

Mr. Davis’s career at the academy was, according to wife Joann, partly a matter of being in the right place at the right time.

“Not that he wasn’t really good at what he did,” she says by phone. “But he was also a lucky man.”

Mr. Davis was working as chair of the theater department at Juniata College in Pennsylvania when he and Joann loaded all of their belongings atop their Mazda GLC and headed to Los Angeles in pursuit of Hollywood dreams. Davis had been working on a few screenplays while teaching, and his agent told him needed to move closer to the action to network and take meetings.

“Neither of us had jobs when we left Pennsylvania,” Joann says. “We just bit the bullet and drove out. It was a leap of faith.”

Shortly after arriving, Mr. Davis met someone at a party whose wife worked at the motion picture academy. That soon led to Mr. Davis taking a job arranging lectures and seminars and, later, overseeing the organization’s public programming.

Mr. Davis became the academy’s seventh executive director in 1989, leading it through a sizable expansion of staff, relocating the academy’s Margaret Herrick Library to the Beverly Hills Waterworks building in 1991 and setting up its film archive at the Pickford Center for Motion Picture Study in 2002.

“Bruce would drive back and forth to work and see that Waterworks building at the time that they were looking for places for the library to expand,” Joann says.



AMANDA EDWARDS/GETTY IMAGES

Executive Director Bruce Davis at an Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences dinner on Nov. 4, 2010, in Beverly Hills, California.

“And one day, it just occurred to him that maybe that would be a building, and so initiated conversation with Beverly Hills. It was kismet.”

Mr. Davis had hoped to build an academy museum next to the Pickford, persuading the group’s board of governors to purchase a nearby 3.5-acre site in 2006 for a reported \$50 million, but the 2008 recession derailed those plans. His successor, Dawn Hudson, led the push to partner with the Los Angeles County Museum of Art, eventually building the museum at the former May Co. building at Wilshire and Fairfax. It opened in 2021.

Mr. Davis was also instrumental in doubling the Oscars’ best picture category from five nominees to 10 in 2009, establishing the preferential ballot system that determines the academy’s top prize.

“That way, best picture reflects the choice of the greatest number of people,” Davis told The Times.

Mr. Davis’s Oscar book, “The Academy and the Award,” was published in 2022, long after he

“To this day, when I get out of the car on Oscar night and step up there onto that carpet, you get that rush of energy. The lights are popping — not that anybody’s aiming at me — but still I think it’s one of the great rushes, emotionally speaking, that a person can have.”

Bruce Davis, after retiring in 2011

originally anticipated it would hit stores.

“He thought a couple months of research, a couple more months to write it, and voila, in two years, he’d have it done,” Joann says. “But he kept finding new things he wanted to explore.”

Shortly before it published, Mr. Davis told the Los Angeles Times that he hoped the book would dispel myths surrounding the Oscars, including Susan Orlean’s assertion in her Rin Tin Tin biography that the dog received more votes than any male actor at the first Academy Awards and that Bette Davis gave the golden

statue its nickname because its backside mirrored that of her then-husband Harmon Oscar Nelson.

“There’s a lot of nonsense out there,” Mr. Davis said, “and the real story is almost always more interesting.”

“He was deeply committed to preserving the academy’s history, establishing dedicated homes for our library and film archive, and relaunching the concept of creating a museum,” current academy chief executive Bill Kramer and President Lynette Howell Taylor said in a statement. “He had a profound love for the academy.”

Mr. Davis loved to read and collect books, devouring anything from John Updike and Margaret Atwood, among other authors, a passion that necessitated having bookshelves in every room of his home. Language itself was an obsession, with many family dinners ending with Davis pulling out his unabridged Oxford English Dictionary to share the derivation of a word.

“He was a really fascinating guy,” Joann says.

Perhaps the only thing Mr. Davis didn’t like about the Oscars was the ceremony’s annual in memoriam segment, which pays tribute to those who died in the previous year.

“It is the single most troubling element of the Oscar show every year,” Davis told the Associated Press, “because more people die each year than can possibly be included in that segment.”

Next year’s ceremony now has one certain addition.

In addition to Joann, Davis is survived by four daughters: Brangien Davis, Alexandra Davis, Archer Davis and Roxanne Davis.

DEATH NOTICE

BURTON

RUTH ANNA BURTON (Age 92)
On Tuesday, September 1, 2026, of Silver Spring, MD. Beloved husband of Mack E. Burton, Sr., loving mother of Mack Edward Burton, Jr. and his wife Debbie Louise Burton; grandmother of Mack Edward Burton, III. Graveside Service and interment were held at Mountain View Cemetery, 1019 Valley Dr, Bristol, VA, on Thursday, September 10, 2026 at 12:00 PM.

LILLY

ARTHUR BRENT LILLY (Age 79)
Arthur Brent Lilly, lovingly known as Brent, passed away peacefully at his home in Manassas, Virginia, on September 4, 2026, at the age of 79.

A talented artist, master glider and frame maker, and musician, Brent had a deep appreciation for art, music, nature, animals, cars—especially Porsches—and the beauty of the world around him. He will be remembered for his gentle spirit, creativity, kindness, and love for his family and friends.

He is survived by his loving wife, Nancy Lilly, his mother, Ellen Robbins; his brother, Charles B. Robbins Sr. (Rose); his sister, Leigh Robbins (Ken); his daughter, Carina Marsala (Joey); his grandson, Johnny Lapore; his nephew, Charles B. Robbins (Manuela); his niece, Jessica Powell (Frederick); and his cherished great-nieces and great-nephews.

A Celebration of Life will be held Sunday, September 20, 2026, from 1:00 to 4:00 p.m. at National Funeral Home in Falls Church, Virginia.

LORENZ



BLAKE THOMAS LORENZ (Age 82)
Blake Thomas Lorenz, 82, of Anham, Maryland, a physicist and NASA engineer, died September 5, 2026, in Hershey, Pennsylvania. Born in Lima, Peru, he became a nationally recognized expert in space communications at NASA’s Goddard Space Flight Center and contributed to the first Space Shuttle mission. He studied physics at the University of California, Berkeley. A lifelong lover of music and choral singing, Blake performed at Carnegie Hall, the Kennedy Center, and served as vice president of the Prince George’s Philharmonic. He is survived by his partner, Gracie Wilson; children, Benjamin Lorenz and his wife, Ganesha Martin, and Laura Williams and her husband, Justin Williams; granddaughter, Chloe Lorenz; and many cousins and friends. The memorial service will be held at 12:00 p.m. on September 26, 2026, Unity by the Bay, 4 Pointless Forest Trail, Annapolis, Maryland. In lieu of flowers the family requests donations be made to the Prince George’s Philharmonic “In memory of Blake Lorenz.”

MEYER

CHARLES EDWARD MEYER
Charles Edward Meyer, age 90, of Fairfax, Virginia, passed away peacefully on September 11, 2026. Born on August 30, 1936 in Philadelphia, Pennsylvania.

Charlie was preceded in death by his wife, Kathleen Meyer (Siegmann) of 60 years, his father, John Meyer, his mother, Elsie Meyer (Heath), his brother, John (Jack) Meyer, III (Eileen), and his sister Elvira McKay (Joel). He is survived by his children Susan Barrett (John), Stephen Meyer (Ingrid Mohr) and Stacey Isidro (Hernando), as well as his grandchildren John Barrett, III (Nichole), Meghan Benson (Kyle), Karl Meyer (Kaitlin), Amelia Meyer, Nicolas Isidro and Thomas Isidro and his great grandchildren Jacob Benson, Hannah Benson, and Vivian Meyer.

Charlie graduated from Penn State in 1959 with a Bachelor’s degree in Mechanical Engineering, in college he joined the Army ROTC and was commissioned as a 2LT where he served for 20 years, retiring as a Lt. Colonel. As a mechanical engineer for over 40 years, he had an extraordinary career designing railway infrastructures all over the world, Philadelphia, Florida, Washington DC, Brazil and England, while with the Pennsylvania Railroad, Klauder Associates and LTK Engineering Services.

Charlie had a passion for trains, traveling, sudoku puzzles and loved music, especially ‘Jimmy Buffet’. He enjoyed being outdoors (especially the beach), with family and friends, and was a parishioner of Fairfax Presbyterian church and choir for many years!

Charlie, Dad, Pop Pop and friend will be dearly missed for his ability to bring the family together, his kindness and his devotion to those he loved.

A Celebration of Life will be held on Monday, September 21st at 1:00pm at Fairfax Presbyterian Church 10723 Main St., Fairfax, VA 22030. In lieu of flowers, the family requests that a tree be planted in his name or donations be made to The Alzheimer’s Association.

www.fmfh.com

PRICHARD



WALTER M. PRICHARD
Walter M. Prichard, 99 years, of Dickerson, Maryland, passed away peacefully on September 10th 2026.

Funeral services for family and close friends will be held Wednesday, September 16th 2026 at 10:30 am at the Boyds Presbyterian Church, 19901 White Ground Rd, Boyds, Maryland 20841. Burial will follow at the church. Arrangements are by Hilton Funeral Home.

All are welcome to join us for a Celebration of Life 12:30 pm -2:30 pm at The Comus Inn, 23900 Old Hundred Rd, Dickerson, Maryland 20842. To read the full obituary please visit www.hiltonfh.com.



MONDAY, SEPTEMBER 14, 2026

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Biz Ops/Services: 202-334-5787

Legal Notices

Department of Justice
Antitrust Division

Take notice that the United States has filed a proposed Final Judgment in a civil antitrust case in the United States District Court for the Southern District of New York, *United States of America v. KKR & Co. Inc., et al.*, Civil Action No. 1:25-cv-343-LTS. On January 14, 2025, the United States filed a Complaint alleging that KKR failed to make complete and accurate premerger filings at least sixteen separate times, violating Section 7A of the Clayton Act, 15 U.S.C. § 8a(1). The proposed Final Judgment, filed on August 26, 2026, requires KKR to pay a civil penalty in the amount of \$250,000,000 to the United States within thirty calendar days of entry of the Final Judgment. A Competitive Impact Statement filed by the United States on August 27, 2026, describes the Complaint, the proposed Final Judgment, and the remedies available to private litigants who may have been injured by the alleged violation.

Copies of the Complaint, proposed Final Judgment, and Competitive Impact Statement are available for inspection on the Antitrust Division's website at <http://www.justice.gov/atr> and at the Office of the Clerk of the United States District Court.

Interested persons may address comments in English to Danielle Hauck, Acting Chief Technology and Digital Platforms, Antitrust Division, Department of Justice, 450 Fifth Street NW, Suite 7100, Washington, DC 20530 (email address: ATR.Public-Comments-Turney-ACM@usdoj.gov) within 60 days of the first publication date of this notice. Such comments, including the name of the submitter and responses thereto will be posted on the Antitrust Division's website, filed with the Court, and, under certain circumstances, published in the Federal Register.

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Trustees Sale - DC

4616 HAYES STREET NORTH EAST, WASHINGTON DC 20019

In execution of the Superior Court for the District of Columbia Decree of Sale in Case: 2023-CAB-003618 the undersigned Trustee(s) will offer for sale the property known as 4616 HAYES STREET NORTH EAST, WASHINGTON DC 20019 at a public auction within the offices of, HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC. 5335 Wisconsin Avenue NW Suite 440, Washington, DC 20015 202-463-4567 On **OCTOBER 13, 2026 AT 11:00 A.M.**, the land and premises situated in the District of Columbia, and designated as and being Lot 0012 and in Square 5150 and more particularly described in the Deed of Trust recorded in the Land Records of the District of Columbia, on OCTOBER 25, 2013 as Instrument Number. 2013121826 property will be sold by Trustee's Deed "as is" without any covenant, expressed or implied, in Fee Simple, subject to conditions, restrictions, easements, and all other recorded instruments superior to the Deed of Trust referenced above, and subject to ratification by the Court

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of the lesser of \$30,000.00 or 10% of the sale price will be required at time of sale in cash or certified funds. The deposit required to bid at the auction is waived for the Noteholder and any of its successors or assigns. The Noteholder may bid up to the credit and may submit a written bid to the Trustee which shall be announced at sale. The balance of the purchase price is to be paid in cash within 30 days of final ratification of the sale by the Court.

TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE.

Trustees Sale - DC

5039 - 5043 A ST SE, WASHINGTON DC 20019

In execution of the Superior Court for the District of Columbia Decree of Sale in Case: 2024-CAB-000429 the undersigned Trustee(s) will offer for sale the property known as 5039 - 5043 A ST SE, WASHINGTON DC 20019 at a public auction within the offices of, HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC. 5335 Wisconsin Avenue NW Suite 440, Washington, DC 20015 202-463-4567 On **OCTOBER 13, 2026 AT 11:00 A.M.**, the land and premises situated in the District of Columbia, and designated as and being Lot 10, 11 & 12 and in Square 5327 and more particularly described in the Deed of Trust recorded in the Land Records of the District of Columbia, on SEPTEMBER 23, 2022 as Instrument Number: 2022097635 property will be sold by Trustee's Deed "as is" without any covenant, expressed or implied, in Fee Simple, subject to conditions, restrictions, easements, and all other recorded instruments superior to the Deed of Trust referenced above, and subject to ratification by the Court

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of the lesser of \$50,000.00 or 10% of the sale price will be required at time of sale in cash or certified funds. The deposit required to bid at the auction is waived for the Noteholder and any of its successors or assigns. The Noteholder may bid up to the credit and may submit a written bid to the Trustee which shall be announced at sale. The balance of the purchase price is to be paid in cash within 30 days of final ratification of the sale by the Court.

TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE.

Trustees Sale - DC

5618 EASTERN AVENUE NE, WASHINGTON DC 20011

In execution of the Superior Court for the District of Columbia Decree of Sale in Case: 2025-CAB-001789 the undersigned Trustee(s) will offer for sale the property known as 5618 EASTERN AVENUE NE, WASHINGTON DC 20011 at a public auction within the offices of, HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC. 5335 Wisconsin Avenue NW Suite 440, Washington, DC 20015 202-463-4567 On **September 29, 2026 AT 11:00 A.M.**, the land and premises situated in the District of Columbia, and designated as and being Lot 0096 and in Square 3744 and more particularly described in the Deed of Trust recorded in the Land Records of the District of Columbia, on SEPTEMBER 11, 2017 as Instrument Number: 2017100225 property will be sold by Trustee's Deed "as is" without any covenant, expressed or implied, in Fee Simple, subject to conditions, restrictions, easements, and all other recorded instruments superior to the Deed of Trust referenced above, and subject to ratification by the Court

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of the lesser of \$50,000.00 or 10% of the sale price will be required at time of sale in cash or certified funds. The deposit required to bid at the auction is waived for the Noteholder and any of its successors or assigns. The Noteholder may bid up to the credit and may submit a written bid to the Trustee which shall be announced at sale. The balance of the purchase price is to be paid in cash within 30 days of final ratification of the sale by the Court.

TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE.

Trustees Sale - DC

Brock and Scott, PLLC
5431 Oleander Drive
Wilmington NC, 28403

In execution of the Superior Court for the District of Columbia Decree of Sale in Case: 2025-CAB-006038 the undersigned Trustee(s) will offer for sale the property known as **2215 Hunter Place SE, #303, Washington, DC 20020** at public auction within the offices of, HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC. 5335 Wisconsin Avenue NW Suite 440, Washington, DC 20015 202-463-4567 On **SEPTEMBER 22, 2026 AT 11:30 AM**, the land and premises situated in the District of Columbia, and designated as and being 2006001865 in BOOK 5812 AND SQUARE 2023, and more particularly described in the Deed of Trust recorded in the Land Records of the District of Columbia, on DECEMBER 30, 2005 as Instrument Number 2006001865.

The property will be sold by Trustee's Deed "as is" without any covenant, expressed or implied, in Fee Simple, subject to conditions, restrictions, easements, and all other recorded instruments superior to the Deed of Trust referenced above, and subject to ratification by the Court

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of the lesser of \$19,000.00 or 10% of the sale price will be required at time of sale in certified check or a cashier's check. The deposit required to bid at the auction is waived for the Noteholder and any of its successors or assigns. The Noteholder may bid up to the credit and may submit a written bid to the Trustee which shall be announced at sale. The balance of the purchase price is to be paid in cash within 30 days of final ratification of the sale by the Court.

TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE.

Public Information Meeting

ROUTE 234 AND SUDLEY MANOR DRIVE INTERCHANGE PROJECT
VDOT UPCI 128159
State Project Number: 666-076-381

Wednesday, October 7th, 2026
6:00 p.m. - 8:00 p.m.
Freedom Aquatic & Fitness Center, Community Room
9100 Freedom Center Boulevard
Manassas, VA 20110

The Prince William County Department of Transportation and Capital Construction (PWC DTC) will conduct a Public Information Meeting for Route 234 and Sudley Manor Drive Interchange project at the Freedom Aquatic & Fitness Center, Community Room, 9100 Freedom Center Blvd, Manassas, VA 20110, from 6:00 p.m. to 8:00 p.m. on Wednesday, October 7, 2026. Prince William County representatives and County consultant design staff will be present to discuss the project and answer questions.

The Route 234 and Sudley Manor Drive Interchange Project includes proposed improvements to Route 234 and the surrounding roadway network near Sudley Manor Drive, Wellington Road, and Bethlehem Road. The project will include new sidewalks, shared-use paths, and stopping at either location. A new roadway and bridge will be constructed over Route 234 to provide a grade-separated connection between Sudley Manor Drive and Wellington Road. This connection will allow cross traffic to travel between areas on both sides of Route 234 without directly intersecting traffic. The project will also include roadway and median improvements throughout the project area. Pedestrian and bicycle accommodation is an integral part of the project and will include new sidewalks, shared-use paths, and improve connections between nearby roadways and destinations. Together, these improvements are intended to improve traffic delays, improve roadway connectivity, enhance traffic control devices, and provide more accessible travel for motorists, pedestrians, and bicyclists.

The public can review current project information, at: <https://www.pwcva.gov/department/transportation/current-road-projects>

Information regarding right-of-way acquisition and relocation assistance, if applicable, will be available for review at the Public Information Meeting.

Provide your written comments at the Public Information Meeting or submit them by October 22, 2026 to Mr. Gary L. Project Manager, Prince William County Department of Transportation, 5 County Centerplex Court, Suite 290, Prince William, VA 22192. You may also email your comments to Glen.Gilgus@pwcva.gov. Comments regarding Route 234 and Sudley Manor Drive Interchange Project" in the subject heading.

Prince William County ensures nondiscrimination and equal employment in all programs and activities in accordance with Title VI and Title VII of the Civil Rights Act of 1964. For more information, call 703-792-4228 or TDD 703-792-5223.

Accessibility to Persons with Disabilities: This Public Information Meeting is being held at a public facility accessible to persons with disabilities. If you need more information or special assistance for persons with disabilities or limited English proficiency, contact Mr. Gary Project Manager, Prince William County Department of Transportation, 5 County Centerplex Court, Suite 290, Prince William, VA 22192. You may also email your comments to Glen.Gilgus@pwcva.gov. Comments regarding Route 234 and Sudley Manor Drive Interchange Project" in the subject heading.

Cars

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Legal Notices

Department of Justice
Antitrust Division

Take notice that the United States has filed a proposed Final Judgment in a civil antitrust case in the United States District Court for the Western District of Virginia, *United States of America, et al. v. CRH PLC, et al.*, Civil Action No. 2:26-cv-03012. On August 7, 2026, the United States filed a Complaint alleging that CRH PLC, et al. ("CRH") proposed acquisition of Standard Construction Group ("Standard") would violate Section 7 of the Clayton Act, 15 U.S.C. § 8. The proposed Final Judgment, filed on August 26, 2026, requires CRH to pay a civil penalty in the amount of \$250,000,000 to the United States within thirty calendar days of entry of the Final Judgment. A Competitive Impact Statement filed by the United States on August 7, 2026, describes the Complaint, the proposed Final Judgment, and the remedies available to private litigants who may have been injured by the alleged violation.

Copies of the Complaint, proposed Final Judgment, and Competitive Impact Statement are available for inspection on the Antitrust Division's website at <http://www.justice.gov/atr> and at the Office of the Clerk of the United States District Court named above.

Interested persons may address comments in English to Acting Chief Sounding Choe, Defense, Industrials, and Aerospace Section, Antitrust Division, Department of Justice, 450 Fifth Street NW, Suite 6700, Washington, DC 20530 (email address: ATR.Public-Comments-Turney-ACM@usdoj.gov) within 60 days of the first publication date of this notice. Such comments, including the name of the submitter, and responses thereto will be posted to the Antitrust Division's website, filed with the Court, and, under certain circumstances, published in the Federal Register.

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Department of Justice
Antitrust Division

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Montgomery County

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND

ANDREW J. BRENNER, et al.
6001 Executive Blvd, Suite 200
Rockville, MD 20852
Substitute Trustees/Plaintiffs,

VS.

SHERI K. GAGE
FREDERICK A. GAGE
11104 Lund Place
Kensington, MD 20895
Defendants(s).

Case No. C-15-CV-25-006282

NOTICE

Notice is hereby given this 8th day of September, 2026, by the Circuit Court of Montgomery County, Maryland, that the sale of the property mentioned in this proceedings and described as 11104 Lund Place, Kensington, MD 20895 made and reported by the Substitute Trustee, will be RATIFIED AND CONFIRMED, unless cause to the contrary thereof be shown on or before the 8th day of October, 2026, provided a copy of this notice be inserted in said county once in each of three successive weeks before the 8th day of October, 2026. The report states the purchase price at the foreclosure sale to be \$450,000.00.

KAREN A. BUSHELL
CLERK OF THE CIRCUIT COURT
MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND

Sep 14,21,28, Oct 5, 2026 0012525403

Montgomery County

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND

DIANA THEOLOGOU, ET. AL.
Substitute Trustees
Plaintiffs

VS.

ILIANA T. CASTILLA
Defendant(s).

Case No. C-15-CV-24-005348

NOTICE

ORDERED this 8th day of September, 2026, by the Circuit Court for Montgomery County, Maryland, that the sale of the property mentioned in this proceedings and described as 10017 Ridgeline Dr., Montgomery Village, MD 20886 mentioned in these proceedings, made and reported by DIANA C. Theologou, et al., Substitute Trustee, be ratified and confirmed, unless cause to the contrary thereof be shown on or before the 24th day of September, 2026, provided a copy of this notice be inserted in said county once in each of three successive weeks before the 24th day of September, 2026. The Report of Sale states the amount of sale to be \$735,000.00.

Mahasin El Amin
Clerk Circuit Court for
PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY

Sep 14,21,28, Oct 5, 2026 0012525416

Prince Georges County

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MARYLAND

SYDNEY E. ROBERSON
Substitute Trustee
Plaintiff

VS.

OLIVIA TAYLOR PULLER
Defendant

Civil No. C-16-CV-23-003916

NOTICE OF SALE

12120 Chip Shot Lane,
Upper Marlboro, MD 20772

Notice is hereby issued by the Circuit Court of PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, this 24th day of August, 2026, that the sale of the property mentioned in these proceedings, made and reported by John C. Hanrahan, Substitute Trustee BE RATIFIED AND CONFIRMED, unless cause to the contrary thereof be shown on or before the 30th day of September, 2026, provided a copy of this Notice be inserted in some newspaper published in PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, once in each of three successive weeks before the 24th day of September, 2026. The Report of Sale states the amount of sale to be \$735,000.00.

Mahasin El Amin
Clerk Circuit Court for
PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY

Sep 14,21,28, Oct 5, 2026 0012525416

Anne Arundel County

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY

Brennan Ferguson, et al
Substitute Trustees

Versus

Michael B Stafford, et al
Defendant

No. C-02-CV-25-000555

NOTICE

Notice is hereby issued this Monday, August 31, 2026 that the sale of the property in the proceedings mentioned, made and reported by John C. Hanrahan, Substitute Trustee BE RATIFIED AND CONFIRMED, unless cause to the contrary thereof be shown on or before the 30th day of September 2026 next, provided, a copy of this Notice be inserted in some newspaper published in Anne Arundel County, once in each of three successive weeks before the 30th day of September 2026 next. The report states that the amount of sale of the property at 1514 MARLBOROUGH COURT, CROFTON, MD 21114 to be \$204,000.00.

Scott A. Poyer
Circuit Court for
Anne Arundel County, MD.

Sep 7,14,21, 2026 0012525416

Anne Arundel County

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY

Brennan Ferguson, et al
Substitute Trustees

Versus

Donald I Puller Jr., A/K/A Donald Puller, Jr., et al
Defendant

No. C-02-CV-23-002186

NOTICE

Notice is hereby issued this Monday, August 31, 2026 that the sale of the property in the proceedings mentioned, made and reported by John C. Hanrahan, Substitute Trustee BE RATIFIED AND CONFIRMED, unless cause to the contrary thereof be shown on or before the 30th day of September 2026 next, provided, a copy of this Notice be inserted in some newspaper published in Anne Arundel County, once in each of three successive weeks before the 30th day of September 2026 next. The report states that the amount of sale of the property at 94 PINE RD, PASADENA, MARYLAND 21122 to be \$204,000.00.

Scott A. Poyer
Circuit Court for
Anne Arundel County, MD.

Sep 7,14,21, 2026 0012525429

Frederick County

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR FREDERICK COUNTY, MARYLAND

100 West Patrick Street
Frederick, Maryland 21701
Clerk of the Court: 301-600-1976
Assignment Office: 301-600-2015

Case Number: C-10-CV-25-000673
Other Reference Numbers:

ANDREW BRENNER

VS.

JERAMY STROUTH, ET AL.

Date: 09/09/2026

NOTICE OF SALE

Notice is hereby issued by the Circuit Court for Frederick County, Maryland, this 9th day of September, 2026, that the sale made and reported by Philip Shriver for the sale of the property described in these proceedings

11639 South Baugher Road,
Thurmont, MD 21788

be ratified and confirmed thirty (30) days from the date of this Notice, unless cause to the contrary be shown, provided a copy of this Notice be inserted in some Newspaper published in this County, once in each of three (3) successive weeks. The report states the amount of sale to be \$472,500.00.

AND Together with all improvements and appurtenances thereto belonging, and subject to easements, restrictive covenants, restrictions and rights of way of record, Tax ID: 29136100 (031.03-03-13).

TERMS OF SALE: A bidder's deposit of \$14,000.00 or 10% of the sale price, whichever is lower, will be required in the form of a certified or cashier's check. Cash will not be accepted as a deposit. Settlement within fifteen (15) days of sale, otherwise Trustee may forfeit deposit. FINCEN reporting will be required of all successful purchasers, absent a lawful exemption. Additional terms to be announced at sale. This is a communication from a debt collector. This notice is an attempt to collect on a debt and any information obtained will be used for that purpose. (Trustee # Z-009837)

Substitute Trustee: ALG Trust-ee, LLC C/O Orland Law Group PLLC, PO Box 2548, Leesburg, VA 20177 (703) 777-7011 website: www.Orland.com

Sep 7,14,21, 2026 0012524809

City of Alexandria

TRUSTEE'S SALE OF 1450 North Galliard Street, Alexandria, VA 22304

In execution of a Deed of Trust in the original principal amount of \$500,000.00 dated March 24, 2025 recorded among the land records of the Circuit Court of City of Alexandria, 520 King Alexander, VA 22314 on October 19, 2026 at 09:30 AM the property described in said deed of trust, located at the above address and briefly described as: Lot 1, Subdivision of Parcel "E", Section 4, Vandevoorde, in same appears duly dedicated, planted and recorded in the land records of the City of Alexandria, Virginia in Deed Book 658 as Page 40 collect and

LESS AND EXCEPT that portion conveyed to the City of Alexandria in Deed Book 834 at Page 404 among the aforesaid land records.

AND Together with all improvements and appurtenances thereto belonging, and subject to easements, restrictive covenants, restrictions and rights of way of record, Tax ID: 29136100 (031.03-03-13).

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Sep 7,14,21, 2026 0012524809

Montgomery County

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND

DIANA THEOLOGOU, ET. AL.
Substitute Trustees
Plaintiffs

VS.

ILIANA T. CASTILLA
Defendant(s).

Case No. C-15-CV-24-005348

NOTICE

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Mahasin El Amin
Clerk Circuit Court for
PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY

Sep 14,21,28, Oct 5, 2026 0012525416

Anne Arundel County

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY

Brennan Ferguson, et al
Substitute Trustees

Versus

Michael B Stafford, et al
Defendant

No. C-02-CV-25-000555

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Scott A. Poyer
Circuit Court for
Anne Arundel County, MD.

Sep 7,14,21, 2026 0012525416

Frederick County

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR FREDERICK COUNTY, MARYLAND

100 West Patrick Street
Frederick, Maryland 21701
Clerk of the Court: 301-600-1976
Assignment Office: 301-600-2015

Case Number: C-10-CV-25-000673
Other Reference Numbers:

ANDREW BRENNER

VS.

JERAMY STROUTH, ET AL.

Date: 09/09/2026

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Antitrust Division

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Montgomery County

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND

ANDREW J. BRENNER, et al.
6001 Executive Blvd, Suite 200
Rockville, MD 20852
Substitute Trustees/Plaintiffs,

VS.

SHERI K. GAGE
FREDERICK A. GAGE
11104 Lund Place
Kensington, MD 20895
Defendants(s).

Case No. C-15-CV-25-006282

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CLERK OF THE CIRCUIT COURT
MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND

Sep 14,21,28, Oct 5, 2026 0012525403

Montgomery County

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND

DIANA THEOLOGOU, ET. AL.
Substitute Trustees
Plaintiffs

VS.

ILIANA T. CASTILLA
Defendant(s).

Case No. C-15-CV-24-005348

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Mahasin El Amin
Clerk Circuit Court for
PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY

Sep 14

MONDAY, SEPTEMBER 14, 2026

EZ

Trustees Sale - DC

**Alderman, Devorsetz & Hora PLLC5637
1025 Connecticut Avenue, NW
Suite 615
Washington, DC 20036
Phone (202) 969-8220
www.adlawfirm.com**

CONDOMINIUM ASSOCIATION'S SALE OF VALUABLE CONDOMINIUM UNIT NUMBER 201 (SQUARE 5673, LOT 2106) CONTAINED WITHIN PREMISES OF 2105 Fort Davis Street, SE, Washington, DC 20020. Pursuant to the District of Columbia Condominium Act of 1976, Section 313 as well as the Declaration and Bylaws of Fairfax Village Condominium VI Association, Inc., which may also be known as the Council of Co-owners of Fairfax Village Condominium VI, as amended, and in accordance with Public Law 90-566 and 42 D.C. Code Section 1903.13 as amended, notice was filed on August 20, 2026 and at the request of the Attorney for the Unit Owners' Association, we shall sell at public auction on **September 23, 2026 at 12:17 pm at the office of Alex Cooper Auctioneers, Inc. at 4910 MASSACHUSETTS AVENUE, NW, SUITE 100, WASHINGTON, DC 20016**, the following described premises situated in the District of Columbia and designated as:

Part of Lot Fifteen (15) in Square numbered Five Thousand Six Hundred Seventy Three (5673) in subdivision made by Fairfax Village Extension, Incorporated, as per plat recorded in the Office of the Surveyor for the District of Columbia in Liber 113, folio 41, being more particularly described as Condominium Unit No. 2105-201 in the Third Amendment to Fairfax Village Condominium VI; percentage share Interest .64, according to the Declaration of Condominium recorded July 29, 1976 as Instrument No. 20042 as amended by Instrument recorded January 21, 1977 as Instrument No. 2133 among the Land Records of the District of Columbia, and as per plat of Condominium Subdivision recorded in Condominium Book 20 Page 8 of the Office of the Surveyor for the District of Columbia.

Note: At the date hereof the above described land is designated on the Records of the Assessor for the District of Columbia for assessment and taxation purposes as Lot numbered 2106 in Square numbered 5673.

SUBJECT TO Provisions of the Declaration of Condominium recorded July 29, 1976, as Instrument No. 20042 as amended among the Land Records of the District of Columbia and rights of others entitled thereto in and to the joint use of the common elements as defined in the Declaration referred to above, restrictions, conditions, provisions and maintenance payments and assessments as provided in the Declaration referred to above.

TERMS OF SALE: Sold subject to real estate taxes and shall also be subject to any other superior liens, encumbrances, and municipal assessments, if any, the further particulars of which may be announced at time of sale. Pursuant to DC Code Section 42-1903.13(c)(4)(B), the Notice of Foreclosure Sale of Condominium Unit for Assessments Due ("Notice") must indicate (and thus indicate) whether the foreclosure sale is for a 6-month priority lien and not subject to a deed of trust, or for more than the 6-month priority lien, but subject to a deed of trust. With respect to the Notice related to this foreclosure sale, more than 6 months has been selected on the Notice, subject to a deed of trust, because the statute requires a selection of one of those two choices (either for a 6-month priority lien and not subject to a deed of trust, or for more than the 6-month priority lien, but subject to a deed of trust). There does not appear to be a deed of trust to which this condominium lien foreclosure is subject, however.

A deposit of \$10,000.00 will be required at time of sale, such deposit to be in certified check. All conveyances, recording, recodation tax, transfer tax, etc. at purchaser's cost. All adjustments made as of date of sale. The balance of the purchase price, together with interest at the rate of 10% per annum from date of sale to date of receipt of the balance of the purchase price, must be paid in cash or by cashier's or certified check and all other terms to be complied with within 30 days, otherwise deposit is forfeited and the property may be re-advertised and resold at the discretion of the Unit Owners' Association and at the risk and cost of the defaulting purchaser. Association shall convey a deed pursuant to 42 D.C. Code Section 1903.13, as amended, and makes no further representations or warranties as to title. The Association cannot guarantee clear title or the purchaser's ability to obtain Title Insurance. For this reason, the purchaser may not be able to obtain financing and therefore must be able to pay the purchase balance in any case within 30 days. In the event of failure on the part of the Association to convey such deed purchaser's sole remedy shall be return of deposit. Contact: T. Cary Devorsetz at (202)-969-8220, attorney for Fairfax Village Condominium VI Association, Inc.

ALEX COOPER
auctioneers
4910 Massachusetts Avenue, N.W. • Suite 100
Washington, DC 20016 • 202.364.0306
www.alexcooper.com

Sep 14, 18, 22, 2026 0012525813

Fairfax County

TRUSTEE'S SALE
Real property
12929 Goyne Pointe Road,
Apt. C,
Fairfax, VA 22033

In execution of a Commercial Deed of Trust in the principal amount of \$750,000.00 dated December 27, 2002 and recorded on January 02, 2005 in the land records of Fairfax County, Virginia at Instrument Number 200500246.001, Default having been made in the said debt, the undersigned Substituted Trustee will offer for sale at public auction at the front entrance to the Fairfax County Circuit Court, 4110 Chain Bridge Road, Fairfax, VA 22030, the above referenced property and fixtures or improvements thereon, together with the interest therein briefly described as Parcel ID No. 045-2-08-2929C, and Condominium Unit Number 12929C, Phase Nine (9), GRAY'S POINT.

September 22, 2026 at 12:45 PM

TERMS OF SALE: The property will be sold "AS IS" WITHOUT REPRESENTATION OR WARRANTY OF ANY KIND AND WITHOUT ANY environmental or other conditions, covenants, restrictions, reservations, easements, rights of way, prior liens, and all other matters of record, taking priority over the Deed of Trust. If any Substituted Trustee shall have no obligation to return possession of the property or any other obligation as to the premises.

A bidder's deposit of \$75,000.00 or 10% of the sale price, whichever is lower, will be required at the time of sale in the form of a certified check or cashier's check from the purchaser or the bid will be rejected. Successful bidder will be required to sign a memorandum of sale at the time of the sale and settle by remitting the balance of the purchase price within fourteen (14) days of sale. If the buyer wishes to use their own settlement company and documentation, there will be a fee of \$300.00 for review of their settlement documents. In the event of default by the successful bidder, the entire deposit shall be forfeited and applied to the costs and expenses of sale and Substituted Trustee's fee according to the Code of Virginia.

All other public charges or assessments, including water, sewer, charges to be prorated through date of sale; those incurred after the date of sale and all other costs incident to settlement to be paid by the purchaser. In the event taxes, any other public charges have been advanced, a credit will be due to the seller, to be adjusted from the date of sale at the time of settlement. Sale is subject to post sale confirmation that the borrower did not file for protection under the U.S. Bankruptcy Code prior to the sale as well as to post-sale confirmation of the status of the commercial loan with the loan servicer and that not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into any repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the commercial loan prior to the sale or whether other legal impediment to title exists, in any such event, the sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Additional terms may be announced at the time of sale.

FOR INFORMATION CONTACT: Cohn Goldberg, Debra L. Goldberg, 296-2250 or www.cdg-law.com, or C.D. 465702. Cohn Goldberg Debra L. Goldberg is a debt collector; any information obtained will be used for that purpose.

BLUE RIDGE TRUSTEES LLC
Sep 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 2026 0012525786

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Trustees Sale - DC

**Brock and Scott, PLLC
5431 Oleander Drive
Wilmington NC, 28403**

Trustees Sale - DC

In execution of the Superior Court for the District of Columbia Decree of Sale, CASE NUMBER 2017-CA-003179-RRP, the undersigned Trustee(s) will offer for sale the property known as **123 Peabody Street, NW, Washington, DC 20011** at public auction within the offices of, HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC., 5335 Wisconsin Avenue NW Suite 440, Washington, DC 20015 202-463-4567 on **SEPTEMBER 22, 2026 at 11:30 AM**, the land and premises situated in the District of Columbia, and designated as and being in **SQUARE 3376 AND LOT 0028**, and more particularly described in the Deed of Trust recorded in the Land Records of the District of Columbia, on APRIL 10, 2007 as Instrument Number 2007049437.

The property will be sold by Trustee's Deed "as is" without any covenant, expressed or implied, in Fee Simple, subject to conditions, restrictions, easements, and all other recorded instruments superior to the Deed of Trust referenced above, and subject to ratification by the Court

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of the lesser of \$ 500.00 or 0.5% of the sale price will be required at time of sale in certified check or a cashier's check. The deposit required to bid at the auction is waived for the Noteholder and any of its successors or assigns. The Noteholder may bid up to the credit and may submit a written bid to the Trustee which shall be announced at sale. The balance of the purchase price is to be paid in cash within 30 days of final ratification of the sale by the Court.

TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE.

If purchaser fails to settle within the aforesaid thirty (30) days of the ratification, the purchaser agrees to pay the Trustee's reasonable attorney fees as ordered by the Court, plus all costs incurred, if the Trustee has filed the appropriate motion with the Court to resell the property. Purchaser waives personal service of any paper filed with the Court in connection with such motion and any Show Cause Order issued by the Court and expressly agrees to accept service of any such paper or Order by certified mail and regular mail sent to the address provided by the purchaser and as recorded on the documents executed by the purchaser at the time of the sale. Service shall be deemed effective upon the purchaser 3 days after postmarked by the United States Post Office. It is expressly agreed by the purchaser that actual receipt of the certified mail is not required for service to be effective. If the purchaser fails to go to settlement the deposit shall be forfeited to the Trustees and all expenses of this sale (including attorney fees and full commission on the gross sales price of the sale) shall be charged against and paid from the forfeited deposit. In the event of resale the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds or profits resulting from any resale of the property regardless of any improvements made to the real property. Interest is to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note from the date of the sale to the date of payment. If the purchaser fails to pay the purchase price in full by the date of settlement, the purchaser shall be responsible for the physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss from the date of sale forward. The sale is subject to post sale audit by the Mortgage holder to determine whether the borrower filed bankruptcy, entered into any repayment/forbearance agreement, reinstated or paid off prior to the sale. In any such event the Purchaser agrees that upon notification by the Trustees of such event the sale is null and void and of no legal effect and the deposit returned without interest.

Brennan Ferguson, John C. Hanrahan,
Jeremy B. Wilkins, Amanda Driscoll,
Robert Oliveri, and Paul Heimmuller
Trustees'
File No. 19-15821

HARVEY WEST
AUCTIONEERS, LLC
300 E. Joppa Road
Harrisonville, MO 64583
Baltimore, MD 21204
410-798-0772

Aug 24, 31, Sep 7, 14, 2026 0012524808

Loudoun County

Trustee's Sale
42447 Oak Park Square,
Ashburn, VA 20148
(Parcel ID: 157155674000)

Default having been made in the terms of a certain Deed of Trust dated November 19, 2018, in the original principal amount of \$620,998.00, as recorded in the Clerk's Office of the Loudoun County Circuit Court, on November 26, 2018, as Instrument Number 20181126-0008079, the undersigned Substituted Trustee will sell at public auction on **October 19, 2026 at 2:15 PM**, in front of the building housing the County of Loudoun Circuit Court, 18 East Market Street, Leesburg, VA 20178, the property designated as Lot 33, Linn Property, also known as Belmont Run, as the same appears duly described and plat and recorded as Instrument #20161215-0085338 among the Land Records of Loudoun County, Virginia. Sale is subject to all prior liens, easements, restrictions, covenants, and conditions, if any, of record, or other matters which would be disclosed by an accurate survey or inspection of the premises.

TERMS: CASH. A deposit of \$62,000.00 or 10% of the sale price, whichever is lower, will be required of the successful bidder at time of sale. Prior to the sale, interested bidders will be required to register with and must present a bid deposit which may be held during the sale by the trustee. The bid deposit must be certified funds and/or cash, but no more than \$9,900.00 of cash will be accepted. Successful bidder's deposit will be retained at the time of sale and applied to the sale price. If the trustee, all other bid deposits will be returned to the successful bidder. Settlement is to be made within 15 days. The successful bidder will be responsible for obtaining possession of the property and fees related to recording the Trustee's Deed, including the grantor's tax. The successful bidder will be required to execute a Memorandum of Trustee's Sale, available for review upon request before the sale, outlining additional terms of sale and settlement. A Trustee's Deed will be prepared by Trustee's attorney at high bidder's expense.

This is a communication from a debt collector. Tromberg, Miller, Morris & Partners, PLLC on behalf of Southeast Equity Trustees, LLC and/or NFPS-Va LLC, Substitute Trustees), 5310 Market Road, Suite 201, Richmond, VA 23230, File No. 26-000212, Tel: 804-525-1570.

Sep 14, 21, 2026 0012524935

DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA

Rooms for Rent

Petworth Furnished room for rent.
\$850. David: 202-793-9663
3 blocks to subway

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The Washington Post

Trustees Sale - DC

**Gordon Feinblatt LLC
1001 Fleet Street, Suite 700
Baltimore, Maryland 21202**

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF
636 EDGEWOOD STREET, N.E.,
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20017**

Under a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust and Security Agreement (the "Deed of Trust") dated August 21, 2022, and recorded on August 22, 2023, as Instrument No. 2023072599, default having occurred under the terms of the Deed of Trust, and following the recording of a Deed of Removal of Trustees and Appointment of Substitute Trustees as Instrument No. 2026081075, an Affidavit of Non-Residential Mortgage Foreclosure as Instrument No. 2026081079, and a Notice of Foreclosure Sale of Real Property or Condominium Unit as Instrument No. 2026083411, at the request of the party secured by the Deed of Trust, the Substitute Trustees will sell at public auction at the offices of Alex Cooper Auctioneers, Inc., 4910 Massachusetts Avenue, N.W., Suite 100, Washington, D.C. 20016, on

SEPTEMBER 23, 2026 AT 12:30 PM

All that fee simple lot of ground, together with any buildings or improvements thereon located in the City of Washington, District of Columbia and more fully described in the Deed of Trust; the improvements being known as 636 Edgewood Street, N.E., Washington, D.C. 20017, Square 3637, Lot 103 (the "Property"). The Property is believed to be improved by an apartment building.

TERMS OF SALE: This advertisement, as amended or supplemented by any oral announcements during the sale, constitutes the entire terms upon which the Property shall be offered for sale, sold, or purchased.

The Property will be sold in "AS IS" condition and with no warranty of any kind. The purchaser shall be solely responsible for obtaining possession of the Property. The Property will be sold subject to (i) all conditions, liens, restrictions, rights of redemption, covenants, encumbrances, and agreements of record that take priority over the Deed of Trust; (ii) any violations of housing, building, environmental, or other codes, and (iii) such state of facts that an accurate survey or physical inspection of the Property might disclose.

A \$75,000 deposit shall be required at the time and place of the auction and shall be in the form of a cashier's check drawn on a bank acceptable to the Substitute Trustees. The deposit will not earn interest in the hands of the Substitute Trustees. The purchaser shall increase the deposit to ten percent (10%) of the bid price within two (2) business days of the sale, payable by cashier's check or immediate funds wire transfer to the Substitute Trustees. The party secured by the Deed of Trust (the "Secured Party") or any affiliate thereof, if a bidder, is not required to post a deposit or to pay interest on the unpaid purchase money. If the Secured Party purchases the Property at the sale, the amount bid by the Secured Party, after deducting all expenses related to the sale, shall be a credit against the indebtedness secured by the Deed of Trust.

The balance of the purchase price, with interest at the rate set forth in the Promissory Note, shall be paid by cash, cashier's check, or another acceptable form at settlement, which must occur within thirty (30) days following the sale. Interest will accrue from the date of sale until the date funds are received by R.L. Title and Escrow, Inc., the closing agent for the Substitute Trustees. There shall be no abatement of interest if settlement is delayed.

The purchaser of the Property shall be responsible for all condominium or homeowners' association fees and unpaid real property taxes due with respect to the Property, and all amounts due in connection therewith and there shall be no adjustment therefor. All water and sewer charges, and all other charges and assessments against the Property shall be the responsibility of the purchaser and there shall be no adjustment therefor. The purchaser shall pay all closing costs of the sale. The Noteholder and Substitute Trustees assume no liability for fuel, gas, electricity, water and sewer charges, any other utilities and other operating charges accrued before or after the sale and all such charges shall be the sole responsibility of the purchaser. All obligations of the purchaser hereunder shall survive closing and delivery of the deed. The purchaser (other than the Secured Party) shall sign a contract including this advertisement and other terms. Time is of the essence.

The Property is sold subject to the rights, if any, of parties in possession, if such rights have priority over the Deed of Trust, and to any and all covenants, conditions, restrictions, easements, rights of way, and limitations of record.

The purchaser shall deliver to the Substitute Trustees, within two (2) business days following the sale, an insurance certificate confirming that the purchaser has obtained casualty and liability insurance coverage on the Property, naming the Substitute Trustees and the Secured Party as additional insured parties on the policy, and otherwise in form and content acceptable to the Substitute Trustees. The failure of the purchaser to provide such evidence of insurance coverage shall constitute grounds for nullifying and voiding the sale. The Substitute Trustees reserve the right to require registration and/or pre-qualification of bidders, to modify or waive the requirements for bidders' deposits, to approve the creditworthiness of any bidder, to withdraw the Property from sale, to cancel the sale, to use an agent or attorney to conduct the sale, to reject any and all bids or to postpone the sale and keep the bidding open for any length of time.

If the purchaser defaults, the Substitute Trustees may retain the deposit as liquidated damages, resell the Property at the risk and cost of the defaulting purchaser, and recover any deficiency in the purchase price, all costs and expenses of both sales, attorneys' fees, and related expenses, or may avail themselves of any other legal or equitable remedies available to them. The defaulting purchaser is not entitled to any surplus from the resale, even if such surplus is due to improvements made by the defaulting purchaser.

If the Substitute Trustees are unable to convey the Property by reason of any defect in the title or otherwise, the sole remedy of the purchaser of the Property at law or in equity shall be the refund of the deposit. Upon refund of the deposit to the purchaser, the sale shall be void and of no effect. The conveyance by the Substitute Trustees to the purchaser at settlement shall be by Substitute Trustees' Deed, without covenant or warranty.

TERMS OF SALE: ALL CASH. A deposit of ten percent (10%) of the sale price or ten percent (10%) of the original principal balance of the subject Deed of Trust, whichever is lower, will be required of the successful bidder at time of sale. Prior to the sale, interested bidders will be required to register with and must present a bid deposit which may be held during the sale by the trustee. The bid deposit must be certified funds and/or cash, but no more than \$9,900.00 of cash will be accepted. Successful bidder's deposit will be retained at the time of sale and applied to the sale price. If the trustee, all other bid deposits will be returned to the successful bidder. Settlement is to be made within 15 days. The successful bidder will be responsible for obtaining possession of the property and fees related to recording the Trustee's Deed, including the grantor's tax. The successful bidder will be required to execute a Memorandum of Trustee's Sale, available for review upon request before the sale, outlining additional terms of sale and settlement. A Trustee's Deed will be prepared by Trustee's attorney at high bidder's expense.

This is a communication from a debt collector. Tromberg, Miller, Morris & Partners, PLLC on behalf of Southeast Equity Trustees, LLC and/or NFPS-Va LLC, Substitute Trustees), 5310 Market Road, Suite 201, Richmond, VA 23230, File No. 26-000212, Tel: 804-525-1570.

Sep 14, 21, 2026 0012524935

DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA

Rooms for Rent

Petworth Furnished room for rent.
\$850. David: 202-793-9663
3 blocks to subway

MARYLAND

Roommates

Germantown - 2 Furnished bedrooms. \$850 each. Cable. No smoking of any kind. Call 240-671-3783

Houses Wanted to Buy

WE BUY HOUSES FOR CASH AS IS! No repairs. No fuss. Any condition. Easy three step process. Call, get cash offer and get paid. Get your free report. Call 866-541-7929.

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The Washington Post

Trustees Sale - DC

**Gordon Feinblatt LLC
1001 Fleet Street, Suite 700
Baltimore, Maryland 21202**

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF
636 EDGEWOOD STREET, N.E.,
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20017**

Under a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust and Security Agreement (the "Deed of Trust") dated August 21, 2022, and recorded on August 22, 2023, as Instrument No. 2023072599, default having occurred under the terms of the Deed of Trust, and following the recording of a Deed of Removal of Trustees and Appointment of Substitute Trustees as Instrument No. 2026081075, an Affidavit of Non-Residential Mortgage Foreclosure as Instrument No. 2026081079, and a Notice of Foreclosure Sale of Real Property or Condominium Unit as Instrument No. 2026083411, at the request of the party secured by the Deed of Trust, the Substitute Trustees will sell at public auction at the offices of Alex Cooper Auctioneers, Inc., 4910 Massachusetts Avenue, N.W., Suite 100, Washington, D.C. 20016, on

SEPTEMBER 23, 2026 AT 12:30 PM

All that fee simple lot of ground, together with any buildings or improvements thereon located in the City of Washington, District of Columbia and more fully described in the Deed of Trust; the improvements being known as 636 Edgewood Street, N.E., Washington, D.C. 20017, Square 3637, Lot 103 (the "Property"). The Property is believed to be improved by an apartment building.

TERMS OF SALE: This advertisement, as amended or supplemented by any oral announcements during the sale, constitutes the entire terms upon which the Property shall be offered for sale, sold, or purchased.

The Property will be sold in "AS IS" condition and with no warranty of any kind. The purchaser shall be solely responsible for obtaining possession of the Property. The Property will be sold subject to (i) all conditions, liens, restrictions, rights of redemption, covenants, encumbrances, and agreements of record that take priority over the Deed of Trust; (ii) any violations of housing, building, environmental, or other codes, and (iii) such state of facts that an accurate survey or physical inspection of the Property might disclose.

A \$75,000 deposit shall be required at the time and place of the auction and shall be in the form of a cashier's check drawn on a bank acceptable to the Substitute Trustees. The deposit will not earn interest in the hands of the Substitute Trustees. The purchaser shall increase the deposit to ten percent (10%) of the bid price within two (2) business days of the sale, payable by cashier's check or immediate funds wire transfer to the Substitute Trustees. The party secured by the Deed of Trust (the "Secured Party") or any affiliate thereof, if a bidder, is not required to post a deposit or to pay interest on the unpaid purchase money. If the Secured Party purchases the Property at the sale, the amount bid by the Secured Party, after deducting all expenses related to the sale, shall be a credit against the indebtedness secured by the Deed of Trust.

The balance of the purchase price, with interest at the rate set forth in the Promissory Note, shall be paid by cash, cashier's check, or another acceptable form at settlement, which must occur within thirty (30) days following the sale. Interest will accrue from the date of sale until the date funds are received by R.L. Title and Escrow, Inc., the closing agent for the Substitute Trustees. There shall be no abatement of interest if settlement is delayed.

The purchaser of the Property shall be responsible for all condominium or homeowners' association fees and unpaid real property taxes due with respect to the Property, and all amounts due in connection therewith and there shall be no adjustment therefor. All water and sewer charges, and all other charges and assessments against the Property shall be the responsibility of the purchaser and there shall be no adjustment therefor. The purchaser shall pay all closing costs of the sale. The Noteholder and Substitute Trustees assume no liability for fuel, gas, electricity, water and sewer charges, any other utilities and other operating charges accrued before or after the sale and all such charges shall be the sole responsibility of the purchaser. All obligations of the purchaser hereunder shall survive closing and delivery of the deed. The purchaser (other than the Secured Party) shall sign a contract including this advertisement and other terms. Time is of the essence.

The Property is sold subject to the rights, if any, of parties in possession, if such rights have priority over the Deed of Trust, and to any and all covenants, conditions, restrictions, easements, rights of way, and limitations of record.

The purchaser shall deliver to the Substitute Trustees, within two (2) business days following the sale, an insurance certificate confirming that the purchaser has obtained casualty and liability insurance coverage on the Property, naming the Substitute Trustees and the Secured Party as additional insured parties on the policy, and otherwise in form and content acceptable to the Substitute Trustees. The failure of the purchaser to provide such evidence of insurance coverage shall constitute grounds for nullifying and voiding the sale. The Substitute Trustees reserve the right to require registration and/or pre-qualification of bidders, to modify or waive the requirements for bidders' deposits, to approve the creditworthiness of any bidder, to withdraw the Property from sale, to cancel the sale, to use an agent or attorney to conduct the sale, to reject any and all bids or to postpone the sale and keep the bidding open for any length of time.

If the purchaser defaults, the Substitute Trustees may retain the deposit as liquidated damages, resell the Property at the risk and cost of the defaulting purchaser, and recover any deficiency in the purchase price, all costs and expenses of both sales, attorneys' fees, and related expenses, or may avail themselves of any other legal or equitable remedies available to them. The defaulting purchaser is not entitled to any surplus from the resale, even if such surplus is due to improvements made by the defaulting purchaser.

If the Substitute Trustees are unable to convey the Property by reason of any defect in the title or otherwise, the sole remedy of the purchaser of the Property at law or in equity shall be the refund of the deposit. Upon refund of the deposit to the purchaser, the sale shall be void and of no effect. The conveyance by the Substitute Trustees to the purchaser at settlement shall be by Substitute Trustees' Deed, without covenant or warranty.

TERMS OF SALE: ALL CASH. A deposit of ten percent (10%) of the sale price or ten percent (10%) of the original principal balance of the subject Deed of Trust, whichever is lower, will be required of the successful bidder at time of sale. Prior to the sale, interested bidders will be required to register with and must present a bid deposit which may be held during the sale by the trustee. The bid deposit must be certified funds and/or cash, but no more than \$9,900.00 of cash will be accepted. Successful bidder's deposit will be retained at the time of sale and applied to the sale price. If the trustee, all other bid deposits will be returned to the successful bidder. Settlement is to be made within 15 days. The successful bidder will be responsible for obtaining possession of the property and fees related to recording the Trustee's Deed, including the grantor's tax. The successful bidder will be required to execute a Memorandum of Trustee's Sale, available for review upon request before the sale, outlining additional terms of sale and settlement. A Trustee's Deed will be prepared by Trustee's attorney at high bidder's expense.

This is a communication from a debt collector. Tromberg, Miller, Morris & Partners, PLLC on behalf of Southeast Equity Trustees, LLC and/or NFPS-Va LLC, Substitute Trustees), 5310 Market Road, Suite 201, Richmond, VA 23230, File No. 26-000212, Tel: 804-525-1570.

Sep 14, 21, 2026 0012524935

DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA

Rooms for Rent

Petworth Furnished room for rent.
\$850. David: 202-793-9663
3 blocks to subway

MARYLAND

Roommates

Germantown - 2 Furnished bedrooms. \$850 each. Cable. No smoking of any kind. Call 240-671-3783

Houses Wanted to Buy

WE BUY HOUSES FOR CASH AS IS! No repairs. No fuss. Any condition. Easy three step process. Call, get cash offer and get paid. Get your free report. Call 866-541-7929.

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Trustees Sale - DC

**Gordon Feinblatt LLC
1001 Fleet Street, Suite 700
Baltimore, Maryland 21202**

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF
1603 ISHERWOOD STREET, UNIT 1
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20002**

Under a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust and Security Agreement (the "Deed of Trust") dated August 12, 2022, and recorded on August 30, 2022, as Instrument No. 2022090233, default having occurred under the terms of the Deed of Trust, and following the recording of a Deed of Removal of Trustees and Appointment of Substitute Trustees as Instrument No. 2026081076, an Affidavit of Non-Residential Mortgage Foreclosure as Instrument No. 2026081080, and a Notice of Foreclosure Sale of Real Property or Condominium Unit as Instrument No. 2026083834, at the request of the party secured by the Deed of Trust, the Substitute Trustees will sell at public auction at the offices of Alex Cooper Auctioneers, Inc., 4910 Massachusetts Avenue, N.W., Suite 100, Washington, D.C. 20016, on

SEPTEMBER 23, 2026 AT 12:32 PM

All that fee simple lot of ground, together with any buildings or

C14 CLASSIFIED

Trustees Sale - DC

Trustees Sale - DC

Samuel I. White, P.C.
6100 EXECUTIVE BLVD.
SUITE 400
ROCKVILLE, MARYLAND 20852

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE
OF VALUABLE RESIDENTIAL DWELLING
KNOWN AS:**
1366 H STREET NE, WASHINGTON, DC 20002

By virtue of Deed of Trust recorded in the land records of the District of Columbia recorded on July 11, 2005, as Instrument Number 2005095498, and in accordance Judgment filed on August 27, 2026 in case 2024-CAB-002501 and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustees will offer to sell at public auction, within the office of

HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC.
5335 Wisconsin Avenue, NW, Suite 440
Washington, DC 20015-2034
On
October 13, 2026 at 12:00 PM

the land and premises situated in the District of Columbia and more particularly described in the above referenced Deed of Trust and as of the date hereof designated on the Records of the Assessor of the District of Columbia for assessment purposes as

1366 H Street NE, Washington, DC 20002
LOT 0152 AND SQUARE 1026

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, the ability of the purchaser to obtain title insurance or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to any assessments including assessment pursuant to D.C. Code Section 42-1903.13.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$20,000.00 PAYABLE ONLY BY certified funds, shall be required at the time of sale. CASH WILL NOT BE AN ACCEPTABLE FORM OF DEPOSIT. The balance of the purchase price with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note (9.5% per annum) from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Trustees, payable in cash or certified funds within TEN DAYS after the final ratification of the sale. There will be no abatement of interest due from the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. Adjustment of current years real property taxes are adjusted as of the date of sale, and thereafter assumed by the purchaser. All other public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer charges, ground rent, whether incurred prior to or after the sale are to be paid by the purchaser. All costs of deed recordation including but not limited to title examination, conveyancing, city revenue stamps, transfer taxes, title insurance, and all other costs incident to settlement are to be paid by the purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from date of sale. Time is of the essence for the Purchaser. If the Purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, Purchaser agrees that the property will be resold and the entire deposit retained by the Substitute Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchasers default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser agrees to accept service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for all correspondence including any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into and repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to sale. In any such event or if the sale is not ratified, the purchaser's only remedy is return of the deposit without interest.

Trustees File No. 3335
Daniel J. Pesachowitz, Esquire
Attorney for Trustees



HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC.
5335 Wisconsin Ave., NW, Ste 440
Washington, DC 20015
(202) 462-6997
www.hwestauctions.com

Sep 14,21,28,Oct 5, 2026

0012525722

851 Prince Georges County

851 Prince Georges County

De Cubas & Lewis, PA
PO Box 5026
Fort Lauderdale, FL 33310

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE
OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY
KNOWN AS**
**4803 Crest View Dr
Hyattsville, MD 20782**

By virtue of a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust from JASMINE MCKENS, dated November 30, 2018 and recorded in book 41590, page 7 among the Land Records of PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, Maryland, default having occurred thereunder (Foreclosure Case docketed as Case No. C-16-CV-25-004271; Tax ID No. 17-5559393) the Substitute Trustee will sell at public auction PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY C courthouse located at FRONT OF THE DUVAL WING OF THE COURTHOUSE COMPLEX 14735 MAIN ST, UPPER MARLBORO, MD 20772.

SEPTEMBER 29, 2026 at 2:15 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$ 38,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK, CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at five (5)000 % from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustee. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted to the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee is unable to convey insurable title for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 25-02112)

THOMAS GARTNER, JUSTIN HOY, Substitute Trustee (s)



HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, LLC
300 E. Joppa Road
Hagerstown Plaza, Suite 1103
Hagerstown, MD 21766
410-769-9797

Sep 14,21,28, 2026 0012525165

Trustees Sale - DC

Trustees Sale - DC

Pardo & Drazin, LLC
Russell S. Drazin, Attorney
4400 Jenifer Street, NW, Suite 2
Washington, DC 20015
202-223-7900

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE
OF REAL PROPERTY**

807 K Street, NE
Washington, DC 20002
Lot 0063 in Square 0910
(formerly Lots 26 and/or 62 in Square 0910)

809 K Street, NE
Washington, DC 20002
Lot 0064 in Square 0910
(formerly Lots 26 and/or 62 in Square 0910)

811 K Street, NE
Washington, DC 20002
Lot 0065 in Square 0910
(formerly Lots 26 and/or 62 in Square 0910)

813 K Street, NE
Washington, DC 20002
Lot 0066 in Square 0910
(formerly Lots 26 and/or 62 in Square 0910)

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust and Security Agreement (the "Deed of Trust") dated August 4, 2023 and recorded on August 18, 2023 as Instrument No. 2023071531 from 811 K ST. NE LLC, a District of Columbia limited liability company, as grantor, to SCOT R. BROWNING and PAUL L. MERRITT ("Original Trustees"), as trustees, securing a certain Deed of Trust Note dated August 4, 2023 in the maximum principal amount of \$4,329,000.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, pursuant to a Deed of Appointment of Substitute Trustee removing Original Trustees as trustees, under the Deed of Trust and appointing Hunter C. Piel ("Substitute Trustee") as successor trustee under the Deed of Trust, and following the mailing and recordation of an Affidavit of Non-Residential Mortgage Foreclosure and a Notice of Foreclosure Sale of Real Property or Condominium Unit, at the request of the current noteholder, Substitute Trustee will sell at public auction at the office of Alex Cooper Auctioneers, Inc., 4910 Massachusetts Avenue, NW, Suite 100, Washington, DC 20016, on

SEPTEMBER 23, 2026 AT 12:50 PM

ALL THOSE LOTS OF GROUND AND THE IMPROVEMENTS THEREON (if any) situated in the City of Washington, District of Columbia, known as 807 K Street, NE, Washington, DC 20002 (Lot 0063 in Square 0910), 809 K Street, NE, Washington, DC 20002 (Lot 0064 in Square 0910), 811 K Street, NE, Washington, DC 20002 (Lot 0065 in Square 0910), and 813 K Street, NE, Washington, DC 20002 (Lot 0066 in Square 0910), and more fully described in the Deed of Trust, as well as ALL PERSONAL PROPERTY (if any) encumbered by the Deed of Trust and/or that certain UCC Financing Statement recorded on August 18, 2023 as Instrument No. 2023071501 (but only as that UCC Financing Statement pertains to 811 K ST. NE LLC, a District of Columbia limited liability company, as debtor).

The properties described above will be offered for sale both separately and as a whole. Substitute Trustee reserves the right, in Substitute Trustee's sole discretion, to sell each property separately, to sell both properties together as a single combined sale, or to do both and select whichever alternative yields the higher aggregate sale price — that is, the sum of the highest bids received for the properties when offered separately, or the highest single bid received for the properties when offered together, whichever is greater. Substitute Trustee's determination as to the order, manner, and grouping of the properties offered for sale shall be final and binding on all bidders.

The properties will be sold in an "AS IS" condition, with no warranty of any kind, and subject to conditions, restrictions, agreements, liens, and encumbrances of record affecting the same — except those encumbrances of record that are extinguished by operation of District of Columbia law by virtue of the foreclosure of the Deed of Trust.

Purchaser will take title to the properties subject to any and all real estate taxes and water and sewer charges. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the properties from the date of sale forward. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the properties.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$75,000.00 per lot, or \$300,000.00 if all lots are sold together, by cashier's check will be required of purchaser at the time and place of sale, with the deposit to be increased to 10.00% of the gross purchase price within two (2) business days, if applicable. Purchaser shall settle within thirty (30) days of sale. TIME SHALL BE OF THE ESSENCE WITH RESPECT TO SETTLEMENT BY PURCHASER. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash or certified funds at settlement. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money from the date of sale to the date of settlement at the applicable interest rate set forth in the debt instrument secured by the Deed of Trust. Purchaser shall be responsible for payment of all settlement costs.

The noteholder and its affiliates, if a bidder, shall not be required to post a deposit or to pay interest.

In the event that purchaser does not settle as required for any reason, purchaser shall be in default. Upon such default, the deposit shall be forfeited to Substitute Trustee and all of the expenses of this sale (including legal fees and costs, and full commission on the gross sale price) shall be charged against and paid out of the forfeited deposit. Substitute Trustee may sell the properties at the risk and expense of the defaulting purchaser. The defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds or profits resulting from any resale of the properties. Defaulting purchaser shall be liable to Substitute Trustee for legal fees and costs incurred by Substitute Trustee in connection with such default.

If Substitute Trustee is unable to settle as set forth herein, purchaser's sole remedy at law and in equity shall be limited to a refund of the deposit and the sale shall be considered null and void and of no effect whatsoever.

Substitute Trustee reserves the right, in Substitute Trustee's sole discretion, to reject any and all bids, to withdraw the properties from sale at any time before or at the auction, to extend the time to receive bids, to waive or modify the deposit requirement, to waive or modify the requirement that interest be paid on the unpaid purchase money, and/or to extend the period of time for settlement.

Additional terms may be announced at the sale. The successful bidder will be required to execute and deliver to Substitute Trustee a memorandum or contract of the sale at the conclusion of bidding.

Hunter C. Piel, Substitute Trustee



ALEX COOPER
auctioneers
4910 Massachusetts Avenue, NW • Suite 100
Washington, DC 20016 • 202.364.0306
www.alexcooper.com

Sep 11,14,16,18,22, 2026

0012525618

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The Washington Post



50115-2x4

The Washington Post

Trustees Sale - DC

Trustees Sale - DC

Pardo & Drazin, LLC
Russell S. Drazin, Attorney
4400 Jenifer Street, NW, Suite 2
Washington, DC 20015
202-223-7900

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE
OF REAL PROPERTY**

330 15th Street, SE
Washington, DC 20003
Lot 0090 in Square 1074

827 Randolph Street, NW
Washington, DC 20011
Lot 0087 in Square 3027

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust and Security Agreement (the "Deed of Trust") dated February 14, 2024 and recorded on February 16, 2024 as Instrument No. 2024014943 from 827 & 829 RANDOLPH ST NW LLC, a District of Columbia limited liability company, and 330 15TH ST SE LLC, a District of Columbia limited liability company, as grantors, to SCOT R. BROWNING and PAUL L. MERRITT ("Original Trustees"), as trustees, securing a certain Deed of Trust Note dated February 14, 2024 in the maximum principal amount of \$4,100,000.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, pursuant to a Deed of Appointment of Substitute Trustee removing Original Trustees as trustees under the Deed of Trust and appointing Hunter C. Piel ("Substitute Trustee") as successor trustee under the Deed of Trust, and following the mailing and recordation of an Affidavit of Non-Residential Mortgage Foreclosure and a Notice of Foreclosure Sale of Real Property or Condominium Unit, at the request of the current noteholder, Substitute Trustee will sell at public auction at the office of Alex Cooper Auctioneers, Inc., 4910 Massachusetts Avenue, NW, Suite 100, Washington, DC 20016, on

SEPTEMBER 23, 2026 AT 12:40 PM

ALL THOSE LOTS OF GROUND AND THE IMPROVEMENTS THEREON (if any) situated in the City of Washington, District of Columbia, known as 330 15th Street, SE, Washington, DC 20003 (Lot 0090 in Square 1074) and 827 Randolph Street, NW, Washington, DC 20011 (Lot 0087 in Square 3027), and more fully described in the Deed of Trust, as well as ALL PERSONAL PROPERTY (if any) encumbered by the Deed of Trust and/or that certain UCC Financing Statement recorded on February 16, 2024 as Instrument No. 2024014944.

The properties described above will be offered for sale both separately and as a whole. Substitute Trustee reserves the right, in Substitute Trustee's sole discretion, to sell each property separately, to sell both properties together as a single combined sale, or to do both and select whichever alternative yields the higher aggregate sale price — that is, the sum of the highest bids received for the properties when offered separately, or the highest single bid received for the properties when offered together, whichever is greater. Substitute Trustee's determination as to the order, manner, and grouping of the properties offered for sale shall be final and binding on all bidders.

The properties will be sold in an "AS IS" condition, with no warranty of any kind, and subject to conditions, restrictions, agreements, liens, and encumbrances of record affecting the same — except those encumbrances of record that are extinguished by operation of District of Columbia law by virtue of the foreclosure of the Deed of Trust.

Purchaser will take title to the properties subject to any and all real estate taxes and water and sewer charges. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the properties from the date of sale forward. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the properties.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$100,000.00 per lot, or \$200,000.00 if both lots are sold together, by cashier's check will be required of purchaser at the time and place of sale, with the deposit to be increased to 10.00% of the gross purchase price within two (2) business days, if applicable. Purchaser shall settle within thirty (30) days of sale. TIME SHALL BE OF THE ESSENCE WITH RESPECT TO SETTLEMENT BY PURCHASER. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash or certified funds at settlement. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money from the date of sale to the date of settlement at the applicable interest rate set forth in the debt instrument secured by the Deed of Trust. Purchaser shall be responsible for payment of all settlement costs.

The noteholder and its affiliates, if a bidder, shall not be required to post a deposit or to pay interest.

In the event that purchaser does not settle as required for any reason, purchaser shall be in default. Upon such default, the deposit shall be forfeited to Substitute Trustee and all of the expenses of this sale (including legal fees and costs, and full commission on the gross sale price) shall be charged against and paid out of the forfeited deposit. Substitute Trustee may resell the properties at the risk and expense of the defaulting purchaser. The defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds or profits resulting from any resale of the properties. Defaulting purchaser shall be liable to Substitute Trustee for legal fees and costs incurred by Substitute Trustee in connection with such default.

If Substitute Trustee is unable to settle as set forth herein, purchaser's sole remedy at law and in equity shall be limited to a refund of the deposit and the sale shall be considered null and void and of no effect whatsoever.

Substitute Trustee reserves the right, in Substitute Trustee's sole discretion, to reject any and all bids, to withdraw the properties from sale at any time before or at the auction, to extend the time to receive bids, to waive or modify the deposit requirement, to waive or modify the requirement that interest be paid on the unpaid purchase money, and/or to extend the period of time for settlement.

Additional terms may be announced at the sale. The successful bidder will be required to execute and deliver to Substitute Trustee a memorandum or contract of the sale at the conclusion of bidding.

Hunter C. Piel, Substitute Trustee

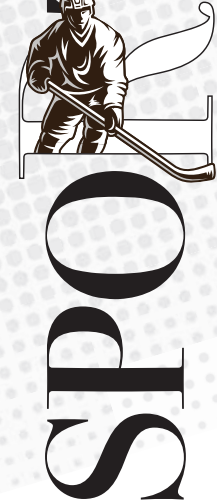


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Trustees Sale - DC

Trustees Sale - DC

Samuel I. White, P.C.
6100 EXECUTIVE BLVD., SUITE 400
ROCKVILLE, MARYLAND 20852
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE
OF
**VALUABLE RESIDENTIAL DWELLING KNOWN AS:
3122 SHERMAN AVENUE NW, WASHINGTON, DC 20010**

By virtue of Deed of Trust recorded in the land records of the District of Columbia recorded on April 25, 2023, as Instrument Number 2023034046, and in accordance Judgment filed on March 24, 2026 in case 2025-CAB-003829 and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustees will offer to sell at public auction, within the office of

HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC.
5335 Wisconsin Avenue, NW, Suite 440
Washington, DC 20015-2034
on
October 13, 2026 at 12:00 PM

the land and premises situated in the District of Columbia and more particularly described in the above referenced Deed of Trust and as of the date hereof designated on the Records of the Assessor of the District of Columbia for assessment purposes as

515 Kenyon Street NW, Washington D.C. 20010,
35 T Street NE, Washington D.C. 20002 and
3122 Sherman Avenue NW, Washington, DC 20010
also known as
LOT 0105 AND SQUARE 2846
LOT 0044 AND SQUARE 3046
LOT 0114 AND SQUARE 3530

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, the ability of the purchaser to obtain title insurance or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to any assessments including assessment pursuant to D.C. Code Section 42-1903.13.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$20,000.00 PAYABLE ONLY BY certified funds, shall be required at the time of sale. CASH WILL NOT BE AN ACCEPTABLE FORM OF DEPOSIT. The balance of the purchase price with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note (2.5% per annum) from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Trustees, payable in cash or certified funds within TEN DAYS after the final ratification of the sale. There will be no abatement of interest due from the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. Adjustment of current years real property taxes are adjusted as of the date of sale, and thereafter assumed by the purchaser. All other public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer charges, ground rent, whether incurred prior to or after the sale are to be paid by the purchaser. All costs of deed recordation including but not limited to title examination, conveyancing, city revenue stamps, transfer taxes, title insurance, and all other costs incident to settlement are to be paid by the purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from date of sale. Time is of the essence for the Purchaser. If the Purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, Purchaser agrees that the property will be resold and the entire deposit retained by the Substitute Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser agrees to accept service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for all correspondence including any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into and repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to sale. In any such event or if the sale is not ratified, the purchaser's only remedy is return of the deposit without interest.

Trustees File No. 92534



HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC.
5335 Wisconsin Ave., NW, Ste 440
Washington, DC 20015
(202) 462-6997
www.hwestauctions.com

Sep 14,21,28,Oct 5, 2026

0012525475

851 Prince Georges County

851 Prince Georges County

De Cubas & Lewis, PA
PO Box 5026
Fort Lauderdale, FL 33310

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE
OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY
KNOWN AS**
**8585 SEASONS WAY UNIT 7B
Lanham, MD 20706**

By virtue of a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust from BEATRICE BABATUNDE, dated November 17, 2025 and recorded in book 51505, page 607 among the Land Records of PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, Maryland, default having occurred thereunder (Foreclosure Case docketed as Case No. C-16-CV-26-003917; Tax ID No. 21-2426492) the Substitute Trustee will sell at public auction PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY C courthouse located at FRONT OF THE DUVAL WING OF THE COURTHOUSE COMPLEX 14735 MAIN ST, UPPER MARLBORO, MD 20772.

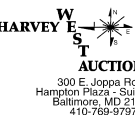
SEPTEMBER 29, 2026 at 2:15 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$ 31,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK, CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at 6.1200 % from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustee. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted to the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee is unable to convey insurable title for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 26-02272)

THOMAS GARTNER, JUSTIN HOY, Substitute Trustee (s)



HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, LLC
300 E. Joppa Road
Hagerstown Plaza, Suite 1103
Hagerstown, MD 21766
410-769-9797

Sep 14,21,28, 2026

0012525164

EZ

MONDAY, SEPTEMBER 14, 2026

Trustees Sale - DC

Trustees Sale - DC

Samuel I. White, P.C.
6100 EXECUTIVE BLVD.
SUITE 400
ROCKVILLE, MARYLAND 20852

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE
OF VALUABLE RESIDENTIAL DWELLING
KNOWN AS:**
4515 TEXAS AVENUE SE, WASHINGTON, DC 20019

By virtue of Deed of Trust recorded in the land records of the District of Columbia recorded on July 24, 2019, as Instrument Number 2019077855, and in accordance Judgment filed on August 5, 2025 in case 2024-CAB-007496 and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustees will offer to sell at public auction, within the office of

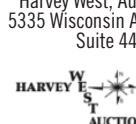
HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC.
5335 Wisconsin Avenue, NW
Suite 440
Washington, DC 20015-2034
on
October 13, 2026 at 12:00 PM

the land and premises situated in the District of Columbia and more particularly described in the above referenced Deed of Trust and as of the date hereof designated on the Records of the Assessor of the District of Columbia for assessment purposes as

4515 Texas Avenue SE, Washington, DC 20019,
LOT 0802 AND SQUARE 5395

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, the ability of the purchaser to obtain title insurance or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to any assessments including assessment pursuant to D.C. Code Section 42-1903.13.

Trustees File No. 82115
Daniel J. Pesachowitz, Esquire
Attorney for Trustees
Harvey West, Auctioneers
5335 Wisconsin Avenue, NW
Suite 440



HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC.
5335 Wisconsin Ave., NW, Ste 440
Washington, DC 20015
(202) 462-6997
www.hwestauctions.com

Sep 14,21,28,Oct 5, 2026

0012524443

851 Prince Georges County

851 Prince Georges County

GREENSPOON MARDER, LLP
201 International Circle, Suite 230
Hunt Valley, MD 21030

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE
OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY
KNOWN AS**
**3500 ASHER ST
Upper Marlboro, MD 20772**

SEPTEMBER 17, 2026 at 2:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$ 36,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK, CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at five percent (5%) from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustee. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted to the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee is unable to convey insurable title for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 25-001466-01)

NICOLE LIPINSKI, GABRIELLE GIOVINAZZO, ERIN KENNEDY,
Substitute Trustee (s)



HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, LLC
300 E. Joppa Road
Hagerstown Plaza, Suite 1103
Hagerstown, MD 21766
410-769-9797

Aug 31,Sep 7,14, 2026

0

MONDAY, SEPTEMBER 14, 2026

EZ

8501

Montgomery County

8501

Montgomery County

Brock and Scott, PLLC
5431 Oleander Drive
Wilmington NC, 28403

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY
KNOWN AS
19115 Grotto Ln
Germantown, MD 20874

Under and by virtue of the power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust to CHRISTOPHER MARKHAM, Trustee(s), dated January 31, 2024, and recorded among the Land Records of MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND in Liber 67732 , folio 120, the holder of the indebtedness secured by this Deed of Trust having appointed the undersigned Substitute Trustee, by instrument duly recorded among the aforesaid Land Records, default having occurred under the terms thereof, and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction at THE MONTGOMERY COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT 50 MARYLAND AVENUE, ROCKVILLE, MD 20850 ON,

SEPTEMBER 23, 2026 at 11:00 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MD, and more fully described in the above-referenced Deed of Trust Tax ID# - 09-02297918.

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to all conditions, liens, restrictions and agreements of record affecting same including any condominium and of HOA assessments pursuant to Md Real Property Article 11-110.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$42,500.00 payable in certified check or by a cashier's check will be required from purchaser at time of sale, balance in immediately available funds upon final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court of MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND interest to be paid at the rate of 7.125% on unpaid purchase money from date of sale to date of settlement. The secured party herein, if a bidder, shall not be required to post a deposit. Third party purchaser (excluding the secured party) will be required to complete full settlement of the purchase of the property within TEN (10) CALENDAR DAYS of the ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court otherwise the purchaser's deposit shall be forfeited and the property will be resold at the risk and expense, of the defaulting purchaser. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser.

Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public/private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground rent, and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes hall be paid by purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale.

Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. If the sale is rescinded or not ratified for any reason, including post sale lender audit, or a resale is to take place for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to the refund of the aforementioned deposit. The Substitute Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if the ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the purchasers sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of their deposit, without interest.

The purchaser waives all rights and claims against the Substitute Trustees whether known or unknown. These provisions shall survive settlement Upon refund of the deposit, this sale shall be void and of no effect, and the purchaser shall have no further claim against the Substitute Trustees. The sale is subject to post-sale review of the status of the loan and that if any agreement to cancel the sale was entered into by the lender and borrower prior to the sale then the sale is void and the purchaser's deposit shall be refunded without interest. Additional terms and conditions, if applicable, may be announced at the time and date of sale.

If this transaction is subject to the FinCEN Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule ("RRE") issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule must be obtained provided to the Reporting Person, as defined in RRE Rule, prior to closing. File No. (25-30652)

BRENNAN FERGUSON, JOHN C. HANRAHAN,
JEREMY B. WILKINS, AMANDA DRISCOLE,
ROBERT OLIVERI, AND PAUL HEINMULLER ,
Substitute Trustees



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Law Offices of Gebhardt & Smith LLP
One South Street
Suite 2200
Baltimore, Maryland 21202

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF VALUABLE LOTS LOCATED IN ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY, MARYLAND AND IDENTIFIED AS:
90 SABRINA LANE; 93 PINEVIEW AVENUE; AND 90 CLARENCE AVENUE; SEVERNA PARK, MARYLAND 21146

Under and by virtue of the power of sale contained in that certain Purchase Money Deed of Trust dated December 29, 2004, executed and delivered by Princess Builders, Inc. ("Princess Builders") to the trustees named therein and recorded among the Land Records of Anne Arundel County, Maryland ("Land Records") at Book 15797, Page 333 ("Deed of Trust"), the holder of the indebtedness secured by said Deed of Trust ("Noteholder"), having subsequently appointed Michael D. Nord and Hannah C. Bondurant as Substitute Trustees in the place and stead of the original trustees under the Deed of Trust by instrument duly executed, acknowledged and recorded among the aforementioned Land Records, a default having occurred under the terms of said Deed of Trust and at the request of the parties secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustees (collectively, "Trustees") will offer for sale at a public auction to be conducted at the Courthouse for the Circuit Court for Anne Arundel County, Maryland located at 8 Church Circle, Annapolis, Maryland 21401 on:

WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 30, 2026 at 10:30 a.m.

All that certain land located in Anne Arundel County, Maryland and being more particularly described as follows ("Property"):

BEING KNOWN AND DESIGNATED AS Lots Numbered 29, 30, 31, 32...36, 37, 38 and 39, in Block "L", and Lots Numbered 38 and 39, in Block "K", as shown on a plat entitled SABRINA PARK, recorded among the Land Records of Anne Arundel County, Maryland, in Plat Book No. 5, page 50.

DESCRIPTION OF UNNUMBERED LOTS
SABRINA PARK
BLOCKS L & K
L 1552, F 247

Beginning for the first at the end of the division line between Lot 33 and the unnumbered Lots of Block L where said line intersects the Southerly right-of-way line of Pine View Avenue as shown on that Plat entitled "Sabrina Park" recorded among the Land Records of Anne Arundel County, Maryland in Plat Book 5, Page 50, Plat 312; thence from the point of beginning so fixed and running with and binding on a part of said right-of-way line as now surveyed by Development Facilitators, Inc.

1. South 69 degrees 44 minutes 23 seconds East, 43.78 feet to a point on the outline of the whole subdivision as shown on said Plat; thence departing said right-of-way line and running with and binding on a part of said outline
2. South 03 degrees 18 minutes 25 seconds West, 29.07 feet to an Iron pipe found; thence South 20 degrees 10 minutes 00 seconds West, 173.36 feet to a point located at the end of the Northerly right-of-way line of Sabrina Lane as shown on said Plat; thence departing said outline and running with and binding on a part of said right-of-way line
3. North 69 degree 44 minutes 23 seconds West, 55.69 feet to the end of the division line between Lot 28 and the unnumbered Lots of Block L as shown on said Plat; thence departing said right-of-way line and running with and binding on said division line and the division line between Lot 33 and said unnumbered Lots
4. North 20 degrees 15 minutes 37 seconds East 200.00 feet to the point and place of beginning.

Containing 10,950 square feet, or 0.25 acres of land, more or less.

Being a part of those lands conveyed to John W. Yarborough and Luesther Yarborough by deed dated November 3, 1961 and recorded among the Land Records of Anne Arundel County, Maryland in Liber 1552, Folio 247, also being all those unnumbered Lots shown on Block L of that Plat entitled "Sabrina Park" recorded among the Land Records of Anne Arundel County, Maryland in Plat Book 5, Page 50, Plat 312, and also being all those Lots referred to as "Lots 29-32, Block L" as shown on said Plat.

Beginning for the second at the end of the division line between Lot 40 and the unnumbered Lots of Block K where said line intersects the Southerly right-of-way line of Sabrina Lane as shown on that Plat entitled "Sabrina Park" recorded among the Land Records of Anne Arundel County, Maryland in Plat Book 5, Page 50, Plat 312; thence from the point of beginning so fixed and running with and binding on a part of said right-of-way line as now surveyed by Development Facilitators, Inc.

1. South 69 degrees 44 minutes 23 seconds East, 30.16 feet to a point on the outline of the whole subdivision as shown on said Plat; thence departing said right-of-way line and running with and binding on a part of said outline
2. South 20 degrees 10 minutes 00 seconds West, 127.97 feet to a stone found; thence
3. South 17 degrees 00 minutes 11 seconds West, 72.15 feet to a point located at the end of the Northerly right-of-way line of Clarence Avenue as shown on said Plat; thence departing said outline and running with and binding on a part of said right-of-way line
4. North 69 degrees 44 minutes 23 seconds West, 34.47 feet to the end of the division line between Lot 37 and the unnumbered Lots of Block K as shown on said Plat; thence departing said right-of-way line and running with and binding on said division line and the division line between Lot 40 and said unnumbered Lots
5. North 20 degrees 15 minutes 37 seconds East, 200.00 feet to the point and place of beginning.

Containing 6,209 square feet, or 0.14 acres of land, more or less.

Being a part of those lands conveyed to John W. Yarborough and Luesther Yarborough by deed dated November 3, 1961 and recorded among the Land Records of Anne Arundel County, Maryland in Liber 1552, Folio 247, also being all those unnumbered Lots shown on Block K of that Plat entitled "Sabrina Park" recorded among the Land Records of Anne Arundel County, Maryland in Plat Book 5, Page 50, Plat 312, and also being all those Lots referred to as "Lots 38-39, Block K" as shown on said Plat.

Tax ID: 3-746-34057100, Tax ID: 3-746- 90230178 and Tax ID: 3-746-34057200.

The Property is believed to consist of vacant land with the addresses of 90 Sabrina Lane, Severna Park, MD 21146; 93 Pineview Avenue, Severna Park, MD 21146; and 90 Clarence Avenue, Severna Park, MD 21146.

The Property will be sold in the entirety.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of Twenty-Five Thousand Dollars (\$25,000.00) for the Property, payable in cash, certified check or other form acceptable to the Trustees, will be required of the purchaser at the time and place of sale. The successful bidder ("Purchaser") will be required to increase the deposit to ten percent (10%) of the bid amount within five (5) calendar days of the date of sale by delivering certified funds to the Trustees in an amount sufficient to bring the total deposit to ten percent (10%) of the bid amount (collectively, the "Deposit"). The balance of the purchase price shall be due at settlement in cash or by certified check together with interest on the unpaid balance of the purchase price at the rate of seven percent (7%) per annum from the date of sale to and including the date of settlement, which settlement shall occur within thirty (30) days following the final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for Anne Arundel County, Maryland, unless said period is extended by the Trustees for good cause shown. Time is of the essence. If ratification or settlement is delayed for any reason, there shall be no abatement of interest. In the event the beneficiary under the Deed of Trust, or an affiliate thereof, is the successful bidder at the sale, such party will not be required to make a Deposit or to pay interest on the unpaid purchase money.

All real estate taxes, assessments, water charges, and other fees relating to the Property and municipal charges owed against the Property which are not extinguished as a matter of law by the foreclosure sale are the responsibility of the Purchaser and shall be paid by the Purchaser at settlement. The cost of all documentary stamps, recordation taxes, transfer taxes, title examination costs, other transfer taxes, and all other costs associated with conveying the Property to the Purchaser shall be the sole responsibility of the Purchaser and shall be paid for by the Purchaser at settlement. At settlement, the Purchaser shall provide all additional information and documentation reasonably requested by the Trustees and/or the Noteholder in order to comply with all applicable anti-money laundering, anti-terrorism or other applicable laws or regulations. The Trustees reserve the right to reject any and all bids, and to extend the time for settlement, at their discretion.

The Property is being sold in an "AS IS" condition and without any warranties or representations of any kind, either express or implied, as to the value, nature, condition or description of the Property or the improvements thereon. The Property is being sold subject to: (a) all existing building and zoning code violations; (b) all existing wetlands; (c) all critical area and wetland violations; (d) all environmental problems, conditions, encroachments and other violations which may exist on or with respect to the Property; (e) all senior liens, encumbrances, easements, conditions, restrictions, agreements, declarations and covenants which are not extinguished as a matter of law; (f) any rights of redemption; (g) such state of facts that an accurate survey or physical inspection of the Property might disclose; (h) all agreements and restrictions of record affecting the Property, if any. The Purchaser is responsible for conducting all of its own due diligence regarding the Property. The Purchaser at the foreclosure sale shall assume the risk of loss for the Property immediately after the sale takes place. It shall be the Purchaser's responsibility to obtain possession of the Property following final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court for Anne Arundel County, Maryland and conveyance of the Property by the Trustees to the Purchaser.

In the event the Purchaser fails to go to settlement as required or fails to deliver the entire Deposit to the Trustees as required herein, in addition to any other legal or equitable remedies available to the Trustees, the Purchaser shall forfeit the entire Deposit and the Trustees may, subject to further order of the court, resell the Property at the Purchaser's sole risk and expense and retain and apply the Deposit to any deficiency in the purchase price sustained by the Trustees and/or the Noteholder, all costs and expenses of both sales, reasonable attorneys' fees, and any other damages sustained by the Trustees and/or the Noteholder as a result of the Purchaser's default, including, without limitation, all incidental damages. In the event a resale of the Property results in a sale in excess of the amount originally bid by the defaulting Purchaser, the defaulting Purchaser waives any and all claims, rights and interest to any such excess amount and shall not be entitled to any distribution whatsoever from the sale proceeds. If the Trustees are unable to convey the Property to the Purchaser as described above for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy at law or in equity shall be limited to a refund of the Deposit, without interest thereon. Upon refund of the Deposit to the Purchaser, the sale shall be void and of no effect, and the Purchaser shall have no further claim against the Trustees, the Noteholder or the Auctioneer conducting the foreclosure sale. The parties' respective rights and obligations regarding the terms of sale and the conduct of the sale shall be governed by and interpreted according to the laws of the State of Maryland.

The information contained herein was obtained from sources deemed to be reliable, but is offered for informational purposes only. The Auctioneer, the Noteholder and the Trustees do not make any representations or warranties with respect to the accuracy of this information.

Michael D. Nord and Hannah C. Bondurant
Substitute Trustees

For further information, contact:

Michael D. Nord Esquire
Gebhardt & Smith LLP
One South Street, Suite 2200
Baltimore, Maryland 21202
Tel: 410-385-5072

Or

Ron West, President
HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, LLC
300 E Joppa Rd, Ste 1103
Towson, Maryland 21286
Tel: 410-769-9797

A181, A316, A311, A183, A425, A426, A461, A463, A508



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Brock and Scott, PLLC
5431 Oleander Drive
Wilmington NC, 28403

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY
KNOWN AS
2313 Crosslanes Way
Odenton, MD 21113

Under and by virtue of the power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust to ROBERT E. TAYLOR, JR., Trustee(s), dated April 14, 2023, and recorded among the Land Records of ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY, MARYLAND in Liber 39594 , folio 319 , the holder of the indebtedness secured by this Deed of Trust having appointed the undersigned Substitute Trustees, by instrument duly recorded among the aforesaid Land Records, default having occurred under the terms thereof, and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction at THE ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT 8 CHURCH CIR, ANNAPOLIS, MD 21401 ON,

SEPTEMBER 30, 2026 at 10:00 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY, MD and more fully described in the above-referenced Deed of Trust Tax ID# - 04-571-90097755.

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to all conditions, liens, restrictions and agreements of record affecting same including any condominium and of HOA assessments pursuant to Md Real Property Article 11-110.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$60,000.00 payable in certified check or by a cashier's check will be required from purchaser at time of sale, balance in immediately available funds upon final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court of ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY, MARYLAND interest to be paid at the rate of 6.625 % on unpaid purchase money from date of sale to date of settlement. The secured party herein, if a bidder, shall not be required to post a deposit. Third party purchaser (excluding the secured party) will be required to complete full settlement of the purchase of the property within TEN (10) CALENDAR DAYS of the ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court otherwise the purchaser's deposit shall be forfeited and the property will be resold at the risk and expense, of the defaulting purchaser. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser.

Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public/private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground rent, and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes hall be paid by purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale.

Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. If the sale is rescinded or not ratified for any reason, including post sale lender audit, or a resale is to take place for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to the refund of the aforementioned deposit. The Substitute Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if the ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the purchasers sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of their deposit, without interest.

The purchaser waives all rights and claims against the Substitute Trustees whether known or unknown. These provisions shall survive settlement Upon refund of the deposit, this sale shall be void and of no effect, and the purchaser shall have no further claim against the Substitute Trustees. The sale is subject to post-sale review of the status of the loan and that if any agreement to cancel the sale was entered into by the lender and borrower prior to the sale then the sale is void and the purchaser's deposit shall be refunded without interest. Additional terms and conditions, if applicable, may be announced at the time and date of sale.

If this transaction is subject to the FinCEN Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule ("RRE") issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule must be obtained provided to the Reporting Person, as defined in RRE Rule, prior to closing. File No. (25-35001)

BRENNAN FERGUSON, JOHN C. HANRAHAN,
JEREMY B. WILKINS, AMANDA DRISCOLE,
ROBERT OLIVERI, AND PAUL HEINMULLER ,
Substitute Trustees

A181, A316, A311, A183, A425, A426, A461, A463, A508



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5431 Oleander Drive
Wilmington NC, 28403

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY
KNOWN AS
502 Sugarbush Cir
Frederick, MD 21703

Under and by virtue of the power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust to JOHN BURSON, ESQ., Trustee(s), dated July 18, 2014, and recorded among the Land Records of FREDERICK COUNTY, MARYLAND in Liber 10174 , folio 201 , the holder of the indebtedness secured by this Deed of Trust having appointed the undersigned Substitute Trustees, by instrument duly recorded among the aforesaid Land Records, default having occurred under the terms thereof, and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction at THE FREDERICK COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT 100 W. PATRICK ST, FREDERICK, MD 21701 ON,

SEPTEMBER 23, 2026 at 9:30 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in FREDERICK COUNTY, MD and more fully described in the above-referenced Deed of Trust Tax ID# - 02-160684.

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to all conditions, liens, restrictions and agreements of record affecting same including any condominium and of HOA assessments pursuant to Md Real Property Article 11-110.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$13,000.00 payable in certified check or by a cashier's check will be required from purchaser at time of sale, balance in immediately available funds upon final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court of FREDERICK COUNTY, MARYLAND interest to be paid at the rate of 4.875 % on unpaid purchase money from date of sale to date of settlement. The secured party herein, if a bidder, shall not be required to post a deposit. Third party purchaser (excluding the secured party) will be required to complete full settlement of the purchase of the property within TEN (10) CALENDAR DAYS of the ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court otherwise the purchaser's deposit shall be forfeited and the property will be resold at the risk and expense, of the defaulting purchaser. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser.

Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public/private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground rent, and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes hall be paid by purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale.

Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. If the sale is rescinded or not ratified for any reason, including post sale lender audit, or a resale is to take place for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to the refund of the aforementioned deposit. The Substitute Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if the ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the purchasers sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of their deposit, without interest.

The purchaser waives all rights and claims against the Substitute Trustees whether known or unknown. These provisions shall survive settlement Upon refund of the deposit, this sale shall be void and of no effect, and the purchaser shall have no further claim against the Substitute Trustees. The sale is subject to post-sale review of the status of the loan and that if any agreement to cancel the sale was entered into by the lender and borrower prior to the sale then the sale is void and the purchaser's deposit shall be refunded without interest. Additional terms and conditions, if applicable, may be announced at the time and date of sale.

If this transaction is subject to the FinCEN Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule ("RRE") issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule must be obtained provided to the Reporting Person, as defined in RRE Rule, prior to closing. File No. (26-06377)

BRENNAN FERGUSON, JOHN C. HANRAHAN,
JEREMY B. WILKINS, AMANDA DRISCOLE,
ROBERT OLIVERI, AND PAUL HEINMULLER ,
Substitute Trustees



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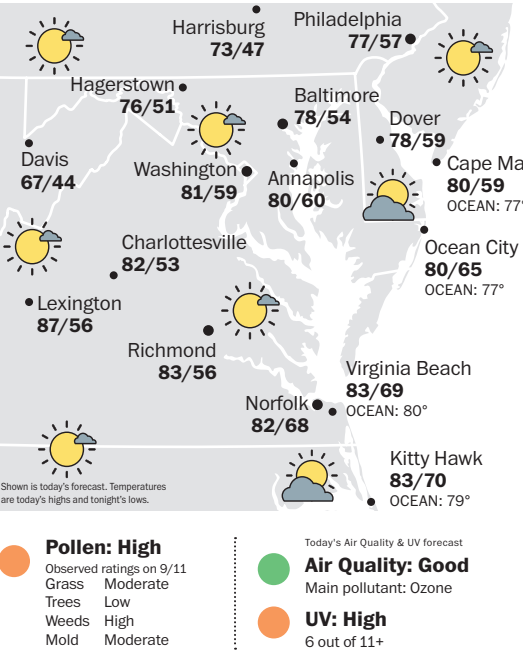
THE WEATHER

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It's not fall just yet ...

... but the next couple of days will feel a lot more pumpkiny. Today should be sunny and blissfully seasonal, with highs around 80 throughout the region. Keep an eye on your hat, though; northerly breezes can produce gusts around 20 mph, especially in the early part of the day, with stronger winds near the Chesapeake Bay. A starry night is on tap this evening as winds drop and the temperatures follow suit, with lows in the upper 50s in urban areas but closer to 50 in the northern and western reaches. A good night to open those windows.

REGION TODAY



Blue Ridge: Shenandoah National Park: Today, less humid, sun, some clouds. High 78. Winds north 4–8 mph. Tonight, clear, cooler. Low 50. Winds north–northeast 3–6 mph. • *Great Smoky Mtns.* National Park: Today, mostly sunny, less humid. High 73. Winds north–northeast 4–8 mph. Tonight, clear. Low 63. Winds southeast 4–8 mph.

Atlantic beaches: Ocean City, MD: Today, breezy this morning, mostly sunny, less humid. High 80. Winds north–northwest 10–20 mph. Tonight, clear. Low 65. • *Virginia Beach:* Today, partly sunny, breezy, less humid. High 83. Winds north 10–20 mph. Tonight, breezy at times this evening, mainly clear. Low 69.

Waterways: Upper Potomac River: Today, mostly sunny. Wind north–northwest 6–12 knots. Waves 1–3 feet. Visibility clear to the horizon. • Lower Potomac and Chesapeake Bay: Today, partly sunny. Wind north 8–16 knots. Waves 1–3 feet on the Lower Potomac; 4–7 feet on the Chesapeake Bay. • River Stages: The stage at Little Falls will be around 2.80 feet today, rising to 2.90 Tuesday. Flood stage at Little Falls is 10 feet.

Today's tides (Shown are High tides in Bold and low tides.)			
Washington	5:45 a.m.	10:59 a.m.	5:48 p.m. 11:17 p.m.
Annapolis	2:10 a.m.	7:42 a.m.	2:02 p.m. 8:45 p.m.
Ocean City	4:03 a.m.	10:18 a.m.	4:41 p.m. 10:36 p.m.
Norfolk	6:01 a.m.	12:27 p.m.	6:47 p.m. none
Point Lookout	3:51 a.m.	10:06 a.m.	4:35 p.m. 11:26 p.m.

AccuWeather FORECAST

Today	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
Sunshine	Partly sunny	Mostly sunny	Sunny intervals; warm	Humid with a shower	Humid
81° 59°	79° 64°	84° 65°	89° 68°	85° 67°	81° 68°
REALFEEL®: 82°	REALFEEL®: 82°	REALFEEL®: 86°	REALFEEL®: 90°	REALFEEL®: 88°	REALFEEL®: 81°
CHANCE PRECIP: 0%	CHANCE PRECIP: 0%	CHANCE PRECIP: 5%	CHANCE PRECIP: 25%	CHANCE PRECIP: 55%	CHANCE PRECIP: 20%
WIND: NNW 8–16 mph	WIND: ESE 6–12 mph	WIND: S 6–12 mph	WIND: S 6–12 mph	WIND: NNE 4–8 mph	WIND: ENE 6–12 mph
HUMIDITY: Moderate	HUMIDITY: Moderate	HUMIDITY: High	HUMIDITY: High	HUMIDITY: High	HUMIDITY: High

NATION TODAY

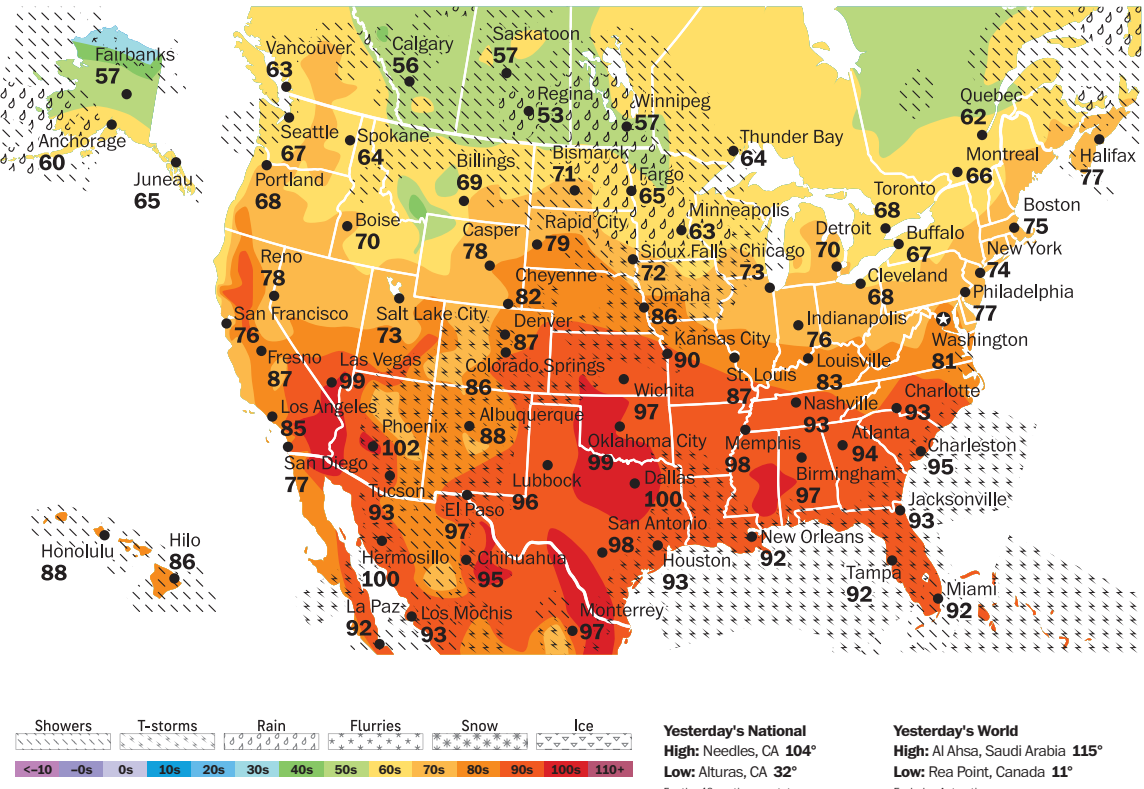




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WELL+BEING

A chance to bare one's sole in nature

Unusual Ariz. park touts benefits of going barefoot. The science is muddy.

BY JULIA SULLIVAN

When I pulled up to the Barefoot Trail, a “grounding park” outside Flagstaff, Arizona, at 9:30 a.m. on a sunny Sunday in August, the parking lot was already packed. A few groups of families were ahead of me in line to purchase a ticket. I cringed — nothing like attempting to connect with nature with hordes of people around. Luckily, the attentive staff at the front noticed I had already purchased a single adult ticket, so they gave me their spiel about using the park and encouraged me to go off on my own before the rush.

The park advertises itself as a “manicured, 1-mile trail through dirt, mud, water, sand, stone, and rocks.” The whole point is to walk it sans shoes, which allows you to take advantage of the supposed benefits of “grounding,” sometimes known as “earthing.” This growing health and wellness trend is based on the idea that touching bare skin to the soil, grass or sand beneath you can yield a wide array of health benefits, from decreased inflammation to better sleep to a reduction in pain.

As someone who regularly wears house slippers just to stroll around my own apartment, the concept of walking around barefoot in public, apart from a

SEE BAREFOOT ON D6

MEDICAL MYSTERIES

First her back ached. Then her belly swelled.

Doctors said she had a benign tumor. But after treatment, her pain continued.

BY DAVID WAHLBERG

When her back began to ache, Maria Morales attributed the soreness to her job as a therapist for children with autism, where she often moved around and sat in “little kid” chairs.

Then after a week with this pain, the 26-year-old from Miami started to feel like she had the flu, but a test for influenza was negative. The next day, she woke up with abdominal pain. At work, it seemed like her belly kept growing. “I couldn’t button my pants,” she said.

She went home, where later that day her boyfriend checked on her. “He put pressure on my stomach, and I yelled out in pain,” she said.

He took her to the emergency room, where a scan showed a mass on her right kidney surrounded by a pool of blood. Doctors said she had an angiomyolipoma, a benign tumor that is more common in women than in men. After undergoing a procedure to stop the bleeding, she was

SEE MEDICAL MYSTERIES ON D6

WELL+BEING

How focusing your attention may fight inflammation

BY RICHARD SIMA

When you feel pain or an itch, you might try to ignore it.

But a fascinating new study has found that this may actually make your inflammation worse in certain situations.

The study, published in the journal *Nature Human Behaviour*, suggests that our brain and attention may change how our immune system responds to inflammation. When people tried to distract themselves from an itch, it caused the inflammation — as measured by redness and swelling of the skin — to grow larger in size and last longer than if they focused their attention on it.

The research adds to growing evidence that the brain and the immune system — long thought to be relatively separate and distinct from each other — actually have an intimate relationship. Dysfunctional immune activity and inflammation have been linked to several psychiatric and neurological disorders, including schizophrenia, depression, long covid and dementia. In fact, recent research has found that our brains may trigger an immune response even from seeing someone who looks as though they might have an infectious condition.

“The two systems are constantly in communication,” said Jonathan Kipnis, a professor of pathology and immunology at Washington University in St. Louis who studies neuroimmune interactions.

SEE BRAIN MATTERS ON D5

ASK A DOCTOR

Know when it’s worth listening to the butterflies in your stomach. D3



HEART

This popular test may not be useful for many, a new study shows. D2

Why you shouldn’t rely on willpower alone, even if you’re Michael Phelps

BY MAGGIE PENMAN

Swimmer Michael Phelps is famous for his work ethic, his incredible drive to succeed and his unusual genetic makeup. He’s won more Olympic medals than any other athlete, most of them gold.

But if you widen the aperture, you see his coach, Bob Bowman, giving him the confidence to succeed. You see his mother, Debbie Phelps, finding swimming as an outlet for her son’s endless energy. And it didn’t hurt that Phelps happened to grow up 10 minutes from one of the best training centers in the country, the North Baltimore Aquatic Club.

“I spent the first half of my career studying individual effort and its importance to success,” said psychologist Angela Duckworth. “And I think that is important, but it’s not everything.”

Duckworth, a professor at the University of Pennsylvania, is best known for her book on “grit” — which she defines as passion and perseverance toward long-term goals. She pointed to Phelps as an example of grit because of his extreme dedication to his sport. But he — and everyone else who finds success — had to be in the right situation with the right people for that effort to pay off.

In her new book, “Situated: Find the People and Places That Bring Out Your Best,” Duckworth explains the research on what it takes to reach our goals, and why we shouldn’t try to muscle through challenges with willpower alone. Here’s what she said to do instead.

Change your situation

It may not be possible to change everything about your circumstances, but Duckworth



Michael Phelps’s extreme dedication and unusual genetic makeup both contributed to his success. But there were other factors at play.

said we often don’t realize how much *is* within our control.

For example, in a new survey from Pew, more than half of American adults say they spend too much time on their phones. The number is even higher for younger adults. Many respondents have tried to cut back with little success.

Duckworth said many people make New Year’s resolutions to spend less time on their phone, but continue to charge their phones next to their bed (as

nearly 8 in 10 Americans do, according to a survey from YouGov in 2025). If your plan is to essentially use willpower to look at your phone less, it probably won’t work.

“What my research shows is that it’s far more effective and also far less exhausting to change the situation,” Duckworth said.

So if you want to spend less time on your phone, charge it in another room. If you want to exercise in the morning, put your workout clothes next to your bed.

If you want to eat less of a certain type of food, don’t keep it easily within reach.

“Essentially, use physical distance to create psychological distance,” Duckworth said. “Don’t rely on mental force of will.”

In Duckworth’s research, young adults who were encouraged to change their situation were more successful at reaching a goal than those who only used self-discipline — and they experienced less temptation in the process.

Phone a friend

Looking at some of the world’s most successful people, from Phelps to Taylor Swift, she said everyone needs help from peers, mentors and friends to stay motivated and accountable.

In her book, Duckworth examines the success of a start-up incubator that was behind companies like Dropbox, Airbnb and Reddit. Unlike some other venture capital firms, it funded companies in groups so the founders had support and guidance.

“We really need a feeling like we’re doing things in a group,” Duckworth said.

People are more likely to reach goals when they work together, she said, explaining that people enjoy being asked for help more than we might think.

Her daughters live near each other and have started going to the gym together.

“You kind of have to show up for the other person,” Duckworth said. “But also it makes it more fun.”

Get expert guidance

Duckworth said the need for outside support also applies to problems, even though it can be harder to ask for help. She and her husband hit a rocky period in their marriage, she said, and it wasn’t until they “called in the cavalry” that things got better, with the support of family, friends and therapy.

“It was humbling for me to admit that I couldn’t work it out,” Duckworth said. “We overcame this strong sense that asking for help was like an admission of failure.”

That experience didn’t just change her marriage. It also changed the way both she and her husband approached their work.

Duckworth decided she wouldn’t do research alone anymore; she instead works with other scientists as collaborators. And her husband, the president of his real estate company, put together an advisory board of trusted mentors to help him make better decisions.

“Find ways to make your situation your ally. And don’t be ashamed of it,” Duckworth said. “I think that to me is the perspective shift that has personally made a difference.”

WELL+BEING

Calcium testing for heart health may have limited value for many, study finds

BY ERICA SLOAN

It’s important to do certain regular screenings for heart health and talk with your doctor about your risk for heart disease — it remains the number-one killer of both men and women in the United States. But one increasingly popular test, which checks for plaque in the arteries feeding the heart, may not provide much value for many people, new research shows.

Called a coronary artery calcium (CAC) scan, the test involves a computed tomography (CT) scan of the chest and offers a prediction of how likely you are to have a cardiac event — such as a heart attack or stroke — within the next few years. A score of zero suggests no evidence of plaque and low risk of heart disease; anything above that reflects some degree of disease, with higher scores (above 100) pointing to more established disease and elevated risk of a heart event.

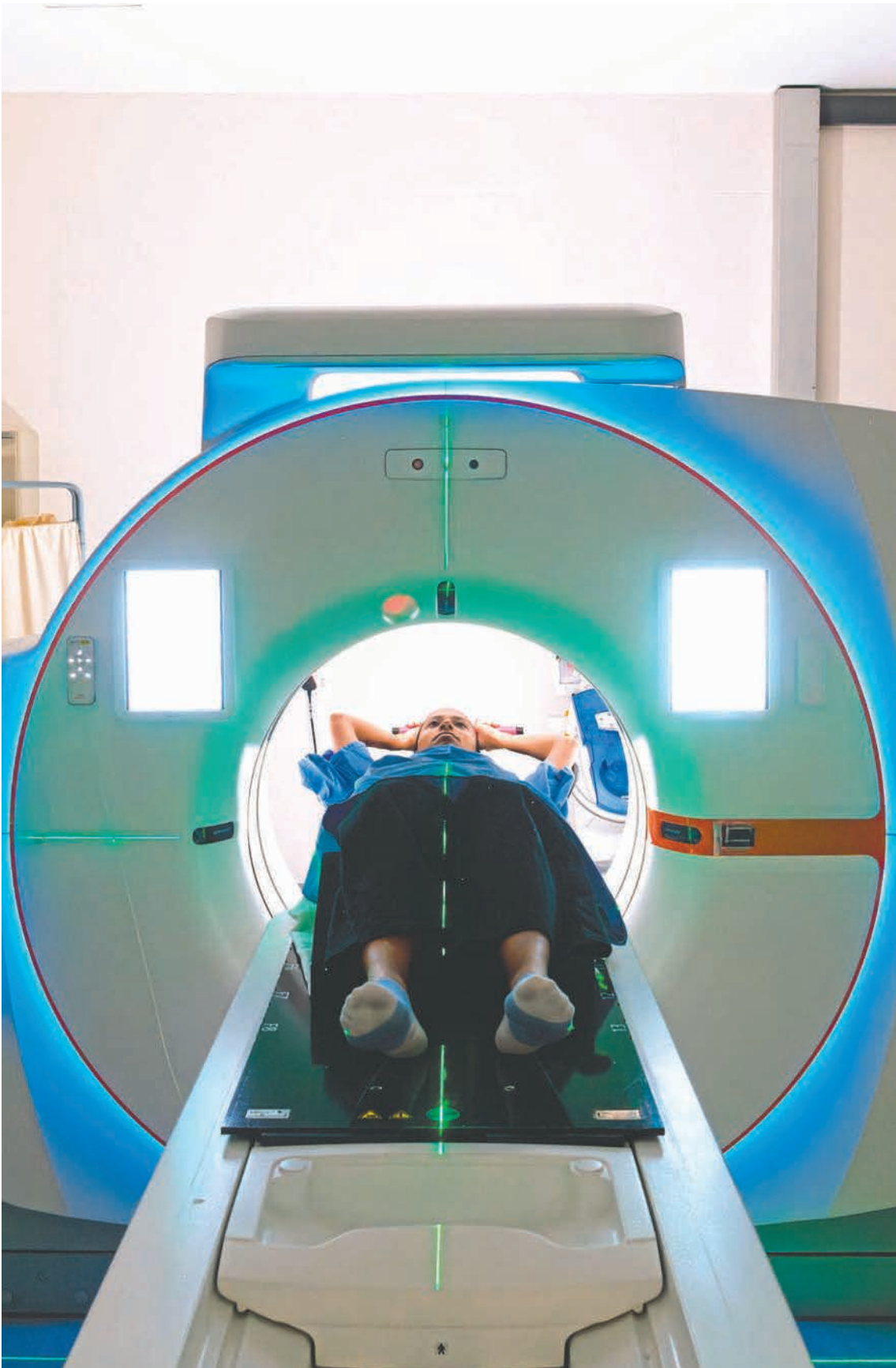
It turns out, however, that most people can glean the same information simply from using the American Heart Association’s risk calculator PREVENT, which accounts for many key factors influencing heart disease risk, including sex, age, blood pressure, cholesterol, whether you have diabetes, whether you smoke and even a measure of kidney function.

The new study, published in JAMA, found that a PREVENT estimate, on its own, could accurately predict who would go on to have a heart event — with one exception. Adding in a calcium score did help better classify the people labeled “borderline” or “intermediate” by PREVENT, or those with a 3 to 9 percent risk of heart disease within 10 years.

It’s a timely moment to weigh the utility of risk-prediction tools. On one hand, the PREVENT calculator is only just making its way into clinical practice — it was added to blood pressure and cholesterol guidelines in the past year. On the other hand, “the use of calcium scores has been exploding” as CAC scans have become more affordable and accessible, said Nilay Shah, senior author on the study and assistant professor of medicine in the cardiology division at Northwestern University Feinberg School of Medicine.

Who can benefit from a CAC scan

In the study, more than 6,000 people aged 45 to 79 received both a PREVENT estimate and a calcium score. The researchers then followed them for 10 years to determine the accuracy of these tools in forecasting who would go on to have a heart attack or stroke. Across the group, factoring in calcium scores barely made a dif-



An increasingly popular test known as a CAC scan checks for arterial plaque. It can help those at intermediate risk of heart disease but may provide little insight for others.

ference; most people were correctly classified based on PREVENT score alone.

But when the researchers looked at just the people deemed borderline risk by PREVENT, they found that considering their calcium scores correctly reclassified most of them to a high- or low-risk category.

The results suggest a CAC score is best used as a “tiebreaker” for people in middle-risk groups for heart disease, Shah said, who may

be unsure whether they should start a cholesterol-lowering medication such as a statin. Evidence of plaque (a CAC score above zero) would suggest starting medication, whereas a CAC score of zero would indicate they can hold off on the medication for now. This approach is in line with the most recent cholesterol guidelines released jointly in March by several medical organizations including the American College of Cardiology and the American Heart Association,

which recommend CAC scans primarily to help guide therapy decisions in middle-risk groups.

“I don’t look at this as a negative study for CAC scores,” said Socrates Kakoulides, cardiologist and chief imaging officer of Baptist Health Heart & Vascular Care, part of Baptist Health South Florida. “What I do think is this really helps us refine which patients are going to get a CAC and are going to benefit from a CAC.”

(Kakoulides was not involved in the study.)

The reason a CAC scan might show plaque in some people at borderline or intermediate risk but not in others is probably because of “risk-enhancing factors” that the PREVENT tool doesn’t account for, Shah explained. These are specific factors that we know are related to heart-disease risk but that we can’t quite quantify, he said, such as having a strong family history of heart disease or having experienced pregnancy-related conditions such as preeclampsia or gestational diabetes. Having a high level of a type of cholesterol called lipoprotein(a) is another factor that isn’t included in PREVENT, Kakoulides said, but could result in a high CAC score.

Why most people at high or low risk for heart disease may not need a CAC scan

The study suggests that for many people, a CAC scan isn’t necessary because the PREVENT calculator generally sorts people into the right risk bucket. In these cases, a CAC score would just confirm what you already know and wouldn’t change the course of treatment, Kakoulides explained. If someone is at high risk, their CAC scan will very likely show plaque; if someone is at low risk, it’ll almost definitely be clear. Per the guidelines, those at high risk would still wind up starting a statin, while those at low risk would generally defer.

That means that in plenty of people with established high or low risk for heart disease, a scan may just amount to unnecessary radiation and wasted time and money — versus offering any actionable information.

In the past, a CAC scan was a more broadly useful tool because the older risk-calculation models generally overestimated risk, Kakoulides said. But the PREVENT tool — which was developed on a more diverse population than previous tools, including several million people from all backgrounds — is quite accurate, Shah said, creating less reason for people to get a CAC scan.

That said, this is one study and reflects a general guideline, not a rule. There might be scenarios in which people at high or low risk of heart disease could still find utility in a CAC score.

For instance, a CAC scan can help determine if a person deemed high-risk is actually at *very* high risk, “a group for whom we would recommend adding additional [medication] such as aspirin,” Kakoulides said. There’s a difference, he pointed out, between a CAC score of 70 and of 400, for example; in both people, a statin makes sense, but the latter score suggests the need for even more intervention.

There could also be certain

low-risk people, for instance those with a strong family history of heart disease, for whom a CAC scan might be sensible, Shah noted. If you’re deemed low-risk by PREVENT but still concerned about your heart health, Shah suggested having a conversation with your primary care doctor — rather than just going to get a CAC scan. That way, you can get a better understanding of what you might learn from a CAC score and the likelihood that this information ends up being valuable.

How to learn about, and lower, your risk of heart disease

It’s important to start a conversation with your doctor about risk, if you haven’t already. The recent cholesterol guidelines advise clinicians to use the PREVENT calculator to estimate risk in all patients aged 30 to 79. If you fall in this group, you can also complete the online PREVENT calculator yourself — it requires inputs such as cholesterol and blood pressure, which you can get at your next physical if you haven’t had these numbers checked recently.

Regardless of your result, discuss it with your doctor. If you’re at borderline or intermediate risk, it’s worth asking about a CAC scan to get a better understanding of what to do next. If you’re at high risk, there’s a good chance your doctor will recommend starting a lipid-lowering medication and possibly additional treatments.

Your score might also be helpful motivation to engage in heart-healthy behaviors such as eating a nutritious diet, getting plenty of physical activity, sleeping well and not smoking. These sometimes get “short shrift” in the guidelines because the most pressing issue for doctors is determining who needs to be started on medication and will get the most benefit from it, Kakoulides said. But that doesn’t negate the importance of these lifestyle interventions for everyone — even those at low risk. As Shah put it, “There really is no risk group that does not benefit from improving the quality of their day-to-day behaviors.”

HEALTH & SCIENCE

Editor: Jay Wang • Art director: Twila Waddy • Photo editor: Maya Valentine • Copy editor: Mike Cirelli • Advertising information: Ron Ulrich, 202-334-5289, ronald.ulrich@washpost.com • To contact us: Email: health-science@washpost.com; Mail: The Washington Post, Health, 1301 K St. NW, Washington, D.C. 20071

Understanding what causes ‘gut feelings’ can help you decide when to trust them



Ask A Doctor

TRISHA PASRICHA

like them, but something feels off. It’s hard to pinpoint what it is, but you just get a bad feeling inside. We often call this sensation a “gut feeling,” and we’ve been conditioned to trust it — sometimes blindly.

But “gut feelings” are simply neurochemical signals that lead to a change in your stomach’s electrical rhythm — and not, in fact, an oracle. I know this because I’ve spent my career studying the gut-brain connection, and my discovery elucidating part of this pathway got an asteroid named after me.

Statistically speaking, gut feelings aren’t necessarily right. Researchers have found that people who make quick judgments based on gut feelings more often misjudge the emotions of others — compared to people who employ a systematic way of thinking. Studies evaluating emergency medicine physicians — who constantly make rapid life-or-death decisions — have found that relying on gut feelings led to the right diagnosis in only about 54 percent of cases.

And the funny thing is, if you’ve made a decision based on a gut feeling, scientists have found you actually may be more likely to dig in your heels about your choice later.

Because of this, I never treat gut feelings like a sign from above. When I get one, I pause, gather more information and think rationally about what to do next. Even if this takes a bit more time, it can yield more accurate information — both when I’m seeing patients and in my personal life.

Behind the scenes of a ‘gut feeling’

Certain triggers in our daily lives — stress, novelty, even prior memories — cause parts of

Q: I often get strong gut feelings when I meet a new person. Where do these come from — and are they a real thing?

A: You meet someone at a party and want to



WASHINGTON POST ILLUSTRATION; ISTOCK

our brain — including the amygdala, the emotional processing hub — to release a molecule called corticotropin-releasing hormone. This kicks off a signaling cascade through the vagus nerve, the main communication highway between the gut and the brain, and that message grinds the stomach to a rapid halt.

By the way, those same signals also trigger spasms in the colon — which is why you may feel queasy but also urgently have to use the bathroom right before your turn at karaoke.

Think of it as a stop sign

Here’s where things get really fascinating: The butterflies you feel on an exciting first date are, on a molecular level, at least partly the same phenomenon as when you’re caught telling a lie and you feel your stomach tying itself into a knot.

Yet one of them feels wonderful and urges you to charge ahead — while the other makes you ill and want to disappear.

Why? The difference is context. In both scenarios, you immediately grasp the external stakes and

environment. But not every gut feeling comes with such clarity — at least at first. Sometimes the signal is triggered by something subconscious — like a memory, a gesture that reminds you of someone, or a seemingly ordinary object in the room that once held a special meaning.

That’s the risk of treating a gut feeling like an oracle: You don’t always know what it is actually responding to. The feeling itself is not “good” or “bad” despite how we often label them.

Think of a gut feeling as a stop sign, not a traffic ticket. It’s not telling you that you’ve done

something wrong. It’s telling you to slow down and look around before you proceed. And yes, sometimes when you stop, you may discover that a bus is barreling right at you. But often, you won’t — and you couldn’t have known that from the feeling alone.

Calm the gut and think clearly

So what can you do if you get a gut feeling but you can’t focus because your stomach is doing somersaults?

Luckily, you can lean into the physiology. Your stomach’s

reaction is dependent on signals traveling through the vagus nerve. So you can use a vagal maneuver — simple actions that engage the vagus nerve — to interrupt it: Try slow breathing with a focus on extending the exhale, for instance, or place a bag of ice cubes or frozen veggies over your face as you hold your breath for about 15 to 30 seconds. Not only will you calm a racing heart, but you’ll help restore the regular rhythm of your gut as well.

Earlier in my career, I sometimes felt ill right before I went live on television. These maneuvers helped me stay sharp when I couldn’t afford to lose focus.

Your gut feeling can also be right

None of this means you should ignore a gut feeling when it shows up — quite the opposite. I often hear from patients that a persistent, nagging sense that something wasn’t adding up was what pushed them to ask for another opinion, request another test or refuse to let a symptom go unexplained. Sometimes, that instinct turns out to be lifesaving. When it is, it’s tempting to conclude that your “gut knew.”

But it’s what you did after experiencing a gut feeling that helped. It was what you chose to do after that pause — the follow-up questions, the digging for more detail — that actually led to the outcome.

We often remember the gut feelings that had a vivid payoff. We don’t remember the countless times a gut feeling flagged nothing at all.

What I want my patients to know

The physiological explanation I’ve described above is one specific pathway. Not every sensation we call a gut feeling necessarily runs through this exact circuit, and psychologists studying intuition more broadly may not be measuring these changes simultaneously.

But the throughline is similar regardless: The body registers something before the mind can articulate it, and much of this will be carried by the vagus nerve.

How to search for an online therapist, according to a mental health expert

BY SHARI HARDING
The Conversation

As a mental health nurse practitioner who sees patients both in person and via telehealth, I’m often struck by just how many of my patients would not have received any mental health treatment before the covid-19 pandemic: the stay-at-home mother without any child care; the college student on a rural campus, many miles from home or a clinic; the middle-aged man who is finally ready for help — but not ready to be seen by a neighbor in the waiting room.

During the pandemic, access to remote mental health care sprouted up almost overnight. In 2020, Medicare, a federal health insurance program for seniors and people with disabilities, began covering online telemental health, and most state Medicaid programs and private insurers soon followed.

Fewer than 2 percent of people getting mental health treatment received such care online in 2019, but now about half receive at least some of their mental health care this way.

Undoubtedly, this shift has brought many benefits. Online mental health visits literally meet you where you are — whether in the comfort of your home, a parked car or a quiet space on your break at work. Virtual care offers convenience, ease and privacy.

But with so many choices, it can be hard to decide how to start accessing mental health care online. Many patients get stuck trying to find clinicians who can treat their concerns, and fit their schedule and budget. But finding an online clinician who fits your needs doesn’t have to be overwhelming.

Understand your goals

Whether you are seeking care online or in person, it helps to define what’s troubling you and what you would like to change. One approach is to write down the symptoms, such as emotions or behaviors, you are experiencing. For example, many people seek treatment for anxiety or mood changes, especially if these feelings are interfering with their daily lives.



ISTOCK

It can take a few sessions to get comfortable talking to a clinician through a screen about issues often kept private.

You should be able to find online practices for any type of clinician you would see in person, such as psychologists, psychiatric nurse practitioners or clinical nurse specialists, psychiatrists, social workers or other licensed counselors.

Consider whether you would prefer engaging in talk therapy, such as cognitive behavioral therapy, exploring the use of medication or both. This will help point you to the type of clinician who could best help you.

But don’t worry too much if you’re not sure. Any clinician you see will be able to evaluate your concerns and help direct you to the best treatment plan. For example, a therapist who does not prescribe medication still will be able to let you know whether you should consider medication, and point you to an advanced-practice nurse or psychiatrist who can prescribe it.

Finding a good fit

Clinicians typically list the types of problems they treat and whether they offer therapy, medication or both. They may also have a profile — either through their practice or on a site such as Psychology Today’s provider listing — outlining their background, treatment style, as well as their license and qualifications.

Services such as life coaching are different from therapy but

also are often found online. Life coaches are not licensed or regulated in the same way as mental health clinicians. If you are seeking formal mental health treatment, you should ensure you are seeing a licensed clinician.

If you plan to use insurance, confirm that the clinician you chose accepts your specific insurance plan. Before your first appointment, make sure to clarify any policies related to co-pays, missed visits and communication between visits, including what to do if you have an urgent or after-hours concern.

If the clinician doesn’t seem to have clear policies, you may find yourself with surprise bills or a lapse in treatment when you need it most.

Your first online session

Talking to a clinician through a screen about things that are often kept highly private can take a little getting used to. Don’t worry if it takes a few meetings to get comfortable with it.

Ensuring that you have a private and comfortable space for your visit can help. These health appointments should be as secure and private as in-person visits. You and the clinician should both be in quiet and private areas, away from other people.

Your appointment is your time to focus on you — a good mental

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‘What we think matters’: Why trying to ignore an itch may make it worse

BRAIN MATTERS FROM DI

The “brain is involved in the individual’s survival, and the immune system is involved in survival, and that’s what they do. So of course they talk to each other.”

In other words, the findings suggest that “what we think matters,” said Liron Rozenkrantz, a principal investigator in the Azrieli Faculty of Medicine of Bar-Ilan University in Israel and the study’s senior author.

Distraction led to more inflammation

In a clever set of experiments, Rozenkrantz and her colleagues caused inflammation on the forearms of 57 people — akin to “a bad mosquito bite,” she said — using a drop of histamine and the prick of a needle. Histamine is a chemical used by immune cells that triggers a reliable inflammatory response — that familiar itching, swelling and redness that anyone with an allergic reaction or mosquito bite knows well.

In one experiment, researchers told people to stare at a screen and either distract themselves with a cognitive task on the screen or focus their attention internally on the sensations at the inflamed site (but without looking at it or touching it). Everything else stayed the same.

Crucially, the same people did the experiment twice, once with each condition.

When people directed their attention to the sensations of their inflamed skin, both the swelling and redness shrank more. By contrast, when the same people distracted themselves, 90 percent of them had more inflammation, with swelling and redness that were about 50 percent greater.

Paying attention to the inflammation also made it recover faster. After 20 minutes, almost 90 percent of people who paid attention had their swelling stabilize or diminish. When they were distracted, just 46 percent had improved inflammation.

These results suggest the extra input from the brain could be helping the immune system better regulate the inflammatory response.

"It was striking to see the consistency of the effect and the fact that it was displayed across the vast majority of participants,"

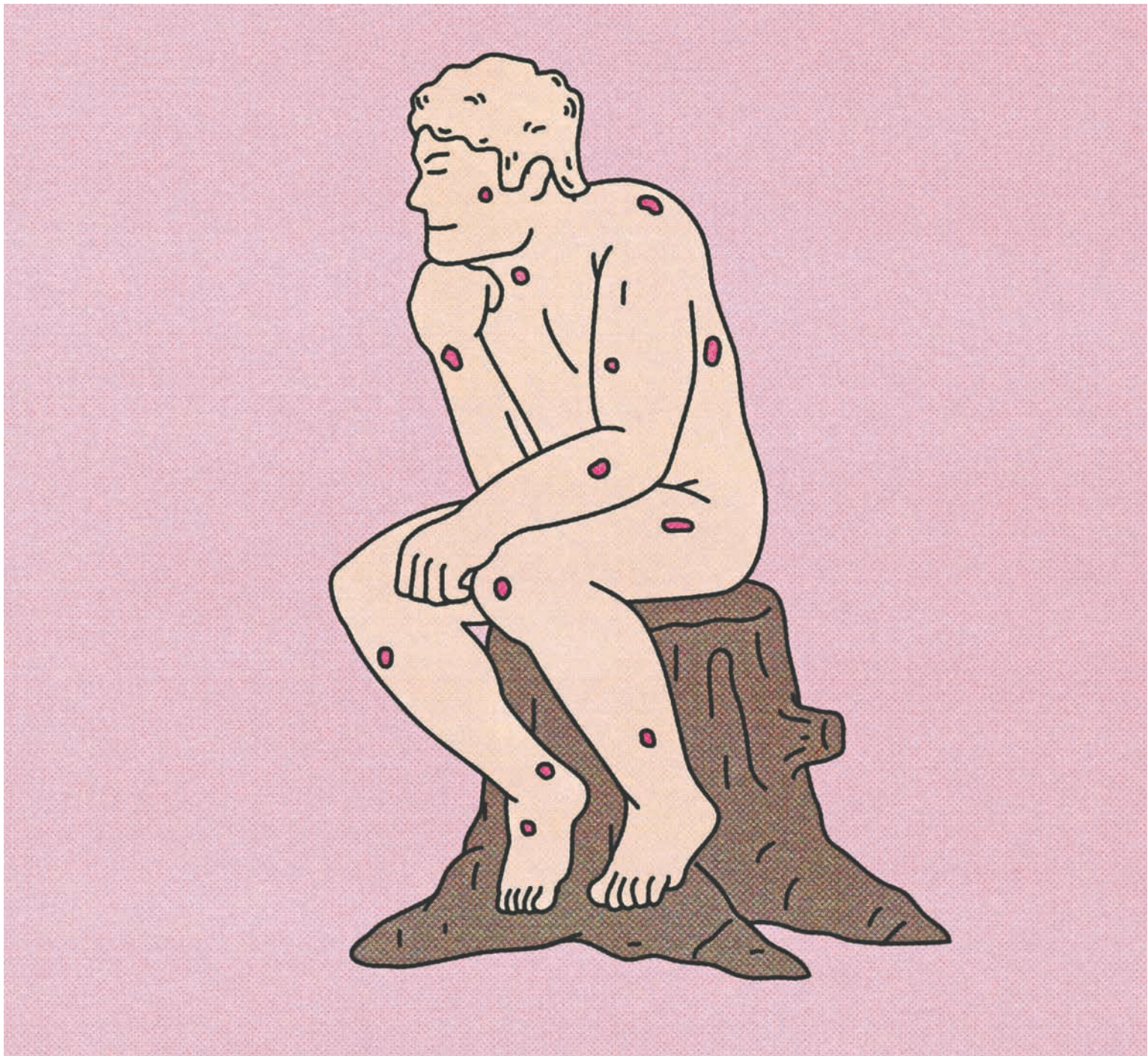


ILLUSTRATION BY GEORGE WYLESOL/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Rozenkrantz said.

The link between inflammation and the brain

There are at least two ways that the brain regulates inflammation, though Rozenkrantz said the mechanisms are not completely understood.

First, the inflamed sensations themselves seem to play a role. In a follow-up experiment, researchers covered people's skin with

lidocaine, a local anesthetic, after administering the histamine. With the sensations dulled, paying attention to the inflammation had a smaller effect on the itch — compared with the experiment without numbing cream. But the results were still better than distracting.

“By thinking about ‘This inflammation is hurting me,’ you’re actually ramping up the input of the inflammation to the nervous

system, which in turn may be ramping up the output to turn it off," said Kevin Tracey, president and chief executive of the Feinstein Institutes for Medical Research.

The study also showed that when people paid attention to the inflamed site, they had more heart rate variability, a widely used proxy for increased parasympathetic activation — less “fight-or-flight” stress response

and more “rest-and-digest” — and activity from the vagus nerve. The vagus nerve — which connects the brain to essential organs via 200,000 nerve fibers down either side of your neck — reduces inflammation when stimulated, Tracey discovered in earlier research.

"It's a very reasonable hypothesis now that the stimulation of the vagus nerve somehow contributes to the decreased inflamma-

tion in the skin of the arm" in this experiment, said Tracey, who wrote "The Great Nerve: The New Science of the Vagus Nerve and How to Harness Its Healing Reflexes."

Could attention help with chronic inflammation?

There are many remaining questions about the brain and immune system, including whether this study's results mean anything clinically.

It's not clear whether the brain was controlling the immune system because the study didn't directly test for inflammatory cells or molecules, said Kipnis, who was not involved in the study but described it as done "really, really well."

Also, the study tested the effect of attention on short-lived inflammation when there was no pathogen present to fight. In follow-up research, Rozenkrantz will look at how attention changes our body's response when it comes to chronic inflammation or fighting a pathogen.

After all, inflammation is not always bad.

"Inflammation is a good thing. It's adaptive. We need it," Rozenkrantz said. "It helps the tissue heal and sort of be separated from the other tissue and get the treatment it needs. But it's also important the inflammation ends when its role is unnecessary anymore."

The results may help explain some of the benefits of meditation known for centuries, Kipnis said. "Some mechanistic evidence is emerging, but we are just at the beginning of the journey to understand how these things work."

This study also “makes you think differently about the placebo effect,” in which beliefs and expectations in the brain lead to biologically measurable changes in the body, Tracey said.

More practically, the fact that the brain may influence inflammation is not a call to eschew painkillers. But "when we find ourselves encountering an unpleasant sensation, maybe we can be more curious about it rather than just try to make it go away," Rozenkrantz said.

Do you have a question about human behavior or neuroscience? Email BrainMatters@washpost.com and we may answer it in a future column.

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A woman’s back pain revealed a disease rare for adults

MEDICAL MYSTERIES FROM D1

released from the hospital with a plan to monitor the tumor.

But four months later, her bloating and fatigue persisted, and the mass continued to grow. The diagnosis she eventually received was much more serious, requiring treatments that caused life-changing complications. The diagnosis was also surprising, given that the condition is almost always found in young children.

Scan finds a mass

Morales, now 34, grew up healthy. She ran regularly and participated in CrossFit programs as a young adult. A cousin's Down syndrome sparked her interest in helping children with special needs, leading her to become a behavioral therapist for kids with autism.

When her back started to hurt in November 2018, she wasn't surprised, given that therapy sessions can involve lifting children and twisting on the floor. But the abdominal pain she developed made her worry. When she arrived at the ER, doctors initially thought she might have appendicitis.

A CT scan revealed a kidney mass nearly the size of a baseball, with bleeding around it. Morales was admitted to the hospital, where additional scans suggested the growth was an angiomyolipoma, doctors said. The noncancerous tumors, made of fat cells, muscle tissue and blood vessels, are somewhat common, especially in women, typically in middle age. They are often discovered when people undergo imaging tests for other reasons.

Morales said doctors assured her the problem wasn't serious. "They said it was a very vascular tumor that burst, but it's nothing to be concerned about," she said. "We trusted them."

Four days after Morales arrived at the ER, doctors performed an embolization, using a catheter to insert tiny beads of gelatin into blood vessels around the tumor to reduce the risk of additional bleeding and to try to shrink the mass. The doctors continued to refer to the tumor as a likely angiomyolipoma, even though their report from the procedure said "its appearance was not characteristic" of that.



Maria Morales and her husband, Octavio Goren.

Five days after the procedure, Morales was discharged from the hospital. Her pain subsided, but she still felt tired and her abdomen still seemed swollen.

The next month, she had clinic visits at separate health systems with two urologic oncologists, who specialize in cancers of the kidneys and the urinary system. Both agreed with the diagnosis of an angiomyolipoma and called for another CT scan in three months, with the first urologist saying it would be better to wait until the bleeding subsided so the image would be clearer.

By the time Morales next saw the first urologist three months later, in March 2019, a new CT scan showed the mass was growing. The doctor said he would

continue to monitor the likely angiomyolipoma. He considered doing a biopsy to check if the tumor might be cancerous, according to medical records, but Morales said he didn't do one. Doctors had not previously suggested she get a biopsy.

Surprising diagnosis

Morales returned to the second urologic oncologist, Mark Gonzalgo, at the University of Miami's Sylvester Comprehensive Cancer Center. Gonzalgo, noting the large size of Morales's apparent angiomyolipoma and now suspecting possible cancer, recommended removing the kidney, which would eliminate the root of the problem and allow for confirmatory testing.

But Morales and her parents, having been told by the other doctors that her condition wasn't serious, were taken aback by the idea of getting rid of her kidney. What if she developed a problem with her remaining kidney?

Gonzalgo referred Morales to an interventional radiologist, who in April 2019 did two embolization procedures, like the one performed earlier in the hospital. When a CT scan showed the mass was still getting bigger, that doctor did another embolization in June 2019.

In July 2019, an additional CT scan was troubling for two reasons. Not only was the mass continuing to grow, but lesions also appeared on her liver. Biopsies of her kidney and liver tissue

revealed that she had Wilms tumor, a type of kidney cancer found almost exclusively in children younger than 5. About 600 cases are diagnosed each year in the United States, only about 3 percent of them in adults.

The prognosis for children with Wilms tumor is good, but the outlook for adults is not as promising. A study in 2020 found that nearly 92 percent of children with the disease were alive 10 years later, compared with 70 percent of adults and roughly 52 percent of young adults.

In August 2019, Gonzalgo removed Morales's kidney and the tumor, confirming she had Stage 4 Wilms tumor that had spread to her liver. The mass had doubled in size from her initial scan nine months earlier, to the size of a large grapefruit. When Gonzalgo saw Morales in March 2019, he thought she might have renal cell carcinoma, the most common type of adult kidney cancer, though the condition is typically seen in older adults. He did not suspect Wilms tumor, which is named after the German surgeon who first described it in 1899.

"It wasn't at the top of the list, that's for sure," Gonzalgo said.

Morales doesn't have inherited genetic mutations that account for a small proportion of Wilms tumor cases, said Aditi Dhir, a pediatric oncologist at the Sylvester Comprehensive Cancer Center who treated her. She does have some family history of cancer: Her maternal grandmother died of breast cancer at age 62, and her father, a former smoker, was diagnosed with lung cancer last year.

Treatment complications

Morales received two weeks of radiation treatments and an intense regimen of chemotherapy, getting combinations of five drugs over more than a year. The infusions, overseen by Dhir and other pediatric oncologists familiar with Wilms tumor, were delivered at the cancer center's clinic for children, where nurses wore scrubs festooned with cartoons.

"It was me and a bunch of kids," Morales said.

A few weeks after the chemotherapy began, Morales's skin turned yellow. She developed veno-occlusive disease of the liver, also known as sinusoidal ob-

struction syndrome, a potentially fatal side effect of chemo and radiation. Small blood vessels in the liver become blocked, causing jaundice and a buildup of fluids.

Morales spent 10 days in intensive care, not allowed to leave her bed even to go to the bathroom. She had low levels of platelets, the blood cell fragments essential for clotting, and doctors worried movement might cause bleeding. Even today, her platelet count remains low, and she must be cautious about her activities.

The cancer treatments triggered early menopause and left Morales infertile, with ultrasounds detecting no follicles or eggs. To manage menopausal symptoms, she wears an estrogen patch and has an intrauterine device that releases progesterone. If she wants to have children, she will need to use an egg donor or surrogate.

For now, she and her husband, Octavio Goren, are uncertain about becoming parents. "I've had so much medical trauma. I don't know if I want to experience more," Morales said.

She wonders if she could have avoided the complications of her aggressive treatments if the cancer had been diagnosed earlier, before it spread. "What would my life have been like if they'd done the biopsy right away and took it out then?" she said.

Dhir said Morales's cancer has been in remission since she finished chemotherapy in October 2020.

"The five-year mark was a good celebration point," Dhir said. "The further and further she keeps going on, the lesser chances of it ever coming back."

Shortly after Morales and Goren got married in 2024, they moved to the Denver area, where they enjoy hiking, camping and exploring parks in the Rocky Mountains. They had visited Colorado in 2017, before Morales got sick, and became enamored with the scenery. When she later struggled with her cancer treatments, she vowed that if she survived, she would relocate and spend more time doing what she loves: appreciating nature.

"You can be on the highway and there's a hike right there, so we'll just stop and do it," she said. "Everything is breathtaking, no matter what angle you look at it."

My experience at the country’s first ‘grounding park’

BAREFOOT FROM D1

pool or beach, seemed odd to me. It's not that I'm averse to the outdoors — I'm an avid hiker — but the sensation of my skin touching the dirty, uneven, pokey (did I mention dirty?) ground feels uncomfortable or annoying at best, or injury-inducing at worst.

But the park is in the same mountain town where I was born and raised, and I was intrigued by the whole idea — so I decided to see what the fuss was all about.

What is ‘grounding’?

First, I called up a couple of integrative medicine experts to get more information on this whole grounding thing. It's relatively simple in terms of execution: Grounding refers to direct skin contact with the earth using either your feet or hands (for no specified amount of time). But the way it supposedly boosts your health is a bit more complex.



The author hiked barefoot to try the “grounding” or “earthing” trend, which promotes direct skin contact with soil.

Some of the research — mostly funded by companies that make them — suggests that earthing mats could reduce stress, insomnia severity and daytime sleepiness. Chiasson, who co-authored a book on grounding, "Barefoot Wisdom: Better Health Through Grounding," said there needs to be more studies dedicated to grounding (beyond company-sponsored ones), but that there is plenty of evidence to back up the basic idea that connecting physically to nature comes with wellness benefits.

"When animals get sick, they go to the ground. We know that people lie down on the ground and they feel better," she said. Research suggests that being in nature can decrease your blood pressure, improve cognitive function and potentially lengthen and improve the quality of sleep.

My experience on the Barefoot Trail

Walk-up pricing is \$15, but buying in advance online will save you a few bucks. After I entered, the briefing was short and to the point: I'd traverse the one-mile loop at my own pace, taking in the sights, sounds and sensations lining the trail. I

dropped my shoes in a cubby and departed down the trail, with dirty, exposed toes out on full display, not a plan in place.

Speaking of no plan: There's really no perceptible route to the walk. The trail is intersected with various (seemingly random) "adventure stations," including ceramic and tile-lined walkways, pits with wood chips and wine corks, climbable ladders and tires, and the occasional water bucket to splash around in. As for exertion, this trail isn't meant to get your heart rate up — it's more of a manicured walking path rather than a rugged, strenuous hike.

There are two zip lines about a quarter-mile into the trail. Given that the majority of park-goers seemed to converge there, I decided to skip them. (For me, the mental health benefits that coincide with being outdoors tend to happen when I'm alone or with very few people.)

About halfway through the trail, I came upon some black tiles organized into a spiral, with an awning overhead blocking the intense Flagstaff sun. Whether it was the peace from (finally) achieving solitude or the dizzy trance from walking in a literal circle when I followed the tiles,

my brain was quieter than when I started the trek. I circled that maze two, perhaps three, times before settling into a nearby hammock in the shade, of which there are several on the trail. There are also plenty of benches to sit and rest on.

From that point forward, I did, admittedly, feel a bit more at peace — despite the last half of the trail paralleling a busy highway. With about a quarter-mile left, I came upon a wooden "deck" station assembled with wind-chime-like accessories for making noise. This station didn't have anything to do with grounding, but it ended up being my favorite: I felt like a kid again, banging around my mom's pots and pans in the sandbox.

Could I have, theoretically, reaped the benefits of barefoot walking on my own at a local park for free? Probably. However, I appreciated the park's attention to detail, particularly when it came to manicuring the trail — at no point did anything dig into my feet. Out on a regular hiking path, and especially in a place as densely wooded as Flagstaff, you're bound to get a few scrapes from sharp pine needles or jagged lava rocks. So if you're interested in trying barefoot walking, this park would be a solid introduction to doing so safely.

As expected, my feet were filthy by the end of the walk. Luckily, the owners of the Barefoot Trail know sensory-sensitive people like me exist and provided a handy foot-washing station at the end. Of course, I gave my toes a more thorough double-scrub back at home, just for good measure.

And as for whether charged Earth electrons lowered my blood pressure and cortisol levels that day, there's no way to tell.

"I think it will be difficult to dissect out the collective good that being in nature has on our bodies," Soffer said. "Could it be these charged electrons running through our bodies? It is possible. Could it be the biogenic volatile organic compounds that plants release, we breathe in and interact with our immune system? Also possible! Could it just be being away from our phones, walking outside and breathing fresh air? Also possible. At the end of the day, I think it is all these things together."

How to find the right online therapist for you

THERAPIST FROM D3

health clinician will not appear distracted or have a lot of outside interruptions. You should be able to see and hear each other clearly. If they seem disorganized, or you do not feel they understand and are attentive to your concerns, that is a red flag.

The clinician will ask a lot of questions about you, the history of your symptoms and your current concerns. After the first meeting or two, they should share their diagnosis and treatment plan. They should be able to explain how those recommended treatments work, any potential risks and how you both will decide whether things are improving.

As online mental health care has become more available, more people are seeking care. That is a good thing, but it's important to remember that mental health care should provide a specific treatment for a specific problem. You and the practitioner you work with can't know whether you have addressed it if you haven't first defined it.

If you have any concerns, ask questions and don't be afraid to speak up. Questions about privacy, a clear diagnosis, understanding your treatment options — whatever it is, if the clinician cannot address your concerns, they are probably not a great fit for you.

Future-proof your treatment plan

Regulations for online mental health services have changed a lot in the past several years, and they are still in flux. Many Medicare plans have committed to covering remote mental health care through December 2027, but what happens after that is an open question.

The same pandemic-era regulations that expanded access to telehealth in 2020 also permitted mental health practitioners to prescribe controlled substances — medicines with higher potential for abuse or misuse, including benzodiaz-

epines or stimulants — via online care, without an in-person exam. These rules are set to expire in December, though some states already have additional laws, such as requiring an in-person visit before or during treatment.

If you take controlled substances prescribed by a clinician you see remotely, ask how they will manage potential changes in laws or regulations that affect your access to them. This might involve switching to in-person visits, transitioning to a clinician who can continue prescribing them or changing your treatment plan.

A team-based approach

No matter what kind of mental health treatment you receive, it is essential to work as a team with your primary care team and other clinicians. As a start, inform your primary care and your online mental health care clinicians about everyone who is treating you and their contact information. You may have to sign a release so that they can share information to coordinate your care.

This coordination is important because many mental and physical health conditions have overlapping symptoms. Additionally, if you take any medications to treat mental health conditions, your primary care clinician or other clinicians may be best positioned to manage any possible side effects. You may need certain lab tests or other assessments, such as vital signs or a physical exam, to safely use those medications.

Online mental health treatment can be just as effective as traditional in-person visits. In my experience, communication and teamwork are the keys to making it work.

Shari Harding is a psychiatric-mental health nurse practitioner (PMHNP) and associate professor of nursing at UMass Chan Medical School.

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